UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

Sales and Services Associate Training

Facilitator Guide

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Employee Resource Management

Sales and Services Associate Training

Facilitator Guide

United States Postal Service
Employee Resource Management
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A Commitment to Diversity

The Postal Service is committed to fostering and achieving a work and learning environment that respects and values a diverse workforce. Valuing and managing diversity in the Postal Service means that we will build an inclusive environment that respects the uniqueness of every individual and encourages the contributions, experiences and perspectives of all people.

It is essential that our work and learning environments be free from discrimination and harassment on any basis.

In our classrooms, on the workroom floor, in casual conversation and in formal meetings, employees and faculty are asked to encourage an open learning environment that is supportive of everyone.

Course materials and lectures, classroom debates and casual conversation should always reflect the commitment to safety and freedom from discrimination, sexual harassment and harassment on any prohibited basis. Instructors and class participants are expected to support this commitment.

If you find course material that is presented in the classroom or in self-instructional format that does not follow these guidelines, please let an instructor know immediately.

If classroom discussions do not support these principles please point that out to the instructor as well.

Diversity is a source of strength for our organization. Diversity promotes innovation, creativity, productivity and growth, and enables a broadening of existing concepts.

The Postal Service's policy is to value the diversity of our employees, customers and suppliers, and to do what is right for our employees and the communities we serve, thereby ensuring a competitive advantage in the global marketplace.

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Facilitator Preparation

Course Overview

- 16 eLearning modules
- 25 classroom led modules

Learning Strategies

Participants will take the 16 eLearning modules before they attend classroom training. Review modules covering the eLearning content are included in the classroom portion of this training. Resource information on the eLearning content is included in the front of the Facilitator and Participant Guides.

Course Evaluation Process

Learners will receive certification on each eLearning module as they are completing online.

Examination Process

Learners must receive a passing score on the Qualifying Exam.

Module 1: Understanding the USPS/Vision

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Define the mission and vision of the Postal Service
- Recognize the Postal Service's commitment to the security and sanctity of the mail
- Demonstrate knowledge of the 24-Hour Clock concepts

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 hour

Instructional Methods:

- Understanding the USPS/Vision eLearning course #10019885

Summary:

- Understanding the USPS

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Understanding the USPS

Our Mission: Provide trusted, affordable, universal service

Our Vision: Be profitable to deliver for future generations

The United States Postal Service touches virtually every household and business nearly every day. It has visibility and a physical presence in almost every community. It has an impact that goes far beyond its basic mission of providing trusted, affordable, universal service.

Size and Scope

Every American has access to our services and pays the same postage regardless of where they live or work. We, process and deliver more than 167.9 billion pieces of mail; letters, cards, ads, bills, payments and packages; every year.

This equates to:

- 554 million pieces per day
- 23 million pieces per hour
- 384,000 pieces per minute
- 6,400 pieces per second

The Postal Service delivers mail to more than 151 million homes, businesses and PO Boxes in every state, city and town, and in Puerto Rico, Guam, the American Virgin Islands and American Samoa.

The USPS handles 40 percent of the world's card and letter mail volume; delivering more mail to more addresses in a larger geographical area than any other post in the world.

The Postal Service does not receive tax dollars for operations. We are a self-supporting agency, using the revenue from the sale of postage and products to pay expenses.

Customers can purchase stamps at:

- More than 31,000 commercial retail outlets.
- 71,000 banking and credit union ATMs.
- 2,500 Self-Service kiosks
- The Postal Service is vital to the nation and its economy. Our vision, purpose, and direction are evident in performance and maintenance of affordable mail service to every American. We are the second largest employer in the United States today.

The Postal Service has a tradition of high performance in on-time delivery and customer satisfaction, cutting-edge automated equipment, and information technology. We are always looking for creative ways to perform our mission in the face of a changing marketplace.

Ensuring Security and Sanctity of the Mail

The Postal Service has standards of ethical conduct for all postal employees. Our commitment to trust and integrity permeates our organization, from the Postmaster General to the letter carrier you trust to secure and deliver your mail. Our long history and tradition of trust and integrity coupled with excellent customer service is tied directly to the efforts of Postal employees.

We were recognized in a national study, the 2009 Privacy Trust Study of United States Government, as the most trusted federal agency by our customers. The independent study by the Ponemon Institute involved 57 federal agencies and focused on advancing responsible information and privacy management practices within business and government.

The Postal Service preserves and protects the security of mail in its custody from unauthorized opening, inspection, or reading of content. This also covers tampering, delay, or other unauthorized acts. This is a public trust vested in each Postal Service employee.

Failure to uphold the public trust vested in each Postal Service employee may result in removal from the Postal Service as well as criminal prosecution, resulting in fines and/or imprisonment.

Corporate Strategy

The USPS must operate as a much leaner, more efficient organization. Postal prices are driven by operating costs, and reasonable postage rates are the ultimate result of sound cost management. The corporate strategy is to improve operational efficiency. The plan is to reduce the cost of meeting universal service obligations by focusing on major cost drivers, especially delivery operations.

Standardization and innovation will continue to be central to the Postal Service's cost reduction strategies. The Postal Service, through transformation, will aggressively review and update its processes, establish new standards, train its employees on best practices, and manage challenging process management objectives.

24 Hour Clock

The 24 Hour Clock is an end-to-end process to ensure mail is collected, distributed and delivered. Each process indicator of the 24 Hour Clock has been identified as an essential ingredient to service performance. Successful implementation of these processes will standardize operations and provide improved service to our customers. Effectively managing these processes will result in reduced costs and efficient operations.

One of the main purposes of tracking the 24 hour milestones is to complete the outgoing processes by the national CT (clearance time) of 2300 and move carriers to earlier completion times. Benchmarking the intermediate target times will lead to consistently achieving the goals and meeting commitments to deadlines.

The eight key indicators of the 24 Hour Clock are:

1. All carriers back by 1800 (6PM)
2. Cancel 80% of collection mail by 2000 (8PM)
3. Process outgoing primary-sort mail by 2300 (11PM)
4. Process outgoing secondary-sort mail by 2400 (midnight)
5. Clear Managed Mail Program (MMP) mail by 2400. Have zero MMP on hand at 2400 (midnight)
6. Assign commercial air/FedEx outgoing mail by 0230 (2:30AM)
7. Process all DPS 2nd-pass mail by 0700 (7AM)
8. Dispatch mail on time from plants to delivery units between the hours of 0400-0900 (4AM to 9AM)

The 24 Hour Clock is a reminder to better manage time, keep the mail moving, and provide customers with the service they expect. It is a way to provide the field with key indicators that show how each operation impacts another operation, ultimately influencing service.

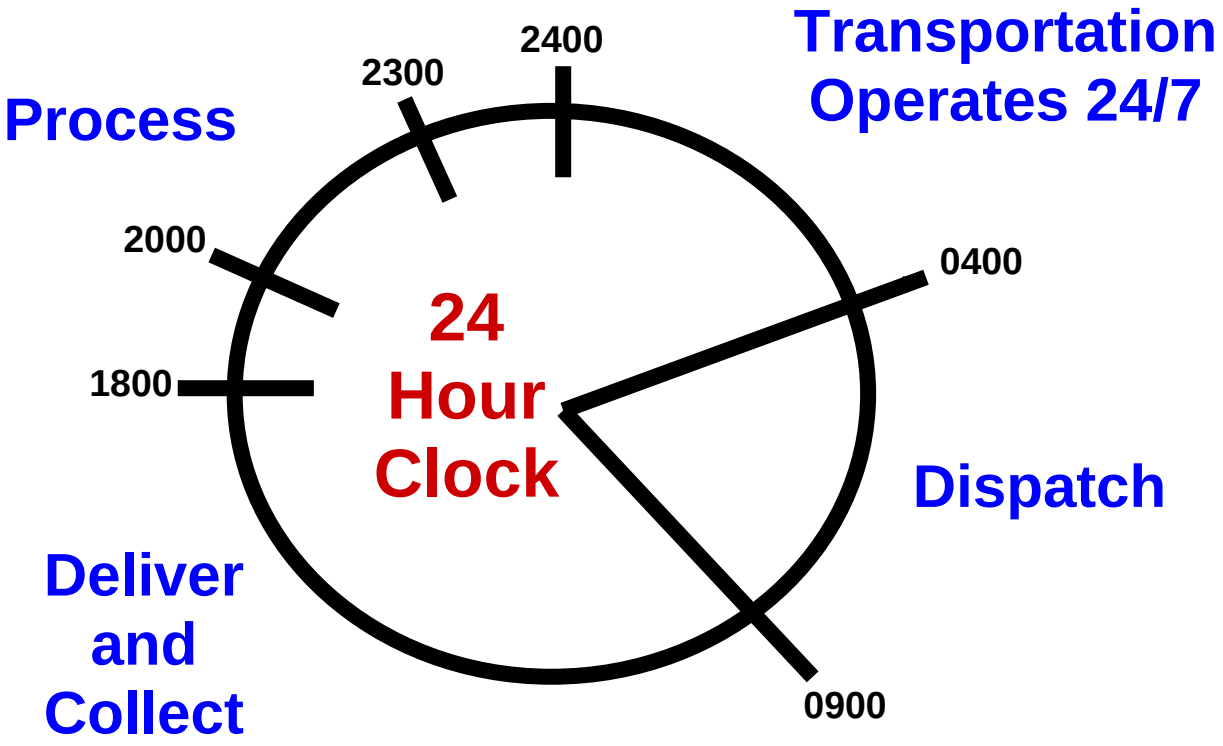

Transportation Operates 24/7
2400
2300
Process
2000
0400
24 Hour Clock
1800
Dispatch
Deliver and Collect
0900

Exhibit 1

Summary

The United States Postal Service touches virtually every household and business nearly every day. It has visibility and a physical presence in almost every community. It has an impact that goes far beyond its basic mission of providing trusted, affordable, universal service.

The Postal Service must preserve and protect the mail in its custody from unauthorized opening, inspection, tampering, delay, or other unauthorized acts such as reading of content.

The USPS must operate as a much leaner, more efficient organization. The plan is to reduce the cost of meeting universal service obligations by focusing on major cost drivers, especially delivery operations. Postal prices are driven by operating costs, and reasonable postage rates are the ultimate result of sound cost management

The 24 Hour Clock is an end-to-end process to ensure mail is collected, distributed and delivered. Each process indicator of the 24 Hour Clock has been identified as an essential ingredient to service performance. Successful implementation of these processes will standardize operations and provide improved service to our customers. Effectively managing these processes will result in reduced costs and efficient operations.

Module 2: Growing the Business

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Describe the current business environment.
- Build and maintain positive customer relationships.
- Communicate with customers, friends and family about postal shipping services including Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, International Mail, and ground services
- Utilize online products and services, including usps.com and convey the information to other customers
- Use Alternative Access Channels and share the information with all customers
- Explain your role in helping to grow the business
- Conclude that the partnerships between the Postal Service, FedEx, and UPS, are designed to grow new business, increase revenue, and improve service

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Growing the Business eLearning course #10019886

Summary:

- Today's Business
- Today's Customer
- Today's Postal Service
- Employee Roles
- Strategic Partnerships

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Today's Business

In today's world, businesses must be innovative and creative; continuously seeking new solutions, opportunities, and ways to grow the business. Managers worldwide believe that their company's number one business goal is improving the customer relationship. These relationships can be strengthened or terminated depending upon the way in which customers are treated. Customer loyalty is a key component to success and all employees, regardless of position, can contribute to that success.

The most successful and respected organizations today are bolstering customer loyalty by ensuring that the customer experience exceeds all expectations. As a result, customers are sharing these memorable experiences with friends and families, resulting in new and repeat transactions which help to grow the business.

Today's Customer

Today's customers have more information available at their fingertips than ever before. They are educated, price conscious, and with so many new choices; more demanding. Customers want value, exceptional service, assurance, and reliability.

A major business imperative is to be responsive to customer needs and expectations; striving to keep customers and making every customer experience an unforgettable one. By meeting these challenges, revenue will increase through repeat transactions and residual business from unsolicited referrals of satisfied customers.

Failing to provide total satisfaction with every business encounter will not deter customers from continuing to use shipping and mailing services; however they will take that business elsewhere. It is important to remember that a missed opportunity equals missed revenue.

True service is measured by the entire experience; from the time a customer entrusts the Postal Service with a package to the time it is delivered. Customers expect that their packages will be processed and delivered properly, timely, and in good condition. Quality end-to-end service is the key to success.

Building Customer Relationships

Maintaining excellent customer relationships help organizations attract new customers, foster customer loyalty, and increase lifetime customer value. In today's highly competitive market, employees must make every customer feel important, provide a high level of satisfaction, and enhance relationships.

Positive Attitude

The first words said to the customer set the tone for the business transaction. A friendly, positive interaction will elicit additional business. The opposite is also true, as a single negative experience can prevent a potential great customer from returning. All employees must take every opportunity to turn each interaction into a positive one; by treating customers they way they expect to be treated.

Listening

Listen with the intent to understand exactly what the customer is requesting; followed by the intent to fulfill that request. If the customer knows that they have been heard, and their needs have been met, they feel valued.

Communication

Customers want clear and concise information presented in a simple and understandable manner. Employees should be prepared to talk about products and services at a moments notice; and with potentially little time to convey the message.

Adapting to Change

Regardless of the change taking place in an organization, customers expect to receive quality service with every transaction. Meeting or exceeding those expectations is a business imperative. To that end, all employees should speak about changes in a supporting way and act on changes in a building way.

Knowledge of Products

Research has proven that customers frequently feel dissatisfied and are less likely to return when the person assisting them lacks the knowledge to provide options. Employees must be knowledgeable of all postal products and services to be able to provide solutions and reinforce that the customer has made the right choice.

Soliciting Customer Feedback

Feedback is an important part of building customer relationships. It is important to listen to customers for their concerns or recommendations. In addition to being a vehicle for comments, suggestions, and constructive feedback; it lets customers know that they are important and makes them feel valued.

Be the Best

Customers are our strength and our future and it is the responsibility of every employee to build and maintain positive customer relationships. It is crucial to show customers that their business is important and striving for excellence in every encounter proves that the Postal Service is the premier shipping company in the industry.

Today's Postal Service

Today's Postal Service offers reliability, convenience, and smart pricing; equating to a better value for customers. In the current economy, everyone is looking for a way to save money. The Postal Service can deliver reliably at a better price than the competitors; creating customers for life and a strong future for everyone, organizationally and individually.

The Postal Service has offices in every city and town; providing a presence in every community with unmatched accessibility. For the customers who can't get to a post office, usps.com provides the ability to access mailing and shipping services without having to leave home or the office. From printing labels to requesting a package pickup at their door, customers can rely on the Postal Service to be the shipping carrier of choice.

Shipping Services

Shipping Services are those in which the Postal Service is competitive with other delivery companies. These services include many of the premier products offered to the public.

Shipping Services include:

- Priority Mail Express
- Priority Mail
- Standard Post
- Parcel Return Service
- International Mail

Mailing Services

Mailing Services are those which are market dominant; with no competition in the marketplace. These include some of the traditional postal products and services that have served the American public for decades. These services include:

- First-Class Mail

- Periodicals
- Standard Mail
- Package Services Mail
  - Standard Post
  - Media Mail
  - Library Mail
- Extra Services

Online Products and Services

The usps.com website enables business owners to ship packages without leaving their desk, order shipping supplies between meetings, or find out where a customer's package is in its destination. It's all in the mail; solutions, opportunities and new ways to assist our customers.

Some products and services offered online are:

- Shipping Assistant
- Click-N-Ship
- Carrier Pickup
- Pickup On Demand
- Cardstore
- Direct Mail
- Premium Forwarding Service

Other Products and Services

The Postal Service offers other products and services to customers such as Self-Service kiosks, Stamps by Mail, Phone, and Fax, along with Forever Stamps, and Semi-Postal Stamps.

Employee Roles

The Postal Service maintains a workforce of 594,000 employees who regardless of their position play an important role in meeting customer needs and growing the business. Everyone must seek leads for sales and growth opportunities among existing customers, family members, and friends. The Postal Services' strength is in its numbers and collectively, all employees can become a powerful force by educating customers about usps.com and other postal products.

Postmasters

Postmasters are business leaders and community anchors. Business Connect allows them to make the local contacts the Postal Service needs to increase its share of the shipping market. For postmasters, recommending Priority Mail or Priority Mail Express is not a question of up selling; it's more like USPS-selling. Postmasters are doing their part, with Business Connect generating more than $609 million in annualized revenue from nearly 2 million leads.

Sales and Services Associates

Sales and services associates (SSAS) can match customers' shipping needs with premium services such as Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail; giving them personalized attention which guarantees that they will get the right service at the lowest price. SSAs can also tell customers that the new zone-based prices for Priority Mail Express offer lower prices than our main competitor does for packages five pounds and under. And the Postal Service continues to expand the number of locations where overnight service is offered.

Retail employees should tell customers with great confidence that Priority Mail packages are just as reliable as the competitors' two and three day service. You can have a great impact on service by fully understanding all products and services and using that knowledge to increase business. They can also ensure that all aspects of the Retail Customer Experience Program are met or exceeded to help drive customer satisfaction and revenue growth.

Carriers

City and rural carriers can grow the business by letting customers know about the pricing changes coming their way. Volume discounts for Priority Mail Express and discounts for purchasing postage online are just a few of the ways that the Postal Service is shaking up the shipping industry.

The Customer Connect program allows city carriers to identify small businesses that would benefit from an increased use of postal products and services. The carrier's relationship with the customer is one of the Postal Service's greatest assets which can be built upon to strengthen the organization and increase profitability.

Mail Processing Employees

Proper scanning is critical to success; so mailhandlers must continue to correctly scan all packages which arrive at the facility and again prior to being dispatched. Mail processors can ensure that sort plans are correct and the greatest depth of sort is being met. All mail processing employees should work towards meeting the indicators of the 24 Hour Clock.

Mail processing employees also have the same opportunities their retail and delivery co-workers do to generate new business. The "Submit a Lead" program, which is available through the Bluepage or LiteBlue, allows all employees to submit a sales lead for potential new business.

Supervisors

In a Processing and Distribution environment, supervisors make sure that mail is processed and dispatched as required. Supervisors ensure that employees come to work every day to meet workforce availability requirements. This is the first step towards meeting processing commitments and service standards.

Supervisors must ensure that throughput and productivity goals are attained or surpassed to achieve the goals of the 24-Hour Clock. This can be accomplished by making sure that employees are properly trained and keeping them informed of new initiatives and directives through weekly safety and service talks.

Customer Service supervisors are also responsible for guaranteeing that employees are properly trained and well informed. Delivery is an essential part of the business, and supervisors must monitor that letter carriers are leaving and returning on time which is critical to meet the service commitments promised to postal customers.

Regardless of function, supervisors should remind employees to process and deliver every piece, every day. Every piece of mail is important to someone; from a child waiting for a birthday card to a hospital technician expecting delivery of a machine part for diagnosing and treating a patient.

Maintenance

Maintenance employees are responsible for the repair and upgrades of all equipment and systems in postal facilities. Maintenance supports Processing Operations through a variety of measures; from scheduling preventative maintenance during low volume periods to responding to calls for assistance expeditiously.

Planning and performing preventive maintenance on a regular basis reduces equipment down time and helps operations to move the mail through the system in a timely manner. Properly maintained mail processing equipment will run at optimum capacity; resulting in maximum throughput and meeting or exceeding productivity goals.

Transportation

The Postal Service has the largest fleet of vehicles in the country and keeping those vehicles in good working condition is essential to the business. Transportation moves mail from one facility to another, to and from airports, and assists major mailers with transporting mail to postal facilities.

Transportation employees must ensure that collection mail arrives at the plant docks as early as possible and mail dispatched for delivery arrives at the carrier stations on time.

Transportation plays an integral role in meeting operating plan commitments and the goals of the 24-Hour Clock; which ultimately influences service. In partnership with processing and delivery operations, transportation moves the mail across the nation; helping to grow the business by providing the quality service upon which customers depend.

Strategic Partnerships

Postal Service and FedEx Partnership

To obtain more reliable service, reduce costs and manage cost growth, the Postal Service needs to use one main integrated national air transportation network with a highly reliable transportation supplier. To that end, the Postal Service has partnered with FedEx and expects savings of about $1 billion in air transportation costs with this partnership. Additionally, doubling of the previous market reach of Priority Mail Express next-day and Priority Mail one, two and three day services are expected. Since the partnership began in 2002, Priority Mail and Priority Mail Express on-time service performance has continuously increased.

Together the Postal Service and FedEx give the American consumer greater choice, flexibility, and convenience while maintaining a high standard of fast, reliable, and efficient service. Whenever the public and private sectors work together, the real beneficiary is the American public.

Postal Service and UPS Partnership

The Postal Service also has a partnership with UPS to provide airline transportation primarily for a portion of First-Class Mail; and to a lesser extent a portion of Priority Mail volumes. A new contract with UPS was signed in 2006 which will allow UPS to transport mail between 98 cities; as opposed to the original contract which only provided for mail transport between 16 cities. This newly established relationship with UPS will help to improve service levels on First-Class Mail.

Partnerships Help to Grow the Business

These partnerships are not about privatizing the Postal Service; rather they are about making the world's best Postal Service even better by enhancing service performance. Being innovative and establishing partnerships helps the Postal Service to grow the business and operate more effectively and efficiently. One of the Postal Services' strengths continues to be maintaining the most retail collection outlets (first mile) and the most door to door delivery service points (last mile). This creates an incredible opportunity for revenue growth from shipping companies such as FedEx and UPS who can also save money by allowing the Postal Service to deliver the "first mile/last mile.

Summary

In today's world, businesses must be innovative and creative; continuously seeking new solutions, opportunities, and ways to grow the business. Our company's number one business goal is improving the customer relationship. Customer loyalty is a key component to success and all employees, regardless of position, can contribute to that success.

The most successful and respected organizations bolster customer loyalty by ensuring that the customer experience exceeds customer's expectations. As a result, customers share these memorable experiences with friends and families, resulting in new and repeat transactions which help to grow the business.

Today's customers are educated, price conscious, more demanding. Customers want value, exceptional service, assurance, and reliability.

Maintaining excellent customer relationships help organizations attract new customers, foster customer loyalty, and increase lifetime customer value.

Today's Postal Service offers reliability, convenience, and smart pricing; equating to a better value for customers. In the current economy, everyone is looking for a way to save money. The Postal Service can deliver reliably at a better price than the competitors; creating customers for life and a strong future for everyone, organizationally and individually.

Presently the Postal Service maintains a workforce of approximately 546,000 employees who regardless of their position play an important role in meeting customer needs and growing the business. Everyone must seek leads for sales and growth opportunities among existing customers, family members, and friends.

To obtain more reliable service, reduce costs and manage cost growth, the Postal Service has partnered with FedEx and with UPS to make the world's best Postal Service even better by enhancing service performance. Being innovative and establishing partnerships helps the Postal Service to grow the business and operate more effectively and efficiently

Module 3: Directives

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify and describe the purpose of each of the directives available.
- Locate information on Postal Products and Services through the directives
- Describe the differences between each of the manuals
- Access handbooks, manuals, postal bulletins, and publications online

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Directives eLearning course #10021001

Summary:

- Directives

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Directives

Postal policies and procedures are an essential part of every business process. They tell our customers how to do business with us, and they give you the information you need to do your job.

Postal Service Directives are available online via the Postal Service PolicyNet Website. The manuals that you will use most often are the Domestic Mail Manual (DMM), International Mail Manual (IMM), Administrative Support Manual (ASM), Postal Operations Manual (POM), and the Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM).

Domestic Mail Manual (DMM)

The Domestic Mail Manual (DMM) sets forth the policies, regulations and procedures governing domestic mail services. Information contained in this manual includes; prices for postage and restrictions on its use, standards of the different classes of mail, and special services and conditions governing their use.

For example, a customer approaches your window and presents an odd-shaped item for mailing. You can consult the DMM to help you determine the processing category and the correct amount of postage to charge the customer.

International Mail Manual (IMM)

The International Mail Manual (IMM) sets forth the policies, regulations, and procedures governing International Mail services. The IMM is the equivalent of the DMM for International Mail.

Information contained in the IMM includes the policies and procedures pertaining to treatment of outbound mail and mailing conditions specific for each individual country. The IMM also contains an Index of Countries and Localities as well as a world map.

Administrative Support Manual (ASM)

The Administrative Support Manual (ASM) contains policies and procedures for administrative and support functions within the Postal Service.

Some of the topics covered in the ASM include; the Postal Service organization, audits and investigations, communications, facilities and equipment, and the Privacy Act.

Postal Operations Manual (POM)

The Postal Operations Manual (POM) sets forth the policies and procedures that govern operational functions of field organizations within the Postal Service. The operational functions covered are retail, philatelic, collection, mail processing, transportation, delivery, and vehicle operations.

Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM)

The Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM) sets forth the personnel policies and regulations governing employment within the Postal Service. Subjects addressed in the ELM include; employment and placement, pay administration, employee benefits, training and development, safety, health and environment, and labor relations.

Handbooks

Postal Service handbooks supplement information contained within Postal Service manuals. Handbooks include more detailed information about the topic.

Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures*, offers standardized procedures for key field accounting activities. By following the standard procedures contained in this handbook, Postal Service employees can perform financial transactions efficiently while creating consistent and accurate financial data. Many of the financial activities performed by an SSA are described in detail in the F-101.

Publications

Publications support subjects that cannot be fully addressed in manuals or handbooks. Publications appear in a variety of formats such as books, brochures, reports, etc. Generally, they do not focus on policy as extensively as manuals or on task descriptions as extensively as handbooks.

Some publications that you might use as a sales and services associate include; Publication 2, Publication 28 and Publication 52.

Publication 2, *Packaging for Mailing,* supplements the standards outlined in the DMM. PUB 2 provides mailers and postal personnel with information on how to properly package items for mailing.

Publication 28, *Postal Addressing Standards,* provides guidance on the proper way to address a mailpiece.

Publication 52, *Hazardous, Restricted, and Perishable Mail*, provides important information to help mailers and Postal Service employees determine what may be mailed and how certain items must be packaged to keep the mail safe.

Postal Bulletin

Retail updates are included in the bi-weekly Postal Bulletin. The Postal Bulletin is the official source of updates to Postal policies and procedures. The Postal Bulletin details updates and amendments to current directives.

Postal Bulletins contain; new stamp issuance information, a list of missing, lost, or stolen Postal money orders, and a list of invalid USPS Corporate Account numbers.

Forms

Postal Service forms can be accessed by clicking Forms located on the Essential Links drop down menu on the Bluepage. The Forms webpage contains electronic versions of official Postal service forms. Forms can be selected using the form title or form number.

The Forms page also provides links for access to forms at the following agencies; Office of Personnel Management (OPM), U.S. General Services Administration (GSA), Thrift Savings Plan (TSP), Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA), Office of Worker's Compensation Programs (OWCP).

Summary

Postal Service directives are available online and provide guidance on regulations for Domestic and International Mail, administrative support, personnel matters and field operational functions.

Manuals, handbooks and publications are key to providing you with the most current retail information. Use these tools as references to assist you in the functions of your job.

Module 4: Hazardous Materials (Hazmat)

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify, accept and process HAZMAT according to Department of Transportation policies
- Explain safe handling procedures of HAZMAT
- Identify key characteristics of the Prevent All Cigarette Trafficking (PACT) Act of 2009 and locate the Field Information Kit as a resource

Time Allocated for Module:

- 45 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Hazardous Materials eLearning course #10021006

Summary:

- HAZMAT

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

HAZMAT

Hazardous materials are substances or materials containing a chemical or infectious biological substance in a quantity and/or form that may pose an unreasonable risk to health, safety, or property when transported in commerce, and which pose a risk to the safety and health of USPS employees if not handled properly. Sales and services associates need to know what constitutes HAZMAT, how to identify HAZMAT, and how to safely handle HAZMAT.

You must ask the four components of the HAZMAT question for packages, bulky flats and suspicious mailpieces once during each customer transaction. Please see the classroom module, "Completing the Perfect Transaction" for more information.

What constitutes HAZMAT?

The USPS does not accept regulated quantities of hazardous materials and dangerous goods which require the display of Department of Transportation (DOT) Hazardous Material Warning Labels, with certain exceptions. See DMM and Publication 52 for examples.

Types of HAZMAT include:

- Flammable materials
- Corrosive materials
- Reactive materials
- Toxic materials
- Biological materials
- Radioactive materials

ORM-D

Most hazardous materials accepted for mailing are classified as ORM-D. ORM-D is a term developed by the Department of Transportation (DOT) that signifies the hazard class associated with a consumer commodity. ORM–D materials present the lowest level of risk during transportation.

A package marked ORM-D meets the standards for surface transportation only. The ORM–D category is unique to the United States. Its use is prohibited with international shipments of hazardous materials.

Declared / Undeclared HAZMAT

Declared HAZMAT

Declared HAZMAT is mail that is properly packaged, marked and declared by the mailer, and which is properly accepted by the Postal Service in accordance with the DMM, and Publication 52.

Undeclared HAZMAT

Undeclared HAZMAT is any parcel suspected of containing acceptable or prohibited HAZMAT as described in the DMM and Publication 52 which is not properly packaged, labeled or identified.

If you suspect that a parcel may contain hazardous chemicals or infectious substances, you should pay attention to other indicators such as the following package characteristics:

- Sound of broken glass or plastic.
- Stains leakage, or unusual odor.
- Delivery or return address information (i.e. Chemical company, Laboratory, etc.).
- Preprinted markings on parcel (i.e. bleach aerosol hair spray, etc.)
- Manufacturer's name (i.e. Joe's Chemicals, Butane Lighters R US, etc.)
- Shifting weight or liquid sound.

Non-infectious clinical specimens may be placed into sacks or flat trays/tubs that are properly closed and identified with a Tag 44. Under no circumstances should mail containing HAZMAT, including Biohazard materials, be co-mingled in sacks, pouches or containers with non-HAZMAT mail of any other class.

HAZMAT shall be separated from other mail and placed in a reliable steel container away from traffic flows. Do not place HAZMAT in a canvas hamper or in cardboard containers.

If you are uncertain as to the mailability, labeling or packaging requirements for any substance, contact your district Business Mail Entry Office or the nearest Pricing and Classification Service Center.

Prevent All Cigarette Trafficking (PACT) Act of 2009

Cigarettes and Smokeless Tobacco as Nonmailable Matter

What: The United States Postal Service cannot accept or transmit any package that it knows, or has reasonable cause to believe, contains nonmailable smokeless tobacco or cigarettes.

Cigarettes and smokeless tobacco shipments are banned from the mail if they do not fit in one of the following exceptions:

> *Alaska/Hawaii*: Shipments entirely within Alaska or Hawaii.
> *Business/Regulatory Purposes*: Shipments transmitted between verified and authorized tobacco industry businesses for business purposes or between such businesses and federal or state agencies for regulatory purposes.
>
> *Certain Individuals*: Infrequent, lightweight shipments mailed by age-verified adult individuals.
>
> *Consumer Testing/Public Health*: Shipments of cigarettes sent by verified and authorized manufacturers to verified adult smokers age 21 and over for consumer testing purposes and shipments sent by federal agencies to consumers for public health purposes.

When: A final rule to implement these changes was published in the *Federal Register* on May 27, 2010. The final rule was effective on June 29, 2010.

Why: These new rules result from the enactment of the Prevent All Cigarette Trafficking (PACT) Act which was signed by the President on March 31, 2010.

Changes: Effective January 22, 2012, the Postal Service is revising the Mailing Standards of the United States Postal Service, *Domestic Mail Manual* (DMM) 601.11 to include the new extra services Adult Signature Required and Adult Signature Restricted Delivery in conjunction with Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail as a mailing option for customers mailing cigarettes and smokeless tobacco domestically under the "Business and Regulatory" exception and Adult Signature Restricted Delivery in conjunction with Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail for the "Consumer Testing" exception.

Note: Adult Signature is already a valid service option for customers mailing cigarettes and smokeless tobacco under the "Certain Individual" exception.

Details - Key elements of the final rule: Cigarettes and smokeless tobacco are nonmailable unless an exception applies.

All accepted shipments of cigarettes and smokeless tobacco must be presented in face-to-face transactions with USPS employees (this includes shipments with postage paid online or through commercial shippers).

Carrier Pickup™ and Pickup On Demand® Service are not permitted for excepted shipments.

Customers creating postage labels using Click-N-Ship® or Shipping Assistant® must bring their packages to a Post Office (excluding any contract retail unit) for mailing.

All excepted shipments of cigarettes must bear a unique marking on the address side of the package. Each exception category has its own marking.

With the exception of shipments entirely within Alaska and Hawaii, and to APO/FPO/DPO addresses, all excepted shipments of cigarettes and smokeless tobacco must be sent via the following options:

1. Priority Mail Express ® Hold For Pickup.
2. Priority Mail Express with Adult Signature Required or Adult Signature Restricted Delivery extra service (Adult Signature Restricted Delivery only for the "Consumer Testing" exception). Available for online and commercial customers only; however, shipment must be presented to a USPS employee at a Post Office.
3. Priority Mail with Adult Signature Required or Adult Signature Restricted Delivery extra service (Adult Signature Restricted Delivery only for the "Consumer Testing" exception). Available for online and commercial customers only; however, shipment must be presented to a USPS employee at a Post Office.

For shipments from the United States to APO/FPO/DPO addresses, check the *Postal Bulletin* or the link at http://postcalc.usps.gov/Restrictions.aspx for tobacco restrictions, which apply to certain ZIP Codes, and confirm with a USPS employee that Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail with Delivery Confirmation is available to the desired destination.

When permitted, shipments of cigarettes and smokeless tobacco to APO/FPO/DPO addresses must use Priority Mail Express Military Service (PMEMS) "Priority Mail Express" or Priority Mail® with USPS Tracking . Priority Mail Express Hold For Pickup, Adult Signature Required and Adult Signature Restricted Delivery are not available for shipments to APO/FPO/DPO addresses.

Other than shipments entirely within Alaska or Hawaii, absolutely no sales transactions of cigarettes or smokeless tobacco may be sent by mail. Business/government customers sending shipments under the "business/regulatory" and "consumer testing/public health" exceptions must apply for and receive an eligibility letter from the USPS Pricing and Classification Service Center (PCSC) prior to mailing. This letter must be presented each time an excepted mailing is presented to a Postal Service employee at acceptance.

Shipments sent by business/government customers under the "business/regulatory" and "consumer testing/public health" exceptions must bear a return receipt (PS Form 3811) returnable to the PCSC PACT Mailing Office.

Delivery of cigarettes or smokeless tobacco mailed under the "consumer testing/public health" exception is restricted to the addressee, who must be at least 21 years of age.

Individuals sending shipments under the "certain individuals" exception must furnish proof of age at the time of mailing and must orally confirm that the addressee is of age to purchase tobacco at the place of destination. The operative legal age to purchase tobacco is age 18 in all states and U.S. territories and possessions, with the exception that the minimum age is 19 in the states of Alaska, Alabama, New Jersey, and Utah, and in Nassau, Onondaga, and Suffolk counties in New York.

Shipments sent under the "certain individuals" exception must be infrequent (no more than 10 shipments in any 30-day period) and weigh 10 ounces or less; however, no special weight limits apply to shipments entirely within Alaska and Hawaii.

Cigarettes and smokeless tobacco are prohibited in both inbound and outbound international mail.

Note: These rules do not apply to cigars, which continue to be mailable matter.

What you need to know:

Familiarize yourself with the contents of the Field Information Kit on the PACT Act 2009 located on the Customer Services Operations and Retail website, including service talks and other helpful information.

http://blue.usps.gov/customerservicesoperationsandretail/policyandprocedures/servicetalks/domesticservicetalks/pdf/pact_act_field_information_kit.pdf

Summary

Hazardous Materials Program represents the commitment of the U.S. Postal Service to providing a safe environment for our customers, employees, and the traveling public.

As an SSA, you play an important role in indentifying, processing accepting and rejecting items that are covered under the Hazardous Materials Program.

Hazardous materials are substances or materials containing a chemical or infectious biological substance in a quantity and/or form that may pose an unreasonable risk to health, safety, or property when transported in commerce, and which pose a risk to the safety and health of USPS employees if not handled properly.

Sales and services associates need to know what constitutes HAZMAT, how to identify HAZMAT, and how to safely handle HAZMAT.

Types of HAZMAT include flammable materials, corrosive materials, reactive materials, toxic materials, biological materials and radioactive materials.

Most hazardous materials accepted for mailing are classified as ORM-D. ORM-D is a term developed by the Department of Transportation (DOT) that signifies the hazard class associated with a consumer commodity. ORM–D materials present the lowest level of risk during transportation.

A package marked ORM-D meets the standards for surface transportation only. The ORM–D category is unique to the United States. Its use is prohibited with international shipments of hazardous materials.

Declared HAZMAT is mail that is properly packaged, marked and declared by the mailer, and which is properly accepted by the Postal Service in accordance with the DMM, and Publication 52.

Undeclared HAZMAT is any parcel suspected of containing acceptable or prohibited HAZMAT as described in the DMM and Publication 52 which is not properly packaged, labeled or identified.

If you suspect that a parcel may contain hazardous chemicals or infectious substances, you should pay attention to other indicators such as sound of broken glass or plastic, stains or leakage, or unusual odor, delivery or return address information, preprinted markings on parcel, manufacturer’s name or shifting weight or liquid sound.

Module 5: Anonymous Mail

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify, accept and process Anonymous mail according to aviation mail security policies
- Explain the procedures for accepting and handling Anonymous Mail
- Describe procedures for preventing Anonymous Mail from being introduced into the mailstream
- Explain USPS Aviation Mail Security Instructions
- Describe Anonymous Mail Labels and placement on packages

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Anonymous Mail eLearning course #10020997

Summary:

- Anonymous Mail

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Anonymous Mail

The Aviation Mail Security program represents the commitment of the U.S. Postal Service to providing a safe environment for our customers, employees, and the traveling public. The danger to life and property in the handling and transportation of Anonymous Mail is real. It is to our mutual advantage to safeguard ourselves and our property from potential hazards.

Anonymous mail is any mailpiece that bears ONLY stamps as postage, weighs more than 13 ounces and was NOT accepted by an employee at a retail service counter.

Anonymous mail is considered anonymous because it cannot be traced back to the sender.

Why is Anonymous Mail Important

The mission of the National Preparedness, Aviation Mail Security Program is to prevent anonymous mail from entering the system and promote the safety of all USPS employees, customers, and transportation networks.

Identifiable Mail

The other category of mail that must be defined and understood related to the Aviation Security Anonymous Mail Program is Identifiable Mail.

Identifiable mail is categorized as identifiable because it can be traced back to the sender or the mailpiece point of entry into the mailstream.

Identifiable mail includes postage that incorporates traceable information about the sender or stamped mail that was presented in person by a mailer at a retail window.

Identifiable mail can bear electronic postage such as Postage Validation Imprints (PVI), meter strips, PC Postage, Click-N-Ship or eStamps.

Identifiable Mail can also bear Self-Service Kiosk postage, Permit Imprints, or Aviation Security (AVSEC) Clearance Stamps.

Attachment of any of these items to the mailpiece makes the mailpiece identifiable because, if needed, the mailpiece can be traced back to the mailer or the mailpieces' point of entry into the mailstream. This will alert downstream operations that the mailpiece was accepted at a retail window and prevents it from being returned to the customer.

Standard Operating Procedures

The Aviation Security Anonymous Mail Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) explains the policies and procedures relating to the acceptance, handling, processing and transportation of anonymous mail.

Acceptance

All anonymous mail brought into your facility by carriers, collectors, or contract delivery service suppliers must be forwarded as quickly as possible to your facility's Anonymous Mail Unit (AMU). The Anonymous Mail Unit or AMU is the designated area within a facility where anonymous mail is taken for resolution. Every postal facility handling mail is required to have an AMU.

You MAY NOT apply a $0.00 PVI, postal meter strip or AVSEC Clearance Stamp to anonymous mailpieces brought into your facility by carriers, collectors or contract delivery service suppliers.

You MAY NOT apply a $0.00 PVI, postal meter strip or AVSEC Clearance Stamp to mailpieces found in unattended locations such as counters, docks; lobbies, or collection receptacles. Mailpieces found in unattended locations must be screened for anonymous mail; anonymous mail must be isolated, placarded, and expedited to the facility's Anonymous Mail Unit for processing.

If you are in doubt about how to handle a mailpiece, ask your supervisor for assistance.

Labels and Decals

In addition to the Standard Operating Procedures, the Decal DDD1-*The 13 Ounce Rule*, Label DDD2-*Important Customer Information*, and Label 127-*Surface Transportation Only* (No Fly Sticker) are used as part of the Anonymous Mail Program.

Decal DDD1

The Decal DDD1, *The 13 Ounce Rule* label is attached to all mail receptacles, lobby drops and Self-Service Kiosk collection receptacles.

The Decal DDD1 explains to mailers that mailpieces weighing more than 13 ounces bearing stamps only as postage must be taken by the customer to a retail service counter a post office in order to be mailed.

Label DDD2

The Label DDD2, *Important Customer Information* label is attached to anonymous mailpieces being returned to customers.

The label explains to customers that due to security requirements mailpieces weighing more than 13 ounces, bearing stamps only as postage must be taken by the customer to a retail service associate at a post office in order to be mailed.

Label 127

The Label 127, *Surface Transportation Only* is attached to anonymous mail being returned to customers. Label 127 is attached to ensure mailpiece is returned to mailer by surface transportation only.

The Label 127 is used in conjunction with a Label DDD2 for anonymous mailpieces being returned to the mailers.

Once a mailpiece has been confirmed to be anonymous, a Label DDD2 and a Label 127 sticker are attached to the anonymous mailpiece.

Anonymous Mailpiece Reclassified as an Identifiable Mailpiece

Mailpieces weighing more than 13 ounces and bearing only stamps as postage can be reclassified as identifiable mail only if it is delivered in person by the customer to a retail window.

In this situation you will affix a meter strip or $0.00 PVI to the item to indicate that the mailpiece has been properly accepted by an employee at a retail service counter.

If the acceptance office does not have the capability to affix a meter strip or $0.00 PVI to the mailpiece, you must apply an AVSEC Clearance Stamp to the mailpiece to indicate that it was accepted from a customer in a face-to-face transaction at a retail counter.

Mailpiece Bearing a Label DDD2

Occasionally, a customer may present an item for mailing that bears a Label DDD2, *Customer Notification Sticker*.

Employees at a retail service counter presented with a mailpiece accepted directly from a customer bearing Label DDD2 should:

- Remove Label DDD2
- Remove Label 127

Apply a $0.00 PVI, meter strip, or AVSEC Clearance Stamp as applicable adjacent to the postage stamps. The postage stamps should be cancelled with a postmark device or round-dater stamp that uses black ink and is intended for that purpose.

If customers have questions about these policies/procedures, refer them to the facilities postmaster for facility manager for assistance.

Summary

The Aviation Mail Security Program represents the commitment of the U.S. Postal Service in providing a safe environment for our customers, employees, and the traveling public. Anonymous mail procedures are mandatory and apply to all employees that handle mail. You play an important role in identifying, processing and accepting items that are covered in the Aviation Mail Security program and preventing those mailpieces from entering the mailstream.

Anonymous mail is any mailpiece that bears ONLY stamps as postage, weighs more than 13 ounces and was NOT accepted by an employee at a retail service counter.

Identifiable mail includes postage that incorporates traceable information about the sender or stamped mail that was presented in person by a mailer at a retail window.

The Aviation Security Anonymous Mail Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) explains the policies and procedures relating to the acceptance, handling, processing and transportation of anonymous mail. In addition to the Standard Operating Procedures, the Decal DDD1-*The 13 Ounce Rule*, Label DDD2-*Important Customer Information*, and Label 127-*Surface Transportation Only* (No Fly Sticker) are used as part of the Anonymous Mail Program.

Mailpieces weighing more than 13 ounces and bearing only stamps as postage can be reclassified as identifiable mail only if it is delivered in person by the customer to a retail window.

Module 6: Domestic Mail

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Sell, accept and process Domestic Mail
- Identify and explain various Domestic Mailing and Shipping Services
- Identify the features and benefits of each class/type of Domestic Mail
- Define mail standards including size and weight limitations and acceptance requirements

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Domestic Mail elearning course #10021003

Summary:

- Domestic Mail

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE computer

Domestic Mail

Domestic mail consists of items sent within the United States, its territories and possessions including Army Post Offices (APOs), Fleet Post Offices (FPOs), and the United Nations.

Mailing Services

The Postal Service offers a variety of Domestic Mailing Services to our customers. They include First-Class Mail, Periodicals, Standard Mail, Package Services, and Extra Services.

First-Class Mail

First-Class Mail consists of personal and business correspondence, bills, documents, and small packages. Any mailable item that weighs 13 ounces or less can be sent by First-Class Mail. Items sent by First-Class Mail are sealed against inspection and offer security for both the sender and the receiver.

The delivery standard for First-Class Mail is one to three business days, anywhere in the country. First-Class Mail is forwarded free for up to 12 months, and will be returned free of charge if it cannot be delivered.

Periodicals

Periodicals are authorized publications such as magazines and newspapers whose primary purpose is transmitting information. Periodicals must be published at least four times a year at a stated frequency from a known office of publication and be formed of printed sheets.

Standard Mail

Standard Mail is used to send printed matter, flyers, advertising, newsletters, catalogs and small packages.

To qualify for Standard Mail prices, customers must perform some of the work the Postal Service would otherwise do. Mailers must have at least 200 pieces or 50 pounds of pieces per mailing. A single piece of Standard Mail must weigh less than 16 ounces and customers must pay an annual presort fee at each facility where they enter mail.

Package Services

Package Services include the sub-classes; Standard Post, Bound Printed Matter, Media Mail and Library Mail.

Package Services items are not sealed against postal inspection. Each sub-class has its own content requirements and may be examined for eligibility.

The required markings for the sub-class must appear in the postage area on each mailpiece. Pieces not clearly marked as required are treated as single-piece Standard Post and are subject to additional postage as necessary.

Bound Printed Matter

Sheets must be permanently-bound by secure fastenings such as staples, spiral binding, glue, or stitching. At least 90% of the sheets must be imprinted by any process other than handwriting or typewriting. Bound Printed Matter mailpieces can weigh up to 15 pounds.

Pricing is based on weight, distance, and shape and is paid by permit imprint only. Mailers pay for postage from a permit imprint advance deposit account. Bound Printed Matter is not sold at retail.

Library Mail

Content for Library Mail is limited to books, sound recordings, academic theses, and certain other items. Advertising restrictions apply.

To qualify for Library Mail prices, items must be sent to, from or between educational organizations, museums and other qualified organizations. Items on loan from or mailed between academic institutions, public libraries, museums, and other qualified organizations can be sent using Library Mail.

The name of an educational organization, museum or other qualified organization must be shown in the address or return address of the mailpiece. Each piece can weigh no more than 70 pounds.

Media Mail

Content for Media Mail is limited to books, sound recordings, recorded video tapes, printed music, recorded computer-readable media, such as CDs, DVDs, and certain other items. Media Mail can not contain advertising except for incidental announcements of books. Each piece can weigh no more than 70 pounds.

Standard Post

Gifts and merchandise can be sent using Standard Post. Standard Post packages can weigh up to 70 pounds and measure up to 130 inches in combined length and girth.

Standard Post pricing is based on weight, distance, and shape. A surcharge is applied to certain items including parcels weighing over 35 pounds, or 25 pounds for books and printed matter, and certain shapes such as tubes, rolls, and parcels measuring over 84 inches in combined length and girth.

Extra Services

Extra Services are enhancements that provide greater security and accountability of mailpieces, for a fee, in addition to postage.

Extra Services offer Proof of mailing with Certificate of Mailing and Certified Mail, Protection in transit with Insured Mail and Registered Mail, Confirmation of delivery with COD, Delivery Confirmation, Signature Confirmation, Restricted Delivery, Return Receipt and Return Receipt for Merchandise, and Services after mailing such as Merchandise Return.

Shipping Services

Shipping Services are those products in which the Postal Service is competitive with other delivery companies. These services include many of the premier products offered to the public. Domestic Shipping Services include Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, Parcel Select, Standard Post and Parcel Return Service.

Priority Mail Express

Priority Mail Express is a class of mail with guaranteed overnight delivery to most destinations 365 days a year. Sunday and holiday delivery is available to many destinations for an additional fee. This premier product offers tracking, proof of delivery, insurance up to $100 at no cost, and a money-back on time delivery guarantee.

Priority Mail Express packaging is free to customers using the service. Priority Mail Express Flat-Rate Envelopes and Flat-Rate Boxes are available. Any amount of material that will fit in the container without reconfiguring the packaging or exceeding 70 pounds will ship at the Flat-Rate price.

Priority Mail

Priority Mail is typically used to send documents, gifts and merchandise and offers expedited one, two and three day service to most domestic destinations. There is no minimum weight for Priority Mail. However, items may not weigh more 70 pounds or measure more than 108 inches in combined length and girth.

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes allow customers to ship packages for one price regardless of the weight or domestic destination. If it fits, it ships! Only Postal Service-produced Priority Mail Flat-Rate Boxes and Envelopes are eligible for Flat-Rate prices.

Parcel Select

Parcel Select is a ground delivery service for parcels, entered in bulk, including those entered at destination facilities.

This shipping offers mailers the ability to save money by entering parcels at a Destination Delivery Unit (DDU), Area Distribution Center (ADC), or a Network Distribution Center (NDC). Parcel Select is designed for large and medium mailers.

Parcel Return Service

Parcel Return Service is the Postal Service's bulk parcel return product. Parcel Select provides a convenient way for merchants who send a large volume of parcels to receive returned merchandise from their customers.

Parcel Select service allows customers to return merchandise to merchants without paying postage. The merchant guarantees the return postage for items using Parcel Return Service. Merchandise returns are made to select return delivery units or any return bulk mail center.

Zone Charts

Zone information is used to compute Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail and Standard Post prices. Zone Charts identify the appropriate distance code assigned to each originating and destinating ZIP Code pairing for every ZIP Code in the nation.

Zone charts create a ZIP Code matrix based on origination and destination of the mailing and identify the correct zone for the distance.

Additional Pricing Considerations

Sometimes, a piece of mail requires additional postage because it is a certain shape or has characteristics that make it difficult to process on mail sorting machines. Surcharges may apply to these pieces to help ensure postage accurately reflects transportation and operational costs.

Postal surcharges include Balloon Pricing, Dimensional Weight pricing, and Oversize Pricing.

Oversize Price

The oversized price applies to Standard Post pieces that measure over 108 inches but not more than 130 inches in combined length and girth.

Balloon Price

The Balloon Pricing applies to Standard Post and Priority Mail addressed for delivery to zones 1 through 4.

Mailpieces that weigh less than 20 pounds and measure over 84 inches in combined length and girth are charged the price for a 20-pound parcel for the zone to which it is addressed.

Dimensional Weight Pricing

Dimensional Weight Pricing applies to Priority Mail packages shipped to zones 5-8 that have any dimension that exceeds one cubic foot (1,728 cubic inches).

Dimensional weight is determined by multiplying the length by the height and by the width (H x L x W). If the result is 1728 or more, divide the result by 194.

To calculate the dimensional weight for odd shaped items, multiply the length, height and width and then multiply the result by .75. If the result is 1728 or more, divide the result by 194.

The package is priced based on the higher of two weights: the actual package weight or the package dimensional weight. POS ONE can assist in calculating the dimensional weight.

Addressing, Packaging, Preparation and Sealing

Items presented for mailing must meet standards for addressing, packaging, preparation, and sealing. You must verify that these standards are met before accepting the item for mailing.

Addressing

Customers must address the mailpiece on the side that bears postage. When you inspect items for acceptance, ensure that only one delivery address is displayed. You must also ensure that the address contains all required elements; Recipient Name, Delivery Address Line, and City, State and ZIP Code Line.

The Postal Service designates the line immediately above the city, state and ZIP Code as the delivery address line. The apartment or Suite Number helps to ensure the mailpiece is delivered to the right location. If customers wish to include both a street address and a Post Office Box number, they must be placed on separate Lines.

The city, state and ZIP Code or ZIP+4 Code information is the last line of domestic addressing. The return address should be located in the upper left corner on the front of the envelope.

Packaging

The box or package used should have enough room for cushioning material around the contents. Sturdy paperboard or corrugated fiberboard boxes are best for items that weigh 10 pounds or less.

Customers mailing heavy or very high density items should pack the contents securely with a strong material for bracing to prevent shifting, and tape all the edges with reinforced tape.

Customers can purchase boxes and tubes of various sizes at most post offices. Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail boxes are available free at the post office for items sent using either of these services.

Preparation

Cushioning should be used all around the items being mailed. Customers can use newspaper, foam peanuts, or shredded paper. Customers should use foamed plastic or padding to protect fragile items, placing the cushioning inside hollow items as well.

Sealing

Customers should tape the opening of the box and reinforce all seams with 2-inch wide clear or brown packaging tape, reinforced packing tape, or paper tape. Cord, string, twine, masking or cellophane tape should not be used.

Boxes that originally contained common hazardous materials like bleach, household cleaners, and liquor must have all original markings and labels on the box removed or completely obliterated to be accepted for mailing.

Postal Service employees may not remove, cross out, or obliterate markings or labels on a mailpiece, even if directed to do so by a mailer.

Summary

The Postal Service offers a variety of Domestic Mailing services to our customers. They include First-Class Mail, Periodicals, Standard Mail, Package Services, and Extra Services.

Shipping Services are those products in which the Postal Service is competitive with other delivery companies. These services include many of the premier products offered to the public. Domestic Shipping Services include Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, Parcel Select, Standard Post and Parcel Return Service.

An item presented for acceptance into the domestic mailstream must meet certain mailability standards. Surcharges may be applied to items presented for mailing due to their shape, size or machinability.

A complete, accurate delivery address enhances the processing and delivery of mailpieces. Proper preparation of packages helps to ensure the safe delivery of mailed items.

Module 7: International Mail

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Use the International Mail Manual (IMM) to determine conditions for International Mailings
- Identify the features and benefits of different types of International Mail and mail services
- Describe the use of Extra Services with International Mail
- Identify the forms required for accepting International Mail, Global Express Guaranteed, Priority Mail Express Mail International, Priority Mail International, First-Class Mail International and First-Class Package International Service
- Accept International Mail Services

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- International Mail eLearning course #10020994

Summary:

- International Mail

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

International Mail

There are four categories of International Mail, First-Class Mail International, First-Class Package International Service, Priority Mail International, Priority Mail Express Mail International, and Global Express Guaranteed. Each category of International Mail has a specified delivery standard.

First-Class Mail International

First-Class Mail International has a delivery standard that varies by the destination. The delivery standard for Priority Mail International is 6-10 business days, Priority Mail Express International is 3-5 business days, and Global Express Guaranteed is 1-3 business days.

To find postage prices and other mailing conditions for International Mail, access the International Mail Manual (IMM). The IMM is available online via the postal services PolicyNet- pe.usps.com. The conditions for mailing overseas are listed by individual country.

Articles that are prohibited by the destination country are non-mailable. Advise customers of the items that are restricted by the destination country when mailing. Also advise customer that the mail is subject to the import requirements of that country. Items that are not acceptable for domestic mail are also non-mailable in International Mail.

First-Class Mail International encompasses airmail letter-post, post cards, letters, flats and First-Class Package International Services (packages). Pricing starts at one ounce. First-Class Mail International and First-Class Package International Service items are sealed against inspection and are subject to pricing by shape.

Addressing

You must ensure that mail addressed to international destinations is properly addressed. Many foreign postal administrations require complete sender and addressee information in Roman letters and Arabic numerals on postal items. All outbound International Mail *should* bear the complete return address of the sender.

The entire right half of the address side of the envelope, package, or card should be reserved for the destination address, postage, labels, and postal notations. The Delivery addresses must appear in ink or be typewritten. Pencil is unacceptable.

Dimensions

International First-Class Mail must be at least 5-1/2 inches in length, 3-1/2 inches in height, and .007 inches thick. The maximum weight of First-Class Mail International is four pounds.

The weight limit for letter-size First-Class Mail International is 3.5 ounces. Letter-size First-Class Mail International pieces exceeding 3.5 ounces are charged the First-Class Mail flat-size price.

To qualify for the First-Class Mail International flat price, pieces can weigh no more than 4 pounds; they must be rectangular and meet the standards for flexibility and uniform thickness in the IMM.

Flats must exceed 11 ½ inches in length or 6 1/8 inches in height or ¼ inch in thickness, and not exceed 15 inches long, 12 inches in height or ¾ inches in thickness. Pieces that do not meet these standards are charged the applicable small packet price.

Note: The length of a large envelope (flat) is the longest dimension. The height is the dimension perpendicular to the length. A First-Class Mail International large envelope (flat) that does not meet the standards in IMM 241.23 is not eligible for the large envelope (flat) size price and is charged the applicable package (small packet) price.

To qualify for the First-Class Mail International package price, pieces can weigh no more than 4 pounds. Small Packets must measure no more than 24 inches in length and 36 inches in length, height and depth combined. Packages must be large enough to accommodate the postage, address, return address, customs form and markings.

Rolls, must measure at least 4 inches in length, and at least 6-3/4 inches when the length and twice the diameter of the roll are combined. Rolls must measure no more than 36 inches in length and no more than 42 inches when the length and twice the diameter of the roll are combined.

Markings

First-Class Package International Service (FCPIS) must be marked “LETTER-POST” on the address side of the mailpiece.

When a First-Class Mail International mail is prepared, ensure that it is marked “LETTER” and “AIR MAIL/PAR AVION” or that Label 19 is affixed. There is no official mailing label, but PC postage vendors offer online labels and postage payment.

Customs Form

Shipments that weigh less than 16 ounces without potentially dutiable contents do not require a customs form.

When mailing an article that may be dutiable, the sender must use PS Form 2976, *Customs Declaration* and follow the special instructions provided in the Individual Country Listings. The maximum value for dutiable merchandise is $400.

Extra Services

Extra Services that may be available include: Certificate of Mailing, Registered Mail service, and Return Receipt. Check the Individual Country Listings in the IMM for country-specific availability and other extra services. USPS Tracking is available at no charge for FCPIS shipments completed and paid for online to select destinations.

Priority Mail Express International (PMEI)

Priority Mail Express International (PMEI) is a reliable, high-speed mail service. Specific average business days to delivery will be displayed on POS ONE terminals and will vary by mailpiece origin and destination.

Priority Mail Express International shipments containing merchandise are insured against loss, damage, or missing contents up to $200 at no additional charge. Shipments containing only non-negotiable documents are insured against loss, damage, or missing contents up to $100 at no additional charge.

This service offers a money-back guarantee to Australia, China, Hong Kong, Japan, France, Great Britain, and the Republic of South Korea. Tracking of Priority Mail Express International is also available. Customers may use all domestic Priority Mail Express packaging including the Flat-Rate Envelope for international shipping.

Priority Mail Express International offers special pricing for pieces destinating in Canada and Mexico and separate pricing to all other countries. Use Price List, Notice 123 for a list of current prices.

Customers who purchase postage online receive postage incentives. Coins, jewelry, watches, and other valuables are prohibited in Priority Mail Express International.

Global Express Guaranteed

To identify the weight limit for a Global Express Guaranteed shipment, check the Individual Country Listing. The maximum for any shipment is 70 pounds. Check the Individual Country Listing for Global Express Guaranteed service to find dimension standards for each country.

Customers must prepare the mailpiece as a large envelope (flat) or package using either the Global Express Guaranteed envelope provided by the Postal Service or customer-supplied packaging.

Dimensions

Maximum size and weight dimensions for Priority Mail Express International service vary by country and are noted in the Individual Country Listings found in the IMM. The maximum weight limit for any Priority Mail Express International shipment is 70 pounds.

Maximum dimensions for any shipment may not exceed 46 inches in length, 35 inches in width, 46 inches in height, or a combined length and girth of 108 inches.

Customs Forms

Complete the Global Express Guaranteed Air Waybill/Shipping Invoice (Item 11FGG1), and if applicable, PS Form 6182. Enclose both items into PS Form 2976-E, *Customs Declaration Envelope* and affix the envelope to the address side of the mailpiece. Refer to the POS ONE or *GXG Service Guide,* May 2007 for required use information.

Priority Mail International (PMI)

Priority Mail International (PMI) is a reliable, cost-effective way to send documents and merchandise. PMI is designed for outbound international postal parcels and has 6-10 average business day delivery with tracking to major destinations.

Limited indemnity coverage is included at no extra charge on all PMI parcels. The PMI Small Flat Rate Boxes or PMI Flat Rate Envelopes are considered letter post items and do not come with the free limited indemnity coverage. Coverage is limited to the maximum indemnity based on the weight of the article or to the actual value of the contents, whichever is less.

Priority Mail International service offers special pricing for Canada and separate pricing to all other countries. All domestic Priority Mail Flat-Rate packaging can be used for international shipping.

There is a 4 pound weight maximum for the Flat-Rate Envelope and small Flat-Rate Box. These mailpieces must bear a properly completed PS Form 2976, *Customs Declaration* and may not exceed $400 in value. There is no tracking or insurance available for the Small Flat –Rate Boxes or Flat-Rate Envelope. However, USPS Tracking is available for these items when done online to select destinations.

The regular, medium, and large Flat-Rate Boxes have a 20 pound weight maximum limit. Ordinary and insured parcel weight limits vary by country and are noted in the Individual Country Listings, but may not weigh more than 70 pounds.

Extra Services

The Extra services that are available may depend upon the type of item mailed and the specific country of destination. Extra Services that may be available include: Certificate of Mailing service, Registered Mail service, and Insured Mail service. Check POS ONE or the IMM for country-specific availability.

Customs Form

All International mailpieces must bear a properly completed PS Form 2976-A, *Customs Declaration and Dispatch Note.*

Summary

This chart provides you with a summary of the services that are available for each class of International Mail. Please note that some services vary depending on the destination country.

USPS International Shipping Options

	Global Express Guaranteed (GXG)	Priority Mail Express International (PMEI)	Priority Mail International (PMI) Variable Weight Parcels & Medium or Large Flat Rate Boxes	Priority Mail International (PMI) Small Flat Rate Boxes & Envelopes Max. Weight 4 lbs. Max. Content Value $400	First-Class Package International Service (FCPIS) Max. Weight 4 lbs. Max. Content Value $400
					
Delivery	1 to 3 Business Day Delivery	3 to 5 Business Day Delivery	6 to 10 Business Day Delivery	6 to 10 Business Day Delivery	Varies by Destination
Date-Certain Delivery	With Money-Back Guarantee to All Destinations	With Money-Back Guarantee to Select Destinations	Not Available	Not Available	Not Available
Insurance	Includes $100	Includes $200 for Merchandise and $100 for Documents	Includes Indemnity Insurance Available for a Fee.	Not Available	Not Available
Customs Forms	GXG Commercial Invoice (CI) PS Form 6182	PMEI 2976-B or Online Combined Label and Customs Form	PMI 2976-A or Online Combined Label and Customs Form	PS Form 2976	PS Form 2976
Tracking	Use GXG Air Waybill Number	Use 2976-B or Online Combined Label and Customs Form Number	Use 2976-A or Online Combined Label and Customs Form Number	Use Online – Only Customs Form number to most major destinations	Use Online – Only Customs Form number to most major destinations

In this lesson we have discussed how to access the IMM to determine conditions for mailing internationally, the features and benefits of the different types of International Mail, and the use of Extra Services with International Mail

In this lesson we also described the forms that are required when accepting First-Class Mail International, Priority Mail International, Priority Mail Express International and Global Express Guaranteed service.

Module 8: Priority Mail Express

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Sell and accept Priority Mail Express items
- Identify the features and benefits of Priority Mail Express Services
- Verify that the customer has completed the applicable portions of the Priority Mail Express label
- Complete the applicable SSA portion of Priority Mail Express labels and place Priority Mail Express labels on packages

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Priority Mail Express eLearning course #10021004

Summary:

- Priority Mail Express

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Priority Mail Express

Priority Mail Express offers guaranteed on-time 1-Day or 2-Day delivery 365 days per year with expedited handling from the time of acceptance through delivery of the mailpiece. Priority Mail Express includes:

- Insurance coverage up to $100 free of charge. Additional insurance is available for purchase.
- Free USPS Tracking
- No extra charge for Saturday delivery
- Online price incentives at USPS.com.
- Sunday and holiday Guaranteed Delivery is available for an additional fee

Priority Mail Express services include Priority Mail Express Post Office to Addressee (1-Day or 2-Day depending on origin and destination ZIP Codes), and Priority Mail Express Military Service (PMEMS).

1-Day Delivery

Priority Mail Express items must be mailed by a certain time to meet the delivery commitment. This is called the drop-off or cut-off time. Customers can still send the item after the drop-off time; however, the same service guarantee will not be available.

Priority Mail Express 2-Day Delivery

Priority Mail Express 2-Day delivery items are delivered to the addressee 3 p.m. on the second delivery day.

Customers who send Priority Mail Express items can have their shipments held securely at any one of our 31,000 post offices to await pickup.

Recipients can pick up their packages when it's convenient for them. Hold for Pickup (HFPU) service includes an automated callback notification to customers about the arrival status of their package.

Priority Mail Express Military Service (PMEMS)

Priority Mail Express Military Service (PMEMS) is available between the United States and designated APO/FPO addresses to provide military personnel stationed overseas, and others entitled to APO/FPO mailing privileges, an expedited delivery service to or from the United States.

Priority Mail Express Labels

Priority Mail Express Label 11-HFPU, *Hold for Pick Up*, is used by customers sending Priority Mail Express shipments that will be held for pickup at the location identified on the label.

Priority Mail Express Label 11-B, *Post Office to Addressee*, is used by customers sending shipments that will be delivered to the recipient's address.

Both labels are a multi-copy form consisting of the mailing label, customer copy, and addressee copy. Labels are available at any Post Office, and can also be generated by customers online and at Self-Service kiosks.

When accepting Priority Mail Express, you must verify that the customer has properly completed the required sections of the Priority Mail Express Label. These sections are designated FOR CUSTOMER USE ONLY.

After verifying that the Customer's section of Label 11-B or Label 11-HFPU is properly complete, you must complete the ORIGIN POSTAL SERVICE USE ONLY section of the form.

When the Priority Mail Express Hold For Pickup (HFPU) shipment arrives at the designated Hold for Pickup location, you, as the receiving employee, will complete the DESTINATION POST OFFICE section.

Packaging

Priority Mail Express envelopes and boxes are available to customers free of charge at local post offices or by ordering them online at usps.com Regardless of how the packaging is reconfigured or how markings may be obliterated, any matter mailed in Priority Mail Express packaging is charged the appropriate Priority Mail Express price.

The Priority Mail Express Flat-Rate Envelopes and boxes eliminate the need for weighing and calculating postage. If it fits, it ships!

Extra Services

Customers can add Extra Services to their Priority Mail Express item for an additional fee. The Extra Services that are available with Priority Mail Express are Return Receipt, additional Insurance, and Collect on Delivery (COD).

Commercial Base Pricing

Customers who ship a high volume of Priority Mail Express may be eligible for Commercial Base Pricing incentives when they use approved shipping services. Approved shipping services include: Click-N-Ship, USPS Corporate Account (USPSCA), Federal Agency Account, or a Postage Evidencing System such as Endicia, Stamps.com, Pitney-Bowes, or eBay.

Commercial Base price incentives apply to postage only. These discounts are not offered on extra services such as the Sunday and Holiday delivery premium. Most Commercial Base Pricing shipments can be identified by the marking COMMERCIAL BASE PRICING on the postage label.

Scanning and Priority Mail Express Hold For Pickup (HFPU)

The mailpiece barcode is scanned upon arrival at unit, and scanned again upon arrival at pickup point. The Date Received information is entered in the Date and Time Received sections and the receiving employee enters their initials. The scan triggers an automatic notification to the recipient identified during the acceptance transaction.

When the recipient, or their designee, picks up the Priority Mail Express Hold For Pickup (HFPU) shipment at the designated Hold for Pickup location, scan the shipment as delivered and then complete the PICKED UP BY ADDRESSEE section, by entering the month, day, year, time of pickup and your initials.

Refunds

If service commitments are not met, an Priority Mail Express refund may be issued upon customer's request. Exceptions to the refund policy are listed on the reverse side of Label 11-B, Customer Copy.

Refunds are not made if the delay was caused by the proper detention of the Priority Mail Express article for law enforcement purposes, any strike or work stoppage, the late deposit of the Priority Mail Express article by the customer, if the article must be forwarded, if the article is returned to sender, if the delivery address is incorrect or has an incorrect ZIP Code, or if flights used for transportation are delayed or cancelled.

In addition, no refund is paid when governmental actions, beyond the control of the Postal Service or air carriers, war, insurrection, or civil disturbance, or the breakdown of a substantial portion of the Postal Service transportation network, or acts of God result in delivery delays.

Summary

Priority Mail Express is a premium service offered by the Postal Service that offers guaranteed on-time Next Day or Second Day delivery 365 days per year with expedited handling from the time of acceptance through delivery of the mailpiece. Priority Mail Express includes insurance coverage up to $100 free of charge, free USPS Tracking, signature upon request , no extra charge for Saturday delivery, online price incentives at usps.com and Sunday and holiday Guaranteed Delivery is available for an additional fee.

Priority Mail Express envelopes and boxes are available to customers free of charge at local Post Offices or by ordering them online at usps.com.

Priority Mail Express Flat-Rate Envelopes and boxes eliminate the need for weighing and calculating postage. If it fits, it ships!

Customers can add Extra Services to their Priority Mail Express item for an additional fee. The Extra Services that are available with Priority Mail Express are Return Receipt, additional Insurance, and Collect On Delivery (COD).

Customers who ship a high volume of Priority Mail Express may be eligible for Commercial Base Pricing incentives when they use approved shipping services.

Module 9: Priority Mail

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Sell, accept and process Priority Mail
- Identify and explain various Priority Mail Services
- Identify the features and benefits of Priority Mail Products
- Define mail standards including size and weight limitations and acceptance requirements

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Priority Mail eLearning course #10020995

Summary:

- Priority Mail
- Dimensional Weight
- Priority Mail Flat-Rate Shipping
- Commercial Base Pricing
- Extra Services

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Priority Mail

Priority Mail is a Postal Service premier product typically used to mail documents, gifts and merchandise. Priority Mail offers expedited 2 to 3 day service to most domestic destinations. Large or thick envelopes, tubes or packages containing mailable items can be sent using Priority Mail.

Priority Mail customers have a wide selection of Priority Mail products from which to choose. Distinctive Priority Mail envelopes and boxes in a variety of sizes are available to customers at no cost. Priority Mail provides high value shipping solutions to a broad range of customers.

Customers do not pay extra for residential delivery, extended area delivery, additional handling, address corrections, or missing or incorrect account numbers.

Weight and Size Standards

Priority Mail is subject to weight and size standards. There is no minimum weight for Priority Mail. However, items may not weigh more 70 pounds or measure more than 108 inches in combined length and girth.

Surcharges

Priority Mail is subject to Balloon Pricing and Dimensional Weight Pricing for lightweight and odd-shaped Priority Mail pieces.

Balloon Pricing

The Balloon Price is charged for packages that are both large and lightweight to better align postage with transportation costs. The Balloon Price applies to Priority Mail addressed for delivery to zones 1 through 4.

Mailpieces that weigh less than 20 pounds and measure over 84 inches in combined length and girth are charged the price for a 20-pound parcel for the zone to which it is addressed.

Dimensional Weight

Dimensional Weight Pricing applies to Priority Mail packages shipped to zones 5-8 that exceed one cubic foot (1,728 cubic inches).

Dimensional Weight Pricing helps to ensure that the postage charged accurately reflects transportation and operational costs when a package is large in size and takes up a lot of a space.

Dimensional weight is determined by multiplying the length by the height and by the width (H x L x W). If the result is 1728 inches or more, divide the result by 194.

To calculate the dimensional weight for odd shaped items, multiply the length, height and width and then multiply the result by .75. If the result is 1728 or more, divide the result by 194.

The package is priced based on the higher of two weights: the actual package weight or the package dimensional weight. For example, a large box containing a pillow would be subject to Dimensional Weight Pricing because cost is based on cubic size, not just package weight.

POS ONE can assist in calculating the dimensional weight.

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Shipping

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes allow customers to ship packages for one price regardless of the weight or domestic destination. If it fits, it ships! Only Postal Service-produced Priority Mail Flat-Rate Boxes and Envelopes are eligible for Flat-Rate prices.

Distinctive Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes are available at no cost in eco-friendly and a variety of sizes. Priority Mail Flat-Rate Boxes are available in, small, two differently shaped medium sizes, and one large box. Only Postal Service-produced Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes are eligible for flat rate prices.

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelope

There are a total of six Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes that can be shipped for a Flat-Rate price regardless of whether or not they bear Flat-Rate markings.

Priority Mail Small Flat-Rate Box

The Priority Mail Small Flat-Rate Box is about the same size and shape as three stacked DVD cases. It’s just right for jewelry, electronics, event tickets, paperback books, and other small items.

Priority Mail Medium Flat-Rate Boxes

Priority Mail Medium Flat-Rate Boxes are available in two sizes. Box 1 is flatter in shape, and is ideal for shipping a shirt or pair of pants, board games, books and other thinner items. Box 2 is taller and is made for shipping a pair of shoes, model cars, hard cover books, and other taller items.

Priority Mail Large Flat-Rate Box

The Priority Mail Large Flat-Rate Box has 50 percent more capacity than the Medium Flat-Rate Boxes. Priority Mail Large Flat-Rate Boxes allow mailers of smaller items to consolidate shipments on multiple orders and save on shipping costs.

A special version of the Priority Mail Large Flat-Rate Box, the Priority Mail APO/FPO Flat-Rate Box, featuring the "America Supports You" logo, is available for customers shipping to APO/FPO addresses. This box is featured at a lower price than the standard Priority Mail Large Flat-Rate Box.

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes

Any amount of material, up to 70 pounds, may be mailed in a Postal Service-produced Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelope or Box.

When sealing a Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelope or Box, the container flap must be able to close within the normal folds. Tape may be applied to the flaps and seams to reinforce the container; provided the design of the container is not enlarged by opening the sides and the container is not reconstructed in any way.

Packaging and Postage Options

In addition to Priority Mail packaging available at the Post Office, a customer may order different shapes and sizes of Priority Mail Envelopes and Boxes at usps.com. Customers can pay for Priority Mail postage and print Priority Mail labels online using Click-N-Ship.

Customers may also use their own packaging or ReadyPost® supplies for Priority Mail shipments. These mailpieces must be labeled as Priority Mail using official Priority Mail labels and tape.

Commercial Base Pricing

Customers who ship a high volume of Priority Mail may be eligible for Commercial Base Pricing incentives when they use approved shipping services. Approved shipping services include: Click-N-Ship or a Postage Evidencing System such as Endicia, Stamps.com, Pitney-Bowes, or eBay.

Commercial Base price incentives apply to postage only. Most Commercial Base Pricing shipments can be identified by the marking COMMERCIAL BASE PRICING on the postage label.

When a customer presents Priority Mail items marked COMMERCIAL BASE PRICING on the postage label, the mail is processed as being properly paid, providing that the weight on the package matches the scale weight. You must verify that the weights match.

Extra Services

Extra Services may be added to a Priority Mail item for an additional fee. These services provide greater security and accountability for mail, convenience to the mailer, or improved handling. These Extra Services include, Certificate of Mailing, Certified Mail, Collect on Delivery (COD), USPS Tracking, Insured Mail, Registered Mail, Restricted Delivery, Return Receipt, Return Receipt for Merchandise, Signature Confirmation, and Special Handling.

Summary

Priority Mail is a Postal Service premier product and is typically used to send documents, gifts and merchandise. Priority Mail offers expedited 2 to 3 day service to most domestic destinations. Large or thick envelopes, tubes or packages containing mailable items can be sent using Priority Mail.

Priority Mail customers have a wide selection of Priority Mail products from which to choose. Distinctive Priority Mail envelopes and boxes are available to customers at no cost, in a variety of sizes, providing high value shipping solutions to a broad range of customers.

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes allow customers to ship packages for one price regardless of the weight or domestic destination. If it fits, it ships! Only Postal Service-produced Priority Mail Flat-Rate Boxes and Envelopes are eligible for Flat-Rate prices.

Priority Mail is subject to weight and size standards. There is no minimum weight for Priority Mail. However, items may not weigh more 70 pounds or measure more than 108 inches in combined length and girth. The Balloon Price and Dimensional Weight Pricing may apply to lightweight and odd-shaped packages.

Extra Services may be added to a Priority Mail item for an additional fee. These services provide greater security and accountability for mail, convenience to the mailer, or improved handling. Customers can pay for Priority Mail postage and print Priority Mail labels online using Click-N-Ship. Commercial Base Pricing incentives are available for qualified customers.

Module 10: Confirmation Services

Objective:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Sell, accept and process USPS Tracking and Signature Confirmation Services
- Identify the features and benefits of USPS Tracking and Signature Confirmation Services
- Explain the Extra Services combined with each type of Confirmation Services
- Describe Confirmation Services Receipts and placement of Confirmation Services forms

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Confirmation Services eLearning course #10021000

Summary:

- Confirmation Services

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Confirmation Services

Confirmation Services provide the customer with delivery information on their mailpieces for a fee in addition to postage. These services include USPS Tracking and Signature Confirmation.

USPS Tracking Service and Signature Confirmation Service may be used with parcels mailed as First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, and Package Services. USPS Tracking for Parcel Select and Standard Mail parcels is only available when they are mailed using the electronic option.

Signature Confirmation Service and USPS Tracking Service may be purchased at a Post Office, online at USPS.com, or at a, Self-Service Kiosk.

USPS Tracking Service

USPS Tracking Service may be used with parcels mailed as First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, Standard Mail, and Package Services. USPS Tracking for Parcel Select and Standard Mail parcels is only available when mailed using the electronic option.

USPS Tracking Service and Signature Confirmation Service provide customers with the date, ZIP Code, and the time the article was delivered. If delivery was attempted, the customer will receive a notice with the date and time of attempted delivery.

USPS Tracking Service is available for mail sent to domestic and most APO/FPO destinations. USPS Tracking Services is also available for mail sent to any United States territory or its possession as defined in the Domestic Mail Manual (DMM).

When postage and additional fees are paid, USPS Tracking Service may be combined with Registered Mail, Domestic Insured Mail, Collect on Delivery (COD), Return Receipt for merchandise, and Special Handling.

USPS Tracking may also be combined with Return Receipt and Restricted Delivery if it is also purchased with either Registered Mail, Insurance over $200, or COD and postage and additional fees are paid and specific requirements are met.

Signature Confirmation Service

Signature Confirmation Service provides customers with an added level of security by requiring a signature from the person who accepts the package.

Signature Confirmation Service is available for Domestic Mail parcels and may be used with First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, Package Services, and Parcel Select. Signature Confirmation is not available for mail addressed to APO/FPO destinations or any U.S. territory or possession.

When postage and additional fees are paid, Signature Confirmation Service may be combined with Registered Mail, Insured Mail, Collect on Delivery (COD), and Special Handling.

Signature Confirmation Service may be combined with Restricted Delivery if it is also purchased with either Registered Mail, Insurance over $200, or COD if postage and additional fees are paid and specific requirements are met.

Retail and Electronic Pricing

The pricing for Confirmation Service varies based on how the service was purchased; retail versus electronic. The two fees are designed to meet a variety of customer's needs, making Confirmation a convenient and easy-to-use service.

Signature Confirmation and USPS Tracking retail prices are available for purchase at any Post Office. These services must be purchased at the time of mailing.

An Electronic Option is available for customers who purchase Signature Confirmation Service or USPS Tracking Service online at usps.com or they may obtain an authorized electronic link from the Postal Service to send and receive Signature confirmation information electronically.

Customers can print their own ELECTRONIC RATE APPROVED Confirmation barcode labels or use printed barcode labels, Label 315 for Signature confirmation or PVI Tracking label or Label 400 at manual offices for USPS Tracking, provided by the Postal Service.

Forms

You must properly complete the receipt portion of PS Form 153, *Signature Confirmation*, when a Signature Confirmation item is presented at your counter and PVI Tracking label or Label 400 at manual offices, when a USPS Tracking item is presented.

The self-stick barcoded label portion of the forms are attached to the mailpiece and the detachable mailing receipt portion containing the Signature Confirmation Number or USPS Tracking Number, toll-free number, website address, and information on delivery service is provided to the customer.

Place USPS Tracking or Signature Service labels on the address side of the mailpiece, above the delivery address and to the right of the return address. Alternatively, you may place it to the left of the delivery address.

When placing USPS Tracking or Signature Service labels, do not bend it around the package's edge. On odd-sized packages, such as tubes, place the label so that the barcode is horizontal to the length of the package. Do not place the label vertically or cover the barcode with tape or plastic wrap.

Fees

When mailing items with Signature and USPS Tracking Services, customers must pay the USPS Tracking Service fees in addition to postage and fees for any other Extra Services they request.

You can accept postage stamps, meter stamps, or a withdrawal from a permit imprint account as methods of payment. Precanceled stamps are not permitted as postage payment for USPS Tracking Service fees.

Summary

Confirmation Services provide customers with delivery information on their mailpieces for a fee in addition to postage. These services include USPS Tracking, and Signature Confirmation.

Confirmation Services fees, plus postage must be collected at the time of mailing. Certain Extra Services may be combined with Confirmation Services as long as fees are paid and specific requirements are met.

Confirmation Service labels must be properly completed and placed on the package for visibility and scanning. Retail refunds for Extra Services combined with Confirmation Services cannot be collected without the original postmarked receipt.

Customers may choose either the retail or electronic option to purchase Confirmation Services.

Module 11: Insured Mail

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Sell, accept and process Domestic and International Insured Mail Services
- Identify the features and benefits of Insured Mail
- Describe and process Extra Services available with Insured Mailings
- Describe Insured Mail Receipts and placement of Insured Mailing forms
- Describe Insured Mail forms, record keeping, and holding periods

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Insured Mail Service eLearning course #10021007

Summary:

- Insured Mail

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Insured Mail

Insured Mail Service provides indemnity coverage for merchandise sent through the mail if the item is damaged, or lost while in the possession of the Postal Service. The Postal Service provides reimbursement for the actual value (less depreciation) of the articles at the time of mailing, repair costs, or the insurance amount purchased, whichever is less.

Insured Mail service may be purchased up to $5,000. The price of the insurance is based on the declared value of the merchandise.

Mailing Services

Insurance may be applied as an Extra Service to Priority Mail, First-Class Mail, Standard Mail parcels, and Package Services. Additional insurance may also be purchased for Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail.

Insured Mail service is available for purchase with First-Class Mail if the mailpiece contains items mailable as Standard Mail, Standard Post or Package Services, or is a small package weighing 13 ounces or less.

Extra Services

Insured Mail service may be used in conjunction with USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, Special Handling, Parcel Airlift Service (PAL), Return Receipt for Merchandise, Return Receipt, and Restricted Delivery.

Purchase Options

Insurance can be purchased at any Post Office, Self-Service Kiosk or online.

Customers may purchase up to $5,000 indemnity coverage when insurance is purchased at a Post Office. Up to $5,000 indemnity coverage may also be purchased at an Self-Service Kiosk or through usps.com. Insurance purchased online, or at a Self-Service Kiosk cannot be combined with insurance purchased at a Post Office.

Forms

When your customers purchase insurance, you must document the purchase of insurance using PS Form 3813, *Domestic Insured Mail Receipt* or PS Form 3813-P, *Domestic Insured Mail Receipt.*

PS Form 3813 is used for items insured for $200 or less. The form includes a barcode label and a detachable customer receipt. No signature of receipt is required or obtained at the time of delivery.

PS Form 3813-P, *Insured Mail Receipt,* is a blue two-part form that includes a barcode label and a detachable customer receipt. Use this form for items insured for over $200 up to $5,000. A signature of receipt is obtained at the time of delivery.

You must properly complete the customer receipt portion of both PS Form 3813 or PS Form 3813-P when the mailpiece is presented for mailing at the retail counter.

It is the customer's responsibility to complete the "Sent to" section at the bottom of the receipt. The customer must retain the original receipt in the event that a claim for damage is filed.

Place PS Form 3813 or PS Form 3813-P on the address side of the mailpiece above the delivery address and to the right of the return address. Alternatively, you may place it to the left of the delivery address.

Fees

You can accept postage stamps, meter stamps, or a withdrawal from a permit imprint account as methods of payment. Pre-canceled stamps are not permitted as postage payment for Insured Mail service fees.

Delivery of Insured Items

When customers pick up insured items at your window, you must ensure that all delivered insured items are scanned. If the item is insured for over $200, you must also obtain the recipients signature of receipt. A record of delivery is maintained in your office.

If a carrier attempts to deliver an insured item and is unable to complete the delivery, a PS Form 3849, *Sorry We Missed You!* notice is left at the delivery address. A second or final notice is issued five calendar days from the first delivery attempt of the insured mailpiece.

The insured mailpiece is returned to the sender if it is not claimed within fifteen days from first attempted delivery. The item is not returned to the sender if a mailer endorsement indicates otherwise.

If an insured item is lost or damaged in transit, customers may file a claim for the item at their local Post Office, online at usps.com, or by mail.

Summary

Insured Mail provides indemnity coverage for merchandise mailed if it is damaged, lost, or missing items while in the possession of the Postal Service.

Customers can insure a mailed item for up to $5,000 against loss, damage, or theft. Insurance covers only what the contents are worth, the actual value at the time and place of mailing.

Attach PS Form 3813 or PS Form 3813-P to Insured Mail items and ensure that the forms are properly completed and placed.

Customers may purchase insurance at any post office, Self-Service Kiosk or online at usps.com. Extra Services may be combined with Insured Mail.

Insurance claims for items lost or damaged in transit may be filed at the local Post Office, online at USPS.com, or by mail.

Module 12: Certified Mail

Objective:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Describe and explain the features and benefits of Certified Mail
- Properly accept Certified Mail items

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Certified Mail eLearning course #10020998

Summary:

- Certified Mail

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Certified Mail

Certified Mail service provides customers with proof of mailing and the date and the time the item was delivered or delivery was attempted. Insurance is not included. Certified Mail service must be requested at the time of mailing.

Certified Mail may only be combined with domestic First-Class Mail and Priority Mail. Certified Mail service can be used for mailpieces destined for APO and FPO addresses. Customers may add both Restricted Delivery Service and Return Receipt Service to Certified Mail items.

PS Form 3800, *Certified Mail Receipt*

PS Form 3800, *Certified Mail Receipt*, is a two–part barcoded form that provides a mailing receipt with a unique identifier number. The receipt portion of PS Form 3800, *Certified Mail Receipt*, must be completed when the mailpiece is presented at the retail counter.

Calculate the postage and applicable fees and enter the information on the PS Form 3800 and then round date stamp in the POSTMARK HERE section. Ensure that sufficient postage is affixed to the mailpiece. If requested, you can also indicate the time the article was accepted on the receipt.

PS Form 3800 Placement

Affix the self-stick label section of the receipt and applicable Extra Services labels to the mailpiece. It is the customer's responsibility to complete the "Sent To" section of the receipt. Advise the customer to retain the original receipt for their records.

PS Form 3800 must be placed on the address side of the mailpiece above the delivery address and to the right of the return address or to the left of the delivery address. PS Form 3800 is folded on the dotted line over the top edge of the mail item.

PS Form 3877, *Firm Mailing Book for Accountable Mail* may be used to record multiple mailings for a single transaction.

Fees

When mailing Certified Mail items, customers must pay the Certified Mail fees in addition to postage and fees for any other Extra Services they request. You can accept postage stamps, meter stamps, or a withdrawal from a permit imprint account as methods of payment. Pre-canceled stamps are not permitted as postage payment for Certified Mail service fees.

Delivering Certified Mail

Obtain a signature from the addressee when delivering a Certified Mail item. The addressee must sign PS Form 3849, *Delivery Notice/Reminder/Receipt* or PS Form 3883 is used for addresses that receive an average of six or more pieces at of Certified Mail at one time. PS Form 3811, *Return Receipt*, when it is affixed to the individual mailpiece.

If delivery of the Certified Mail item is attempted, but not completed, a PS Form 3849, *Delivery Notice/Reminder/Receipt,* is left at the delivery address.

A second or final notice is issued after 5 calendar days from the first delivery attempt of the Certified Mail article. An undeliverable Certified Mail article may be held a maximum of 15 days before it is returned to the sender, unless otherwise indicated by a mailer endorsement.

Summary

Certified Mail service provides customers with proof of mailing. The date and the time the item was delivered or delivery was attempted is also provided. Certified Mail service must be requested at the time of mailing.

Certified Mail may only be combined with domestic First-Class Mail and Priority Mail. Certified Mail service is available for mailpieces destined for APO and FPO addresses. Customers may add both Restricted Delivery Service and Return Receipt Service to Certified Mail items.

PS Form 3800, *Certified Mail Receipt*, provides a mailing receipt and a unique identifier number and must be affixed to the mailpiece.

PS Form 3877, *Firm Mailing Book for Accountable Mail* is used for mailers that send a larger number of pieces.

PS Form 3883 is used for addresses that receive an average of six or more pieces at of Certified Mail at one time.

Customers can verify that their item was delivered online at usps.com, using their unique identifier number. Upon request, an electronic verification that the article was delivered or attempted to be delivered is provided to the customer.

Module 13: Registered Mail

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Sell, prepare and accept items utilizing Registered Mail Service
- Identify the features and benefits of Registered Mail Service
- Accept items that utilize Registered Mail Service combined with other Extra Services
- Complete Registered Mail Service forms and attach Label 200, *Registered Mail* in an approved location
- Describe Registered Mail Service forms, record keeping and holding periods

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Registered Mail eLearning course #10020996

Summary:

- Registered Mail

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Registered Mail

Registered Mail service is the most secure service that the Postal Service offers. A system of receipts is utilized to monitor the movement of Registered Mail from the point of acceptance to the point of delivery. All Registered Mail is kept separate from ordinary mail.

Registered Mail articles must meet specified standards to be acceptable for mailing. Articles must be securely sealed by the customer. You are not permitted to assist customers in preparing or sealing articles to be sent as Registered Mail. Priority Mail Express must not be used in conjunction with Registered Mail.

The complete name and address of both the sender and addressee must be included on the article. The face of the article must meet the minimum size standard of 3 ½ inches high and 5 inches long, regardless of thickness. Packaging must be of sufficient strength to withstand processing.

Specific requirements for preparing Registered Mail items are in place to prevent tampering. Quality envelopes should be used, with glue across the entire edge of the flap of the envelope. Large envelopes or flats that are completely sealed and also have paper tape across the intersections of the flaps are acceptable. Self-sealing envelopes are not acceptable.

Articles to be sent Registered Mail may not be placed in an envelope or mailer manufactured of plastic, glossy paper, spun-bonded olefin, such as Tyvek®, or substances that will not absorb an ink seal.

Fees

Registered Mail is charged the applicable First-Class Mail or Priority Mail price plus the additional fees for registry and Extra Services. Registered Mail may be combined with Collect on Delivery (COD), USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, Return Receipt, and Restricted Delivery.

Insurance

Postal insurance is provided for Registered Mail articles valued at a minimum of one cent, and up to a maximum insured value of $25,000. This insurance is included in the Registered Mail fee. Postal Insurance for Registered Mail is limited to the declared value of the article.

Articles valued between $25,000 and $1,000,000 must be charged the appropriate handling fee. The handling fee is charged for every $1,000 over the first $25,000 or fraction thereof. Fees for articles valued over $25,000 are for handling only.

PS Form 3806, *Receipt for Registered Mail*

PS Form 3806, *Receipt for Registered Mail,* is completed for each registered article. The customer enters the complete name and address in the "TO and FROM" sections of the form.

The customer declares the full value of the article at the time of mailing and records the amount on the form. The customer presents the form along with the article to you for further processing.

Label 200, *Registered Mail*

Label 200, *Registered Mail,* is used to designate articles as Registered Mail. Label 200 is a preprinted, red and white, self-adhesive, barcoded label with a sequential serial number. Keep a roll of Label 200 behind the retail counter for use when preparing articles for registry.

Preparation

The registry number you enter on PS Form 3806, *Receipt for Registered Mail,* must match the number found on Label 200, *Registered Mail,* which is applied to the article.

Customers requesting Return Receipt service with domestic Registered Mail must complete a PS Form 3811, *Domestic Return Receipt*. You will verify the proper completion of the form and write the Registry number from Label 200, in block two, Article Number, of PS Form 3811.

Customers requesting Return Receipt service with international Registered Mail must complete a PS Form 2865, *Return Receipt for International Mail*. You will verify the proper completion of the form and write the registry number from Label 200 in the Article Number block on the back side of the form.

You must verify the PS Form 3806, *Receipt for Registered Mail*, presented by the customer. Then determine the postage, Registered Mail fees, and fees for any other requested Extra Services and record the amounts in the appropriate sections of the form.

Once complete, provide the receipt copy, *Copy 1 – Customer*, to the customer.

You must properly round date stamp Registered articles. Round date stamp letter-size envelopes at all seams on the back of the envelope. Ensure each article is round date stamped at the crossing of the upper and lower flaps.

Flats and packages must be round date stamped on all seams of the article. Packages and flats sealed with paper tape are round date stamped across the opposite edges of the tape strips.

When you accept Registered Mail; record the Registry number and the office of origin on PS Form 3854, *Manifold Registry Dispatch Book.*

Secure the Item

Once you have accepted the Registered Mail item from your customer you must properly secure it in a locked designated area until the article is ready to be dispatched. If the office does not have a caged-in area that is specifically designated for Registered Mail articles, (Registry Cage) or a safe vault, then the articles must be kept in a locked drawer or cabinet.

Shared access is strictly prohibited. Individual employee accountability of Registered Mail must be maintained at all times.

Withdrawal

The sender may withdraw or recall Registered Mail without charge *before dispatch* from the originating or acceptance office by writing on the receipt, WITHDRAWN BEFORE DISPATCH, signing and surrendering the receipt, and presenting acceptable photo identification to you.

The sender does not receive a refund of postage and fees when withdrawing or recalling Registered Mail.

Dispatch of Articles

Complete PS Form 3854 when transferring Registered Mail articles to the dispatch employee. When completing PS Form 3854 you must round date stamp the copies of PS Form 3854, in the POSTMARK OF DISPATCHING OFFICE blocks on the top right of the form.

When rotary locks are not available, a numbered tin band seal must be used to seal the sack. Enter the rotary lock number or the tin band seal number for the pouch, in the top heading part of PS Form 3854.

Ensure that all hand-written numbers are accurate and draw diagonal lines through any unused spaces.

Summary

Registered Mail service is the most secure service that the Postal Service offers. All Registered Mail is kept separate from ordinary mail.

Specific requirements for preparing Registered Mail items are in place to prevent tampering.

Registered Mail is charged the applicable First-Class Mail or Priority Mail price plus the additional fees for registry and Extra Services. Registered Mail may be combined with Collect on Delivery (COD), Delivery Confirmation, Signature Confirmation, Return Receipt, and Restricted Delivery.

Postal insurance is provided for Registered Mail articles valued at a minimum of one cent, and up to a maximum insured value of $25,000.

Once you have accepted the Registered Mail Item from your customer you must properly secure it in a locked designated area until the article is ready to be dispatched.

Shared access is strictly prohibited. Individual employee accountability of Registered Mail must be maintained at all times.

Module 14: Collect on Delivery (COD)

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Sell, accept and process Collect on Delivery (COD) Mail
- Identify the features and benefits of each class/type of Collect on Delivery (COD) Mail
- Describe Collect On Delivery (COD) forms, record keeping, and holding periods

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Collect on Delivery (COD) eLearning course #10020999

Summary:

- Collect on Delivery (COD)

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Collect on Delivery (COD)

Customers can use Collect on Delivery (COD) service to mail merchandise for which the mailer has not been paid and have the price of the merchandise and the cost of postage and handling collected from the recipient by the Postal Service at the time of delivery.

Customers can also used COD Service to send merchandise to customers who do not wish to pay in advance and collect payment for merchandise when recipients do not have access to a credit card.

Dissatisfied customers may not use COD service to return merchandise unless the original mailer consents in advance to such a return. COD service may not be used to mail only bills or statements of account or for collection agency purposes.

COD Benefits

COD offers benefits to both mailers and recipients. The Postal Service collects payment and promptly reimburses the sender either the same day or the next business day after the article is delivered.

COD articles are covered against loss or damage of merchandise and recipients are allowed to pay for delivery of COD items by cash, check, debit card, or money order. Only one form of payment can be used for a single mailpiece.

Mailing Services with COD

Customers may request that only the cost of the merchandise is remitted, or only the cost of the postage and fees be remitted, or that they receive both the merchandise cost and postage and fees as remittance. COD service may be used with Priority Mail Express , First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, and Package Services.

COD can be used with Parcel Select if the mail has the complete names and addresses of the mailer and addressee, the mailer guarantees to pay any return postage, and the goods shipped are ordered by the addressee.

The maximum amount collectible from the recipient for an individual article and the indemnity for failure to collect or issue payment is $1,000.

Articles sent to or from an APO or FPO address, including official mail and shipments to Armed Forces agencies may not use COD Service

Extra Services

COD may be combined with Return Receipt, Restricted Delivery, USPS Tracking, Registered Mail, Signature Confirmation and Special Handling if the applicable standards for the services are met and the Extra Service fees are paid.

PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt*

Mailers sending articles using COD service must complete PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt* by handwriting in ink, typewriting, or computer generating the form.

PS Form 3816 is a five part barcoded carbonless form used to document the acceptance and delivery of a COD parcel. COD articles are identified by the number that appears on each copy of PS Form 3816.

The form must show the article number, the names and addresses of the mailer and recipient and the amount due the mailer. If a money order is used to remit payment to the mailer, the amount of the money order fee must be included. The mailer may not stipulate Cash Only as a payment method on PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt*.

Copy 1, *Delivery Unit* is used to document the acceptance and delivery of a COD mailpiece. You must enter information into the upper portion of Copy 1. Copy 1 is retained in the delivery office.

Copy 2, *Payment* is used to document a COD payment to the mailer. Copy 2 is sent along with the money order or the check received from the recipient to the mailer by the delivery office.

Copy 3, *Mailer* is the mailer's receipt. The information from the upper portion of Copy 1 is automatically transferred onto the upper portion of Copy 3 when you enter the information onto Copy 1.

Additionally, you must check the box and enter the fee amount for any Extra Services requested by the mailer, enter COD Fee, postage.

Copy 4- *Mailing PO* is a duplicate of Copy 3. As the mailing Post Office, you must retain Copy 4 for your records.

Copy 5, *Addressee* is a self-adhesive label that must be attached to the COD article that includes the check or cash amount and mailer and recipient information.

PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt*, must be placed above the delivery address and to the right of the return address, or to the left of the delivery address on parcels.

Fees

COD articles must be mailed at the Post Office or through a rural letter carrier.

The applicable COD fee must be paid in addition to postage and the fees for any Extra Services requested. The COD fee is charged per piece and is determined by the amount that is to be collected for the merchandise or the amount of insurance requested by the mailer, whichever is greater.

The fee for COD service includes insurance against loss, rifling, or damage to the article and the failure to receive payment for the article. Postal liability for the failure to receive payment for the article is limited to the loss of the payment during transit.

COD Delivery

When the COD mailpiece is delivered to over the counter, you must sign in the Delivered By signature block, record the date of delivery, the recipient's check number, if applicable, the money order number and the date that the payment is sent to the mailer on PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt.*

File PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt* and retain for 2 years.

Summary

Customers can use Collect on Delivery service to mail merchandise for which the mailer has not been paid and have the price of the merchandise and the cost of postage and handling collected from the recipient by the Postal Service at the time of delivery.

COD articles are covered against loss or damage of merchandise and recipients are allowed to pay for delivery of COD items by cash, check, debit card, or money order. PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt,* is used to document acceptance and delivery of a COD parcel.

COD service may be used with Priority Mail Express, First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, and Package Services.

Articles sent to or from an APO or FPO address, including official mail and shipments to Armed Forces agencies, may not use COD Service.

Module 15: Extra Services

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Sell, accept and process Extra Services
- Identify the features and benefits of Extra Services
- Explain the different types of Return Receipts
- Explain Return Receipt for Merchandise Services
- Describe Extra Services forms and handling procedures

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Extra Services eLearning course #10021005

Summary:

- Extra Services

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Extra Services

Extra Services are enhancements that provide greater security and accountability of mailpieces, for a fee, in addition to postage. Extra Services offer Proof of mailing with Certificate of Mailing and Certified Mail, Protection in transit with Insured Mail and Registered Mail, Confirmation of delivery with COD, USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, Restricted Delivery, Return Receipt and Return Receipt for Merchandise, and Services after mailing such as Merchandise Return.

Return Receipt Service

Return Receipt service provides the customer with evidence of delivery including the date and the recipient's signature. This service may be purchased at the time of the mailing or after mailing.

Customers purchase Return Receipt Service to obtain proof of delivery for mailpieces when using certain accountable mail Extra Services.

Return Receipt Service is commonly purchased with Certified Mail, which can be used on First-Class Mail or Priority Mail (when combined with other Extra Services). In addition to Certified Mail, Return Receipt can also be purchased with Restricted Mail, Collect on Delivery (COD), or Insured Mail valued over $200, as well as Priority Mail Express (hardcopy PS Form 3811 only).

RETURN RECEIPT (ELECTRONIC)

Return receipt service provides mailer information on whom the mail was delivered and date of delivery, along with information about the recipient's actual delivery address. A mailer purchasing return receipt service at the time of mailing may choose to receive the return receipt by mail and/or electronically.

Customers purchasing Return Receipt (Electronic) at the time of mailing will receive an email with an Adobe Acrobat (.pdf) attachment containing the recipient's signature from the PS Form 3849 and the date of delivery, rather than a green card returned through the mail.

This new service is available on domestic mail whenever a regular Return Receipt (Green Card) is available, except for Priority Mail Express. Return Receipt (Electronic) and Return Receipt (Green Card) can be sold on the same article, but it would be very unusual for a customer to need both.

Domestic Return Receipts

There are three types of Domestic Return Receipts. PS Form 3811, *Domestic Return Receipt*, PS Form 3811-A, *Return Receipt after Mailing*, and electronic return receipt. *Customers elect to receive PS Form 3811, Domestic Return Receipt*, by mail or electronically.

To receive a Return Receipt by mail, the mailer, at the time of mailing, completes PS Form 3811 and writes 'Return Receipt Requested' above the delivery address and to the right of the return address of the item to be mailed.

To receive a Return Receipt electronically, the mailer requests and purchases the service. You must follow the prescribed procedures for the sales transaction. The retail transaction receipt contains instructions for the customer to obtain the information electronically.

After delivery, the customer receives a return receipt proof-of-delivery letter via e-mail. This e-mail includes the date and time of delivery and an image of the recipient's signature.

Return Receipt after Mailing

Customers may purchase Return Receipt Service after mailing, if, at the time of mailing, they purchased Certified Mail, Registered Mail, Insured Mail (items valued over $200), or COD service.

PS Form 3811-A, *Return Receipt after Mailing*, must be completed by the customer. The completed form is sent to the delivery office. You must process and retain this form. It is not to be taken from the office by the customer.

PS Form 3804, *Return Receipt for Merchandise*

Return Receipt for Merchandise provides the mailer with a mailing receipt and a return receipt. The customer will receive the date of delivery and the name of the individual, company or organization that received the mail. PS Form 3804 may only be requested at the time of mailing. PS Form 3811 is mailed back to the customer after delivery of the mailpiece.

This service verifies that merchandise was sent by the customer and received by the addressee. PS Form 3804, *Return Receipt for Merchandise*, and PS Form 3811, *Domestic Return Receipt*, must be utilized for this service. A delivery record is maintained by the Postal Service, but no record is kept at the office of mailing. Insurance is not included with this service.

The Return Receipt for Merchandise label is attached to the address side of the article. You will Postmark the receipt showing the article was accepted for mailing.

Return Receipt for Merchandise service is available for Priority Mail, Standard Post (machinable and irregular parcels), or Package Services and Standard Mail items.

Combined Extra Services

The Extra Services that may be combined with Return Receipt for Merchandise are USPS Tracking, Insurance up to $200, and Special Handling. It may also be combined with Parcel Airlift Service (PAL).

Restricted Delivery Service

Restricted Delivery Service ensures that mail is delivered only to a specific addressee or the addressee's authorized agent. The addressee must be an individual specified by name. Mailpieces for minors or persons under guardianship may be delivered to their parents or guardians.

Mail for which Restricted Delivery Service is requested must be endorsed RESTRICTED DELIVERY in addition to other required Extra Services information. The endorsement must be placed above the address and to the right of the return address.

Restricted Delivery Services is only available for mail sent by Registered Mail, Certified Mail, COD, and Insured Mail (Over $200) when purchased at the time of mailing. Return Receipt may be purchased separately, but is not required.

Restricted Delivery Service can be combined with the following Extra Services , Signature Confirmation, and Special Handling. It may also be combined with Parcel Airlift Service (PAL).

PS Form 3817, *Certificate of Mailing*

PS Form 3817, *Certificate of Mailing*, is a receipt that provides proof of the date mail was presented to the Postal Service for mailing. A Certificate of Mailing does not provide a record of delivery nor insurance coverage.

Certificate of Mailing may only be purchased at the time of mailing and is in addition to postage. Certificate of Mailing may be used with First-Class Mail including Priority Mail, Priority Mail Express, Standard Post and certain international items. Certificate of Mailing may be combined with Parcel Airlift Service (PAL) and Special Handling.

PS Form 3606, Certificate of Bulk Mailing

For Bulk Mailings, PS Form 3606, *Certificate of Bulk Mailing,* may be used to specify the number of pieces mailed, but cannot be used as an itemized list of individual pieces.

Special Handling

Special Handling provides preferential handling, to the extent practicable, in dispatch and transportation. It does not provide preferential delivery. Special Handling is for unusual items that need to be handled specially through the mail such as live poultry and bees.

Special Handling is required for parcels containing honey bees and baby poultry unless sent at the First-Class Mail or Priority Mail prices. Postage and Special Handing fees must be paid at the time of mailing. Special Handling is available only for First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, Priority Mail Express and Standard Post pieces.

The marking "SPECIAL HANDLING" must appear prominently above the address and to the right of the return address on each piece for which special handling service is requested. Special Handling may be combined with COD, USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, Insurance, and Return Receipt for Merchandise. It may also be combined with Parcel Airlift Service (PAL).

Summary

Extra Services are enhancements that provide greater security and accountability of mailpieces for a fee in addition to postage.

In this lesson, we explained Return Receipts, described Return Receipt for Merchandise, Restricted Delivery Service, explained Certificate of Mailing, and discussed Special Handling Service.

Return Receipts provide the customer with evidence of delivery including date and the recipient's signature. Return Receipts can only be purchased along with certain other accountable mail services, such as Certified Mail or Priority Mail Express.

There are three types of Domestic Return Receipts PS Form 3811, *Domestic Return Receipt*, PS Form 3811-A, *Return Receipt After Mailing, and Electronic Return Receipt.*

Module 16: Domestic and International Claims

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify the types of products and services that can be insured
- Identify who may file a Domestic or International Claim
- Identify the time limits for filing Domestic and International Claims
- Inform customer where to file Domestic and International Claims
- Instruct customer on how to file Domestic and International Claims
-
- Inform customer of what's needed to file Domestic and International Claims

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Domestic and International Claims eLearning course #10021002

Summary:

- Domestic and International Claims

Participant Material Used:

- Learning Management System (LMS)

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

Domestic and International Claims

The vast majority of items shipped through the Postal Service arrive undamaged and within the appropriate delivery standard. But there are times when mail gets damaged during processing.

Types of Services

USPS has made changes to our expedited product line to enhance value and meet customer demand for day-certain delivery information.

Types of services impacted are; Priority Mail Express, Qualified Priority Mail, Insured Mail, Register Mail and COD.

Priority Mail Express

Although, there are no changes to the product features, Priority Mail Express will continue as our premium product, offering $100 of insurance coverage and a money back guarantee.

Day-specific delivery information will be provided to customers when the item's origin and destination ZIP Codes are provided

Information should be communicated to the customer appropriately.

Priority Mail

After the origin and destination ZIP Codes are provided, day-specific information will be communicated to the customer for Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail shipments.

This information will be included on retail receipts, at self-service kiosks, on "4x6" shipping labels and other customer facing systems. **1-Day, 2-Day, 3-Day** *(Priority Mail Only).*

Qualifying barcoded Priority Mail pieces will include insurance at no additional charge. Priority Mail customers will receive at least $50 of included insurance coverage, while some customers will qualify for $100 of insurance coverage depending on the postage payment method used.

Insured items that do not include the embedded insurance are: Merchandise Return Service (MRS), Priority Mail Open and Distribute, Premium Forwarding Service, Priority Mail Reship, and Stamps (when a USPS retail tracking barcode is not applied)

Embedded Insurance Retail

The $50 embedded insurance is included on the retail services listed.

All POS sites will switch to USPS Tracking Labels which replaces Pink Top PVI Tracking barcode label.

You will apply the USPS Label 400 to all parcels that do not already have an extra service barcode applied.

CARS Contract Postal Units will continue with the current process of applying the label generated from the meter device.

Embedded Insurance Commercial

The $100 embedded insurance is included on the commercial services listed.

The $100 insurance coverage is valid on domestic Priority Mail pieces bearing an intelligent Mail package barcode (Impb) or USPS retail tracking barcode. A retail acceptance scan is require on pieces bearing a USPS retail tracking barcode, and at least one physical scan is required on piece bearing an IMPB

The Product Tracking System insurance enhancement separates the fees from the postage and Indicate Mail Class to support claims processing.

Insured Mail

If a customer purchases Extra Services, the Extra Service barcode will enable customer tracking, and the label 400 need not be applied. Always scan all barcodes 'Accepted' at the counter.

For example: A customer is mailing a Flat Rate Priority Mail box and wants to insure it for $200.

Apply a Label 3813, scan it accepted, and give the customer their portion of the label.

In this case, the Insured Mail label will be used to identify that the item is insured and will also

be leveraged to provide the tracking on the mail piece. No Label 400 is necessary.

Registered Mail

Although, Label 200N is still required, the new version has no barcode to be used for PC Postage Vendors.

The barcode label is provided as an integrated, single barcode for Registered Mail to improve tracking and reporting on mailpieces with Registered Mail Extra Service.

Collect on Delivery (COD)

New label 500, *COD First-Class Mail Tracer label*, is being introduced as a method for the Postal Service to internally track COD Remittances

Customers that privately print their label will now be required to include Intelligent Mail package barcode on the PS Form 3816

The customers contact phone number (Retail), email address or SMS Text number (commercial) will be collected for COD transactions. Automated notifications will be made on the day of arrival, on Day 5 as a reminder, and on Day 10 indicating the shipment was Returned to the Sender.

Note: The PS 3849-D, Notice to Sender of Undelivered COD Mail, is now obsolete.

Domestic Claims

Customers must allow sufficient time for delivery of the mailpiece before they can initiate a Domestic Claim. Postal Service customers may file a Domestic Claim for packages that are lost, damaged or missing contents either online at usps.com, by mail, or at a Postal Retail Unit (PRU).

Customers should file all claims for damaged or missing contents immediately, but they must file no later than 60 days from the date of mailing.

Domestic claims for a lost article with insurance may file the claim no sooner than 21 days from the mailing date and no later than 180 days from the mailing date.

Customers can file a claim using the online form at USPS.com. Once a customer accesses the usps.com home page, Under Popular Links, select "File a claim".

Next, click the "File Online" button. On the Sign In To Your Account page, enter your Username and Password if you have an existing account.

If new to USPS.com select the "Sign Up Now" button to create an account.

After customers set up an account, they can file a claim online by accessing www.usps.com.

Domestic Online Claims Processing Service is available to customers who purchased services for; Domestic Priority Mail Express, Qualified Priority Mail, Numbered Insured Mail, Registered Mail, and COD.

Online claims processing is enhanced for customer simplification ensuring information and documentation filed by customer is complete. Online claims processing also requires customer to upload supporting documentation for value of item. Customers can check the status of their claim online after 10 days via www.usps.com. Customer support for an online claim is available 7 days a week, 7 a.m. – 11 p.m. EST, or by email at icustomercare@usps.com.

PS Form 1000, *Domestic or International Claim*

If the customer does not have the ability to file a domestic claim online, they can file a Domestic claim by mail. Claims should not be processed locally. Nor, should any insurance fees be refunded.

Customers filing a Domestic Claim by mail must complete PS Form 1000, *Domestic or International Claim* and mail the completed PS Form 1000 to Accounting Services. The address for Accounting Services is included on PS Form 1000.

Accounting Services will notify the customer by mail if they are required to present the damaged item and packaging to a Postal Retail Unit for verification.

PS Form 1000 provides the customer with complete instructions for filing a Domestic or International claim.

The top of PS Form 1000, *Domestic or International Claim,* allows the customer to explain the problem, and provide the mailing receipt information including, mailing receipt number, case number, and date of mailing.

The next section of the form, *Mailer and Addressee Information*, identifies the sender and addressee.

The *Description of Lost, Damaged or Missing Contents* section allows the customer to describe in detail the items mailed.

Customers must complete the *Certification* section to certify that all the information furnished on the form is accurate, truthful, and complete.

Proof of Value

To document the value, the customer may provide a dated sales receipt, a dated invoice, a statement of value or appraisal from a reputable dealer, an estimate of repair costs, or a copy of a canceled check or money order.

A statement of value from the customer is acceptable, but indemnity is limited to $100. The customer may also submit a paid repair bill if the claim is for partial damage, but the repair costs may not exceed the original purchase price.

Customers presenting damaged items to support their claim must provide Proof of Damage which includes the actual item, the package, the wrapper, and all packaging materials.

Accepting a Claim

If you are accepting the claim, you must verify the damage and complete PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*.

Customers wishing to file a claim at a Postal Retail Unit must present their completed PS Form 1000, *Domestic or International Claim* with the required supporting documentation.

To process the claim, you must verify that PS Form 1000 is complete and ensure that the required supporting documentation is attached. Provide the customer with copies of PS Form 1000 and PS Form 3831, *Receipt for Articles(s) Damaged in Mails* and supporting documentation.

Customers filing a claim online or by mail may receive a letter instructing them to present their damaged article and packaging to the Postal Retail Unit for verification.

You should obtain a copy of the Accounting Services letter from the customer, take possession of the damaged item and packaging, and complete PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*.

PS Form 3831, *Receipt for Articles(s) Damaged in Mails*

This receipt is an acknowledgement that you have accepted the items in connection with a claim for indemnity. Provide a copy of PS Form 3831 to the customer. The damaged article and packaging are retained by the Postal Service until the claim process is complete.

PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*

You must also complete PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*. This form is for internal use only. This form should not be completed in the presence of the customer.

PS Form 1000 and PS Form 2856, along with supporting documentation, are mailed daily to Accounting Services. Claims cannot be adjudicated at PRUs, they MUST BE handled by the Accounting Service Center.

International Claims

Customers may file International Claims for Global Express Guaranteed (GXG), Priority Mail Express International, Registered items, and Priority Mail International (insured and ordinary parcels).

Claims may not be filed for ordinary letters or M-bags. Claims for registered items and insured and ordinary parcels may not be filed until after an inquiry has been completed. Claims for items that have been damaged or have missing contents should be filed immediately.

Before a customer can initiate an inquiry on a missing item, they must allow sufficient time for the delivery of the mailpiece in that country. An inquiry for a Priority Mail Express International article can be filed no sooner than 3 days from the date of mailing and must be filed no later than 90 days from the date of mailing.

If a customer is requesting a postage refund for an Priority Mail Express International article with date certain delivery or guaranteed delivery, they have 30 days to initiate an inquiry in order to receive a postage refund for service delays.Postal Service International Inquiry Center (IIC)

To report the loss, damage, or missing contents of an article sent to a foreign country, customers must call the Postal Service International Inquiry Center (IIC) at 800-222-1811.

They will need to provide IIC with relevant information about the article that included, but is not limited to, the item number appearing on the barcode, the name, address, and telephone number of the mailer, the name, address, and telephone number of the addressee, a description of the contents of the article, and the date the article was mailed.

If the IIC determines that a claim for the item should be initiated, they will provide the customer with a claim packet. Claims should not be processed locally. Nor, should any insurance fees be refunded.

Claim Forms

Claims must be supported by PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents* for inbound registered items and insured and ordinary parcels received in damaged condition or with missing contents.

Accepting and International Claim

When accepting an International Claim, you must verify that all of the applicable fields on PS Form 1000, *Domestic or International Claim*, are complete, verify the required supporting documentation, provide the customer with copies of PS Form 1000 and the supporting documents submitted with the claim, and attach a completed PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents* to the claim packet and mail it to International Claims, Accounting Services.

Customers filing an International Claim for damaged or missing contents must present the damaged article, mailing container, wrapping, packaging, and any other content received to the Post Office for inspection.

To obtain the status or information regarding a filed claim, both customers and Postal Service employees may contact the Accounting Help Desk (AHD) at 866-974-2733.

Appeal a Claim Decision

When domestic insurance claims are denied, customers may appeal the decision by filing a written appeal and submitting it to Accounting Services. Customers have 60 days from the date of the original decision to file the appeal.

The appeal must focus on the basis of the claim denial. If the original claim was filed online, customers may file an appeal online by accessing their account at: usps.com

Customers will be notified in writing for any denied International Claims. The process for filing an appeal for a denied International Claim will be included in the notification letter. Appeals must be made in writing within 60 days of the date of the letter.

If a customer receives a check for less than the claimed amount, the customer may file a check protest appeal by submitting a written letter within 60 days of the date of the check. The appeal letter should be mailed to St. Louis Accounting Service Center.

Summary

As a sales and services associate, you have the opportunity to reduce the need for our customers to file claims, and increase customer satisfaction; by ensuring proper acceptance procedures are being followed.

Paying attention to the condition of the items when they are mailed greatly increases our ability to provide the service our customers expect and deserve.

You have the opportunity to reduce the need for our customers to file claims and increase customer satisfaction, by ensuring that you follow proper acceptance procedures.

Customers may file a claim for packages that are lost, damaged or missing contents either online at usps.com, or by mail, or at Postal Retail Units (PRUs). There are established timelines that customers must adhere to when filing a claim.

PS Form 1000, *Domestic and International Claim*, provides the customer with complete instructions for filing a domestic or international claim. Customers must call the International Inquiry Center to report the loss or damage on an article sent to a foreign country.

Module 17: Sales and Services Associate

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify and explain the roles and responsibilities of a sales and services associate

Time Allocated for Module:

- 40 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Video

Summary:

- Customer Perceptions
- Sales and services associate Job description

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- Ace Computer
- Rip Chart
- PowerPoint presentation
- Projector
- “Customer’s Perceptions” video

Customer Perceptions

Facilitator: Show ppts 1-2 and discuss objectives of the module. Show the video "Customer's Perceptions" slide 17-3 and then lead a discussion on the key points.

Show PowerPoint slide 17-4 and refer students to page 17-3 in the Participant Guide.

Refer participants to Exhibit 17-1 in their participant guide. Ask them what they see and discuss responses.

The picture can be seen in two ways: it is an old woman and/or the profile of a young lady. The picture demonstrates that people see things differently, and that what appears one way to you may appear differently to another.

There's a saying that goes like this:

It's not what you say, but what is heard.

It's not what you show, but what is seen.

It's not what you mean, but what is understood.

PERCEPTION IS REALITY.

In today's competitive marketplace, customer perceptions are especially important. Sales and services associates have a unique opportunity to positively influence customer perceptions of the Postal Service. The public's perception of the Postal Service is mostly shaped by what it sees. Sales and services associates are the primary contact people have with the Postal Service.

Exhibit 17-1



Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 17-5. Divide the class into groups. Have participants discuss the roles and responsibilities of a sales and services associate and then record responses on a rip chart.

Have each group present its responses to the class. All duties listed in the Position Description must be discussed. Lead a discussion on each group's responses and compare them to the USPS official job duties and responsibilities.

Sales and Services Associate, PS 06-07

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 17-6 and refer participants to page 17-4.

Functional Purpose

The sales and services associate performs a variety of sales and customer support services for products. They must maintain pleasant and effective public relations with customers and others requiring a general familiarity with postal laws, regulations, and procedures commonly used.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slides 17-7 and 17-8 and refer participants to pages 17-4 and 17-5.

Duties and Responsibilities

1. Performs any variety of sales and customer services at a retail window such as maintaining sufficient inventory of and selling stamps, stamped paper, other retail products and services and may use a computerized system, accepting and delivering packages and accountable mail; issuing and cashing foreign and domestic postal money orders; accepting and responding to customer claims and inquiries, and providing information to the public regarding postal regulations.
2. Provides sales and customer service support by greeting customers and explaining store layout determining special interests and referring to sales and promotional programs; offers assistance in product selection; provides special assistance; and answers customer inquiries when needed.
3. Provides product and service information to customers, including informing customers regarding special offers; suggestive selling related merchandise; promoting products based on customer needs. Provides additional information regarding product features and services.

4. Handles and processes customer purchases and returns relating to products and services and may use a point of sale system. Assists customers with transactions.
5. Maintains appearance of store by setting up, arranging, and replenishing displays and merchandise racks; ensures display and selling areas, work stations, and storage areas are presentable to customers.
6. Conducts product inventories by counting items on hand; attaches and removes security devices; accounts for items on display; and verifies and records sales floor inventory and shrinkage. Brings inventory discrepancies and shrinkage reports to the attention of the appropriate supervisory presence.
7. May verify presort and bulk mailings of all classifications, computing and maintaining on a current basis mailer's credit balances.
8. Checks and sets post office stamp-vending machines and postage meters.
9. Rents Post Office Boxes, receives rental payments, conducts reference checks, and completes related forms.
10. In addition, may assign and clear accountable items and distribute mail as required.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 17-9 and refer participants to page 17-5.

SUPERVISOR

Supervisor, Customer Services, or other supervisor/designee

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 17-10 and refer participants to page 17-5.

BARGAINING UNIT

Clerk

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 17-11. Refer participants to page 17-5.

Summary

Sales and services associates have a unique opportunity to positively influence customer's views of and interactions with the Postal Service. In some cases sales and services associates are the primary contact people have with the Postal Service.

As part of their duties and responsibilities sales and services associates must perform a variety of sales and customer support activities. While performing these activities they must maintain pleasant and effective public relations with customers and others requiring familiarity with postal products, services and mailing procedures.

Module 18: Discovery Map – Focusing on Customers

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Describe the rich history of success of the Postal Service and identify the impact retail activities have contributed to that success
- Discuss today's business realities and the increased pressure on retail business
- Explain the many universal retail strategies, including growing revenue, and educating and satisfying customers necessary to be successful
- Examine how the sales and services associate impacts many parts of the business and the required execution of four key actions
- Discover the wide variety of retail products and services that Postal Service offers

Time Allocated for Module:

- 2 Hours

Instructional Methods:

- Interactive exercise

Summary:

- Focusing On Our Customers Road to Success Discovery Map®

Participant Material Used:

- Focusing On Our Customers Discovery Map®
- Map Cards
- Customer Behavior Cards
- Product Cards
- Retail Unit Cards
- Worksheet
- Challenge Worksheet
- Self-stick notes, pens or pencils

Focusing On Our Customers Discovery Map®

This activity has been designed to allow participants to navigate a process of discovery. It engages participants, promotes interaction, compels discussion and encourages strategic thinking.

As the activity progresses, participants will be busy and mentally involved. They will notice things, ask questions, share experiences, and work together to find solutions.

For this activity, teams work independently, reading cards with questions aloud and using the Map and their own experiences to answer them. It is designed as a fun, fast-paced learning activity in which participants explore important information.

The Map provides participants with an opportunity to visually learn about the organization. Participants embark on a journey of self discovery as they learn about various products and services, the USPS retail environment, and the challenges facing the organization in a constantly changing business environment.

By taking a closer look at the Map, participants will learn more about how sales and services associates engage customers and meet their needs.

Map Main Sections

On the left side of the map, several *Business Realities* represent the challenges we're facing. In addition, there are several other companies, which appear on *Retail Street*.

In the center of the Map, many sales and services associates are working hard at *Engaging the Customers and Meeting Customer Needs*.

Our goals, which are located near the upper right section of the map, are to grow revenue, increase market share and develop lifetime customers. If customers are happy with the services we provide, they will return and help the USPS generate the revenue that all businesses need to survive and grow.

The purpose of the Map is NOT to answer every question that participants may have. The Map is designed to communicate key concepts and provide big-picture understanding. The activity may even create more questions than it answers.

Unlike traditional training sessions, this activity focuses on allowing learners to learn rather than having teachers teach. The quality of learning occurring through discovery is a more natural, effective human process than listening to a lecture or memorizing pieces of information.

Facilitator: ACTIVITY

This activity is designed for teams seated at tables with four to six participants per table.

Experience has shown that one leader can manage a group of up to 36 participants in a single session. If you will have more than 36 participants, it can be helpful to have additional supporting facilitators.

Be sure to plan ample time for setting up the room.

While setting up the room, make certain that participants can see and hear you as well as one another.

The teams will use the Map and the Cards to answer questions and find solutions to problems outlined in the Cards.

Refer to the Focusing On Our Customers Discovery Map® Leader Guide to complete entire activity.

Module 19: Communication Skills

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Explain effective communication
- Define the different types of communication
- Practice effective listening techniques
- Demonstrate active listening
- Effectively use paraphrasing techniques
- Give and receive feedback

Time Allocated for Module:

- 45 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Group Activities

Summary:

- How We Communicate
- What is Communication?
- Types of Communication
- Six Characteristics of Successful Communicators
- How We Listen
- Active Listening

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- Ace Computer
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip Chart and Projector

How We Communicate

Facilitator: The communication process is complex. Understanding the techniques involved in developing basic communication skills is imperative to effective communication. The communication process, involving the way we speak and listen, ensures that individuals are able to nurture existing relations and establish excellent professional and personal relationships for a lifetime.

ACTIVITY: Ask the class the following question:

What is Communication?

Lead a group discussion and record the answers on a rip chart.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-3 and refer participants to page 19-3.

What is Communication?

Communication is the art and technique of using words effectively to impart information or ideas. Approximately 75% of an employee's workday is filled with multiple communication tasks. Communication is the process by which we exchange and interpret messages within a given situation or context. It is a specific continuous series of actions, interrelated steps, directed toward an end.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-4.

Good communication starts when an individual (sender) sends a message (verbally, non-verbally, in writing, etc.) to another individual (receiver) the information to be processed, interpreted, and absorbed regarding a topic. For effective communication to occur, the sender must communicate clearly with the receiver and verify that the message received was decoded correctly.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-5.

The foundation of interpersonal communication, the sender-receiver model, is the process of sharing information with others. The goal of interpersonal communication is to comprehend the exact meaning and intent of others and have others understand the intent and idea through the production, transmission, and reception of the message. Good communication only occurs when the intention of the sender and the interpretation of the receiver are the same.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-6.

Facilitator: ACTIVITY- Have students take out a blank sheet of paper or distribute paper to the class. Inform students that you will be providing verbal instructions shortly and they cannot ask any clarifying questions as you are giving those instructions. Remind students to listen carefully. Give the following verbal instructions to the students:

Using your pen or pencil, draw a square in the center of the page. Then, draw a triangle to the left of the square so it touches the square's upper left corner.

Next, draw a circle at the bottom right angle on the right side of the square, so that it touches the square.

Now, draw another circle inside your first circle. Finally, draw a third circle around the triangle, square, and circle.

Ask the students the following question:

What type of picture do you have? Ask for volunteers to share their picture with the class.

Hand out copies of the correct picture and review it with the class. Use the following points as a basis for group discussion:

Listening is one of the most important components of the communication process.

Communication is an outcome.

The desired outcome in this case is to have drawn the picture as described.

There are several ways we can listen effectively to achieve our desired outcome(s).

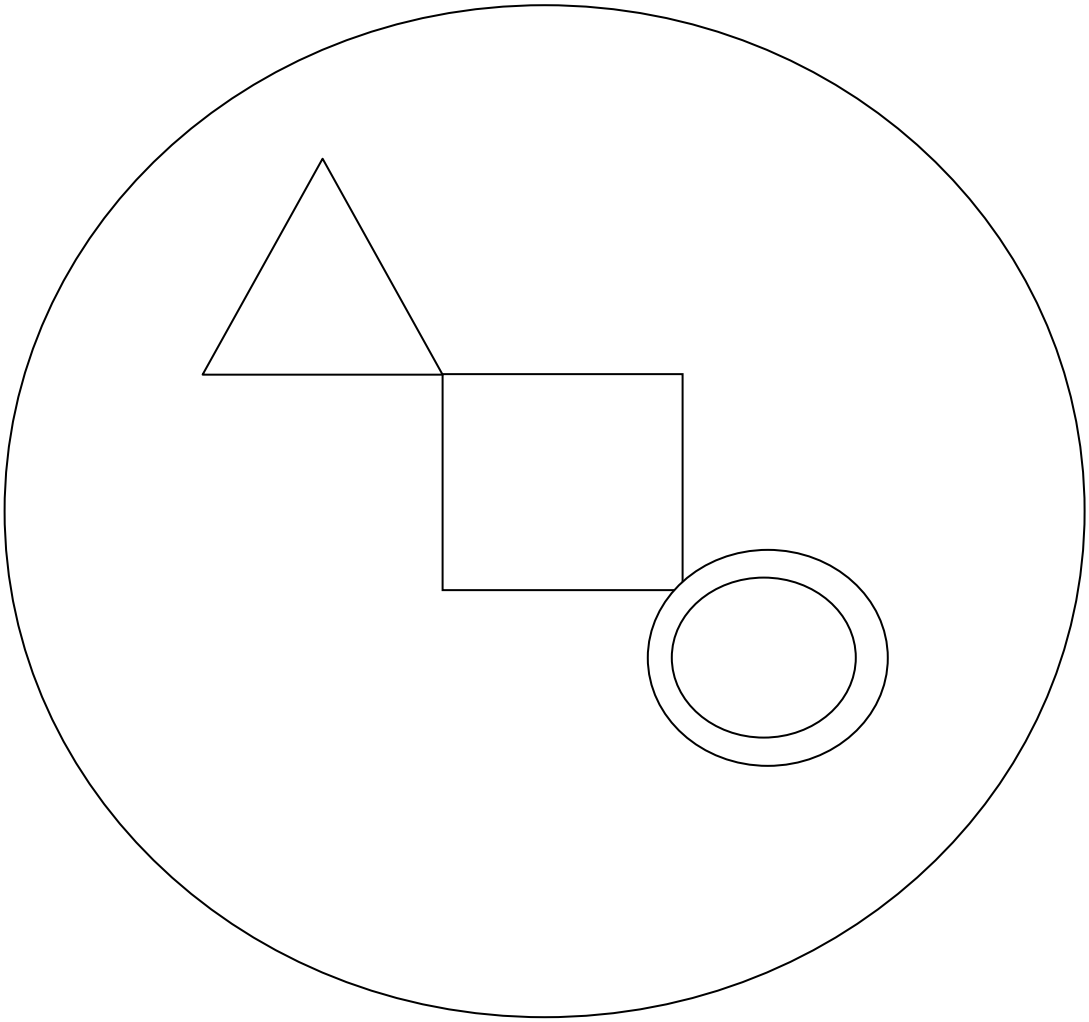
An organization is only as good as the people that work in the organization.

If individuals fail in listening, most of the small group communication that occurs is ineffective.

The outcome of this activity is to reinforce the concept that effective listening is a skill that must be developed in order to successfully understand others; no matter what type of organizational structure exists or how information flows.

Active listening, which will be discussed later in this module, provides the steps to ensure that what is being said by the speaker is clear and fully understood by the listener.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-7.



Types of Communication

Facilitator: Review the types of communication with the class.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-8 and refer participants to page 19-3.

Verbal Communication

Verbal communication involves using spoken words orally, as opposed to written words with a definite beginning and ending point. Be aware that language in communication can take on non-verbal meanings as well.

Verbal communication activates the mind and encourages creativity and change when the message is communicated accurately and clearly. Phrasing words positively can influence emotions, challenge beliefs, and affect thoughts of individuals involved in the communication exchange.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-9.

Non-verbal Communication

Non-verbal communication is defined as the process by which non-verbal and verbal behaviors interact in the exchange and interpretation of information within a given situation or context. Non-verbal communication occurs constantly when people interact with each other. It is virtually impossible not to relay a non-verbal message to others when working on a team. This can be a challenge when individuals involved in the communication draw upon their own experiences and jump to conclusions about the non-verbal message being relayed.

Facilitator: Review the rule regarding non-verbal cues with the class.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-10.

A scientific study determined that something amazing happens to the communication process when the words themselves are ambiguous, or there is a conflict between the words a person uses and the non-verbal cues. When there is ambiguity or conflict, people tend to rely more on the non-verbal to evaluate the emotional state of the person speaking.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-11.

This rule is also known as the 55%-38%-7% rule. Non-verbal cues can account for:

- Gesture, expression and other physical cues 55%
- Vocal variety 38%
- Word 7%

Facilitator: Review the Non-verbal Cues information with the class.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-12.

Non-verbal Cues

Non-verbal cues can enhance or contradict verbal messages. Studies show that it takes less than a minute to react either negatively or positively to someone, and if a first impression is negative several encounters are necessary to change the perception. Examining non-verbal cues can help individuals learn to interpret messages correctly.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-13.

Non-verbal cues within non-verbal communication play a significant role in shaping impressions. Researchers have identified several categories of non-verbal communication:

- Body movement (shuffling feet and folding arms), posture and gestures
- Facial expressions, such as eye contact and facial behavior give a variety of cues including interest, boredom, distraction, confusion, and hostility.
- Personal space – people are distinctly aware of space and territory.

Facilitator: Review the Six Characteristics of Successful Communicators with the class.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slides 19-14 and 19-15.

Six Characteristics of Successful Communicators

Successful communicators tend to share similar traits and characteristics. To be a successful communicator:

- Never assume that if an idea is clear to you, it will be clear to a receiver.
- Always check your own understanding of what another person has told you before you reply.

- Be tolerant of other people's feelings, realizing that their feelings, which may be different from yours, affect their communication.
- Always try to listen to a message from the sender's point of view before evaluating the message from your own point of view.
- Communicate the "why" of any communication, so that the communication makes sense to the receiver.
- Remember that the first barrier any communication has to break through is, "Why should I read, or listen to this communication?"

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-16 and review the How We Listen information with the class.

How We Listen

Approximately half of communication is devoted to listening. However, individuals generally remember 50% of the spoken word in 1-2 days and 25% after the first 2 months. Learning to be an exceptional communicator is to understand when to speak and when to listen.

When mistakes occur during the listening process, time is wasted resulting in ineffective use of resources. Listening involves more than just hearing a message, it is an important link in making and maintaining relationships.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-17.

Although individuals understand that listening is important, most people listen ineffectively. Some common myths about listening include:

- Listening is easy because it is hearing.
- Learning the skill of listening is a natural process of human communication requiring no planning.
- Listeners receive the same message all the time.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-18 and lead the activity.

ACTIVITY: Ask the class the following question:

What are some of the barriers to effective listening?

Lead a group discussion and record the answers on a rip chart.

Suggested answers:

- **External Noise**
- **Daydreaming**

- **Preoccupied**
- **Information Overload**
- **Environment**
- **Physical Impairment**
- **Lack of Interest in Topic**
- **Assumptions**
- **Defensiveness**
- **Evaluating and Judging the Speaker**
- **Not Asking for Clarification**
- **Planning your Response to what the Speaker is Saying**

Conclude the activity by asking the class the following questions:

Have you ever experienced a breakdown in communication due to another person drawing a hasty, incorrect conclusion to your message? How did it make you feel and what impact did it have on the relationship?

Lead a group discussion.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-19.

Active Listening

Facilitator: Review the Active Listening information with the class.

Active listening is a process used by the receiver (listener) to facilitate communication and enhance performance. It involves paraphrasing the statement in one's own words and repeating key information to the speaker for clarification.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-20. Refer participants to page 19-6.

Five essential elements of active listening include:

- Demonstrate an open and respectful demeanor
- Provide verbal and non-verbal questions
- Seek clarification
- Don't make assumptions
- Provide feedback

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-21 and review the Actively Attending and Clarifying information with the class.

Actively Attending

Actively attending enhances listening skills and utilizes non-verbal cues to inform the speaker the listener is attentive. Practice Actively Attending by remembering S.O.L.E.R.

- **Squarely** face the person
- **Open** your posture
- **Lean** towards the sender
- **Eye** contact maintained
- **Relax** while attending

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-22.

Clarifying

Clarifying is a technique in active listening used to bring a message into greater focus. It is used to get more information and identify what is being communicated as well as provide better understanding.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 19-23 and refer participants to page 19-7.

Summary

As a sales and services associate, you communicate with a variety of customers every day. Understanding and using the tools of good communication and effective listening are critical to maintaining a positive relationship with customers and ensuring that you understand what they need.

You can display a real interest in what your customers are saying by using attentive verbal and non-verbal skills. Using these skills allows you to acknowledge feelings of others, ask clarifying questions, paraphrase, and receive feedback regarding your interactions with customers.

Remember, meeting customer's needs and providing an outstanding retail experience should be your primary focus; and effectively communicating during every interaction will ensure success.

Module 20: Selling Techniques

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Develop customer interactions using effective communication and promotion of postal products and services to meet the needs of the customer
- Utilize Need Satisfaction Selling techniques
- Debrief customer interactions to improve the customer experience using techniques learned during training

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 Hour

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Group Activity

Summary:

- Conducting Successful Retail Sales Transactions
- Selling Maximum Value
- Multicultural Outreach
- Need Satisfaction Selling
- Recognizing Needs
- Using GIST
- Engaging Our Customers

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- Ace Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation and Rip chart

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slides 20-3, refer participants to page 20-3, and review the Conducting Successful Retail Sales Transactions information with the class

Conducting Successful Retail Sales Transactions

A successful sales transaction is one in which you and the customer make an informed, mutually beneficial decision. As a sales and services associate, it is your job to direct and manage the customer experience so that this outcome is achieved.

Since customers usually consider more than one need when making decisions, the skills of probing and supporting may be used repeatedly during a transaction. Once you've greeted the customer, gathered information about the customer's needs, and provided information about how you can satisfy that need by offering USPS products and services, you gather and provide information about additional customer needs and the appropriate USPS product and/or service that matches that need. Then, at the appropriate time, you close/complete the transaction.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-4.

As a sales and service associate, you should differentiate USPS' products and services through their value, not solely on any price advantage. This selling strategy is recommended because in the absence of value, price usually becomes the determining decision criteria. Unless the product is positioned as the lowest price available you will often lose the sale.

Solution/product differentiating is based on meeting and exceeding customer needs and expectations. The focus is always on the customer, not on the competition. **When presenting the value of USPS products and services, you align that value with the customer's needs.** This becomes your value proposition – the value to the customer of the product's features and benefits.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-5, refer participants to page 20-4, and review the Selling Maximum Value information with the class.

Selling Maximum Value

Selling maximum value to customers by matching their needs should be the objective of every SSA. Premier expedited products such as Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail receive special attention and focus when being processed, transported, dispatched, and delivered. If speedy delivery of a package is important to the customer, then either Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail is the answer. Adding Extra Services to package sales is like putting icing on the cake. Customers want to know: the status of their item – USPS Tracking; who signed for the item– Signature Confirmation; that it arrived safely – Insurance; and to have a record of delivery – Return Receipt. Combining expedited shipping products with Extra Services offers maximum value for customers. When customers consider our Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail competitive prices, Flat-Rate product options, and complimentary shipping supplies, they will know they are receiving maximum value that can't be beat.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-6.

The best way to increase customer satisfaction is to provide the customer the postal product that fits their need. Customers look to you as the retail expert to be knowledgeable about what we have to offer and to recommend the appropriate product and service for them.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-7 and refer participants to page 20-5.

Access the Multi-Cultural Outreach Postal Products and Translator Services web page.

Multicultural Outreach

Outreach contains information, guides and product fact sheets in several languages to assist those who use USPS products and services but are not native English speakers.

Additional information can be obtained through the Human Resources Inclusiveness Website such as:

- Translation Aids: Postal Products and Services Translator
- Product Fact Sheets
- Extra Services Translation Guides

- Passport Fairs and special events
- DMM 100, 100C, and 100S - A Customer's Guide to Mailing (English, Chinese, and Spanish)
- Translated Posters and Publications

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-8.

Postal Products and Services Translator

The Postal Products and Services Translator is a great new tool to support communication with our multicultural retail customers! The Translator is a four-page information sheet that highlights our major products and services, and provides responses to common questions asked at the retail counter. The Translator is available in Arabic, Chinese, French, German, Hindi, Korean, Polish, Portuguese, Russian, Spanish and Vietnamese.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-9.

Product Fact Sheets

Product fact sheets contain information on U.S. Postal Service products. These fact sheets will be helpful in providing our non-English speaking customers with updated information about our products and how they can help our customers' mailing needs.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-10.

Extra Services Translation Guides

The Extra Services Translation Guides are designed to provide our non-English speaking customers with step by step instructions on how to properly complete U.S. Postal Service Extra Service forms.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-11.

HAZMAT Question Translator

The HAZMAT Question Translator provides translations in 23 languages, including English, Arabic, Chinese, and Spanish.

Need Satisfaction Selling

Facilitator: Discuss the following points with participants:

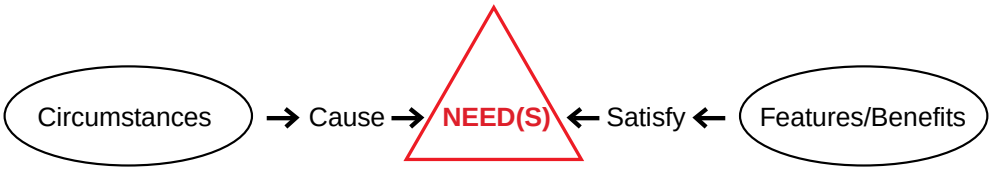
Has anyone ever heard the term Need Satisfaction Selling? Let's start by defining that phrase and seeing how it applies to you as a SSA. In its simplest form, need satisfaction selling is the understanding of a customer's needs through the use of probing questions and careful listening. Remember that the customer has both stated and unstated needs. The stated needs are obvious as the customer provides that information during the initial discussion.

But, it is often the discovery of those unstated needs that identifies what product or service will provide the customer with a solution and satisfy their need.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-12.

Need satisfaction selling is based on the simple recognition that customers buy products to satisfy their needs. **Needs are the driving force** behind a customer's willingness to interact with you, learn about Postal products, and make a purchase commitment.

You're able to satisfy a customer's needs when your product and organization have **features** which provide **benefits** that are important to the customer.



Generally speaking, the customer is the expert on his or her circumstances and needs. You're the expert on the features and benefits you offer. It's through dialogue with the customer that you reach a mutual understanding of all these elements.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-13 and refer participants to page 20-6.

Success: Yours and Your Customers'

Like you, your customers want to be successful. **Part of your success as a SSA depends on your commitment to your customers' success** and your ability to help customers make decisions that contribute to their success. Customers tell you how you can help them succeed when they express needs – that is, when they express a desire to improve or accomplish something.

NEED: a desire to improve or accomplish something

You help your customers, the Postal Service, and yourself succeed by understanding and satisfying your customers' needs.

Recognizing Needs

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slides 20-14, refer participants to page 20-7, and discuss the following points with participants.

Often times, customers are not sure of the right product or service to satisfy their need. They will look to you, the SSA, to provide that information and make a recommendation. Customers will try to explain what they need, but you should listen for those words or phrases which tell you what that person desires; what is commonly called the language of needs. The language of needs can help you to uncover the customers "true need;" providing the best option, and a potential opportunity to sell another postal product or service.

You can't see a customer's needs. They're "inside" the customer, and only the customer can tell you what they are. However, you can be reasonably sure a customer has a need when he or she uses the **language of needs** – words and phrases that express desire. For example:

"I want . . . . ."

"I need . . . . . "

"I'd like . . . . . "

"I'm looking for . . . . . "

"I'm interested in . . . . . "

"I wish . . . . . "

"I hope . . . . . "

"What matters is . . . . . "

"It's important to . . . . . "

"My objective . . . . . "

"My goal . . . . . "

"I must . . . . . "

When you interact with your customer, it's important to listen for and recognize the language of needs. If you don't, you might make unwarranted assumptions about what a customer is looking for and waste time talking about things in which he or she is not interested.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slides 20-15, refer participants to page 20-8, and conduct activity.

ACTIVITY- Have participants complete the following activity identifying statements that are expressing a postal need.

When all of the participants have completed the activity read each statement and ask participants to share their reasons for making their selections.

__X__ Not only do I need to get in there in 1-3 days, but what I'm sending is very valuable."

_____ "Our Company is growing very fast. We'll be opening three new branches this month and two more by the end of the quarter."

This customer is providing information about his or her company. While he or she may go on to express a need, this statement does not express one. Unless the customer uses the language of needs, you can't be sure he or she has a need.

__X__ "My people aren't happy with the software support they're getting. I'm hoping we can do better."

__X__ "It's important for us to have them distributed by the end of the month."

_____"We don't have the most sophisticated system in the world; but it works for us and I'm satisfied."

This customer recognizes the potential to improve his or her system but isn't expressing the desire to do so. The language of needs is absent.

A need is a desire to improve or accomplish something

Expressing a Need Activity

Place a check mark next to each of the statement(s) below where a customer is expressing a need.

_____"Not only do I need to get it there in 1-3 days, but what I'm sending is very valuable."

_____"Our Company is growing very fast. We'll be opening three new branches this month and two more by the end of the quarter."

_____"My people aren't happy with the software support they're getting. I'm hoping we can do better."

_____"It's important for us to have them distributed by the end of the month."

_____"We don't have the most sophisticated system in the world, but it works for us, and I'm satisfied."

Fill in the blank

A need is _____.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-16 and refer participants to page 20-9.

Using GIST

The customer's experience can be enhanced at the retail counter by practicing the basic (Greet, Inquire, Suggest and Thank) principles. By remembering to use the GIST principles, you can "Engage our Customers" each time, every day.

SSAs will be able to demonstrate sales strategies by practicing the Greeting – Inquiring – Suggesting - Thanking (GIST) and "Engaging our Customers" principles.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-17.

Ask participants: "How do you personalize your greeting?" Promote discussion based on the responses to the initial exercise – "How does it feel when the person waiting on you isn't being attentive? – Does it make for a positive customer experience?" Allow participants to respond. Ask the participants: "When you enter a retail location and the person waiting on you calls you by name, how do you feel?" Let participants respond. Advise participants if they know their customer's name to use it when they greet them.

"G" – Greeting Customers

Have you ever noticed that greeting your customer sets the tone for the entire transaction? A pleasant greeting and eye contact encourage open communication with your customer. Greet your customer by name, if you know it. Being attentive throughout the entire transaction tells your customers that they are important and that you value their business. A SSA in complete uniform also communicates trust in your ability to provide reliable service in a professional manner.

Facilitator: Ask the participants: "Are you one of the folks who thinks you know what your customer needs?" Promote discussion by asking the following question: "Can anyone give an example of a repeat customer who required a different service than what they routinely used?" Give time for participants to respond. Ask participants to share what questions they ask customers to help determine their needs.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-18.

"I" – Inquiring

Customers' needs change every day. By inquiring, we engage our customer to better understand their mailing needs. What they needed yesterday, may not be the same as what they need today. We have a variety of products and services which are not easily understood by many of our customers. Ask questions, for example, "would you like to purchase insurance to give you peace of mind in case your package is lost or damaged?" It is important to communicate with each customer and to listen carefully to what they say.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-19

Remind the participants that our customers rely on SSAs to offer the appropriate products and services to meet their mailing and shipping needs.

"S" – Suggesting

It is the SSA's responsibility to suggest options that would best meet your customers' mailing needs. Suggesting and promoting our premier products and services is one of the best ways to ensure customer satisfaction while offering excellent value. Suggesting Extra Services such as USPS Tracking and Insurance adds value by providing customers with peace of mind since customers will know when their packages arrive and that they are insured against damage or loss. Suggesting additional products or services adds value by saving customers an unnecessary extra trip to the Post Office. Remember - customers rely on you, the retail expert, to suggest products and services, and to explain their features and benefits.

Facilitator: Ask the participants: "What have your customers shipped via Priority Mail Express? Why do you think they used Priority Mail Express?"

Have participants share what their customers have shipped via Priority Mail and GXG as well, and why the customer used those products.

This helps the participants understand the needs of customers and what items are normally shipped by which product.

NOTE: It is possible repeat customers need change.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-20.

Premier Products

Premier products and shipping services offer expedited shipping and handling services to customers. These products and services generate a much higher profit per piece than other domestic package products. Premier products provide better value and added service which equates to satisfied mailing and shipping customers who will use these products and services to satisfy their future mailing and shipping needs.

Suggesting - Premier Products

Did you know the Postal Service was first to introduce Express Mail (now called Priority Mail Express)as a new class of mail?

Priority Mail Express became so popular that competitors emerged and began selling overnight service too. They recognized the value of expedited services and became successful because of it.

Do we recognize the value of our premier products and offer them to our customers?

When suggesting shipping services to customers; SSA's should start by offering Priority Mail Express for domestic shipping or Global Express Guaranteed for international shipping. Priority Mail Express provides tracking ability which customers like because they can monitor the progress of their shipment throughout its delivery. SSA's should always explain the unique features and benefits – this ensures customers are aware of their options so they can make informed shipping decisions.

Remember: When selling Priority Mail Express, always inform customers of the insurance and tracking features included with the price.

Suggesting – Premier Shipping

Priority Mail Express is automatically insured up to $100 against loss or damage. Additional insurance can be purchased. Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail generate a much higher contribution (profit) per piece than other domestic package products. Global Express Guaranteed is the highest profit per piece product in the Postal Service. Premier products provide better value-added service which equates to satisfied customers who will return again and again.

Remember, the lowest cost is not always the best value for our customers!

Facilitator: Ask the participants: "Have you ever had a customer who assumed insurance was included in their package price?" Provide specific examples of how the customer was impacted by not purchasing insurance. Emphasize the importance of always offering USPS

Tracking and Insurance. These are Extra Services that offer best value to the customer.

Suggesting – Extra Services

After it has been determined that a customer wants to ship a package as Priority Mail, you should offer extra services such as Insurance with USPS Tracking or Signature Confirmation. Insurance provides the customer peace of mind in case of loss or damage. Customers often assume that insurance is included in the postage.

From a customer's perspective, it would be perceived as poor customer service to think that a package was insured and to discover later that is wasn't. That is why it is especially important to offer insurance!

USPS Tracking is an inexpensive, user-friendly service that allows a customer to verify delivery. Customers trust us to protect their mail and provide quality service. So, don't forget to offer the customer our extra services. When you offer Insurance and USPS Tracking to every customer who mails a package, you will be offering them extra services that meet their needs.

Facilitator: Ask the participants: "What additional products do you normally offer? Is there a specific time that you offer a specific product?"

Example: I always offer a new ReadyPost product when someone mails something, especially if they don't have a box.

Suggesting Additional Products

In today's world, customers are often in a hurry and may forget to ask for additional products. Do they need stamps, packaging/shipping (ReadyPost) products, a PO Box, passports, or money orders? Our customers appreciate it when we remind them of other things they might need while they are at the Post Office. Make sure customers are completely satisfied when they walk out the door.

Facilitator: Refer back to the Expressing A Need activity. Remind the participants to always provide the customer with their receipt.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-21.

"T" – Thanking

When we were children, we learned the importance of saying "thank you." Have you ever been in a retail establishment when you weren't thanked when the transaction was completed? Did you feel unappreciated? Did you feel like going back? It is important that our customers know how much we appreciate their business. Satisfied customers are repeat customers who we can "thank" for paying our salaries. Always end the transaction in a pleasant manner by saying "Thank you" or "Thank you for choosing the US Postal Service" and always provide customers with their receipt.

You are not just selling our products and services, but also the experience which the customer will evaluate during and after the interaction. How you respond to a customer's questions and/or concerns has a long lasting impact on the relationship and can either ensure a customer for life or one that will never return. Selling the experience can be a great opportunity to salvage and even improve customer relationships; but only if you act thoughtfully and with intention.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-22 and refer participants to page 20-12.

ACTIVITY: Divide the class into two groups. Based on the scenario, have each group develop an answer to the question assigned.

A customer approaches you and places a small package on the counter. Before you can even greet her, she says, "Send it regular mail."

Group 1 – What is your general starting point to uncover the customer's needs?

Group 2 – After your initial interaction, the customer has informed you that she would like to have the package delivered soon; preferably within one day or two at the most. What is the next step in satisfying this customer's need?

Have each group record their answers on a rip chart and present their findings to the entire class.

Suggested answers:

Group 1

Refer to the first steps of the GIST Model

- **G - Greet the customer**
- **I - Inquire about the customer's needs**

Group 2

Refer to the third step of the GIST Model

- **S - Suggest products or services which would meet her needs**
- **T - Thank the customer for choosing the US Postal Service and always provide customers with their receipt. In this case, Priority Mail Express to have it delivered the next day guaranteed or Priority Mail if it would be okay for a 1-3 day delivery window**

Identifying the Customer Need Activity

Read the scenario below and develop an answer to the question assigned to your group.

A customer approaches you and places a small package on the counter. Before you can even greet her, she says, "Send it regular mail."

Group 1 - What is your general starting point to uncover the customer's needs?

Group 2 – After your initial interaction, the customer has informed you that she would like to have the package delivered soon; preferably within one day or two at the most. What is the next step in satisfying this customer's need?

Record your answers on a rip chart and present your findings to the entire class.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-23.

Engaging Our Customers

Building business relationships with customers keeps them coming back. You have the opportunity to create a relationship with each customer by fitting their need with just the right service. While your retail transaction and your individual style may vary from other SSA's, you should interact with customers based on that customer's needs. The customer in front of you is the most important one. Always remember, you never get a second chance to make a first impression. "Engaging our Customers" will assist you with the necessary steps to ensure that customers are offered maximum value during their package transactions.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-24.

Engaging our Customers

1. Greet customer pleasantly and make eye contact

Be attentive to the customer throughout the entire transaction. Give the customer your undivided attention. Make sure every customer feels important when they come to your window.

2. Always ask the four components of the HAZMAT question for packages, bulky flats and suspicious mailpieces.

"Does this package contain anything liquid, fragile, perishable or potentially hazardous?"

3. Always offer Priority Mail Express first by name stating the service standards.

"Would you like to use Priority Mail Express for this package, which is guaranteed delivery by tomorrow (or second day) for only (current rate)? That price includes $100 of free insurance and you can track your package using USPS.com or 1-800-ASK-USPS. (Pause and wait for the customer to respond).

"We have Priority Mail that should arrive in 1-3 days. Priority Mail includes USPS Tracking and $50 insurance coverage when purchased at retail. (Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail are the preferred services that usually offer the customer the best value.)

When you offer Standard Post or another Package Service option, explain the product's features. "We do have Standard Post, which includes USPS Tracking but can take up to 7-10 days for delivery and return postage is not included. Packages that can't be delivered for any reason will be returned postage due." To help the customer make an informed decision, look at the difference of Standard Post and Priority Mail. In some cases, Priority Mail is just a few cents more than Standard Post.

4. Offer both Insurance and USPS Tracking by name explaining the features of each.

Would you like to purchase Insurance to protect your package against loss or damage?

For an additional charge, you can check the status of your package with our USPS Tracking Service (point out *USPS.com* and 1-800-ASK-USPS that is included on the receipt).

5. Offer a specific additional product to purchase and explain the feature.

Select one or more of the following "high profit" products and explain at least one benefit or feature of the product (stamps, packaging supplies, Post Office Box rental, passports, and/or money order). **Note: If offering stamps, offer an additional product or service other than stamps.** When offering stamps and another additional product, you only have to explain a benefit or feature of the additional product (other than stamps). Offering additional products to purchase helps educate customers about our services that they may not have considered purchasing before, or it may be something they would purchase at another retail establishment. Below are a few examples. Be creative and use your knowledge to expand on any of these services.

Stamps: Can I interest you in our "Forever" stamps today?" They feature locked-in postage, so, if the price of stamps increase – You're safe!

Packaging supplies: We have some very good quality mailing boxes. Would you like to purchase one of our ReadyPost decorative mailers for your next mailing?

Post Office Box rental: Can I interest you in our Post Office Box service? It's our most secure delivery service and allows you to have access to your mail earlier in the day.

Passports: Did you know this office (or a neighboring office) is an official U.S. Passport site. If you're considering traveling out of the country or if you just want to have a passport as your preferred form of identification, you can apply for your passport here.

Money Orders: Did you have a need for a Postal money order today? They can be cashed at any U.S. Post Office or most banks in the United States.

6. Always provide the customer with a receipt.

Always end the transaction in a pleasant manner by saying "Thank you," or "Thank you for choosing the U.S. Postal Service."

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 20-25

As a sales and services associate, you have the opportunity to help not only improve the customer experience, but also generate revenue for the organization. Using effective sales techniques to identify and meet the customers' needs will help to ensure customers for life.

Summary

Developing great customer relationships is not something which happens overnight. It takes practice and persistence that normally happens on the job. Asking probing questions and matching the customer mailing and shipping need to a specific product or service will ensure that you build and strengthen that customer relationship.

Take advantage of every opportunity to talk to your customers, ask the right questions, and find the best solution to that customer's needs. Every transaction should end with the customer knowing that the Postal Service offers the best prices with great service performance; equating to the best value in the marketplace.

Module 21: Mailability, Processing Categories, and Machinability

Objectives:

Upon Completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Define minimum and maximum size standards for mailable matter
- Name the five mail processing categories
- Determine the processing category of a mailpiece by using the Domestic Mail Manual (DMM) and Notice 3-A (Letter-Size Mail Dimensional Standards Template)
- Determine if a mailpiece is Nonmachinable
- Define Nonmachinable mail characteristics and how they affect prices

Time Allocated for Module:

- 45 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Discussion
- Group Activity

Summary:

- Mailability
- Processing Categories
- Nonmachinable Surcharge

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide
- Notice 3-A and Notice 3-S

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Notice 3-A and Notice 3-S

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-3.

Mailability

Mailpiece design and construction that conforms to Postal Service requirements reduce costs for the Postal Service. Proper design and construction of a mailpiece also ensures its mailability. Mailpieces not meeting minimum requirement criteria or exceeding certain maximums are nonmailable. Nonmailable means that the piece, as designed, is prohibited from the mailstream. No fee, surcharge, or additional postage can make a nonmailable item mailable.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-4 and refer participants to page 21-3.

Mailability refers to a mailpiece conforming to minimum and maximum size standards. The orientation of the delivery address on a letter-size piece generally establishes which dimensions of the piece are the length and the height. The height is perpendicular to the address as read.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-5.

Minimum Dimensions

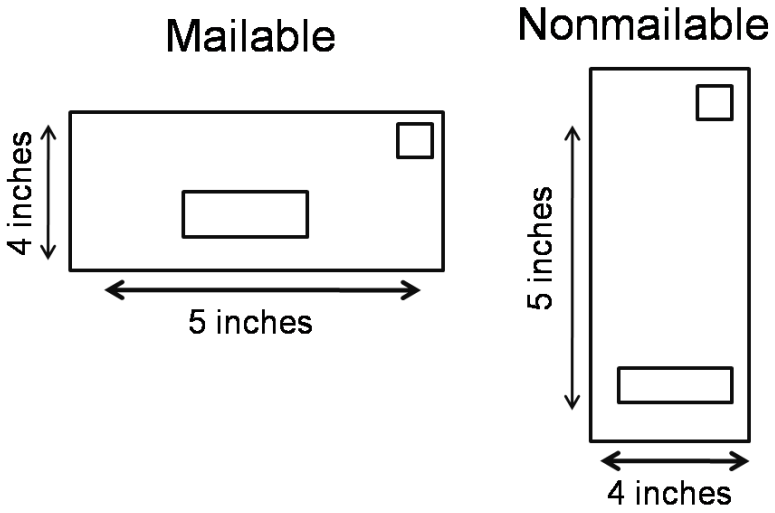
All mailpieces (except Customized Market Mail, keys and identification devices mailed under the applicable standards, DMM 705) that are ¼ inch thick or less must be:

- **Rectangular in shape**
  Note: Letter-size, card-type mailpieces made of cardstock may have finished corners that do not exceed a radius of 0.125 inch ($^{1}/_{8}$ inch).
- **At least 3 ½" in height**
- **At least 5" in length**
- **At least .007" in thickness**

Improper placement of the address on a letter-size mailpiece may result in a failure to meet minimum size standards and can render the mailpiece nonmailable.

Facilitator: Use Notice 3-A to demonstrate mailability requirements.

A letter-size mailpiece can be mailable or nonmailable, depending upon the orientation of the delivery address.



Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-6.

Maximum Dimensions

No mailpiece can weigh more than 70 pounds or measure more than 108 inches in length and girth combined (Exception: a Standard Post mailpiece over 108 inches but not more than 130 inches in combined length and girth is mailable at the applicable oversized price.) For parcels, length is the distance of the longest dimension and girth is the distance around the thickest part.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-7 and 21-8.

A mailpiece that is too small, too large or too heavy is not mailable. If a mailpiece does not meet the minimum size standards, it is nonmailable. If a mailpiece exceeds the maximum size or weight for the class of mail, it is nonmailable.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-9 and refer participants to page 21-4.

Processing Categories

Based strictly on the physical dimensions and characteristics of a mailpiece, regardless of address orientation, the mailpiece is assigned to one of the five (5) mail processing categories. These categories help the Postal Service determine prices, processing locations, equipment and mechanical needs, and transportation costs. The more successfully these areas are managed, the more cost effective we become, and the more efficiently and timely we can deliver each mailpiece.

All mailpieces entering the mail stream are separated into one of five mail processing categories:

- Letters
- Flats
- Machinable Parcels
- Irregular Parcels
- Outside Parcels

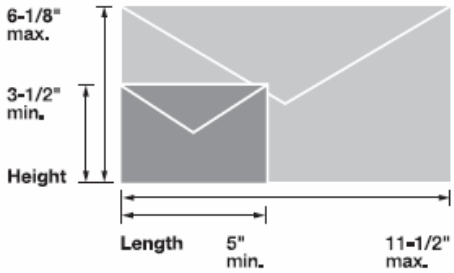
Refer to DMM 101, **Mail Processing Categories.** Remember that **processing categories** are determined by physical dimensions and characteristics; **NOT** by address placement.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-10.

Letter-Size Mail

Facilitator: Refer to DMM 101. Letter-Size Mail dimension standards. Use Notice 3-A to demonstrate letter-size dimensions.

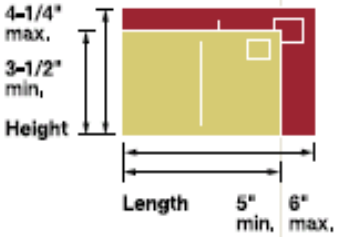
Letter Dimensions



	minimum	maximum
Length	5 inches	11-1/2 inches
Height	3-1/2 inches	6-1/8 inches
Thickness	0.007 inch	1/4 inch

- Rectangular.
- Minimum: 3½ inches high, 5 inches long, and .007 inch thick.
- Maximum: 6 $^{1}/_{8}$ inches high, 11½ inches long, and ¼ (.25) inch thick.
- Maximum weight 3.5 ounces.

Facilitator: Nonmachinable characteristics are listed in DMM 101.1.0 or IMM 241.217

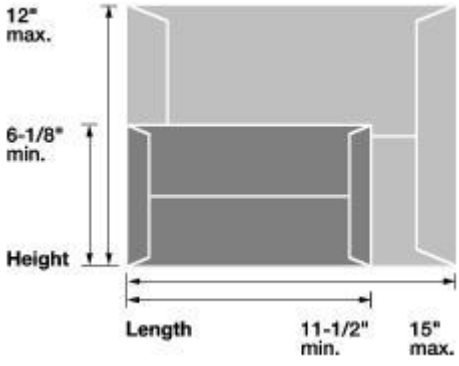
SHAPE	SIZE	
POSTCARDS	minimum	maximum
	length	5 inches	6 inches
	height	3-1/2 inches	4-1/4 inches
	thickness	0.007 inch	0.016 inch

Postcards must be rectangular. The minimum size for a postcard is 3½" high by 5" long by .007" thick and cannot exceed 4¼" high by 6" long by .016" thick to receive the postcard price. Cards larger than the maximum dimensions are charged letter prices. Postcards are processed as letters and fall into the letter processing category.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-11.

Flat-Size Mail

Facilitator: Refer to DMM 101, Flat-Size Mail dimension standards. Use Notice 3-S to demonstrate Flat-sized dimensions.

Flat Dimensions			
		Minimum*	Maximum
	Length	11-1/2 inches	15 inches
	Height	6-1/8 inches	12 inches
	Thickness	1/4 inch	3/4 inch
	* Flats exceed at least one of these dimensions		

- Flexible
- Uniformly thick
- Rectangular

- Minimum: more than 6 $^{1}/_{8}$ inches high OR more than 11½ inches long OR more than ¼ inch thick
- Maximum: 12 inches high and 15 inches long and ¾ inch thick
- The minimum flat-size dimensions must exceed at least ONE of the maximum letter-size dimensions

Flat-Size Pieces not Eligible for Flat Prices

Mailpieces that:

- Do not meet Flexibility standards
- Are not Uniformly thick
- Are not Rectangular in shape

First-Class Mail pieces pay the parcel price and Standard Mail pieces will qualify as either Standard Mail Marketing parcels or Parcel Select Lightweight parcels.

Uniform Thickness

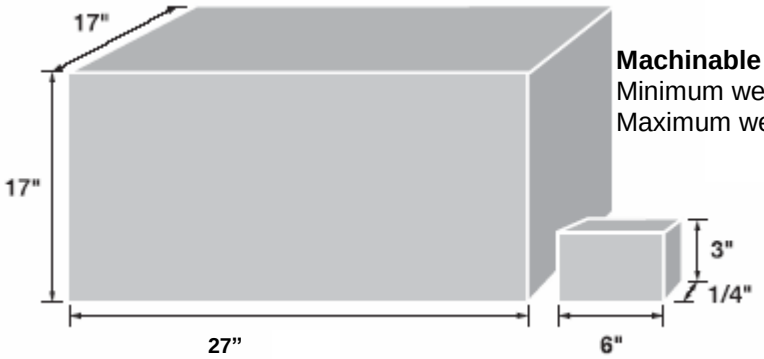
Flat-size mailpieces must be uniformly thick so that any bumps, protrusions, or other irregularities do not cause more than $^{1}/_{4}$-inch variance in thickness. (Do not consider the selvage when measuring variance in thickness.) If the contents are significantly smaller than the envelope, wrapper, or sleeve, mailers must secure those contents to prevent shifting of more than 2 inches within the mailpiece.

Facilitator: Refer to Notice 3-S First-Class Mail Shape-Based Pricing Template.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-12.

Refer to DMM 101.3.3, Machinable Parcels dimensions, and explain the size restrictions to learners.

Machinable Parcels



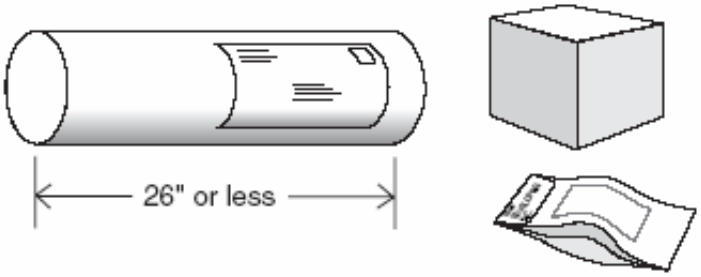
Machinable Parcels
Minimum weight: 6 ounces
Maximum weight: 25 pounds

- Machinable parcels must weigh at least 6 ounces, but not more than 25 pounds. High density parcels maximum weight is 15 pounds (Exception for lightweight parcels).
- Pieces may not be less than 3” in height, or less than 6” in length, or less than ¼” in thickness.
- Pieces may not exceed 17” in height, or 27” in length or 17” in thickness.
- Soft goods wrapped in paper or plastic bags and enveloped printed matter are machinable only if all packaging standards in 601.2.0 are met.
- Mailpieces that qualify for mailing as letter size, flat size, irregular parcels or outside parcels may not be prepared as machinable parcels.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-13 and refer to page 21-8.

Irregular Parcels

Facilitator: Refer to DMM 101 Irregular Parcels. (Nonmachinable) dimensions. Irregular Parcels are parcels that cannot be processed by Network Distribution Center (NDC) parcel sorters.



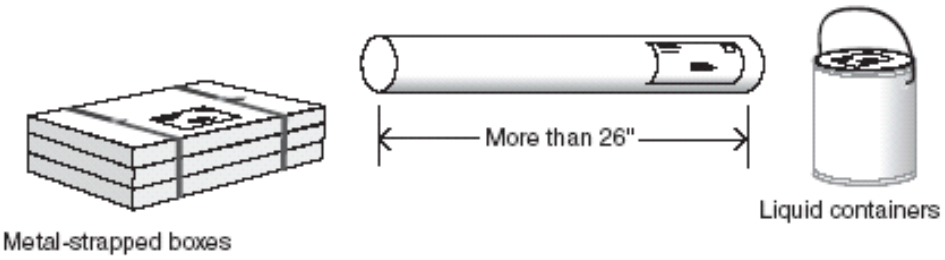
This includes parcels with any **one** of the following characteristics:

- Less than 6” in length, or less than 3” in height, or less than 6 ounces in weight.
- Rolls and tubes 26” long or less.
- Merchandise samples that are not individually addressed and not letter-size or flat-size.
- Unwrapped, paper-wrapped, or sleeve-wrapped articles that are not letter size (DMM 101) or flat size (DMM 101).
- Articles enclosed in envelopes that are not letters, flats or machinable parcels.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-14 and refer participants to page 21-9.

Outside Parcels

Facilitator: Refer to DMM 101, Outside Parcels (Nonmachinable) dimensions. Outside parcels are those parcels which, because of their size, shape, density, container type, or the nature of their contents, cannot be processed in postal sacks.



Outside parcels may have the following characteristics:

- Length more than 27”, or height more than 17”, or thickness more than 17”.
- Weight more than 25 pounds or 15 pounds if identified as high density.
- Rolls and tubes longer than 26”.
- Metal band strapped boxes, metal boxes, and wooden boxes.
- Articles outside of boxes or other containers, including tires, trailer hitches, exhaust pipes, shrubs, and trees.
- Harmful and hazardous matter or materials that meet requirements of DMM 601.10.
- Containers with all dimensions exceeding the minimum dimensions of a machinable parcel, where the friction coefficient or ability to slide on a smooth hard surface is not similar to that of a domestic class fiberboard box of the same size and weight.

The maximum weight for all parcels is 70 pounds. However, maximum length and girth combined can be up to 130 inches for Standard Post.

Nonmachinable Surcharge

First-Class Mail letter-size pieces that meet one or more of the nonmachinable characteristics are excluded from automated processing. Nonmachinable letter-size pieces are handled manually and subject to a nonmachinable surcharge. This does not apply to postcards.

Facilitator: Use Notice 3-A to demonstrate aspect ratio.

Letters

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-15. Refer participants to page 21-10.

DMM 101 lists the nonmachinable characteristics, which are the same for First-Class Mail letters (not postcards).

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-16.

The nonmachinable surcharge will be applied to First-Class Mail letters when any of the following conditions exist:

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-17.

- Aspect ratio (length divided by height) of less than 1.3 or more than 2.5.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-18.

- Is polybagged, polywrapped, enclosed in any plastic material, or has an exterior surface made of a material that is not paper.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-19.

- Clasps, strings, buttons or similar closure devices.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-20.

- Contains items such as pens, pencils, keys, or coins that cause the thickness of the mailpiece to be uneven; or loose keys or coins or similar objects not affixed to the contents within the mailpiece. Loose items may cause a letter to be nonmailable when mailed in paper envelopes; see DMM 601.2.3, *Odd-Shaped Items in Paper Envelopes*

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-21.

- Is too rigid (does not bend easily).

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-22.

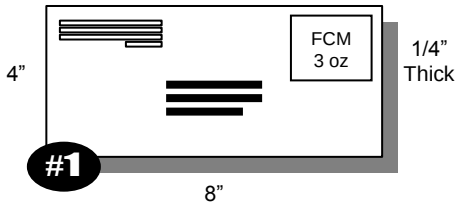
- Pieces more than 4 ¼ inches high or more than 6 inches long and the thickness is less than .009 inch.
- Has a delivery address parallel to the shorter dimension of the mailpiece.

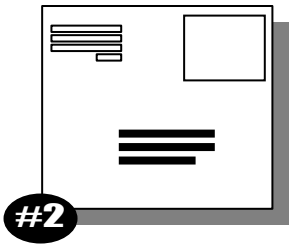
Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-23.

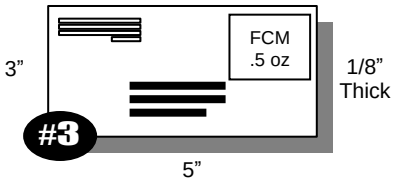
- Is a self-mailer that is not prepared (tabbed) according to DMM 201.3.14.1
- Is a booklet that is not prepared (tabbed) according to DMM 201.3.14.1

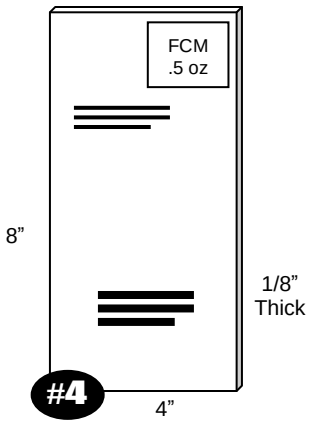
Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-25.

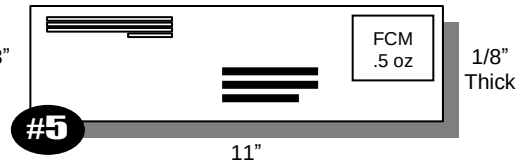
Facilitator: Have participant identify if the pieces on the following page are mailable, if so, identify the processing category, and determine nonmachinable characteristics.

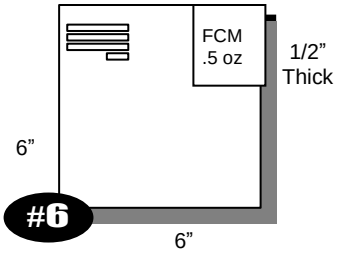

FCM
3 oz
4”
1/4”
Thick
8”
#1


#2

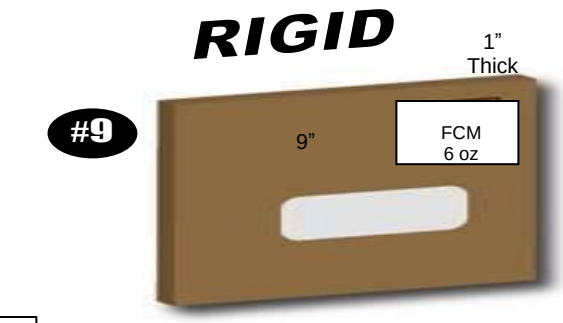

FCM
.5 oz
3”
1/8”
Thick
5”
#3

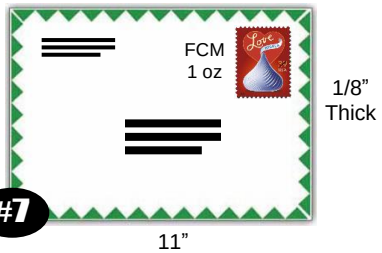

FCM
.5 oz
8”
1/8”
Thick
4”
#4

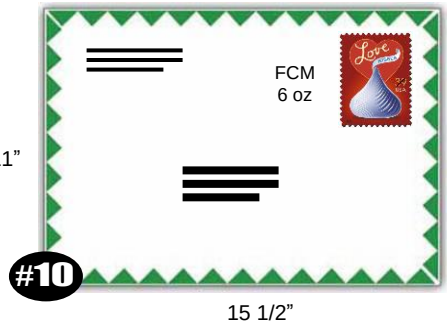

FCM
.5 oz
3”
1/8”
Thick
11”
#5

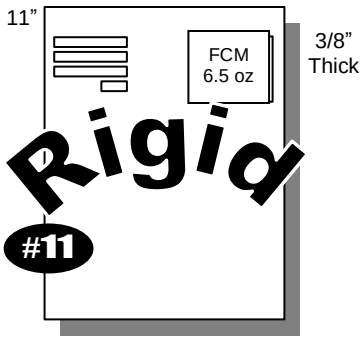

FCM
.5 oz
1/2”
Thick
6”
6”
#6

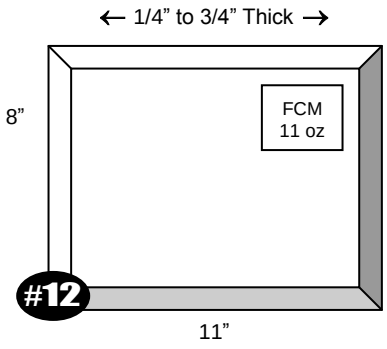

RICHARD BURTON
FCM
2.5 oz
8 1/2”
1/2”
Thick
BECKET
#8


RIGID
1”
Thick
FCM
6 oz
9”
#9

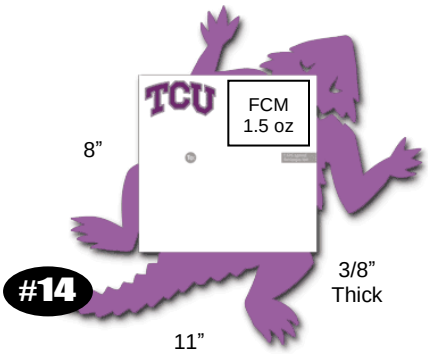

FCM
1 oz
6 1/2”
1/8”
Thick
11”
#7

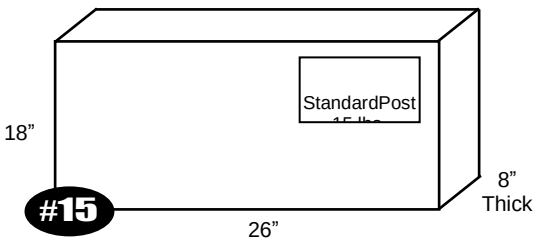

FCM
6 oz
11”
1/2”
Thick
15 1/2”
#10


11”
FCM
6.5 oz
3/8”
Thick
Rigid
#11


← 1/4” to 3/4” Thick →
8”
FCM
11 oz
#12
11”


FCM
2.5 oz
7 1/2”
1/2”
Thick
#13
5 1/4”


TCU
FCM
1.5 oz
8”
#14
3/8”
Thick
11”


StandardPost
18”
8”
Thick
#15
26”

MACHINABILITY Exercise Worksheet for *Participant Guide*

Directions	
Step 1: Mailability	Determine MAILABILITY with regard to the orientation of the address (identify "height" and "length").
Step 2: Processing Category	Determine the PROCESSING CATEGORY without regard to the orientation of the address.
Step 3: Price	Determine if the mailpiece has NONMACHINABLE Characteristics and is subject to the Nonmachinable surcharge

Item	Mailpiece Dimensions			STEP 1	STEP 2	STEP 3			
				Is it Mailable?	What is the Processing Category?	Does the mailpiece have NONMACHINABLE Characteristics and subject to the Nonmachinable surcharge?			
	Height	Length	Thickness	Yes or No	Letter, Flat, Machinable Parcel, Irregular Parcel, Outside Parcel	Class of Mail (FCM)	Weight	Nonmachinable criteria	Rationale
1	4"	8"	1/4"			FCM	3 oz		
2	6"	6"	1/8"			FCM	.5 oz		
3	3"	5"	1/8"			FCM	.5 oz		
4	8"	4"	1/8"			FCM	.5 oz		
5	3"	11"	1/8"			FCM	.5 oz		
6	6"	6"	1/2"			FCM	.5 oz		
7	6 1/2"	11"	1/8"			FCM	1 oz		
8	8 1/2"	4 1/2"	1/2"			FCM	2.5 oz		
9	4 1/2"	9"	1"			FCM	6 oz		
10	11"	15 1/2"	1/2"			FCM	6 oz		
11	8 1/2"	11"	3/8"			FCM	6.5 oz		
12	8"	11"	1/4" – 3/4"			FCM	11 oz		
13	7 1/2"	5 1/4"	1/2"			FCM	2.5 oz		
14	8"	11"	3/8"			FCM	1.5 oz		
15	18"	26"	8"			Standard Post	15 lbs		

ANSWER KEY Mail Processing Category Identification Exercise Worksheet									
Directions	Step 1: Mailability	Determine MAILABILITY with regard to the orientation of the address (identify "height" and "length").							
	Step 2: Processing Category	Determine the PROCESSING CATEGORY without regard to the orientation of the address.							
	Step 3: Price	Does the mailpiece have NONMACHINABLE Characteristics and subject to the Nonmachinable Surcharge?							
Item	**Mailpiece Dimensions**			**STEP 1**	**STEP 2**	**STEP 3**			
				Is it Mailable?	**What is the Processing Category?**	Does the mailpiece have NONMACHINABLE characteristics and subject to the Nonmachinable Surcharge?			
	Height	**Length**	**Thickness**	**Yes or No**	**Letter, Flat, Machinable Parcel, Irregular Parcel, Outside Parcel**	**Class of Mail (FCM, STD)**	**Weight**	**Nonmachinable criteria**	**Rationale**
1	4"	8"	1/4"	Yes	LETTER	FCM	3 oz	No	
2	6"	6"	1/8"	Yes	LETTER	FCM	.5 oz	Yes	Aspect Ratio
3	3"	5"	1/8"	No		FCM	.5 oz		
4	8"	4"	1/8"	No		FCM	.5 oz		
5	3"	11"	1/8"	No		FCM	.5 oz		
6	6"	6"	1/2"	Yes	FLAT	FCM	.5 oz	No	
7	6 1/2"	11"	1/8"	Yes	FLAT	FCM	1 oz	No	
8	8 1/2"	4 1/2"	1/2"	Yes	IRREGULAR PARCEL	FCM	2.5 oz	Yes	Irregular Parcel
9	4 1/2"	9"	1"	Yes	MACHINABLE PARCEL	FCM	6 oz	No	
10	11"	15 1/2"	1/2"	Yes	MACHINABLE PARCEL	FCM	6 oz	No	
11	8 1/2"	11"	3/8"	Yes	MACHINABLE PARCEL	FCM	6.5 oz	No	
12	8"	11"	1/4" – 3/4"	Yes	MACHINABLE PARCEL	FCM	11 oz	No	
13	7 1/2"	5 1/4"	1/2"	Yes	IRREGULAR PARCEL	FCM	2.5 oz	Yes	Irregular Parcel
14	8"	11"	3/8"	Yes	IRREGULAR PARCEL	FCM	1.5 oz	Yes	Irregular Parcel
15	18"	26"	8"	Yes	OUTSIDE PARCEL	Standard Post	15 lbs	Yes	Outside Parcel

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 21-28.

Summary

Mailpiece design and construction that conforms to Postal Service requirements reduce costs for the Postal Service. Proper design and construction of a mailpiece also ensures its mailability. Mailability refers to a mailpiece conforming to minimum and maximum size standards Mailpieces not meeting minimum requirement criteria or exceeding certain maximums are non-mailable. No fee, surcharge, or additional postage can make a non-mailable item mailable.

A mailpiece that is too small, too large or too heavy is not mailable. If a mailpiece does not meet the minimum size standards, it is nonmailable. If a mailpiece exceeds the maximum size or weight for the class of mail, it is nonmailable.

Processing categories of mail are based strictly on the physical dimensions and characteristics of a mailpiece, regardless of address orientation; the mailpiece is assigned to one of the five (5) mail processing categories. These categories help the Postal Service determine prices, processing locations, equipment and mechanical needs, and transportation costs. The more successfully these areas are managed, the more cost effective we become, and the more efficiently and timely we can deliver each mailpiece.

All mailpieces entering the mail stream are separated into one of five mail processing categories: Letters, Flats, Machinable Parcels, Irregular Parcels or Outside Parcels.

Module 22: Product Knowledge and Best Value

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify features and benefits of retail products and services
- Recommend and sell premier products and services; specifically Priority Mail Express , Priority Mail, Insured Mail, and PO Boxes
- Communicate the purpose of each product available during a customer retail experience
- Describe the purposes of each product to the customer to ensure the customer is receiving the best value for mailings
- Identify and offer the products and/or services which provide the best value to customers
- Identify features and basics of retail acceptance for Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM)

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 Hour 15 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Group Activity

Summary:

- Promoting Products and Services
- Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM)
- Identifying and Offering the Best Value

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer,
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation

- Rip chart Promoting Products and Services

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-3.

Promoting Our Products and Services

Facilitator: Review the Promoting Our Products and Services information with the class.

The USPS sells a variety of products and services to meet the changing demand of our customers. Continuous service improvement is focused on aligning product and service features with customer needs. Customers count on you, our sales and services associates, to be knowledgeable about the features and benefits of postal products and services. As a skilled associate, you can share product information with customers and can assist them in making informed decisions concerning their purchases.

Knowledge is power and for SSAs, product knowledge can mean more revenue. It is difficult to effectively sell our products and services to a customer if you cannot explain how a particular product or service will address the customer's needs.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-4 and refer participants to page 22-3.

Let's explore some of the ways that knowing the products you sell can benefit customers and the Postal Service.

Strengthens Communication Skills - Having a thorough understanding of the products we offer can help you to use different techniques and methods of presenting the product to customers. Stronger communication skills will allow you to recognize and adapt a sales presentation for the various types of customers.

Boosts Enthusiasm - Being completely enthusiastic about a product is one of the best selling tools. As you generate excitement for the product, you remove any uncertainty that the product may not be the best solution for that customer. The easiest way to become enthusiastic is to truly believe in the product.

Assists in Overcoming Concerns – Concerns or objections made by customers may be struck down with factual information regarding the product. That information usually comes in the form of product knowledge. Being well versed not only in postal products, but with similar products sold by our competitors, allow you to easily counter objections.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-5.

Research has proven that customers frequently feel dissatisfied and are less likely to return when the person assisting them lacks the knowledge to provide options. As a sales and services associate, you must be knowledgeable of all postal products and services to effectively provide solutions to our customers and reinforce that the customer has made the right choice. Offering information about the features and benefits of our products and services helps to ensure that our customer needs are being met and an opportunity for additional business is developed.

What is Product Knowledge?

Product knowledge is being aware of what we have to offer, being proficient at our jobs and making the effort to inform our customers. Product knowledge is also the willingness and desire to help a customer select the correct product. The goal is not to "up sell" a customer, but to correct sell.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-6.

Why is Product Knowledge Important?

- Provides personal satisfaction in helping a customer
- Increases customer knowledge
- Increases revenue
- Increases interaction between the sales and services associates and customer
- Empowers the sales and services associates to be the expert
- Ensures loyal, satisfied, returning customers

Customers choose coming to the post office versus our competitors because we are dependable, trustworthy and knowledgeable. Customer relationships are built on trust and product knowledge. Knowledge of our products allows us to share that with our customers and sets us apart from the competition. When interfacing with customers, it is critical that we inform and offer the best solution to fit their needs.

Being informed of current acceptance procedures, new stamp releases, new products and the many constant changes in our business, not only builds customer knowledge but allows employees to be the expert in the retail mailing and customer service business. The Postal Bulletin and www.usps.com are excellent sources that provide up-to-date information concerning our business. Knowledge of our products and services allows us to be the vendor of choice.

Product knowledge helps us accomplish the retail mission of the Postal Service to provide quality products and services at a reasonable cost. By asking questions and listening with attention, energy and skill, we are able to offer solutions and maintain loyal customers that continue to use our products and services.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-7.

Gaining Product Knowledge

Product Knowledge comes in various forms from a product's features for its intended purpose, to what goes with what, and how the product works. Retail Associates are expected to know the features and benefits of postal products sufficient enough to effectively explain the products or service to our customers.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-8.

There are many opportunities to gain the information you need to be proficient to sell postal products and services. Information on each service is usually available online at USPS.com and on the Bluepage. There is also printed literature which can be helpful when answering customer questions and determining the correct product or service. We will be discussing some of these references later in this training.

Every customer experience should end with that customer feeling special and appreciated. When we fail to address and respond to our customers needs, those same customers have other options. Failing to provide total satisfaction with every business encounter could result in customers taking their business elsewhere. It is important to remember that a missed opportunity to meet a customer’s needs equals missed revenue.

Facilitator: Become comfortable and confident in providing correct product information to customers, product explanation equates to an improved customer experience and ultimately, increased revenue.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-9.

Promoting Premier Products

Facilitator: SSAs should match customers' shipping needs with premium products and services such as Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail.

You should tell customers with great confidence that Priority Mail packages are just as reliable as our competitors' one, two and three day products. You can have a great impact on service by fully understanding all products and services and using that knowledge to increase business.

In addition to premier products like Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail, two services which can meet customers' needs and increase revenue for the Postal Service are Insured Mail and Post Office Boxes.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-10 and refer participants to page 22-6.

Priority Mail Express

Priority Mail Express is a class of mail with the Guaranteed by End of Day delivery, 365 days a year. It is the fastest service for time-sensitive letters, documents or merchandise. Priority Mail Express offers overnight delivery to most locations or the customer gets their money back.

- The fastest way to send packages
- Delivery to most destinations 365 days per year – even Sundays and holidays
- No Saturday delivery charges
- No residential surcharges
- No fuel surcharges
- Free tracking information
- The only overnight delivery to mailboxes and PO Boxes addresses
- Signature proof of delivery available upon request

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-11.

Priority Mail

Priority Mail is a class of mail typically used to send documents, gifts, and merchandise. Priority Mail Flat-Rate boxes and envelopes give customers a single, predetermined rate regardless of the weight or delivery zone for Domestic and International Mail.

- Nationwide delivery within one-three days in most locations
- Fast and affordable

- Flat-rate boxes and envelopes that ship for one flat price regardless of weight or destination. If it fits, it ships!
- Domestic can weigh up to 70 pounds
-
- Delivery to every address in the U.S. including PO Boxes and military addresses (APO/FPO)
- Saturday and residential deliveries at no extra cost
- Automatically includes USPS Tracking and $50 of insurance coverage when purchased at retail.
- Extra services such as Signature Confirmation, Insurance, and other services are available for all Priority Mail shipping
- International
  - Flat-Rate envelope and small boxes limits of 4 pounds
  - Medium and large flat-rate boxes are limit of up to 20 pounds

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-12.

Insured Mail

The Postal Service provides the security and peace of mind needed when a customer sends a valuable item through the mail. The insurance should not exceed the value of the item(s) shipped since evidence of value or estimated repair costs will be required if a claim is filed. Priority Mail Express automatically includes $100 insurance coverage; Priority Mail includes $50 coverage for Retail and Commercial Base shipments and $100 coverage for Commercial Plus.

There are three convenient ways to add insurance to a package:

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-13.

Purchase insurance online

- Provides up to $5,000 indemnity coverage for a lost or damaged item
- Automatically includes proof of delivery
- Online option to file claims for domestic insurance is available

Note: Insurance purchased online cannot be combined with insurance purchased at a Post Office.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-14.

Purchase insurance at a Self-Service Kiosk

- Provides up to $5,000 indemnity coverage for lost or damaged items
- Self-Service Kiosks are available in many Post Office lobbies. Some 24 hours a day, seven days a week and accept credit cards and most debit cards.
- Does not require an additional Insurance label
- Insurance available only for domestic labels printed with postage

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-15.

Purchase insurance at any Post Office

- Provides up to $5,000 indemnity coverage for a lost or damaged items
- For items of greater value requiring additional insurance, customers can use Registered Mail, which covers up to $25,000. Registered Mail can only be used with First-Class Mail and Priority Mail.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-16.

PO Boxes

A premier service available to customers is Post Office Boxes. In addition to being a great value, PO Boxes offer customers privacy, security, and flexibility. It provides customers with the ability to get their mail when and where it is most convenient. There are many benefits of renting a PO Box including:

Fast - Mail typically arrives faster at a PO Box than at a residential or business address.

Private - Use a PO Box address for selected contacts and transactions.

Affordable – Low affordable fees for three, six and twelve month terms. Customers can receive one month free if paid twelve months upfront on initial purchase.

Permanent – A customer can move around, but their PO Box address stays the same.

Good business – Customers can open PO Boxes in multiple cities and expand business opportunities.

Convenient –Customers can choose a location close to work or home - whatever fits their needs. Select Post Offices have extended business hours and/or 24-hour lobby access.

Customers can renew a PO Box on-line with a credit card or through an automatic renewal process. PO Boxes can also be renewed at a Self-Service Kiosk, by sending a check or money order or in person at a post office.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-17 and refer participants to 22-8.

ACTIVITY: Divide the class into groups of three. Have each group conduct a role play of an interaction between a sales and services associate and a customer. Assign each person to play a part in the role-play activity.

A – Plays the part of a customer who is unsure of the best way to get a package to a friend who lives in another state

Instruct the person playing the part of the customer to be very generic when first interacting with the SSA; requiring the Sales and Services Associate to engage the customer.

B – Plays the part of a Sales and Services Associate working the counter at a busy Post Office

C – Observes and offers feedback based on the interaction during the role-play

At the end of the role-play, have each observer report what went well with the interaction and what, if any, additional discussion points could have enhanced the overall customer experience.

Debrief by covering the following suggested interaction points:

The person playing the part of the SSA should have asked open-ended questions to determine the customer's needs prior to identifying and suggesting the best product or service to meet that need.

Asking the right questions and offering the best solution will result in maintaining excellent customer relationships, fostering customer loyalty, and increasing lifetime customer value.

Based on when the customer needed the package to arrive, the SSA should have provided the customer with information on Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail.

Priority Mail Express:

- **The fastest way to send packages**
- **Delivery to most destinations 365 days per year – even Sundays and holidays**
- **No Saturday delivery charges**
- **Free USPS Tracking**
- **Includes $100 insurance coverage**
- **The only overnight delivery to mailboxes and PO Boxes**

Priority Mail:

- **Free USPS Tracking**
- **Nationwide delivery within one-three days in most locations**
- **Fast and affordable**
- **Flat-rate boxes and envelopes that ship for one flat price regardless of weight or destination**
- **No weight limit (up to 70 pounds)**
- **Includes $50 insurance when mailed at retail**
- **Delivery to every address in the US including PO Boxes and military addresses (APO/FPO)**

Another role play option is to have one person play the part of a customer who runs a business from his home. While sending a package at the post office, the customer mentions that his mail is getting delivered late in the afternoon and his business is being negatively impacted.

The second person will play the part of the SSA assisting this customer.

The third person will observe and offer feedback based on the interaction during the role-play.

Again, at the end of the role-play, have each observer report what went well with the interaction and what, if any, additional discussion points could have enhanced the overall customer experience.

Suggested interaction:

- **SSA should recommend a PO Box and explain the features and benefits of renting a PO Box.**
- **Provides privacy, security, and flexibility**
- **Customer's mail can be picked up at the PO Box earlier than when it is being delivered**
- **Getting mail earlier could help to expand business opportunities**
- **PO Box is affordable and a great value**
- **Depending on the office, there may be extended business hours and/or 24-hour lobby access**

Sales and Services Associate/Customer Interaction Activity

Within your group, conduct a role play of an interaction between a sales and services associate and a customer. You will play the part assigned to you by the facilitator.

A – Plays the part of a customer who is unsure of the best way to get a package to a friend who lives in another state

B – Plays the part of a SSA working the counter at a busy post office

C – Observes and offers feedback based on the interaction during the role-play

When the role-play is completed, the observer will report what went well with the interaction and what, if any, additional discussion points could have enhanced the overall customer experience.

Facilitator: Introduce EDDM as an example of one way the Postal Service offers value to our customers.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-18, 22-19, 22-20 and 22-21 and refer participants to page 22-9.

Every Door Direct Mail - Retail

The Postal Service has opened up a whole new way for customers to reach local markets. Customers that mail 5,000 or fewer flat-sized mailpieces within an area serviced by a single Post Office can use Every Door Direct Mail-Retail. The Retail option allows customers to mail small volumes at Retail using cash, check, debit card, or full-pay meter indicia. These customers do not need to purchase a permit when they utilize the Every Door Direct Mail-Retail option, but they must register.

Customers do not have to acquire an address list or print specific names on their mailpieces. This reduces their mail preparation costs and helps to build their business.

We provide customers with an online tool to help them choose mailing routes by neighborhood, ZIP Code, city, or a target area around their business. The online tool identifies the number of active households and businesses in chosen areas to estimate postage. Then, customers are prompted to generate and print out the appropriate documentation and facing slips to take with their mailing to the Post Office.

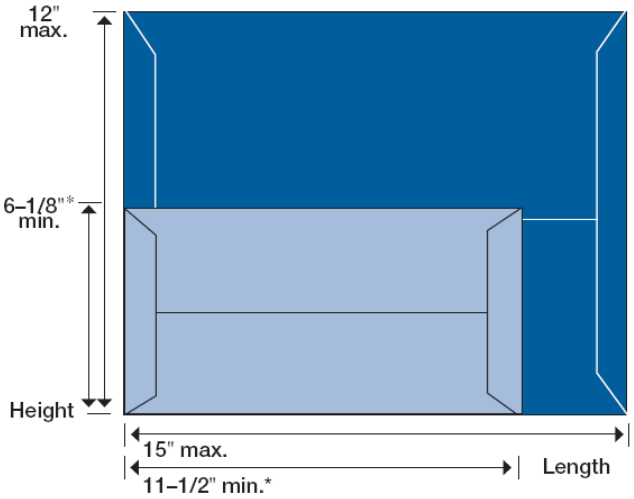
For Internal Use Only

Flats Dimensions

- Maximum weight 15.994 ounces
- Pieces that exceed any maximum flats dimension are parcels



PRSRT STD
ECRWSS
U.S.POSTAGE
PAID
EDDM Retail



*Flats exceed at least one of these dimensions.

	Minimum*	Maximum
Length	11–1/2 inches	15 inches
Height	6–1/8 inches	12 inches
Thickness	1/4 inch	3/4 inch
Weight		15.994 ounces

*Flats exceed at least one of these dimensions.

Flats with the following characteristics pay parcel prices:

- Not flexible
- Not rectangular
- Not uniform in thickness

Additional mailing requirements

- Minimum 0.007 inches thick (about the same as 2–3 sheets of copy paper)
- Per-piece weight limit of 3.3 oz (heavier pieces must be entered at BMEU)
- Approved EDDM Retail postage indicia (see sample above) containing ECRWSS in the address area or within or below the permit indicia
- Postage paid in advance using cash, check, PIN debit card, or metered postage (no trust fund payments accepted).

Documentation from mailer

- Retail postage statement PS 3587 or PS 3602-R with manifest slip
- Sample mailpiece
- Facing slip or carrier route information line on each bundle of 50

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM) New Functionality Guide v1.00

Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM) New Functionality Guide

06/14/12 (v1.00)

IMPORTANT: This guide is intended to be read by all POS ONE users no more than two weeks prior to the functionality being activated in their units.

Regarding the use of this guide: POS ONE training materials are produced by USPS Retail Operations and may be sent to the field electronically for the purpose of convenience, cost effectiveness and timely delivery. The materials are not to be electronically edited and reprinted without permission of Retail Operations.

Note: The sign in sheet at the back of this guide should be recorded and maintained locally.

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      B. EDDM Mailing without Online Receipt (PS Form 3587)

II. **Back Office Changes**
   2. Every Direct Door Mail - Unit Report

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I. Front Office Changes

1. Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM)

Under **[Customer Services]**, the **<Pre-paid Mail Acceptance>>>** button has been changed to **<Pre-paid Mail / Shipment Acceptance>>>** and will include the new EDDM workflow.

When the **<Pre-paid Mail / Shipment Acceptance>>>** is selected, you will be taken to the current Pre-paid Mail Acceptance screen, with the new option **<Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM)>** added to the third button. See screen below.



This workflow will allow you to:

- Accept an EDDM mailing with an online receipt. (Note: online receipt is referring to PS Form 3587)
- Accept an EDDM mailing without an online receipt. (Note: online receipt is referring to PS Form 3587)

The workflows for each of these are described below.

file:///C|/...ttings/EP151006/My%20Documents/Software%20Release/R54.0%20Docs/Ebook01/LatestNewFunc/EDDM_nfg/EDDM_nfg.htm[6/14/2012 3:09:29 PM]

Facilitator: Direct participants to the appendix to view the EDDM New Functionality Guide.

Identifying and Offering the Best Value

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-22 and refer participants to page 22-12.

Product Offering and Product Explanation

Effective product offering and product explanations of Postal Service products and services are key to generating revenue and keeping our customers coming back. The Postal Service offers many products and services. Many customers do not know about the products and services that the Postal Service offers. Employees need to educate customers so that they can make an informed mailing decision.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-23.

It is important to let your customers decide how they want to mail their article. Do not assume that the customer wants the cheapest price. Remember that customers want value, not necessarily the cheapest price. They want to know their options. By offering customers Postal Service premium services and explaining the service standards, the customers can make an informed mailing decision based on information which is presented to them.

Facilitator: Proper use of product offerings and product explanations at your office can make the difference in whether your office achieves its revenue goals and customer satisfaction targets. Review your office's Retail Customer Experience for Product Offerings and Product Explanations. Discuss opportunities for improvement.

As a sales and services associate, you have the task of identifying the customer's needs and offering a product and services to meet these needs. Remember, customers want value, not necessarily the cheapest price.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-24.

Let's take a look at a couple of examples:

> A customer approaches the counter and tells the SSA, "I have to send this package to my granddaughter. I saw a commercial and think I would like to use Priority Mail."

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-25.

> The SSA responds, "You know, if it doesn't have to get there in the next few days you don't need to send it Priority Mail. You can send it Standard Post and it will be much cheaper."

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-26.

The customer did not ask about the **cheapest** service available to send a package. She was trying to confirm that Priority Mail was the service to get her package to her grandchild.

Did the customer really want the cheapest? Is the customer really looking for the best value for the price? Do you think this is this an opportunity for revenue generation?

Facilitator: Ask the participants to think of a recent purchase. Did the associate offer the cheapest product? Take for example, buying a new car. Don't the salespeople try to sell the model complete with all the bells and whistles? How about when you purchase perfume? Do the associates start with the store brand? Again, these are revenue opportunities.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-27.

It is important that you understand what the customer's values are and don't let your own get in the way. Not everyone wants the cheapest price. Most people want good value for the price, which isn't necessarily the same thing as the lowest price. Customers are looking for quality, selection, convenience, and service in addition to price. Every customer values these elements differently and you should never assume how our customer prioritizes them.

So, what is the best way to determine what a customer is thinking? That's easy. Just ask. The SSA helping the woman with her package should have answered her question and/or asked for clarification.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-28.

The SSA's own assumption was the basis for the way in which he/she responded. Never assume the customer is shopping on price alone unless they have specifically told you so either verbally or non-verbally. Remember, most people want a good price, not simply a cheap price.

To truly be successful, don't assume you know what is important to the customer. When you ask your customer what they need, you may well learn that they don't really know the answer yet. But by asking good follow-up questions, together you can determine what the customer truly values.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 22-29.

Summary

The USPS sells a variety of products and services to meet the changing mailing and shipping demand of our customers. Customers count on sales and services associates, to be knowledgeable about the features and benefits of postal products and services.

Knowledge is power and for sales and services associates, product knowledge can mean more sales. It is difficult to effectively sell our products and services to a customer if you cannot explain how a particular product or service will address the customer's needs.

As a sales and services associate, you must be knowledgeable of all postal products and services to effectively provide solutions to our customers and reinforce that the customer has made the right choice

Product knowledge is being aware of what we have to offer, being proficient at our jobs and making the effort to inform our customers. Product knowledge is also the willingness and desire to help a customer select the correct product. It is not to "up sell" a customer, but to correct sell.

Product knowledge is important because it provides personal satisfaction in helping a customer, increases customer knowledge, increases revenue, increases interaction between the sales and services associate and customer, empowers the SSA to be the expert and ensures loyal, satisfied, returning customers

Product knowledge helps us accomplish the retail mission of the Postal Service to provide quality products and services at a reasonable cost.

There are many opportunities to gain the information you need to be proficient at selling postal products and services. Information on each service is usually available on-line at USPS.com and on the USPS Bluepage. There is also printed literature which can be helpful when answering customer questions and determining the correct product or service.

Module 23: Dimensional Weight and Other Pricing Considerations

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Explain to customers the reason for Dimensional Weight Pricing
- Calculate Dimensional Weight
- Identify packages that meet Balloon Price and Oversized Price criteria
- Apply Dimensional Weight Pricing and Balloon Price to Priority Mail packages
- Apply Balloon Price and Oversized Price to Standard Post packages

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion

Summary:

- Dimensional Weight Pricing
- Balloon Price
- Oversized Price

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip chart
- Measuring tape

Dimensional Weight Pricing

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 23-3 and review the Dimensional Weight pricing information with the class.

Dimensional weight pricing is applying a dimensional weight to Priority Mail packages that are more than one cubic foot (1,728 cubic inches) and are destined for Zones 5 through 8.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 23-4.

Dimensional weight pricing applies only for Priority Mail and is a mechanism that converts the cubic size (capacity) of an item into a dimensional weight. If a large Priority Mail package is addressed for delivery to Zones 5-8, it could be charged as a heavier-weight item due to its size. The maximum size for mailing a Priority Mail item is 108 inches combined length and girth.

Did You Know?

Packages shipped in USPS-provided Priority Mail packaging are not subject to dimensional weight pricing or balloon rate.

What to Tell the Customer

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 23-5.

Dimensional weight pricing helps ensure that postage accurately reflects transportation and operational costs when a package is large in size and takes up a lot of space. Similar pricing practices are used by our competitors. For irregularly-shaped packages, there is an adjustment factor that ensures a dimensional weight assessment is 21.5% lower than for rectangular-shaped packages. This is something that our competitors do not offer.

Determining the Shape

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 23-6.

Mailpieces come in different shapes and sizes. It is important to determine which shape price category applies. The determination is made by the length, width, thickness, and weight of the item.

Dimensional Weight Pricing Criteria & Calculations

Facilitator: Most packages will not be measured since they will not meet the below criteria.

Dimensional Weight Pricing Criteria

- Priority Mail
- Measures more than one cubic foot (1,728 cubic inches)
- Item is destined for Zones 5 through 8

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 23-7 and refer participants to page 23-4.

Determining Dimensional Weight Pricing

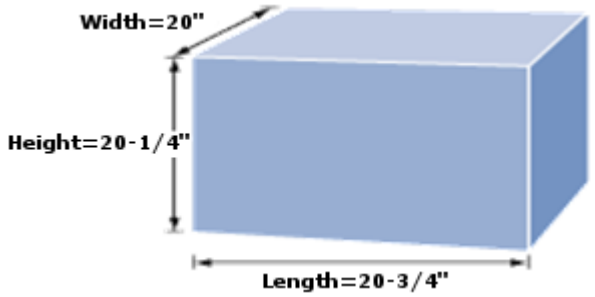
1. Weigh the item (round any fraction of a pound to the next whole pound).
2. Determine if measurements are required (use a measurement template if available).
3. If needed, measure the length, width, and height (round off individual measurements to the nearest inch) and enter measurements into retail equipment.

   Facilitator: Dimensional weight will be calculated in POS ONE and an electronic scale or Postal Explorer CD-ROM at most manual offices. Other manual offices must perform steps 4 thru 6.

4. Multiply the length by the width by the height. This figure is the cubic capacity. If the result is 1,728 cubic inches or less, dimensional pricing does not apply. Postage will be based on the scale weight and the appropriate zone.
5. Rectangular-Shaped Package: If the result from step 4 above is more than 1,728 cubic inches, divide it by 194 to determine the dimensional weight. Round up any fraction of a pound to the next whole pound. The applicable postage is based on the scale weight or the dimensional weight, whichever is greater, and the appropriate zone.

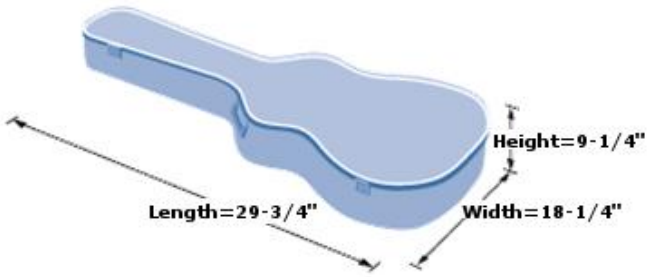
6. Irregularly-Shaped Package: Multiply the result from step 4 above by the 0.785 adjustment factor. If the result is more than 1,728 cubic inches, divide it by 194 to determine the dimensional weight. Round up any fraction of a pound to the next whole pound. The applicable postage is based on the scale weight or the dimensional weight, whichever is greater, and the appropriate zone. If the result is 1,728 cubic inches or less, dimensional pricing does not apply and postage will be based on the scale weight and the appropriate zone.

Dimensional Weight Pricing: Rectangular-Shaped Items



Example: 21" x 20" x 20" = 8,400 cubic inches / 194 = 43.29 pounds, which is rounded up to 44 pounds.

Dimensional Weight Pricing: Irregularly-Shaped Items



Example: 30" x 18" x 9" = 4,860 cubic inches x 0.785 = 3,815.1 / 194 = 19.67 pounds, which is rounded up to 20 pounds.

Facilitator: Demonstrate how to measure length, height and girth. Provide an example of a package that measures 20"L X 20" W X 20" H and weighs 40 pounds. Demonstrate the difference between the Dimensional Weight price and the regular price using Price List, Notice 123.

Dimensional Weight Pricing FAQs

Why is dimensional weight pricing important with Priority Mail?

Dimensional weight pricing is an important component of Priority Mail because it allows our prices to better align with transportation costs. For example, air transportation costs are based on the cubic size (capacity) of the package—not its weight—while our current prices are weight-based.

Dimensional weight pricing only applies to Priority Mail packages larger than one cubic foot and traveling to destinations within Zones 5-8 (zones which use air transportation).

When dimensional weight pricing for Priority Mail packages is implemented, will there still be a (minimum) balloon rate?

Yes; for Priority Mail packages measuring larger than 84 inches (but not more than 108 inches) in combined length and girth traveling to destinations within Zones 1-4 that weigh less than 20 pounds. The minimum rate would be 20 pounds (up from 15 pounds).

Would anything mailed in a Priority Mail Box ever be subject to dimensional weight pricing or the balloon rate?

No.

Dimensional weight pricing calculations seem to be complicated. Will POS ONE support dimensional pricing?

Yes. POS ONE will perform the calculations for dimensional weight pricing when provided the appropriate measurements. Non-POS sites and customers can also perform these measurements on the rate calculator available at USPS.com.

Other Pricing Considerations

Other pricing considerations for Priority Mail and Standard Post packages include the Balloon Price (20-pound price) and the Oversized price (Standard Post only).

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 23-8 and refer participants to page 23-6.

Balloon Price

Balloon Pricing applies to:

- Priority Mail packages (addressed for delivery to local and Zones 1–4 only)
- Standard Post parcels

Parcels that weigh less than 20 pounds but measure more than 84 inches (but not more than 108 inches) in combined length and girth are charged the applicable price for a 20-pound parcel (balloon price).

The balloon price for Priority Mail is limited to local and Zones 1–4 only, to reflect the costs of handling and transporting large parcels via surface transportation. No Priority Mail item will ever be subject to both dimensional-weight and balloon-rate pricing.

Standard

Parcel Post

RETAIL—PARCELS

Weight Not Over (pounds)	Zone[1]						
	1 & 2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	$5.20	$5.25	$5.35	$5.45	$5.55	$5.60	$5.70
2	5.30	5.65	6.16	7.49	7.78	8.13	8.83
3	5.75	6.53	7.37	8.54	9.36	9.87	11.14
4	6.17	7.33	8.10	9.51	10.41	11.10	12.09
5	7.29	8.42	9.18	10.34	11.08	11.74	12.70
6	8.01	9.28	10.13	11.17	11.74	12.38	13.48
7	8.46	9.98	10.66	12.03	12.65	13.39	14.61
8	8.77	10.48	11.03	12.40	13.27	14.13	15.51
9	9.01	10.81	11.43	12.77	13.86	14.85	16.39
10	9.27	11.17	11.80	13.16	14.48	15.62	17.29
11	9.56	11.50	12.19	13.52	15.07	16.34	18.18
12	9.86	11.86	12.53	13.88	15.68	17.08	19.05
13	10.19	12.18	12.92	14.24	16.29	17.85	19.97
14	10.49	12.54	13.30	14.61	16.89	18.57	20.88
15	10.79	12.87	13.66	14.97	17.49	19.33	21.78
16	11.09	13.23	14.04	15.35	18.11	20.08	22.66
17	11.42	13.55	14.42	15.71	18.70	20.84	23.55
18	11.73	13.93	14.79	16.19	19.32	21.56	24.46
19	12.03	14.26	15.13	16.68	19.91	22.31	25.35
20	12.33	14.61	15.48	17.15	20.53	23.06	26.23

For example, a Standard Post package that measures 90 inches and weighs 15 pounds is presented for mailing. The 15 pound price for the destination of the parcel is $17.49. However, since the package measures over 84 inches, you must charge the customer the 20 pound price for the destination of $20.53 (Prices are for demonstration only. Please check a current version of Price List, Notice 123).

Facilitator: Priority Mail items measuring more than 108 inches in combined length and girth and Standard Post items that measure more than 130 inches in combined length and girth are nonmailable.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 23-9 and refer participants to page 23-7.

Oversized Price

Oversized Pricing applies to Standard Post packages that measure over 108 inches but not more than 130 inches in combined length and girth. This price is charged regardless of the weight (up to 70 pounds) (Prices are for demonstration only. Please check a current version of Price List, Notice 123).

Standard

Facilitator: Packages weighing over 70 pounds are nonmailable.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 23-10.

Summary

It is important to understand and use Dimensional Weight Pricing whenever applicable. As a SSA, you will use the DIM Weight Pricing Worksheet for manual offices when the POS system is not available.

Dimensional Weight Pricing and other pricing considerations provide a good opportunity for the Postal Service to generate revenue. Correctly identifying packages that meet the criteria for Dimensional Weight Pricing, the Balloon Price, and the Oversized Price and applying correct pricing to those packages will help to protect retail revenue and ensure that postage accurately reflects transportation and operational costs.

Module 24: Products eLearning Review

Objectives:

Based on this comprehensive review of the Domestic Mail, International Mail, Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail eLearning modules you will be able to:

- Identify the features and benefits associated with customer use/selection of Domestic, International, Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail
- Sell Domestic Mail, International Mail, Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail products to customers

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Discussion

Summary:

- Domestic Mail
- International Mail
- Priority Mail Express
- Priority Mail
- Dimensional Weight
- Priority Mail Flat-Rate Shipping
- Commercial Base Pricing
- Extra Services

Participant Material Used:

- Participants Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer

- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation

Facilitator: This module is designed as a participant review activity to reinforce the product information presented in eLearning lessons.

There are three options to present this material.

1. **Utilize the PowerPoint presentation to support facilitation of the material.**
2. **Divide class into two groups. Each group formulates ten questions relating to topics within this module.**

   Formulated questions are posed alternately to the opposing group. The group collectively responds to the opponent's questions.

   Allow groups 10 minutes to formulate questions and 20 minutes for question and answer session. Groups are rewarded one point for each correct answer and the group with the highest score at the end of the activity is declared the winner.
3. **Divide the class into equal teams and utilize round one of the Quiz Bowl presentation to support facilitation of the material. Team with the most points at the end of all three rounds is declared the winner.**

Domestic Mail

Domestic mail consists of items sent within the United States, its territories and possessions including Army Post Offices (APOs), Fleet Post Offices (FPOs) and the United Nations.

Mailing Services

Mailing Services are those products in which the Postal Service has no competition from other delivery companies

First-Class Mail

- Items that consist of handwritten or typewritten personal correspondence such as bills or statements of account, postcards, and Business Reply Mail must be mailed as First Class Mail, Priority Mail, or may be upgraded to Priority Mail Express
- Any mailable item that weighs 13 ounces or less can be sent by First-Class Mail

- First-Class Mail items are sealed against inspection and offer security for both the sender and the receiver
- Delivery standard is one to three business days
- Forwarded free for up to 12 months, and will be returned free of charge if it cannot be delivered

Periodicals

- Authorized publications such as magazines and newspapers whose primary purpose is transmitting information
- Must be published at least four times a year at a stated frequency
- Accepted at Business Mail Entry Unit (BMEU) only

Standard Mail

- Used to send printed matter, flyers, advertising, newsletters, catalogs and small packages
- Customers must perform some of the work the Postal Service would otherwise do
- Mailers must have at least 200 pieces or 50 pounds of pieces per mailing
- Single piece of Standard Mail must weigh less than 16 ounces
- Customers must pay an annual presort fee at each facility where they enter mail
- Accepted at Business Mail Entry Unit (BMEU) only

Package Services

- Bound Printed Matter, Media Mail and Library Mail
- Items are not sealed against postal inspection
- The required markings for the sub-class must appear in the postage area on each mailpiece
- Pieces not clearly marked as required are treated as single-piece Standard Post and are subject to additional postage as necessary

Bound Printed Matter

- Sheets must be permanently-bound by secure fasteners such as staples, spiral binding, glue, or stitching
- Bound Printed Matter mailpieces can weigh up to 15 pounds
- Pricing is based on weight, distance, and shape and is paid by permit imprint only
- Presort mailers pay for postage from a permit imprint advance deposit account
- No longer accepted at the window, accepted at Business Mail Entry Unit (BMEU) only

Library Mail

- Content is limited to books, sound recordings, academic theses, and certain other items
- To qualify for Library Mail prices, items must be sent to, from or between educational organizations, museums and other qualified organizations
- Each piece can weigh no more than 70 pounds

Media Mail

- Limited to books, sound recordings, recorded video tapes, printed music, recorded computer-readable media, such as CDs, DVDs, and certain other items
- Cannot contain advertising except for incidental announcements of books
- Each piece can weigh no more than 70 pounds

Standard Post

- Gifts and merchandise
- Can weigh up to 70 pounds and measure up to 130 inches in combined length and girth
- Pricing is based on weight, distance, and shape
- Surcharge applies to certain items including parcels weighing over 35 pounds, or 25 pounds for books and printed matter, and certain shapes such tubes, rolls, and parcels measuring over 84 inches in combined length and girth

Extra Services

- Enhancements that provide greater security and accountability of mailpieces, for a fee, in addition to postage
- Offers
  - Proof of mailing with Certificate of Mailing and Certified Mail
  - Protection in transit with Insured Mail and Registered Mail
  - Evidence of delivery with Registered Mail, Return Receipt, Restricted Delivery, Return Receipt for Merchandise, USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, and Collect on Delivery (COD)

Shipping Services

Shipping Services are those products in which the Postal Service is competitive with other delivery companies. These services include many of the premier products offered to the public.

Priority Mail Express

- Guaranteed overnight delivery to most destinations 365 days a year
- Sunday and holiday delivery is available to many destinations for an additional fee
- Offers tracking, proof of delivery, insurance up to $100 at no cost, and a money-back guarantee
- Packaging is free to customers using the service
- Any amount of material that will fit in the container without reconfiguring the packaging or exceeding 70 pounds will ship at the Flat-Rate price

Priority Mail

- Typically used to send documents, gifts and merchandise
- Offers expedited one, two or three day service to most domestic destinations
- No minimum weight, however, items may not weigh more 70 pounds or measure more than 108 inches in combined length and girth
- Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes allow customers to ship packages for one price regardless of the weight or domestic destination

Parcel Select

- Ground delivery service for parcels, entered in bulk
- Designed for large and medium mailers
- Offers mailers the ability to save money by entering parcels at
  - Destination Delivery Unit (DDU)
  - Area Distribution Center (ADC)
  - Network Distribution Center (NDC)

Parcel Return Service

- Postal Service's bulk parcel return product
- Provides a convenient way for merchants who send a large volume of parcels to receive returned merchandise from their customers
- Allows customers to return merchandise to merchants without paying postage.

Zone Charts

- Used to compute Priority Mail Express , Priority Mail and Standard Post prices
- Identify the appropriate distance code assigned to each originating and destination ZIP Code pairing for every ZIP Code in the nation
- Create a ZIP Code matrix based on origination and destination of the mailing and identify the correct zone for the distance

Additional Pricing Considerations

Oversize Price

- Applies to Standard Post pieces that measure over 108 inches but not more than 130 inches in combined length and girth

Balloon Price

- Applies to Standard Post and Priority Mail addressed for delivery to zones 1 through 4
- Mailpieces that weigh less than 20 pounds and measure over 84 inches in combined length and girth are charged the price for a 20-pound parcel for the zone to which it is addressed

Dimensional Weight Pricing

- Applied to Priority Mail packages shipped to zones 5-8 that have any dimension that exceeds one cubic foot (1,728 cubic inches)
- Determined by multiplying the length by the height and by the width (H x L x W). If the result is 1728 or more, divide the result by 194
- To calculate the dimensional weight for odd shaped items, multiply the length, height and width and then multiply the result by .75. If the result is 1728 or more, divide the result by 194
- Package shipping price is based on the higher of two weights, the actual weight, or the dimensional weight. POS ONE can assist in calculating the dimensional weight

Addressing, Packaging, Preparation and Sealing

Addressing

- Address the mailpiece on the side that bears postage
- Ensure that only one delivery address is displayed
- Ensure that the address contains all required elements
  - Recipient Name
  - Delivery Address
  - City, State and ZIP Code
- Return address should be located in the upper left corner on the front of the mailpiece

Packaging

Preparation

- Cushioning should be used all around the items being mailed to protect fragile items

Sealing

- Customers should tape the opening of the box and reinforce all seams with 2-inch wide clear or brown packaging tape, reinforced packing tape, or paper tape
- Cord, string, twine, masking or cellophane tape should not be used.
- Boxes that originally contained common hazardous materials like bleach, household cleaners, and liquor must have all original markings and labels on the box removed or completely obliterated to be accepted for mailing
- Postal Service employees may not remove, cross out, or obliterate markings or labels on a mailpiece, even if directed to do so by a mailer

International Mail

There are four categories of International Mail First-Class Mail International, Priority Mail International, Priority Mail Express International, and Global Express Guaranteed. Each category has a specified delivery standard.

- International Mail Manual (IMM) outlines postage prices and conditions for mailing for International Mail
- Items that are not acceptable for domestic mail are also non-mailable in International Mail

First-Class Mail International

- Delivery standard varies by destination.
- Encompasses airmail letter-post, post cards, printed matter, flats and small packets
- Prices start at one ounce
- Items are sealed against inspection and are subject to pricing by shape

Addressing

- Entire right half of the address side of the envelope, package, or card should be reserved for the destination address, postage, labels, and postal notations
- Delivery addresses must appear in ink or be typewritten.
  - Pencil is unacceptable
- All outbound International Mail *should* bear the complete return address of the sender

Dimensions

- International First-Class Mail must be at least 5-1/2 inches in length, 3-1/2 inches in height, and .007 inches thick
- Maximum weight is four pounds
- Weight limit for letter-size First-Class Mail International is 3.5 ounces
- Letter-size First-Class Mail International pieces exceeding 3.5 ounces are charged the First-Class Mail flat-size price
- First-Class Mail International flat price, pieces can weigh no more than 4 pounds
  - Must be rectangular and meet the standards for flexibility and uniform thickness in the IMM
- Flats must exceed 11 ½ inches in length or 6 1/8 inches in height or ¼ inch in thickness, and not exceed 15 inches long, 12 inches in height or ¾ inches in thickness
- Small Packets must measure no more than 24 inches in length and 36 inches in length, height and depth combined
- Packages must be large enough to accommodate the postage, address, return address, customs form and markings
- Rolls, must measure at least 4 inches in length, and at least 6-3/4 inches when the length and twice the diameter of the roll are combined
- Rolls must measure no more than 36 inches in length and no more than 42 inches when the length and twice the diameter of the roll are combined

Markings

- First-Class Mail International packages must be marked "LETTER-POST" on the address side of the mailpiece
- First-Class Mail International mail
  - Ensure that it is marked "LETTER" and "AIR MAIL/PAR AVION" or that Label 19 is affixed

Customs Form

- Items that weigh less than 16 ounces without potentially dutiable contents do not require a customs form
- When mailing dutiable items, the sender must use PS Form 2976, *Customs Declaration* and follow the special instructions in the Individual Country
  - Maximum value for dutiable merchandise is $400

Extra Services

- Certificate of Mailing, Registered Mail service, Return Receipt, and Restricted Delivery service
- Check the Individual Country Listings in the IMM for country-specific availability and other extra services

Priority Mail International (PMI)

- Reliable, cost-effective way to send documents and merchandise
- Designed for outbound international postal parcels
  - 6-10 average business day delivery with tracking to major destinations
- Limited indemnity coverage is provided at no extra charge
- Coverage is limited to the maximum indemnity based on the weight of the article or to the actual value of the contents, whichever is less
- Offers special pricing for pieces destinating in Canada and Mexico
- All domestic Priority Mail Flat-Rate packaging can be used for international shipping
  - 4 pound weight maximum for the Flat-Rate Envelope and small Flat-Rate Box
  - No tracking or insurance available for the Flat-Rate Envelope

  - Regular, medium, and large Flat-Rate Boxes have a 20 pound weight maximum
- Ordinary and insured parcel weight limits vary by country and are noted in the Individual Country Listings, but may not weigh more than 70 pounds

Extra Services

- Certificate of Mailing service, Return Receipt service, Registered Mail service, and Insured Mail service
  - Check POS ONE or the IMM for country-specific availability

Customs Form

- Completed PS Form 2976-A, *Customs Declaration and Dispatch Note*

Priority Mail Express International

- Average business days to delivery will be displayed on POS ONE terminals and will vary by origin and destination.
  - Individual Country Listings found in the IMM
  - Maximum weight limit for any Priority Mail Express International shipment is 70 pounds
- Shipments are insured against loss up to $100 at no additional charge
- Shipments containing non-negotiable documents are insured for up to $100 at no additional charge
- Money-back service guarantee
  - Australia, China, Hong Kong, Japan, and the Republic of South Korea
- Tracking services available
- Maximum size and weight dimensions for Priority Mail Express International service vary by country and are noted in the IMM.
- Packaging
  - May use domestic Priority Mail Express packaging
  - Special prices to Canada
  - Online postage incentives
  - Coins, jewelry, watches, and other valuables are prohibited in Priority Mail Express International.

- Extra Services
  - Option to purchase additional insurance up to a maximum of $5,000
- Return Receipt Service

Customs Forms

- Complete PS Form 2976-B, Priority Mail Express International Shipping Label and Customs Form

Global Express Guaranteed

- Delivery in 1 to 3 business days
- Money-back guarantee to certain destinations
- Includes delivery status information with our Track & Confirm tool
- Maximum weight is 70 lbs. Some countries have lower weight restrictions
  - Weight limits vary by country from 22 lbs to 70 lbs.
  - Check the Individual Country Listing for Global Express Guaranteed service to find dimension standards for each country
- Most hazardous materials cannot be shipped
- With few exceptions, cigarettes and smokeless tobacco shipments cannot be mailed
- $100 liability insurance
  - Additional insurance coverage above $100, up to a maximum of $2,499 may be purchased at the sender's option

Dimensions

- Maximum dimensions for any for any shipment may not exceed 46 inches in length, 35 inches in width, 46 inches in height, or a combined length and girth of 108 inches

Customs Forms

- Global Express Guaranteed Air Waybill/Shipping Invoice (Item 11FGG1), and if applicable, PS Form 6182, *Commercial Invoice*
- PS Form 2976-E, *Customs Declaration Envelope*

Priority Mail Express

- Offers guaranteed on-time Next 1-Day or 2-Day delivery 365 days per year with expedited handling from the time of acceptance through delivery.
- Priority Mail Express includes:
  - Insurance coverage up to $100 free of charge
  - Free USPS Tracking and confirmation services
  - No extra charge for Saturday delivery
  - Online price incentives at USPS.com
  - Sunday and holiday Guaranteed Delivery is available for an additional fee

1-Day Delivery

- Items must be mailed by the drop-off or cut-off time to meet the delivery commitment

Priority Mail Express 2-Day Delivery

- Items are delivered to the addressee by noon or 3 p.m. on the second delivery day
- Recipients can pick up their packages when it is convenient for them. Priority Mail Express Hold For Pickup (HFPU) service includes an automated callback notification to customers about the arrival status of their package

Priority Mail Express Military Service (PMEM)

- Is available between the United States and designated APO/FPO addresses to provide military personnel stationed overseas, and others entitled to APO/FPO mailing privileges, an expedited delivery service to or from the United States

Priority Mail Express Labels

- Priority Mail Express Label 11-HFPU, *Hold For Pick Up*
  - Used by customers sending Priority Mail Express shipments that will be held for pickup at the location identified on the label
- Priority Mail Express Label 11-B, *Post Office to Addressee*

- Used by customers sending shipments that will be delivered to the recipient's address
- Labels are available at any Post Office, generated by customers online or at Self-Service Ship and Mail Centers
- When accepting Priority Mail Express
  - Verify that the customer has properly completed the required sections of the Priority Mail Express Label
  - Complete the ORIGIN POSTAL SERVICE USE ONLY section of the form
- When the Priority Mail Express Hold For Pickup (HFPU) shipment arrives at the designated Hold For Pickup location, you, as the receiving employee, will complete the DESTINATION POST OFFICE section

Packaging

- Priority Mail Express envelopes and boxes are available to customers free of charge
- Priority Mail Express Flat-Rate Envelopes and boxes eliminate the need for weighing and calculating postage. If it fits, it ships!

Extra Services

- Return Receipt
- Additional Insurance
- Collect On Delivery (COD)

Commercial Base Pricing

- Customers who ship a high volume of Priority Mail Express may be eligible for Commercial Base Pricing incentives when they use approved shipping services
- Approved shipping services include: Click-N-Ship, USPS Corporate Account (USPSCA), Federal Agency Account, or a Postage Evidencing System such as Endicia, Stamps.com, Pitney-Bowes, or eBay
- Commercial Base price incentives apply to postage only
- Discounts are not offered on extra services such as the Sunday and Holiday delivery premium

Scanning

- Mailpiece barcode is scanned upon Arrival at Unit, and scanned again upon Arrival at Pickup Point
- Date Received information is entered in the Date and Time Received sections and the receiving employee enters their initials
- Scan triggers an automatic notification to the recipient identified during the acceptance transaction

Refunds

- If service commitments are not met, a Priority Mail Express refund may be issued upon customer's request
- Refunds are not made if the delay was caused by the proper detention of the Priority Mail Express article for law enforcement purposes, any strike or work stoppage, the late deposit of the Priority Mail Express article by the customer, if the article must be forwarded, if the article is returned to sender, if the delivery address is incorrect or has an incorrect ZIP Code, or if flights used for transportation are delayed or cancelled
- No refund is paid when governmental actions, beyond the control of the Postal Service or air carriers, war, insurrection, or civil disturbance, or the breakdown of a substantial portion of the Postal Service transportation network, or acts of God result in delivery delays

Priority Mail

- Premier shipping product typically used to send documents, gifts, merchandise, large or thick envelopes, tubes or packages containing mailable items
- Offers expedited one, two or three day service depending on the destination of the package
- Customers do not pay extra for residential delivery, extended area delivery, additional handling, address corrections, or missing or incorrect account numbers
- Includes USPS Tracking at no charge

Retail and Commercial Base shipments include $50 insurance; Commercial Plus shipments include $100 insurance coverageWeight and Size Standards

- No minimum weight
- Items may not weigh more 70 pounds or measure more than 108 inches in combined length and girth

Surcharges

- Balloon Pricing and Dimensional Weight Pricing for lightweight and odd-shaped Priority Mail piece.

Balloon Pricing

- Charged for packages that are both large and lightweight to better align postage with transportation costs
- Applies to Priority Mail addressed for delivery to zones 1 through 4
- Mailpieces that weigh less than 20 pounds and measure over 84 inches in combined length and girth are charged the price for a 20-pound parcel for the zone to which it is addressed

Dimensional Weight

- Applies to Priority Mail packages shipped to zones 5-8 that have any dimension that exceeds one cubic foot (1,728 cubic inches)
- Dimensional Weight Pricing helps to ensure that the postage charged accurately reflects transportation and operational costs when a package is large in size and takes up a lot of a space

- Dimensional weight is determined by multiplying the length by the height and by the width (H x L x W). If the result is 1728 or more, divide the result by 194
- To calculate the dimensional weight for odd shaped items, multiply the length, height and width and then multiply the result by .75. If the result is 1728 or more, divide the result by 194
- POS ONE can assist in calculating the dimensional weight

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Shipping

- Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes allow customers to ship packages for one price regardless of the weight or domestic destination. If it fits, it ships!
- Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes are available at no cost
- Only Postal Service-produced Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes are eligible for flat rate prices

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelope

Six Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes that can be shipped for a Flat-Rate price.

Priority Mail Small Flat-Rate Box

- About the same size and shape as three stacked DVD cases
- It’s just right for jewelry, electronics, event tickets, paperback books, and other small items

Priority Mail Medium Flat-Rate Boxes

- Available in two sizes: top loading and side loading

Priority Mail Large Flat-Rate Box

- Has 50 percent more capacity than the Medium Flat-Rate Boxes
- Allow mailers of smaller items to consolidate shipments on multiple orders and save on shipping costs

Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelopes and Boxes

- Any amount of material, up to 70 pounds, may be mailed
- When sealing a Priority Mail Flat-Rate Envelope or Box, the container flap must be able to close within the normal folds

- Tape may be applied to the flaps and seams to reinforce the container; provided the design of the container is not enlarged by opening the sides and the container is not reconstructed in any way

Packaging and Postage Options

- Customers may order different shapes and sizes of Priority Mail Envelopes and Boxes at usps.com
- Customers can pay for Priority Mail postage and print Priority Mail labels online using Click-N-Ship
- Customers may also use their own packaging or ReadyPost® supplies for Priority Mail shipments
  - These mailpieces must be labeled as Priority Mail using official Priority Mail labels and tape

Commercial Base Pricing

- Customers who ship a high volume of Priority Mail may be eligible for Commercial Base Pricing incentives when they use approved shipping services
- Approved shipping services include: Click-N-Ship or a Postage Evidencing System such as Endicia, Stamps.com, Pitney-Bowes, or eBay
- Commercial Base price incentives apply to postage only

Extra Services

Extra Services include

- Certificate of Mailing
- Certified Mail
- Collect on Delivery (COD)
- USPS Tracking (included)
- Insured Mail ($50 included for Retail Commercial Base; $100 for Commercial Plus)
- Registered Mail
- Restricted Delivery
- Return Receipt
- Return Receipt for Merchandise
- Signature Confirmation

- Special Handling.

Summary

The Postal Service offers a variety of Domestic Mailing Services to our customers. They include First-Class Mail, Periodicals, Standard Mail, Package Services, and Extra Services.

Shipping Services are those products in which the Postal Service is competitive with other delivery companies. These services include many of the premier products offered to the public. Domestic Shipping Services include Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, Parcel Select, and Parcel Return Service.

There are four categories of International Mail First-Class Mail International, Priority Mail International, Priority Mail Express International, and Global Express Guaranteed, Each category has a specified delivery standard

Priority Mail Express is a premium service offered by the Postal Service that offers guaranteed on-time 1-Day or 2-Day delivery 365 days per year with expedited handling from the time of acceptance through delivery of the mailpiece. Priority Mail Express includes insurance coverage up to $100 free of charge, free USPS Tracking and confirmation services, no extra charge for Saturday delivery, online price incentives at usps.com and Sunday and holiday Guaranteed Delivery is available for an additional fee.

Priority Mail Express envelopes and boxes are available to customers free of charge at local post offices or by ordering them online at usps.com.

Priority Mail is a Postal Service premier product and is typically used to send documents, gifts and merchandise. Priority Mail offers expedited one, two or three day service depending on where the package is going. Large or thick envelopes, tubes or packages containing mailable items can be sent using Priority Mail.

Priority Mail customers have a wide selection of Priority Mail products from which to choose. Distinctive Priority Mail envelopes and boxes are available to customers at no cost, in a variety of sizes, providing high value shipping solutions to a broad range of customers.

Module 25: PO Box Service

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Explain the features and benefits of Post Office Box Service
- Explain the procedures for obtaining Post Office Box Service
- Describe the fee payment periods for Post Office Box Service
- Identify the forms for Post Office Box Service
- Explain the features and benefits of Caller Service
- Explain the features and benefits of General Delivery

Time Allocated for Module:

- 90 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Presentation, Demonstration, and Discussion

Summary:

- Features and benefits of PO Box Service
- Obtaining a PO Box
- PO Box fees
- Caller Service
- General Delivery

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE computer
- PowerPoint presentation and Rip Chart
- PS Form 1093, *Application for Post Office Box Service*
- PS Form 1094, *Request for Post Office Box Key or Lock Service*
- Notice 32, Box Rent Service Fee Due

Features and Benefits of PO Box Service

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-3. Refer participants to page 25-3.

This service is provided as a convenience for customers who wish to pick up their mail at the Post Office for security purposes or to make the mail available to them prior to being delivered by their carrier or at their own convenience during the hours the lobby is open.

Customers may open these boxes by keys or combination locks. Keys to Post Office Boxes are only available through the Post Office. There are two types of offices, Market Dominant and Competitive.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-4.

There is no fee for the first two PO Box keys in Competitive Sites. Market Dominant sites require a deposit for the first two keys. If a key deposit fee has been paid, it is refundable up to one year after the box is surrendered. Broken keys are replaced without charge if the damaged key is returned. Locks and combinations are changed each time a box is closed. A number is assigned to each box.

There are five different box sizes; however, all sizes may not be available at every facility. Customers rent a Post Office Box of a certain size according to their needs.

Obtaining a Post Office Box

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-5.

PS Form 1093, *Application for Post Office Box Service,* is used to obtain a Post Office Box. Customers must complete all appropriate entries on the form and return it to any Post Office that provides window services to the public, even if it is not the Post Office where the customer wishes to acquire the box. If parents or guardians do not object in writing, minors may obtain Post Office Box Service.

Anyone who is to receive mail in the assigned box should have his/her name listed on the PS Form 1093.

Facilitator: Discuss obtaining two forms of identification for everyone assigned to that PO Box.

Box Number(s) _____

Application for Post Office Box™ Service

Fill out all non-shaded fields, and take this application to the Post Office™.

1. This service is for *(Required selection):* ❑ Business/Organization Use ❑ Residential/Personal Use
2. Name of Business/Organization *(if applicable):*
3. Name of Person Applying (*Last, First, MI — include title if representing a business/organization):*
4. Address: Number, Street, Suite _____

   _____

   City _____ State _____ ZIP+4® _____

   Verify initials

5. Telephone Number *(Include Area Code)*
6. Email Address
7. Box Size(s) (Required) *See page 1 for details* ❑ Size 1 ❑ Size 2 ❑ Size 3 ❑ Size 4 ❑ Size 5
8. Applicant must select and enter the ID Number for two items of valid identification listed below. You must present the IDs at a Post Office. One item must contain a photograph and one must be traceable to the bearer (prove your physical address). Both must be current.

   Select one photo ID:

   ❑ Valid driver's license or state non-driver's ID card
   ❑ Armed forces, government, university, or recognized corporate ID
   ❑ Passport, passport card, alien registration card, or certificate of naturalization

   Photo ID Number: _____

   Select one non-photo ID:

   ❑ Current lease, mortgage, or deed of trust
   ❑ Voter or vehicle registration card
   ❑ Home or vehicle insurance policy

   Non-Photo ID Number: _____

Verify initials (For Post Office Use Only) _____

9. On the *back of this form*, list the name(s) of all individuals, including members of a business, who will be receiving mail at this (these) PO Box number(s).
10. On the *back of this form*, list the names of the persons or representatives of the business/organization authorized to pick up mail addressed to this (these) PO Box number(s).

Optional Automatic Renewal Payment — Terms and Agreement (Required for 3-month payment option)

By initialing below and establishing automatic renewal payments at a Post Office, I hereby authorize the U.S. Postal Service® (USPS®) to charge my credit card for the amount of my designated box size per USPS pricing on the scheduled interval I have selected (i.e., 3, 6, or 12 months). This charge could appear on my credit card statement as early as the 15th of the month prior to the due date. If I provided my email address, I understand that I will receive email notification at least 10 days prior to the actual credit card charge. I will also receive a payment due notice in my PO Box before the payment due date. I understand that I may cancel the automatic payment option any time after the initial application/payment process is complete during the business hours at the Post Office where my box is located. If I do not cancel by the 14th of the month prior to the next payment due date, I understand that the payment will be charged to my credit card. I understand that if the payment cannot be transacted due to incorrect or obsolete payment information or the transaction would exceed the credit limit of the account, or the bank or credit card company rejects/returns the payment request, my PO Box may be closed and any mail received after closure would be returned to the sender. If my PO Box is closed for nonpayment, I understand that I could be charged a late payment fee to reactivate my PO Box service. If there are any changes to my credit card number, billing address, or expiration date, I agree to notify the Post Office where my box is located of these changes. I understand that this agreement will remain in effect until I or USPS terminates the PO Box service. The USPS may receive updated credit card account information from the institution that issued the card identified for payment. If I decide to close my PO Box, I must visit the Post Office where my box is located during business hours. (See the PO Box refund policy for information on refunds.) The USPS may terminate my participation under this automatic payment agreement in the event I provide incorrect, false, or fraudulent account information or if I have any returned payment items.

Customer Initials _____ **Billing Address** (*if different from address in 4 above):*

Number, Street, Suite _____

City _____ State _____ ZIP+4® _____

Application Date	Number of Keys Issued	Customer Eligible for No-Fee Service	
	_____	❑ Yes ❑ No	

Signature of Applicant *(Same as item 3)* I certify that all information furnished on this form is accurate, truthful, and complete. I understand that anyone who furnishes false or misleading information on this form or omits information requested on this form may be subject to criminal and/or civil penalties, including fines and imprisonment.

_____

Post Office Date Stamp

PS Form **1093,** January 2012 (Page 3 of 4) 7530-02-000-7165. See our Privacy Act Statement on page 4 of this form.

Facilitator: Discuss obtaining two forms of identification for everyone assigned to that PO Box.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-6 and refer participants to page 25-4.

When you accept an application for Post Office Box Service, you must first perform your local verification procedures:

- You must obtain two forms of valid identification, one being a photo ID and the other must include the customer's physical address.
- Note: With PS Form 1093. Social Security cards are not acceptable as identification.
- The applicant must present at least one of the following photo IDs:
  - Drivers license or state non-driver identification card
  - Military, government, university or an established corporate identification card
  - Passport
  - Alien registration card
  - Certificate of naturalization

In addition to the Photo ID, the applicant must show positive proof that they are the bonafide occupant of the address listed on the PS Form 1093 (Deed, lease, utility bills, mortgage, voter registration, vehicle registration, home or vehicle insurance policy in their name).

An application will be considered verified if there are no discrepancies between the information on PS Form 1093 and the identification presented.

The address shown on the PS Form 1093 must be verified within three workdays. The applicants must reside or conduct business at the address shown.

If the information on the form does not match that on the identification, further verification procedures must be conducted which will substantiate that the applicant resides or conducts business at the address shown. This verification should be completed within 3 work days.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-7.

Customers may sign up for and pay for PO Boxes online with a credit card. The payment includes the three, six or twelve month fee and the key deposit where applicable (there is no key deposit for combination boxes).

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-8.

The customer must bring the online PS Form 1093 and two forms of ID with them to the Post Office to get their keys and box number. You must enter the ID information on PS Form 1093. The completed Form 1093 must be submitted to the Web Box Activity Tracking System (WebBATS) clerk for entry.

If you work in a Point of Sale (POS) office, you will be able to retrieve the customer's record by entering the "issue online pre-paid box" POS workflow and entering the customer's telephone number.

For non-POS offices, access the Online Transaction Report in WebBATS, open the appropriate record and enter the information (including ID information) to activate the box.

PS 1093-A, *Application for Post Office Box™ Service Automatic Recurring Renewal Payment* offers current PO Box customers the convenience to set-up an automatic renewal payment option for every 3-month payments.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Application for Post Office Box™ Service Automatic Recurring Renewal Payment
(Current Post Office Box Customers Only)

Fill out all non-shaded fields and take this application to the Post Office.

1. Name of Applicant *(Last, First, MI) (include title if representing a business/organization)*	2. Email Address *(required for automatic payment notifications)*
3. Name of Business/Organization *(if applicable)*	4. PO Box Number(s)
5. PO Box ZIP Code(s) *(if more than one ZIP Code, specify which box numbers in item 4 are associated with each ZIP Code)*	

Optional Automatic Renewal Payment — Terms and Agreement (Required for 3-month payment option)

By initialing below and establishing automatic renewal payments at a Post Office, I hereby authorize the U.S. Postal Service® (USPS®) to charge my credit card for the amount of my designated box size per USPS pricing on the scheduled interval I have selected (i.e., 3, 6, or 12 months). This charge could appear on my credit card statement as early as the 15th of the month prior to the due date. If I provided my e-mail address, I understand that I will receive e-mail notification at least 10 days prior to the actual credit card charge. I will also receive a payment due notice in my PO Box before the payment due date. I understand that I may cancel the automatic payment option any time after the initial application/payment process is complete during the business hours at the Post Office where my box is located. If I do not cancel by the 14th of the month prior to the next payment due date, I understand that the payment will be charged to my credit card. I understand that if the payment cannot be transacted due to incorrect or obsolete payment information or the transaction would exceed the credit limit of the account, or the bank or credit card company rejects/returns the payment request, my PO Box may be closed and any mail received after closure would be returned to the sender. If my PO Box is closed for nonpayment, I understand that I could be charged a late payment fee to reactivate my PO Box service. If there are any changes to my credit card number, billing address, or expiration date, I agree to notify the Post Office where my box is located of these changes. I understand that this agreement will remain in effect until I or USPS terminates the PO Box service. The USPS may receive updated credit card account information from the institution that issued the card identified for payment. If I decide to close my PO Box, I must visit the Post Office where my box is located during business hours. (See the PO Box refund policy for information on refunds.) The USPS may terminate my participation under this automatic payment agreement in the event I provide incorrect, false, or fraudulent account information or if I have any returned payment items.

Customer Initials _____ **Billing Address** (associated with credit card):

Number, Street, Suite _____

City _____ State _____ ZIP+4® _____

Application Date			

Signature of Applicant ***(Same as item 1)***

I certify that all information furnished on this form is accurate, truthful, and complete. I understand that anyone who furnishes false or misleading information on this form or omits information requested on this form may be subject to criminal and/or civil penalties, including fines and imprisonment.

_____

Post Office Date Stamp

Privacy Act Statement: Your information will be used to provide Post Office Box™ service and to ensure delivery to the box. Collection is authorized by 39 U.S.C. 401, 403, and 404. Providing the information is voluntary; but, if not provided, we will be unable to provide this service to you. We do not disclose your information to third parties without your consent, except to facilitate the transaction, to act on your behalf or request, or as legally required. This includes the following limited circumstances: to a congressional office on your behalf; to financial entities regarding financial transaction issues; to a U.S. Postal Service® auditor; to entities, including law enforcement, as required by law or in legal proceedings; to contractors and other entities aiding us to fulfill the service (service providers); to process servers; to domestic government agencies if needed as part of their duties; and to a foreign government agency for violations and alleged violations of law. Information concerning an individual box holder who has filed a protective court order with the postmaster will not be disclosed except pursuant to court order. For more information regarding our privacy policies, visit *usps.com/privacypolicy*.

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PS Form **1093-A**, January 2012 PSN 7530-13-000-7160

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-9. Refer participants to page 25-8.

PO Box Fees

PO Box size and fees are based on customer need. Fees for size and location of box are determined by referencing a published schedule of fees. A Post Office Box should be assigned immediately upon approval of the application and payment of the required fees.

Facilitator: First time customers that move from a competitor's site to a PO Box may qualify for a 'Bakers Dozen' and receive a thirteenth month of box rental free when they sign up for a 12 month rental. Fee calculations are located in the appendix.

- *First day of the month:* a box-rent service period always begins on the first day of the month. The period for a new Post Office Box is from the first day of that month if approved on or before the 15th or from the first day of the following month if approved after the 15th.

Facilitator: Refer participants to Box Rental Due Date chart page 25-8.

Box Rental Due Date Chart

IF RENTED DURING PERIOD FROM-T0	THREE MONTHS DUE DATE	SIX MONTHS DUE DATE	TWELVE MONTHS DUE DATE
JAN 1 THRU 15	MAR 31	JUNE 30	DEC 31
JAN 16 THRU 31	APR 30	JUL 31	JAN 31
FEB 1 THRU 15	APR 30	JUL 31	JAN 31
FEB 16 THRU 28	MAY 31	AUG 31	FEB 28
MAR 1 THRU 15	MAY 31	AUG 31	FEB 28
MAR 16 THRU 31	JUN 30	SEP 30	MAR 31
APR 1 THRU 15	JUN 30	SEP 30	MAR 31
APR 16 THRU 30	JUL 31	OCT 30	APR 30
MAY 1 THRU 15	JUL 31	OCT 31	APR 30
MAY 16 THRU 31	AUG 31	NOV 30	MAY 31
JUNE 1 THRU 15	AUG 31	NOV 30	MAY 31
JUNE 16 THRU 30	SEP 30	DEC 31	JUN 30
JUL 1 THRU 15	SEP 30	DEC 31	JUN 30
JUL 16 THRU 31	OCT 31	JAN 31	JUL 31
AUG 1 THRU 15	OCT 31	JAN 31	JUL 31
AUG 16 THRU 31	NOV 30	FEB 28	AUG 31
SEP 1 THRU 15	NOV 30	FEB 28	AUG 31
SEP 16 THRU 30	DEC 31	MAR 31	SEP 30
OCT 1 THRU 15	DEC 31	MAR 31	SEP 30
OCT 16 THRU 31	JAN 31	APR 30	OCT 31
NOV 1 THRU 15	JAN 31	APR 30	OCT 31
NOV 16 THRU 30	FEB 28	MAY 31	NOV 30
DEC 1 THRU 15	FEB 28	MAY 31	NOV 30
DEC 16 THRU 31	MAR 31	JUNE 30	DEC 31

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-10.

- ***First day of the month:*** Notice 32, *Box Rent Service Fee Due*, is placed in the boxes of all customers who are in the last month of their service period.
- ***On the 20th day of the month***: a reminder letter is generated from WebBATS and placed in the PO Boxes that are still due.
- ***Last day of the month (the due date):*** Box fees for renewal of service are due by the last day of the last month of the service period.
  - If a customer fails to pay the box fees by the due date, the following day, the box must be plugged or the combination changed. Continue distributing mail to the box, but do not deliver the mail to the customer until the box rent is collected.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-11.

- ***Ten days after the due date***: The customer is granted a 10 day grace period before a late fee is imposed. The box is plugged or the combination is changed. Mail is distributed to the box, but is not delivered to the customer until the box rent is collected.
- ***Eleventh day after the due date:*** The box must be closed. All mail is returned to the sender. Change the lock after 48 days unless the office has no other boxes available for rent. If the customer pays the box rental fee after the 10 day grace period, the box may be reactivated and a late fee is imposed. If the lock has already been changed, a change lock fee is imposed. The customer is charged only one of these fees, never both.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-12.

- ***Three months, Six months or one year:*** Customers may pay for 3, 6 or 12 consecutive months of service. If the fee increases, customers do not have to pay the new rate until the end of the paid period. To be eligible for the three month rental period, the customer must enroll in recurring payment. Recurring payment enrollment is available online or through POS offices.
- Customers may transfer post office service to a different facility within the same city and the same fee group without paying additional fees when transferring to a box of the same size. The customer must submit a new PS Form 1093 where the Post Office Box Service is desired. When a box is closed or surrendered the unused portion in 3 month blocks of the fee may be refunded. Refunds are requested on PS Form 3533, *Application for Refund of Fees, Products, and Withdrawal of Customer Accounts*.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-13.

- Two keys are provided to each customer upon renting a box. These keys are free at Competitive locations, but, a deposit is required in Market Dominant locations. Additional PO Box keys are provided to box holders for a fee and an additional deposit per key. Customers must complete PS Form 1094, *Request for Post Office Box Key or Lock Service.* Key fees are entered in AIC 123 and the receipt, PS Form 3544, *USPS Receipt for Money or Services,* is given to customer.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-14.

When keys are returned and the box is closed, key deposits are refunded.

Facilitator: discuss current policies of the deposit of keys, additional keys, and the maximum refund.

Show PowerPoint slide 25-15 and refer participants to page 25-10.

Firm Holdout

Firm holdout service allows a customer to obtain street-addressed mail from the Post Office when the customer normally receives 50 letters or more on the first delivery trip, or when the customer is a news agent or publisher's representative and receives publications that qualify for newspaper treatment.

To obtain firm holdout service, a customer must fill out Form 3801. The form must include the signature of each employee or agent authorized to pick up the mail. There is no fee for firm holdout service. On the postmaster's approval, based on the availability of resources, the customer may pick up mail at a postal unit once each delivery day at the time and place of delivery specified by the postmaster.

A customer may cancel a firm holdout at any time. The postmaster may cancel firm holdout service when the mail volume falls below the 50-piece requirement on each delivery day over a 30-day period. The postmaster may also cancel the service when the mail is not picked up for 10 consecutive days and the customer does not arrange with the postmaster to hold the mail. A customer may not request restoration of the service for 1 year after its cancellation.

Caller Service

Caller Service is a premium service for people and companies that need more pickup times than Firm Holdout and/or have more mail than the largest box in your office will hold daily. The fees for Caller Service are based upon a minimum of 6 months and the facility fee group. If Caller Service is paid for a current wall box, both caller and box fee must be paid. If any company or individual has currently 5 wall boxes and needs another separation, there must be a phantom or caller number fee. No keys are provided with Caller Service.

Reserve numbers are also available to Caller Service customers. Reserve numbers do not provide additional separations, but are part of the master Caller Service number. These numbers may or may not receive mail. This allows customers to reserve a specific number for future use.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-16.

General Delivery

General Delivery is available at designated post offices for transients and people waiting to get PO Boxes.

To pick up mail, which is being held in General Delivery, a sales and services associate must verify the customer's ID. General Delivery is held for 30 days unless the postmaster extends holding period.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 25-17.

Summary

Post Office Box Service is a premier service available to customers. In addition to being a great value, PO Boxes offer customers privacy, security, and flexibility. It provides customers with the ability to get their mail when and where it is most convenient. There are many benefits of renting a PO Box including:

- Fast - Mail typically arrives faster at a PO Box than at a residential or business address.
- Private - Use a PO Box address for selected contacts and transactions.
- Affordable - Fees are determined by the term and are very reasonable.
- Permanent – A customer can move around, but their PO Box address stays the same.
- Good business – Customers can open PO Boxes in multiple cities and expand business opportunities.
- Convenient –Customers can choose a location close to work or home - whatever fits their needs. Select Post Offices have extended business hours and/or 24-hour lobby access.

Customers can renew a PO Box on-line with a credit card or through an automatic renewal process. PO Boxes can also be renewed at a Self-Service Kiosk, by sending a check or money order, or in person at a Post Office.

Module 26: Other Services

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Explain Package Intercept
- Identify and describe the passport program
- Identify and describe the migratory bird stamp program
- Explain the procedures for registering individuals for the selective service system
- Explain procedures for change of address
- Explain Premium Forwarding Service

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Presentation
- Discussion
- Question/Answer

Summary:

- Other Services
- Change of Address (COA)
- Temporary Forwarding
- Premium Forwarding Service (PFS)
- Authorization to Hold Mail

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip Chart

- Selective Service Forms
- Publication 75, *Official Change of Address Kit*
- PS Form 3546, *Official Change/Correction to Mail Forwarding Change of Address Order*
- PS Form 3575, *Change of Address*, PS Form 8076, *Authorization to Hold Mail* and PS Form 8176, *Premium Forwarding Services (PFS) Application*

Other Services

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-3. Refer participants to page 26-3.

USPS Package Intercept Service

As part of the January 22, 2012, price change, the Postal Service implemented a new mailer service called Package Intercept that enables customers to redirect delivery of mailpieces. Package Intercept is a new domestic service that replaced the Recall of Mail service as follows:

- Package Intercept can be used for any mailable Priority Mail Express , Priority Mail, First-Class Mail, First-Class Package Service, Parcel Select, Standard Post and Package Services maipieces, with a tracking barcode.
- Package Intercept is available by submitting PS Form 1509, *Sender's Request for USPS Package Intercept Service*, and paying a nonrefundable per-piece fee to initiate the process at the Post Office of mailing.

Package Intercept service allows customers to request to have an item they have sent through the Postal Service intercepted prior to delivery. Customers place their request, and the information is sent to the destinating delivery unit for the address on the item. The completed PS Form 1509 request is sent to the destinating Post Office by fax or email.

Package Intercept is a domestic service. Package Intercept is not available for international, APO/FPO/DPO destinations or for items that require a customs form. Package Intercept is also not available for items to a destination that requires a customs form, parcel more than 108 inches in length and girth combined, or mailpieces that indicates surface-only transportation, such as Label 127, *Surface Mail Only*, or bears other hazardous materials markings such as "Consumer Commodity ORM-D".

Customers should check the status of the original shipment tracking number using Track and Confirm on USPS.com, to ensure that the shipment has not been delivered or out for delivery before placing a Package Intercept request.

Items located will be redirected to sender. For all mailpieces that are redirected to the sender, the sender may be subject to payment of the applicable postage. The Postal Service does not guarantee the interception of a mailpiece.

Commercial customers may request to have their package redirected to sender, to a new postal delivery address, or to a Post Office as Hold For Pickup service through the Business Customer Gateway at http://pe.usps.com/. Only the sender or authorized representative can request Package Intercept.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Before completing form, see instructions on page 2.

Sender's Request for USPS Package Intercept™ Service

A. Request for Service

*1. Please intercept the mail described below and redirect to the return address. ***Important:*** To help us locate your mail, please print legibly and provide complete information. *Indicates a required field.

Note: An item to be intercepted **must** be addressed to a domestic address and be considered a mailable item. *(See instructions, A.1.).*

Class of Mail:	Shape:	Extra Service / Tracking Barcode Number:
☐ Express Mail®	☐ Letter	☐ Registered Mail™ No.
☐ Priority Mail®	☐ Large Envelope	☐ Certified Mail® No.
☐ First-Class Mail®	☐ Parcel	☐ Insured No.
☐ First-Class Package Service™		☐ Delivery/Signature Confirmation™ No.
☐ Parcel Select®		☐ Adult Signature No.
☐ Package Services *(i.e., Parcel Post®, Bound Printed Matter, Library Mail, Media Mail®)*		☐ COD No.
		☐ Return Receipt for Merchandise
		☐ Other

*2. Postage type ☐ Stamps ☐ PC Postage® ☐ Meter ☐ Permit Imprint: Permit No:

3. Mailed from ZIP Code™ *(or city and state)*:	*4. Date mailed *(MM/DD/YYYY)*:

5. Other package identifiers *(Describe identifiers such as flat rate, dimensions, color, graphics, pictures.)*

*6. Complete addressing information

(a) How was the article addressed?	(b) Addressed to:	(c) Return address:
☐ Handwritten	Name:	Name:
☐ Printed label	Street/PO Box:	Street/PO Box:
☐ Other *(Describe)*	City, State, ZIP Code:	City, State, ZIP Code:

B. Statement of Understanding

I understand that the fee to initiate Package Intercept service is nonrefundable, and there is no guarantee that the item can be intercepted before delivery. I also understand that the intercepted mail will be redirected back to the sender's return address and may incur postage due at the applicable price to be paid upon delivery by the sender.

*1. Signature of applicant	*2. Date *(MM/DD/YYYY)*	*3. Applicant's address
4. Signature and title of agent *(If signed as agent)*	*5. E-mail	
6. Firm/company name	*7. Telephone number	

C. Processing of Application *(for Postal Service use only)*

1. Application accepted by *(Name of employee at accepting Post Office™)*	2. Initiating Post Office *(City, State, ZIP Code)*	3. Date and time received *(MM/DD/YYYY HH:MM)*
4. Telephoned to *(Destination Post Office)*	5. Copies sent to *(List by ZIP Code)*	6. Returned by *(Name of employee at receiving Post Office)*

7. **Instructions to Accepting Post Office:** Affix Postage Validation Imprint (PVI) for payment of Package Intercept service fee in the box at the right. ➡		8. **Instructions to Receiving Post Office: If mail described in A.1 is found, return to the address listed on the mailpiece.**

PS Form **1509,** January 2012 *(Page 1 of 2)* PSN 7530-01-000-9334

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-4 and refer participants to page 26-5.

Passport Applications

Passport applications are only accepted in designated post offices. A passport is an internationally recognized travel document which certifies the identity and nationality of the bearer. A passport indicates that its bearer is entitled to receive the protection and benefits of the diplomat offices and consulate of his or her country while abroad. In essence, a passport is a request on behalf of the issuing government that citizens and officials of foreign governments be able to travel in their territories and afford the traveler all lawful aid and protection.

To obtain a U.S. passport, a person must apply for it. The Postal Service has the authority to accept passport applications. A U.S. passport may be issued only to a citizen or national of the United States.

Sales and Services Associates who will be required to accept passport applications will receive training on accepting passport applications.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-5.

Migratory Bird Hunting and Conservation Stamps

The Migratory Bird Hunting and Conservation Stamps are required by federal law to hunt migratory birds such as ducks, geese, etc. Post offices act as agents of the federal government in selling these stamps to provide a convenient location for purchasing them and refer to these stamps as bird stamps.

The more common name given by collectors and others to the Migratory Bird Hunting and Conservation stamps is “Duck” Stamps. These stamps are also highly collectible, and there are more than a few specialists, general collectors and fans of all things related to conservation and waterfowl who collect them.

A new stamp is issued every year and is on sale for a specified period of time. The stamp remains on sale in philatelic centers for two years. Postal Retail Units may sell bird stamps from July 1 through March 1 of the following year. These stamps may not be used for postage, are nonredeemable, and all sales are final.

An annual Postal Bulletin article reminds Postal Retail Units to return unsold bird stamps from retail floor stock and stamp credits to their unit reserve stock. Unit reserve custodians hold prior year (unsold) bird stamps

in their inventory to be included with non-saleable stock returned during their next scheduled destruction.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-6.

Selective Service

Selective Service registration is the process by which the U.S. Government collects names and addresses of men age 18 through 25 to use in case a national emergency requires rapid expansion of the Armed Forces. Eligible individuals fill this form out completely and mail it themselves. Forms are made available to customers in Postal lobbies.

Facilitator: Veterans Affairs supplies burial flags, application forms, and the rules and regulations governing flag issue. Postmasters must address all correspondence about the supply and issuance of the flags to the VA regional offices that use their office as a depository.

Change of Address

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-7, and refer participants to page 26-7, and hand out PUB 75 and PS Form 3575 to each participant.

Change-of-Address Order

Delivery post offices keep records of permanent change-of-address orders for a period of 18 months from the end of the month when the change takes effect. These records are used for forwarding and address correction purposes.. A change-of-address order record from general delivery to a permanent local address without time limit is kept for 6 months. A change-of-address order record to other than a permanent local address is kept for 30 days.

Facilitator: Show participants how to properly complete change of address form. Explain the benefits of customers completing this form correctly.

Please stress that the change of address form must be signed by the customer and not by a postal employee. Without a signature, the form will not be processed.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-8.

Change of Address Submission Options

- Submit online - The customer needs to provide an email address and a valid credit card (MasterCard, Visa or American Express).
- Print paper form and mail - The customer will be offered the option to print—at no cost—then mail a change of address order.
- Visit a local post office - The customer's nearest post office provides a free Official Change of Address Kit.
  - Official Change of Address Kits (Pub 75 - Mover's Guides) is kept behind the counter and is provided to customers at no charge. To facilitate online submissions, information cards are located in lobby displays.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-9. Refer participants to page 26-7.

Temporary Forwarding

Customers temporarily changing address may have mail forwarded up to 6 months and may renew an additional 6 months for a total of one year. The customer must show beginning and ending dates on the change-of-address order.

PS Form 3546, *Official Change/Correction to Mail Forwarding Change of Address Order*, is a postal generated form used to make modification or corrections to an existing change of address. This form should only be completed by sales and services associates.

Standard Procedure for Handling Change-of-Address Orders

The procedures for handling change-of-address orders are:

1. Affix the 3982 label to PS Form 3982, *Change of Address Card*.
2. If incorrect information is discovered on the 3982 label, complete PS Form 3546 and select the box for the appropriate action required. Transcribe the information that appears on a 3982 label onto PS Form 3982 and select check box "3546 submitted". When the corrected 3982 label is received, affix the label over the initially transcribed information on PS Form 3982.

3. When a PS Form 3575Z, *Employee Generated Change of Address Form*, is filed, transcribe the information onto PS Form 3982 and select check box "3575Z submitted". When the 3982 label is received, affix the label over the initially transcribed information on PS Form 3982.

   Facilitator: This form requires the initials of the employee completing the form as well as the completion date in order to be processed. PS Form 3982 is normally affixed by the box clerk. PS Form 3546 is an SSA generated form.

   Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-10.

Premium Forwarding Service (PFS)

This service provides residential delivery customers and certain Post Office Box customers an option to have all mail addressed to their primary address reshipped or rerouted to a temporary address by means of a weekly Priority Mail shipment for a fee. PFS is available for a period of not less than 2 weeks and not more than 1 year. This optional service is separate from the piece-by-piece forwarding service offered through a change of address order, whereby only certain mailpieces are forwarded.

Facilitator: Explain the purpose of PS Form 8176 and proper completion of this form.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-11.

Authorization to Hold Mail

Customers going on vacation may have mail held for a minimum of three, but not more than 30 days. They may do this on-line, at the retail counter, or through 1-800- ASK-USPS.

Facilitator: Explain the purpose of PS Form 8076 and the proper completion of the form.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 26-12.

Summary

The Postal Service participates in public service/government agency programs such as accepting passport applications, selling bird stamps and making Selective Service registration forms available.

Change-of-Address orders allow customers to record permanent change-of-address. Records of permanent change-of-address orders are kept by city delivery post offices for 18 months from the end of the month when the change takes effect.

Customers can submit change of address orders online, via a printed and mailed form or at a post office. An Official Change of Address Kit is available for customers use.

Premium Forwarding Service, Temporary Forwarding Service, and Hold Mail Service are available for customer use for the forwarding or holding of their mail.

Module 27: Services eLearning Review

Objectives:

Instructor-led review of eLearning modules designed to clarify and or re-enforce content presented during the following eLearning training modules: Confirmation Services, Insured Mail, Certified Mail, Registered Mail, Collect on Delivery (COD), and Extra Services.

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Discussion

Summary:

- Confirmation Services
- Insured Mail
- Certified Mail
- Registered Mail
- Collect on Delivery (COD)
- Extra Services

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- PowerPoint presentation
- Projector

Facilitator: This module is designed as a participant review activity to reinforce the product information presented in eLearning lessons.

There are three options to present this material:

1. **Utilize the PowerPoint presentation to support facilitation of the material.**
2. **Divide class into two groups. Each group formulates ten questions relating to topics within this module.**

   Formulated questions are posed alternately to the opposing group. The group collectively responds to the opponent's questions.

   Allow groups 10 minutes to formulate questions and 20 minutes for question and answer session. Groups are rewarded one point for each correct answer and the group with the highest score at the end of the activity is declared the winner.
3. **Divide the class into equal teams and utilize round two of the Quiz Bowl presentation to support facilitation of the material. Team with the most points at the end of all three rounds is declared the winner.**

•

USPS Tracking Service

USPS Tracking is automatically included for Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, and Standard Post mailings. USPS Tracking may be purchased with First-Class Mail parcels, and Library Mail parcels and Media Mail parcels. USPS Tracking for Parcel Select and Standard Mail parcels is only available when mailed using the electronic option.

USPS Tracking provides customers with valuable updates on the status of their shipment as it travels to its destination. USPS Tracking service is available for mail sent to domestic destinations and most APO/FPO destinations. USPS Tracking service is also available for mail sent to any United States territory or possession as defined in the Domestic Mail Manual (DMM).

USPS Tracking provides customers with the date, ZIP Code, and the time the article was delivered. If delivery was attempted, the customer will receive a notice with the date and time of attempted delivery.

USPS Tracking may be combined with Registered Mail, Domestic Insured Mail, Collect on Delivery (COD), Return Receipt for merchandise, and Special Handling.

USPS Tracking may also be combined with Return Receipt and Restricted Delivery if it is also purchased with either Registered Mail, Insurance over $200, or COD. Postage and additional fees are paid when specific mailing requirements are met.

Signature Confirmation Service

Signature Confirmation provides customers with an added level of security by requiring a signature from the person who accepts the package.

Signature Confirmation is available for Domestic Mail parcels and is not available for mail addressed to APO/FPO destinations or any U.S. territory or possession.

Signature Confirmation may be used with First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, Standard Post Package Services, and Parcel Select.

When postage and additional fees are paid, Signature Confirmation Service may be combined with Registered Mail, Insured Mail, Collect on Delivery (COD), and Special Handling.

Signature Confirmation may be combined with Restricted Delivery if it is also purchased with either Registered Mail, Insurance over $200, or COD and postage and additional fees are paid and specific requirements are met.

Retail and Electronic Pricing

Signature Confirmation and the USPS Tracking retail prices are available for purchase at any post office. Service must be purchased at the time of mailing.

The electronic option is available for customers who purchase Signature Confirmation Service or USPS Tracking Service online at usps.com or obtain an authorized electronic link from the Postal Service to send and receive Signature Confirmation information electronically.

Customers can print their own electronic rate approved confirmation barcode labels or use printed barcode labels provided by the Postal Service:

- Label 315 for Signature Confirmation
-
- Label 400, USPS Tracking

Forms

Use PS Form 153, *Signature Confirmation*, when a Signature Confirmation item is presented at your counter.

Use Label 400 (or the PVI Tracking label), *USPS Tracking*, when a USPS Tracking item is presented.

Place USPS Tracking or Signature Service labels on the address side of the mailpiece, above the delivery address and to the right of the return address.

When placing USPS Tracking or Signature Service labels, do not bend it around the package's edge. On odd-sized packages, such as tubes, place the label so that the barcode is horizontal to the length of the package. Do not place the label vertically or cover the barcode with tape or plastic wrap.

Fees

Customers must pay the USPS Tracking Service fees in addition to postage and fees for any other Extra Services they request.

Postage stamps, meter stamps, or withdrawals from a permit imprint account are acceptable methods of payment. Pre-canceled stamps are not permitted as postage payment for USPS Tracking Service fees.

Insured Mail

Insured Mail Service provides indemnity coverage for merchandise sent through the mail if the item is damaged, or lost while in the possession of the Postal Service. Insurance may be purchased up to $5,000. The price of the insurance is based on the declared value of the merchandise.

Reimbursement is for the actual value (less depreciation) of the articles at the time of mailing, repair costs, or the insurance amount purchased, whichever is less.

Insurance may be applied as an Extra Service to Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, First-Class Mail, Standard Mail parcels, and Package Services.

As part of its service Priority Mail Express automatically includes insurance up to $100. Priority Mail automatically includes $50 insurance for Retail and Commercial Base shipments; Commercial Plus shipments qualify for $100 insurance. Additional coverage, up to $5,000, is available for purchase above the automatic insurance amount.

Collect on Delivery (COD) and Registered Mail items include insurance coverage as part of the service.

Insured Mail service is available for purchase with First-Class Mail if the mailpiece contains items mailable as Standard Mail or Package Services, or is a small package weighing 13 ounces or less (must be merchandise).

First-Class Mail consists of handwritten personal correspondence such as bills and statements of account, postcards, and Business Reply Mail and must be mailed as First Class Mail, Priority Mail, or may be upgraded to Priority Mail Express . Matter sent as First-Class Mail cannot be insured.

Extra Services

Insured Mail service may be used in conjunction with USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, Special Handling, Parcel Airlift, Service (PAL), Return Receipt for Merchandise, Return Receipt, and Restricted Delivery.

Purchase Options

Insured Mail Service can be purchased at any post office, a Self-Service Kiosk or online.

Insurance purchased online or at a Self-Service Kiosk, cannot be combined with insurance purchased at a post office.

Customers may purchase up to $5,000 indemnity coverage when insurance is purchased at a post office. Indemnity coverage up to $5,000 may be purchased at a Self-Service Kiosk or online through usps.com

Forms

When your customers purchase insurance, you must document the amount of insurance coverage using PS Form 3813, *Domestic Insured Mail Receipt* or PS Form 3813-P, *Domestic Insured Mail Receipt.*

PS Form 3813 is for items insured for $200 or less. It includes a barcode label and a detachable customer receipt. No signature of receipt is required or obtained at the time of delivery.

PS Form 3813-P, *Insured Mail Receipt* is for items insured for over $200 up to $5,000. A signature of receipt is obtained at the time of delivery.

SSA's must properly complete the customer receipt portion of both PS Form 3813 and PS Form 3813-P, when the mailpiece is presented at the retail counter.

It is the customer's responsibility to complete the "Sent to" section at the bottom of the receipt. Customer must retain the original receipt in the event that a claim for damage needs to be filed.

PS Form 3813 or PS Form 3813-P is placed on the address side of the mailpiece, above the delivery address, and to the right of the return address. Alternatively, you may place it to the left of the delivery address.

Fees

You can accept postage stamps, meter stamps, or a withdrawal from a permit imprint account as methods of payment. Pre-canceled stamps are not permitted as postage payment for Insured Mail service fees.

Delivery of Insured Items

When customers pick up insured items at your window, you must ensure that all delivered insured items are scanned.

If the item is insured for over $200, you must also obtain the recipients signature of receipt. A record of delivery is maintained in your office.

Insured mailpieces are returned to the sender if they are not claimed within fifteen days from first attempted delivery. Items are not returned to the sender if a mailer endorsement indicates otherwise.

If an insured item is lost or damaged in transit, customers may file a claim for the item at their local post office, online at usps.com, or by mail.

Certified Mail

Certified Mail Service provides customers with proof of mailing and the date and the time the item was delivered or delivery was attempted. Certified Mail Service must be requested by customers at the time of mailing.

Certified Mail Service can only be combined with domestic First-Class Mail and Priority Mail. Certified Mail Service is available for mailpieces destined for APO and FPO addresses.

Customers may add both Restricted Delivery Service and Return Receipt Service to Certified Mail items.

PS Form 3800, *Certified Mail Receipt*

PS Form 3800, *Certified Mail Receipt* is a two–part barcoded form that provides a mailing receipt and a unique identifier number. The receipt portion of PS Form 3800 must be completed when the mailpiece is presented at the retail counter.

Calculate the postage and applicable fees, enter the information on PS Form 3800, and then round date stamp in the POSTMARK HERE section. Ensure that sufficient postage is affixed to the mailpiece.

If requested, you will also indicate the time the article was accepted on the receipt.

PS Form 3800 Placement

Affix the self-stick label section of the receipt and applicable Extra Services labels to the mailpiece.

Customers are responsible for completing the “Sent To” section of the receipt. Advise the customer to retain the original receipt for their records.

Place the form on the address side of the mailpiece above the delivery address and to the right of the return address or to the left of the delivery address. PS Form 3800 is folded on the dotted line over the top edge of the mail item.

Fees

Customers must pay the Certified Mail fees in addition to applicable postage and fees for any other Extra Services they request. Accept postage stamps, meter stamps, or a withdrawal from a permit imprint account as methods of payment.

Pre-canceled stamps are not permitted as postage payment for Certified Mail service fees.

Delivering Certified Mail

Obtain a signature from the addressee when they pick up a Certified Mail item. If delivery of the Certified Mail item is attempted, but not completed, a PS Form 3849, *Delivery Notice/Reminder/Receipt,* is left at the delivery address.

Addressee must sign PS Form 3849, *Delivery Notice/Reminder/Receipt* and PS Form 3811, *Return Receipt,* when it is affixed to the mailpiece.

Articles may be held a maximum of 15 days before it is returned to the sender, unless otherwise indicated by a mailer endorsement.

Registered Mail

Registered Mail is the most secure service that the Postal Service offers. It utilizes a system of receipts to monitor the movement of Registered Mail from the point of acceptance to the point of delivery.

All Registered Mail is kept separate from ordinary mail. Articles must be securely sealed by the customer.

You are not permitted to assist customers in preparing or sealing articles to be sent as Registered Mail. Specific requirements for preparing Registered Mail items are in place to prevent tampering.

Articles to be sent Registered Mail may not be placed in an envelope or mailer manufactured of plastic, glossy paper, spun-bonded olefin, such as Tyvek®, or substances that will not absorb an ink seal.

Fees

Mail is charged the applicable First-Class Mail or Priority Mail price plus the additional fees for registry and Extra Services.

Extra Services

Registered Mail can be combined with Collect On Delivery (COD), USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, Return Receipt, and Restricted Delivery.

Insurance

Insurance is provided for articles valued at a minimum of one cent, and up to a maximum insured value of $25,000. Postal Insurance for Registered Mail is limited to the declared value of the article.

Articles valued between $25,000 and $1,000,000 must be charged the appropriate handling fee. The handling fee is charged for every $1,000 over the first $25,000 or fraction thereof. Fees for articles valued over $25,000 are for handling only.

PS Form 3806, *Receipt for Registered Mail*

PS Form 3806, *Receipt for Registered Mail* is completed for each registered article.

Customers enter the complete name and address in the "TO and FROM" sections of the form, declare the full value of the article at the time of mailing and record the amount on the form.

The customer presents the form along with the article to you for further processing.

Verify the proper completion of the form and write the Registry number from Label 200, in block two, Article Number, of PS Form 3811.

Determine the postage, Registered Mail fees, and fees for any other requested Extra Services and record the amounts in the appropriate sections of the form.

Once complete, provide the receipt copy, *Copy 1 – Customer*, to the customer.

Label 200, *Registered Mail*

Label 200, *Registered Mail* is used to designate articles as Registered Mail. It is a preprinted, red and white, self-adhesive, barcoded label with a sequential serial number.

The registry number you enter on PS Form 3806, *Receipt for Registered Mail*, must match the number found on Label 200, *Registered Mail*, which is applied to the article.

Extra Services

Customers requesting Return Receipt service with Registered Mail must complete a PS Form 3811, *Domestic Return Receipt*.

Acceptance

You must properly round date stamp Registered Mail articles. Round date stamp letter-size envelopes at all seams on the back of the envelope. Ensure each article is round date stamped at the crossing of the upper and lower flaps.

Flats and packages must be round date stamped on all seams of the article. Packages and flats sealed with paper tape are round date stamped across the opposite edges of the tape strips.

When you accept Registered Mail; record the article number and the office of origin on PS Form 3854, *Manifold Registry Dispatch Book.*

Secure the Item

Once you have accepted the Registered Mail item from your customer you must properly secure it in a locked designated area until the article is ready to be dispatched.

Individual employee accountability of Registered Mail must be maintained at all times.

Withdrawal

Senders may withdraw or recall Registered Mail without charge *before dispatch* from the originating or acceptance office by writing on the receipt, WITHDRAWN BEFORE DISPATCH, signing and surrendering the receipt, and presenting acceptable photo identification to you.

Senders do not receive a refund of postage and fees when withdrawing or recalling Registered Mail.

Dispatch of Articles

Complete PS Form 3854, *Manifold Registry Dispatch Book* when transferring Registered Mail articles to the dispatch employee.

When completing PS Form 3854 you must round date stamp the copies of PS Form 3854, in the Postmark of Dispatching Office blocks on the top right of the form.

Collect on Delivery (COD)

Customers can use Collect on Delivery (COD) Service to mail merchandise for which the mailer has not been paid and have the price of the merchandise and the cost of postage and handling collected from the recipient by the Postal Service at the time of delivery.

COD Service can also used to send merchandise to customers who do not wish to pay in advance and collect payment for merchandise when recipients do not have access to a credit card.

COD Service benefits both mailers and recipients. The Postal Service collects payment and promptly reimburses the sender either the same day or the next business day after the article is delivered.

Articles are covered against loss or damage of merchandise and recipients are allowed to pay for delivery of COD items by cash, check, debit card, or money order.

Customers may request that only the cost of the merchandise is remitted, or that only the cost of the postage and fees is remitted, or that they receive both the merchandise cost and postage and fees as remittance.

Mailing Services

COD service may be used with Priority Mail Express , First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, Standard Post and Package Services.

COD may be used with Parcel Select if the item has the complete names and addresses of the mailer and addressee, the mailer guarantees to pay any return postage, and the goods shipped are ordered by the addressee.

The maximum amount collectible from the recipient for an individual article and the indemnity for failure to collect or issue payment is $1,000.

Articles sent to or from an APO or FPO address, including official mail and shipments to Armed Forces agencies may not use COD Service.

Extra Services

COD Service may be combined with Return Receipt, Restricted Delivery, USPS Tracking, Registered Mail, Signature Confirmation, and Special Handling.

PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt*

Mailers sending articles using COD service must complete PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt* by handwriting in ink, typewriting, or computer generating the form.

PS Form 3816 is a five-part barcoded carbonless form used to document the acceptance and delivery of a COD parcel. COD articles are identified by the number that appears on each copy of PS Form 3816.

The form must show the article number, the names and addresses of the mailer and recipient and the amount due the mailer.

If a money order is used to remit payment to the mailer, the amount of the money order fee must be included. Mailer may not stipulate "Cash Only" as a payment method on PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt*.

- Copy 1, *Delivery Unit* is used to document the acceptance and delivery of a COD mailpiece
- Copy 2, *Payment* is used to document a COD payment to the mailer
- Copy 3, *Mailer* is the mailer's receipt
- Copy 4- *Mailing PO* is a duplicate of Copy 3. As the mailing post office, you must retain copy 4 for your records
- Copy 5, *Addressee* is a self-adhesive label that must be attached to the COD article that includes the check or cash amount and mailer and recipient information

PS Form 3816 must be placed above the delivery address and to the right of the return address, or to the left of the delivery address on parcels.

Fees

COD articles must be mailed at the post office or through a rural letter carrier. All applicable fee(s) must be paid in addition to postage and the fees for any Extra Services requested.

The COD fee is charged per piece and is determined by the amount that is to be collected for the merchandise or the amount of insurance requested by the mailer, whichever is greater.

The fee for COD service includes insurance against loss, rifling, or damage to the article and the failure to receive payment for the article. Postal liability for the failure to receive payment for the article is limited to the loss of the payment during transit.

COD Delivery

When the COD mailpiece is delivered at over the counter you must:

- Sign in the Delivered by signature block
- Record the date of delivery, the recipient's check number, if applicable, the money order number and the date that the payment is sent to the mailer on PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt*
- File PS Form 3816, *COD Mailing and Delivery Receipt* and retain for two years

Extra Services

Extra Services are enhancements that provide greater security and accountability of mailpieces, for a fee, in addition to postage.

Extra Services offer proof of mailing with Certificate of Mailing and Certified Mail, protection in transit with Insured Mail and Registered Mail, confirmation of delivery with COD, USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, Restricted Delivery, Return Receipt and Return Receipt for Merchandise, and services after mailing such as Merchandise Return Service.

Return Receipt Service

Return Receipt Service provides customers with evidence of delivery including the date and the recipient's signature. This service may be purchased at the time of the mailing or after mailing.

Customers commonly purchase Return Receipt Service with Certified Mail, which can be used on First-Class Mail or Priority Mail. In addition to Certified Mail, Return Receipt can also be purchased with Restricted Mail, Collect on Delivery (COD), or Insured Mail valued over $200, as well as Priority Mail Express (hardcopy PS Form 3811 only).

Domestic Return Receipts

There are three types of Domestic Return Receipts; PS Form 3811, *Domestic Return Receipt*, PS Form 3811-A, *Return Receipt after Mailing*, and an Electronic return receipt.

The mailer, at the time of mailing, completes PS Form 3811, *Domestic Return Receipt.* 'Return Receipt Requested' is written above the delivery address and to the right of the return address of the item to be mailed.

PS Form 3811-A, *Return Receipt after Mailing*, may be purchased after mailing, if, at the time of mailing, the customer purchased Certified Mail, Registered Mail, Insured Mail (items valued over $200), or COD service.

- PS Form 3811-A, *Return Receipt after Mailing*, must be completed by the customer. The completed form is sent to the delivery office
- You must be process and retain this form. It is not to be taken from the office by the customer
- Customer receives a return receipt proof-of-delivery letter via e-mail. This e-mail includes the date and time of delivery and an image of the recipient's signature
- The retail transaction receipt contains instructions for the customer to obtain the information electronically

Customers may elect to receive PS Form 3811, *Domestic Return Receipt*, by mail or electronically.

Return Receipt for Merchandise Service

Return Receipt for Merchandise Service is available for Priority Mail, Standard Mail (machinable and irregular parcels), Standard Post or Package Services and Parcel Select items.

Return Receipt for Merchandise Service provides the mailer with a mailing receipt and a return receipt and may only be requested at the time of mailing. Return Receipt for Merchandise Service verifies that merchandise was sent by the customer and received by the addressee. Insurance is not included as part of this service.

PS Form 3811 is mailed back to the customer after delivery of the mailpiece. The customer will receive the date of delivery and the name of the individual, company or organization that received the mail.

PS Form 3804, *Return Receipt for Merchandise*

The label portion of PS Form 3804, *Return Receipt for Merchandise* attached to the address side of the article. The receipt portion of the form is postmarked to show that the article was accepted for mailing.

Extra Services

Extra Services that may be combined with Return Receipt for Merchandise are USPS Tracking, Insurance up to $200, and Special Handling. It may also be combined with Parcel Airlift Service (PAL).

Restricted Delivery Service

Restricted Delivery Service ensures that mail is delivered only to a specific addressee or the addressee's authorized agent. The addressee must be an individual specified by name. Mailpieces for minors or persons under guardianship may be delivered to their parents or guardians.

Mail for which Restricted Delivery Service is requested must be endorsed RESTRICTED DELIVERY in addition to other required Extra Services information. The endorsement must be placed above the address and to the right of the return address.

Restricted Delivery Service fees in addition to postage must be paid at the time of mailing. After mailing, the sender may request restricted delivery by notifying the mailing post office in writing and providing the requisite information.

Extra Services

Restricted Delivery Services is only available for mail sent by Registered Mail, Certified Mail, COD, and Insured Mail (Over $200) when purchased at the time of mailing. Return Receipt may be purchased separately, but is not required.

Certificate of Mailing

Certificate of Mailing provides evidence of the date mail was presented to the Postal Service for mailing. A Certificate of Mailing does not provide a record of delivery nor insurance coverage.

Insurance is not available for purchase with a Certificate of Mailing. PS Form 3817, *Certificate of Mailing* or a facsimile may be used with each single mailpiece.

Certificate of Mailing may only be purchased at the time of mailing. Certificate of Mailing fees must be paid in addition to postage. Certificate of Mailing may be used with First-Class Mail including Priority Mail, Standard Mail, Standard Post and Package Services.

For Bulk Mailings, PS Form 3606, *Certificate of Bulk Mailing,* may be used to specify the number of pieces mailed, but cannot be used as an itemized list of individual pieces.

Certificate of Mailing may be combined with Parcel Airlift Service (PAL) and Special Handling.

Special Handling

Special Handling provides preferential handling, to the extent practicable, in dispatch and transportation. It does not provide preferential delivery.

Special Handling is required for parcels containing honeybees and baby poultry unless sent at the First-Class Mail or Priority Mail prices. Postage and Special Handing fees must be paid at the time of mailing.

Special Handling is available only for First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, Standard Post, Package Services and Parcel Select pieces.

The marking, "SPECIAL HANDLING" must appear prominently above the address and to the right of the return address on each piece for which special handling service is requested.

Special Handling may be combined with COD, USPS Tracking, Signature Confirmation, Insurance, and Return Receipt for Merchandise. It may also be combined with Parcel Airlift Service (PAL).

Domestic Mail

Extra Service	Express Mail	Priority Mail	First-Class Mail	Standard Mail	Package Services
Certified Mail (PS Form 3800)		X	X		
Return Receipt (PS Form 3811)	X	*X	*X	[2]X (P)	[3]X
Return Receipt (Electronic)		*X	*X	[2]X (P)	[3]X
Certificate of Mailing (PS Form 3817/3877)		X	X	[2]X	X
Certificate of Mailing – Bulk metered or precanceled stamp (PS Form 3606)		X	X	X	X
Collect on Delivery COD (PS Form 3816)	X	X	X		X
Delivery Confirmation (PS Form 152)		X	X (P)	X (P)	X (P)
Insurance (PS Form 3813/3813-P)	X	X	X	[2]X	X
Registered Mail (PS Form 3806)		X	X		
Return Receipt for Merchandise (PS Form 3804)		X		X (P)	X
Restricted Delivery (Endorsement)		[4]X	[4]X	[2]X (P)	[3]X
Signature Confirmation (PS Form 153)		X	X (P)		X (P)
Special Handling (Marking)		X	X		X
Adult Signature	X	X			X
Special conditions	* When combined with an Extra Service				
	[2] Bulk Insurance only				
	(P) Parcels Only				
	[3] COD or Insured mail over $200				
	[4] Purchased with Certified Mail, COD. Insured mail over $200, or Registered Mail				

International Mail

Class	Track and Confirm	Proof of mailing	Guaranteed Delivery	Proof of Delivery	Insurance	Delivery Standard	IMM Ref.
Global Express Guaranteed	X	X	X	X	X ($100 automatic, add'l for fee)	Per POS	IMM 210
Express Mail International	X	X	X (Limited)	X (Fee)	X ($100 automatic, add'l for fee)	3-5 Days	IMM 220
Priority Mail International	X (Fee)	X (Fee)		X (Fee)	X (Fee)	6-10 Days	IMM 230
First-Class Mail International		X (Fee)		X (Fee)		Varies by destination	IMM 240

Module 28: The Customer Experience

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Be prepared to provide an outstanding customer experience.
- Recognize the four basic principles of the Customer Experience Essentials program
- Continue to develop positive interactions with customers to improve satisfaction and the total customer experience
- Learn what it means to deliver outstanding customer service including friendliness, knowledgeable support, and the resolution of customer concerns or issues
- Recognize important customer perception factors
- Become familiar with the entire Retail Customer Experience

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 Hour

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion and Activity

Summary:

- Customer Experience Essentials
- Total Customer Experience
- What Makes a Great Customer Service Experience?
- Image Factors

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer, projector, PowerPoint presentation, Rip chart, Postal Operations Manual (POM), Employee Relations Manual (ELM)
- “It begins with a smile” video

Customer Experience Essentials

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-3. Refer participants to page 28-3.

A positive customer experience starts with four basic principles, which have been identified as "customer experience essentials."

They are:

- Telephone Courtesy.
- It Begins with a Smile.
- Delivery Done Right.
- We Value Your Business.

Beginning in FY 2012, the Customer Experience Essentials program encompasses these four principles, "Delivering a Positive Customer Experience," is a collaborative effort between Operations, Consumer and Industry Affairs, Corporate Communications, and all postal management and labor organizations. The data contained in Customer Experience Measurement (CEM) identified these principles as the biggest impact on customers' interaction with postal employees.

For more information, visit the Customer Experience Essentials website: http://blue.usps.gov/blue/caweb/cia-cee.htm

Facilitator's Option: Show slide 28-4 "It begins with a smile":
http://56.88.100.141/ipchecker/odrouter.asp?v=SmileCourtesy_OC.wmv

Total Customer Experience

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-5.

The United States Postal Service is a business, and like every other business must be successful in serving its customers in order to maintain loyalty and grow new business. All businesses face competition every day and must consistently meet or exceed challenges from competitors to succeed. This segment will introduce you to the competition faced by the Postal Service, how the Postal Service compares, and ways in which the Postal Service is working to better serve our customers.

The U.S. Postal Service is the only organization which can offer across the board mailing and shipping services with every customer interaction. No other organization can provide the entire range of mailing and shipping services available to Postal Service customers. We are the only mailing and shipping supplier that offers one-stop shopping for all delivery needs. Most businesses, for example, can exist without our direct competitors, UPS (United Parcel Service) or FedEx (Federal Express), but virtually none can conduct all of their business with their customers without using the United States Postal Service to meet mailing needs.

It is also important to understand that our competitors are far from perfect. There is a perception among many Postal Service employees that our overnight competitors operate in a virtually flawless manner, while there are plenty of "horror stories" about the Postal Service and the services it provides. In reality, our competitors all have their share of well-earned complaints from customers.

The Postal Service does everything the competition does and more. We are very good at what we do and the competition considers us a competitive challenge. For example, we are the only service that delivers Priority Mail Express 365 days to include Christmas.

It is imperative to be knowledgeable about all products and services that we provide to our customers and how to match these products and services to our customers' mailing and shipping needs each and every time. While indirect competition and alternatives offered via the internet, such as electronic banking and payments, have diverted a percentage of traditional mail volume away from the Postal Service, hardcopy mailings are still an important and vital component of doing business in today's economy.

The Postal Service offers ease of access and convenience to its customers, along with products and services to meet almost any mailing and shipping need, not to mention delivery to every address in the United States.

Facilitator: Being great at what you do is about more than being competent or acting professionally. It's not enough

to just deliver a great product or service. It is about *the Total Customer Experience*, from the first encounter until the last - and everything in between, which is from end-to-end.

Explain to the participants that they can affect whether or not a customer chooses to do business with the Postal Service or a competitor. It is all about the customer and their perception of the service they receive. Now, think of yourself as a customer. What do you look for in choosing where to do business?

Conduct a short discussion with participants about their responses – 2 minutes.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-6 and refer participants to page 28-4.

Industry research has shown that customers want a consistent shopping experience. The Postal Service is committed to providing consistent, quality service at retail units and all other customer contact points. Customers expect and deserve professional, courteous, and timely service when they visit any Post Office. The retail motto for providing the ideal customer experience is "Clean, Stocked and Friendly - Every Day."

Facilitator: How many of you have heard the phrase "Brand Loyalty?" Years ago, brand loyalty came from simply providing a good product. But today, brand loyalty is driven primarily by a company's ability to provide interactions with their customers and how well it delivers on what those customers want and need.

When you think of the Postal Service as a brand, you should think about our promise to provide a great customer experience each and every time. As an SSA you represent that brand and its commitment of excellent customer service.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-7.

The essence of the Postal Service brand is built upon our business, and our Business is Delivering. The essence of our brand comes down to four words: Relentless, Simple, Secure and Personal.

What Makes a Great Customer Service Experience?

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-8. Refer participants to page 28-4.

Great customer service starts with making your customers happy by meeting or exceeding their needs, so they will become regular customers and purchase or use your products and services again. A truly great experience stems from focusing on delivering exceptional service. Exceptional service builds loyalty and creates the type of relationship which has customers wanting to come back again and again. It is also a great opportunity to grow the customer base for new business, especially if those customers recommend us to others.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-9.

So why provide such outstanding service? Because research tells us that retail customers stop doing business with a company because:

- The sales associate was rude (73 percent).
- Their issues weren't resolved quickly (55 percent).
- The person assisting them did not have knowledge of products or services (51 percent).

The customer experience that you provide should always include providing friendly, knowledgeable support and resolution of customer issues in a timely manner.

Facilitator: As a SSA, you may be able to sell anything to anyone once. But it will be your approach to customer service that determines whether or not you'll have another opportunity to sell that person anything else. The essence of good customer service is forming a relationship with a customer that builds loyalty and repeat business – a relationship that starts with providing an outstanding experience, each and every time.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-10 and refer participants to page 28-5.

ACTIVITY: Divide the class into three groups. Have each group define good customer service.

Then, have them develop a list of things which SSAs should do to ensure that customers have a great experience and leave the post office feeling satisfied with their effort to meet the needs of their customers.

Outstanding Customer Service Activity

As a group, hold a discussion and decide on what you think is a definition of good customer service.

Then, develop a list of things which SSAs should do to ensure that customers have a great experience and leave the post office feeling like you have met their needs.

Facilitator: Have each group record their answers on a rip chart and present their findings to the entire class.

Record your answers on a rip chart and present your findings to the entire class.

Suggested answers:

- **Definitions of good customer service**
  - **Delivering a positive customer experience each and every time is the basis for good customer service.**
  - **Whether the customer is visiting a post a office or telephoning (the Postal Service) for information or to report a problem, providing a positive customer experience is an important aspect of good customer service.**
  - **A favorable customer service experience includes a series of activities designed to enhance the level of customer satisfaction and the feeling that a product or service has met or exceeded that customer's expectations.**
  - **Outstanding Customer Service is a function of how well an organization is able to constantly and consistently exceed the needs of the customer.**

How SSAs can ensure a great customer experience:

- **Listen carefully and gain an understanding of your customer's needs.**
  - **A positive customer experience includes listening to your customer's wants and needs. On the other hand, not listening to their needs will only upset and frustrate your customer.**
  - **Always be attentive to your customer and their needs when you are helping them.**

- **Offer products and services that match their mailing and shipping needs and not the things they don't want.**

Listen and resolve your customer's issues

- **Acknowledging and validating your customer's questions issues and concerns prepares you to respond effectively.**

Be helpful and knowledgeable

- **Customers look to you as an expert on Postal products and services.**
- **Offer suggestions. Many times the customer may only be looking at one aspect of a situation and may be unfamiliar with all of their options. You can help them by providing options or offering additional information or solutions to their mailing and shipping needs.**

Show how much you appreciate your customers

- **A closing such as, “Thank You" or “Have a Great Day” goes a long way.**
- **Think about yourself as the customer and how you would appreciate being treated with courteously.**

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-11.

A superior customer experience starts with understanding the customer's point of view. It is essential that you focus on the total customer experience. And there are some simple rules to follow which will help you ensure that you provide that experience for your customers with every transaction.

- Appreciate the value of your customer’s time - Customers time is very important to them and when they feel that it is being wasted it can lead to frustration. Periodically ask yourself, “Do I value my customers’ time?” “How would I want to be treated in this situation?”
- During interactions with customers keep them updated on your progress related to the transaction - If your customer’s are waiting, they will appreciate an update on your progress.
- Empathize with the customer - It is amazing how forgiving customers can be if you simply acknowledge and apologize to them for any inconvenience or the delay they have experienced.

You are not just selling our products and services, but also the experience which the customer will evaluate during and after the interaction with you. How you respond to a customer's questions and/or concerns has a long lasting impact on the relationship and can either ensure a loyal customer for life or one that will never return. Selling the experience can be a great opportunity to salvage and even improve customer relationships; but only if you act thoughtfully and with conviction.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-12.

Facilitator: ACTIVITY- Ask the class the following questions:

- **How would you contribute to the total customer experience in a positive way?**

The Postal Service sees every transaction and interaction with our customers as an opportunity to provide a positive customer experience.

Discuss their responses.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-13.

Exceptional customer experiences can be a significant factor and affect the amount of revenue generated at retail outlets. According to the Customer Experience Report, which is the result of an annual study of a mix of different retail experiences, customer experience is playing a significant role in determining where customers choose to shop and how much they are willing to spend. Results show that exceptional customer experience creates loyal customers and has the power to impact a company's revenue.

According to the report eighty-five percent of the customers polled said they would be willing to pay more over the standard price of a good or service to ensure a superior customer experience.

Research shows that a great customer service experience significantly impacts purchasing decisions:

Nearly all consumers (82 percent) stopped doing business with an organization as a result of negative experience and most (75 percent) do not return.

Almost 55 percent of consumers became customers of a company based on its reputation for great customer service, and 40 percent of consumers have switched to a competitor simply because of its reputation for exceptional service.

Image Factors

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-14. Refer participants to page 28-6.

Factors influencing customer perception can be categorized in the following three Ps:

- Personal: Your appearance and demeanor.
  - How do you look from the customer's perspective? How do you treat your customers? Do you project a professional image?
- Professional: Your Post Office.
  - Does your Post Office present an inviting atmosphere?
- Postal: Products and Services.
    - Do you offer what the customer needs?

Personal Appearance

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-15.

If you appear professional, well groomed, and in uniform, you convey to customers that you have pride in yourself and your job. A neat, professional appearance will positively impact customers' perceptions. Perceptions positive or negative are formed by customers within a few seconds, as soon as they walk in the door. The Postal Service has a Uniform Program to ensure that we present a professional image to the customer.

Facilitator: Handout a copy of the Employee Labor Relations Manual (ELM), Section 930 (Retail only), to introduce the participants to the Uniform Program and guidelines.

- **Discuss the elements of proper attire for sales and services associates.**
- **Explain the Uniform Allowance Program.**
- **Review any local procedures on sales and services associate's uniforms.**
- **Provide participants a list of vendors and the procedures for obtaining uniforms.**

Retail Lobby Appearance:

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-16.

Customers are affected not only by the appearance of the sales and services associates, but also by their total surroundings. When a customer walks into a post office, the appearance of the retail lobby has an immediate effect on them. Just like personal appearance, the appearance of the work environment can also have an effect on employee morale.

Facilitator: Explain how point - of - purchase (POP) materials such as menu boards, posters, brochures, etc. as well as Officially Licensed Retail Products (OLRP) should be displayed. The participant can help create a clean, uncluttered and professionally merchandised retail environment that will stimulate sales.

Emphasize that part of the professional environment is their individual work area. A clean and organized workstation is always more appealing to a customer. It is a visual indication to the customer that the Postal Service is organized and orderly in all aspects of servicing their needs.

Finally, using the Postal Operations Manual(POM) Section 125, discuss lobby awareness programs such as the "Lobby Director Program" that are designed to improve customer service and thus affect their perception of our professionalism.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-17 and refer participants to page 28-7.

Unless customers are confident in the products and services offered by the Postal Service, they will turn to our competitors. All of you should be aware of the fact that the Postal Service faces direct competition in the overnight delivery and package services markets. Even mail classes protected by the Private Express Statutes may face indirect competition such as online banking and bill payment. The emergence of new technologies continues to take more and more business away from the Postal Service and provide a substantial threat to the future of our business. For example, handheld mobile devices such as smart phones now allow the customer to access the internet to order merchandise, pay bills or review statements.

Areas in which the USPS competes:

Facilitator: Cover key points to items below for interaction.

Standard Mail

What type of mail typically comes as Standard Mail?

- Credit card offers
- Coupons
- Advertising

What are the alternatives to Standard Mail?

- TV, radio advertising
- Newspapers
- Internet advertising
- Advertising by email or through text messaging

How do economic conditions decrease the volume of Standard Mail?

- Increased levels of unemployment
- Slow economic growth
- Higher inflation (gasoline, food prices) – less discretionary income
- Less discretionary income – lower retail sales
- Lower retail sales – tighter advertising budgets, more targeted advertising
- Increasing costs and declining revenues

First-Class Mail

Despite the Postal Service's monopoly on delivery of First-Class Mail, rapidly developing technology (i.e. Internet, email, fax, Smart phones, etc.) poses a competitive threat. The Postal Service now delivers only 65% of this type of mail.

What type of mail represents USPS major sources of First Class Mail?

- Bills, statements, payments, greeting cards, personal and business correspondence

What are the alternatives to First Class Mail?

- Internet, email and attachments, online bill payment, fax, Electronic funds transfers

How do economic conditions accelerate the diversion of First-Class Mail to other alternatives?

- Less homes – less utility bills and other household mail
- On-line bill payments and electronic funds transfers – less mail
- Email – less personal and business correspondence

Retail

Pack-and-Send retailers are now established as a highly credible alternative to post offices. This is a traditional $2 billion industry serving much of the traditional USPS market.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-18.

USPS competitive strengths:

Priority Mail Express

- Expedited overnight delivery with affordable pricing. Rates are published for customer convenience
- Delivered 365 days a year.
- Free shipping materials that are 100% recyclable
- USPS Tracking and $100 insurance coverage included at no charge.

Priority Mail

- When overnight service is not needed, Priority Mail features expedited 1-3 day delivery at competitive prices.
- If it fits, it ships – flat rate pricing and free shipping materials that are 100% recyclable
- USPS Tracking and $50 insurance coverage included at no charge for retail shipments.

Parcel Delivery Products

What types of goods are generally shipped as packages?

- Retail goods; mail order catalog, internet sales and order fulfillment

Who are the Postal Service's competitors in the package business?

- Fed Ex
- UPS

How do economic conditions decrease the volume of parcel delivery?

- Higher inflation (gasoline, food prices) – less discretionary income

  - Less discretionary income – lower retail sales and orders for merchandise

What do the experts predict for future mail volume growth?

- Increasing diversion of First-Class Mail to the internet in the form of bills, statements, correspondence and payments
- Advertising trends will impact the future growth of Standard Mail
- Package delivery market will continue to grow due to demographics, e-commerce, and globalization
- International mail of all types is expected to grow as a result of the expanding global economy

The most important way to positively impact customer perceptions of the Postal Service is to provide excellent customer service with every single transaction. Customer expectations will rise continually as competition increases and technology evolves. As sales and services associates, your commitment and customer service must exceed customer expectations. People take for granted the nearly 160 billion pieces of mail that the Postal Service delivers each year, and remember only what directly affects them. A successful retail transaction can have more to do with creating a good impression than anything else we do.

As sales and services associates, you play a vital role in delivering excellent customer service to all customers each and every time they visit a post office. Put yourself in your customer's shoes and ask how you would want to be treated and what a positive customer experience would mean to you. Remember, the most important aspect of meeting our competitive challenge is ensuring that our customers –the American public – have positive interaction with and positive perceptions of the United States Postal Service.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 28-19 and refer participants to page 28-10.

Summary

The most important way to positively impact customer perceptions of the Postal Service is to provide excellent customer service with every single transaction. Customer expectations will rise continually as competition increases and technology evolves. As sales and services associates, commitment and customer service must exceed customer expectations. People take for granted the nearly 160 billion pieces of mail that the Postal Service delivers each year, and remember only what directly affects them. A successful retail transaction can have more to do with creating a good impression than anything else we do.

A positive customer experience begins with four basic principles, known as "Customer Experience Essentials": Telephone Courtesy; It Begins with a Smile; Delivery Done Right; We Value Your Business

Delivering a positive customer experience each and every time is not only the basis for good customer service, it is vital to the future growth and success of the Postal Service. Positive customer experiences promote loyalty and repeat business. In addition, loyal and satisfied customers are more likely to recommend the Postal Service to others, creating the opportunity and potential for growth of new business.

As sales and services associates, you play a vital role in delivering customer service to all customers each and every time they visit a post office. And remember, the most important aspect of meeting our competitive challenge is ensuring that our customers –the American public – have positive interaction with and positive perceptions of the United States Postal Service.

Module 29: Completing the Perfect Transaction

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Utilize the six steps of the Perfect Transaction to ensure customers' mailing and shipping needs are met during each visit to the Post Office
- Project a positive first impression and commitment to the organization by displaying product knowledge and maintaining confidence during the customer retail experience
- Maintain a professional and respectful demeanor interacting and communicating with customers to identify their mailing and shipping needs

Time Allocated for Module:

- 20 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Group Activity

Summary:

- Projecting a Positive First Impression
- Completing the Perfect Transaction
- Using GIST

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip Chart

Projecting a Positive First Impression

Facilitator: Review Projecting A Positive First Impression information with the class.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-3.

ACTIVITY: Ask the class the following question: What does a positive first impression mean to you?

Lead a group discussion and record the answers on a rip chart.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-4.

We have all heard the phrase, "first impressions matter". This could not be truer for the Postal Service. First impressions are critical to a successful customer experience.

You have just a few seconds to make a good first impression. Afterwards, it is almost impossible to change it! So make sure that you strive for a great first impression with each new encounter.

What can you do to ensure a good first impression? Are you prepared to make that first impression a positive one for our customers?

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-5.

Tips for Making a Great First Impression:

Be at ease

- Be calm and confident so the other person will feel more at ease as you build a solid foundation for making that first impression a good one.

Present yourself appropriately

- Appropriate dress and grooming helps make a good first impression and helps you to feel more calm and confident.
- Wearing a clean, pressed uniform is a great way to create a good first impression.

Start with a smile

- A warm and confident smile will put both you and the other person at ease.

Be open and confident

- Body language and appearance speak much louder than words. Use your body language to project appropriate confidence and self-assurance.

Be positive

- Your attitude shows through in everything you do.
- Project a positive attitude even in the face of criticism or in the case of nervousness.

Be courteous and attentive

- It goes without saying that good manners and polite, attentive, and courteous behavior help make a good first impression. In fact, anything less can actually ruin the one chance you have at making that first impression a positive one.

Facilitator: Review the Completing the Perfect Transaction information with the class. Discuss each of the six steps.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-6. Refer participants to page 29-4.

Completing the Perfect Transaction

Let's take a minute to talk about the perfect transaction. The perfect transaction includes clean lobbies that are stocked with forms and supplies; properly attired and friendly retail professionals, who are knowledgeable about the products and services offered by the Postal Service and able to match these to our customers' needs each and every time. Sales and services associates must ask the required sales skills questions in order for a "perfect" transaction to be conducted.

Inviting the Customer to the Window

Prior to engaging with the customer, **invite** them to the window in a welcoming and courteous way. Turn towards the customer and greet them with a phrase such as "How may I help you today?"

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-7 and conduct a Short Interactive Exercise

Ask the participants to think of themselves as a customer, and ask them how they would like to be greeted when they are visiting a post office.

Capture up to 5 suggestions on a rip chart

Some suggestions: May I help you; May I help the next customer; Good morning/afternoon, how can I help you today; Welcome to the Postal Service, how may I assist you;

Note: A more familiar greeting may be used as appropriate with known or regular customers

The Perfect Transaction

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-8.

1. **Greet** customer pleasantly and make eye contact

   Be attentive to the customer throughout the entire transaction. Give the customer your undivided attention. Make sure every customer feels important when they come to your window.

Facilitator: You must ask the four components of the HAZMAT question for packages, bulky flats and suspicious mailpieces once during each customer transaction.

Note: If you have to weigh it, then ask the question.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-9.

2. Does this package contain anything liquid, fragile, perishable or potentially hazardous?"

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-10.

3. Always Offer Priority Mail Express first by name stating the service standards

   Would you like to use Express Mail for this package, which is guaranteed delivery by tomorrow (or second day) for only (current rate)? That price includes $100 of free insurance and you can track your package using usps.com or our 1-800 number". (Pause and wait for the customer to respond).

"We have Priority Mail that should arrive in 1,2or 3 days for (current rate).

Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail are the preferred services that usually offer the customer the best value.

When you offer Standard Post or another Package Service option, explain the product's features. "We do have Standard Post, which includes USPS Tracking but can take up to 7-10 days for delivery and return postage is not included. Packages that can't be delivered for any reason will be returned postage due."

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-11.

4. Offer both Insurance and USPS Tracking by name explaining the features of each.

Would you like to purchase insurance to protect your package against loss or damage?

For an additional (current rate), you can track your package with our USPS Tracking Service (point out web site and 1-800 number that is included on the receipt).

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-12.

5. Offer a specific additional product to purchase and explain the feature.

Select one or more of the following "high profit" products and explain at least one benefit or feature of the product (Stamps, Packaging Supplies, Post Office Box Rental, Passports, and/or Money Order).

Note: If offering stamps, offer an additional product or service other than stamps. When offering stamps and another additional product, you only have to explain a benefit or feature of the additional product (other than stamps). Offering additional products to purchase helps educate customers about our services that they may not have considered purchasing before, or it may be something they would purchase at another retail establishment. Below are a few examples. Be creative and use your knowledge to expand on any of these services.

Stamps: Can I interest you in our "Art of Disney – Imagination Stamps" today?" They feature four famous Disney characters.

Packaging Supplies: We have some high quality mailing boxes. Would you like to purchase one of our Ready Post Decorative Mailer for your next mailing?

Post Office Box Rental: Can I interest you in our Post Office Box service? This is our most secure delivery service and allows you to have access to your mail earlier in the day.

Passports: Did you know this office (or a neighboring office) is an official U.S. Passport site? If you're considering traveling out of the country or if you just want to have a passport as your preferred form of identification, you can apply for your passport here.

Money Orders: Did you have a need for a Postal money order today? They can be cashed at any U.S. Post Office or most banks in the United States.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-13.

6. Always provide the customer with a receipt.

Always end the transaction in a pleasant manner by saying "Thank you," or "Thanks," or "Thank you for choosing the US Postal Service."

Each retail transaction and individual sales and services associate's style may vary and sales and services associates should interact with customers based on the transaction occurring at the time. The "Engaging Our Customers" Transaction is provided to serve as a guide to help ensure customers are offered maximum value during package transactions. The POS display is not shown to the customer, but the Customer Display Unit (CDU) is there for the customer and it shows our service options.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-14. Refer participants to page 29-6.

Using GIST

When conducting customer transactions, sales and services associates must use the components of GIST - Greet, Inquire, Suggest, Thank - to help customers make educated decisions. They should greet customers and ask about their mailing needs and the mailability of the contents [hazardous materials (HAZMAT)], offer and explain Postal Service premium services and/or explain the product requested, offer and explain any special services and additional products, and then thank the customers for their patronage.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-15.

Did you know that when you engage the customer with the perfect transaction flow, it improves the overall Retail Customer Experience (RCE) score?

Retail Customer Experience

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-17.

The Retail Customer Experience (formally known as Mystery Shopper) program's purpose and intent is to be a diagnostic tool used to correct conditions that are detrimental to customer satisfaction and may inhibit revenue growth.

The Retail Customer Experience program is not a new program to the Postal Service, but one that has been used in retail units for years. The purpose and intent of the program is to use it as a diagnostic tool to correct conditions detrimental to customer satisfaction and that may inhibit revenue growth. The Retail Customer Experience program gives the Postal Service an objective view of Postal Service retail locations. The Retail Customer Experience can be used as a real-time snapshot of a customer interaction.

Retail Customer Experience results are about driving employee behaviors that will result in improved customer satisfaction and increased retail revenue.

The program uses independently contracted "customers" who visit post offices and document their experiences by answering a standardized questionnaire. Each "customer" conducts a mailing transaction to test the quality of his or her experience at a retail unit. Sales and services associates must ask the required sales skills questions in order for a "perfect" transaction to be conducted. Based on the planned transaction type, the Retail Customer Experience report identifies the lost revenue when the sales and services associate does not ask the appropriate questions.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-18.

The Retail Customer Experience questionnaire is divided into five weighted categories as follows:

Waiting Time in Line (WTIL) — Postal Service customers have repeatedly informed the Postal Service that WTIL helps to define their entire experience at the Post Office. WTIL also helps to determine whether a customer will continue to use Postal Service products and services or go to competitors. Remember, customers have choices, and it is the Postal Service's job to ensure that customers have great service to keep them coming back. Great service means respecting a customer's time.

Hazardous Materials (HAZMAT) — The primary purpose of asking the HAZMAT question is to promote the safety of Postal Service employees, the general public, and the Postal Service transportation network. A majority of common HAZMAT items are relatively safe when used at home or work. However, many HAZMAT items can exhibit potentially dangerous characteristics during shipping due to improper packaging, exposure to extreme temperatures and pressure variations, excessive vibration during transport, improper handling, and storage in proximity to an incompatible material.

Although it may seem repetitive to ask the HAZMAT question on every transaction, asking the question is vital to the safety of our employees, customers and the mail.

Sales Skills and Product Offerings and Product Knowledge and Product Explanations — Effective product offering and product explanations of Postal Service products and services are key to generating revenue and keeping our customers coming back. The Postal Service offers many products and services, however many customers do not know about them. Employees need to educate customers so that they can make an informed mailing decision. It is important to let our customers decide how they want to mail their article. Do not assume that the customer wants the cheapest price. Remember that customers want value, not necessarily the cheapest price. They want to know their options.

By offering customers Postal Service premium services and explaining the service standards, the customers can make an informed mailing decision based on information which is presented to them. Proper use of product offerings and product explanations at your office can make the difference in whether your office achieves its revenue goals and customer satisfaction targets.

Promotion and Merchandising — Every day, the Postal Service has the opportunity to serve 9 million customers in more than 32,000 post offices, stations and branches. The experiences that our customers have when they enter our retail lobbies vary widely from one office to another. We must provide our customers with a consistent, reliable retail experience.

If the post office that a customer visits has outdated signage or offers a poor selection of retail merchandise, there is no reason for the customer to keep coming back. Studies have shown that the wall behind the retail service counter is the most important message area in the post office. While approaching the retail service counter, customers look to the full service lobby for information to help them complete their transactions or prepare packages. Research also shows that the full service lobby is the best place to introduce customers to new products and services.

Image — Customer research indicates that the cleanliness of a Postal Service facility and the employee's attitude and behavior, determine whether a customer will return to conduct his or her business or go to a competitor. If a post office is dirty or an employee is not friendly, it impacts the customers' perception of that office. The Postal Service unit must be neat, clean, and well maintained. To project a professional image and keep customers coming back, the sales and services associate must be in complete uniform, greet the customer, and be attentive and pleasant throughout the transaction.

The questionnaire is conducted at offices that generate $500,000 or more in annual walk-in revenue or are in the top 20 percent of the highest revenue-producing offices within a district.

Using these criteria the Postal Service shops at close to 8,800 retail units, 8 times a year, for a total fiscal year count of about 70,000 shops. Although all retail units do not participate in the Retail Customer Experience program, all Retail employees need to understand and follow the guidelines.

There are many benefits to be gained from the program: checking the cleanliness of the retail unit, the friendliness of your retail staff, the availability of products, etc. For the Postal Service, the main benefit from the Retail Customer Experience program is to test the sales skills of our retail work force through the eyes of our customers.

The Retail Customer Experience survey is a report card of our retail performance. Trained "shoppers" evaluate sales and services associates' ability to sell postal products and services.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-19.

They also:

- Check the cleanliness of the retail unit.
- Evaluate the friendliness and professionalism of our retail staff.
- Verify display of point-of-purchase signage.
- Record the availability of products.

When managed effectively, the Retail Customer Experience data is a great tool for increasing efficiency of retail operations.

The results identify areas that need improvement. The results should be shared with the retail staff.

What's measured in the Retail Customer Experience program should become so commonplace to our everyday performance that if the program were to end tomorrow, it would not change the customer's retail experience in any way.

The Retail Customer Experience represents the customer's experience at the time of shopping. Retail Customer Experience feedback can be a powerful tool for improving customer service as well as increasing revenue.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-20.

All components of the RCE contribute to the overall score including Wait Time in Line and HAZMAT to name a couple. However, there is one component that offers tremendous opportunity and that is product explanation. Improving this category is as simple as:

- Mentioning to the customer that insurance and tracking is included with Priority Mail Express
- Explaining at least one feature and benefit when you offer an Extra Service to the customer.
- Including these two steps in your transaction when assisting your customer will add extra points to your RCE Product Explanation category and ultimately increase your overall RCE score.

Remember, it is all about the customer! Providing customers with quick, easy, and convenient service creates loyal customers who will keep coming back to your office. Loyal customers mean additional revenue for the Postal Service.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 29-21 and refer participants to page 29-10.

Summary

Customer research indicates that the cleanliness of a Postal Service facility and the employee's attitude and behavior, determine whether a customer will return to conduct his or her business or go to a competitor. If a post office is dirty or an employee is not friendly, it impacts the customers' perception of that office. The Postal Service unit must be neat, clean, and well maintained. To project a professional image and keep customers coming back, the sales and services associate must be in complete uniform, greet the customer, and be attentive and pleasant throughout the transaction.

Presenting a positive postal image in every encounter will ensure that our customers feel satisfied that their needs were addressed and met. You can ensure we have their trust that we will provide outstanding service at the best value. Remember, that if you project a positive image, know and sell our products and services, and follow the steps of the perfect transaction, you will guarantee a perfect customer experience.

Module 30: Handling Challenging Customer Experiences

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Effectively interact with challenging customers
- Select the appropriate words and phrases to use during the customer experience

Time Allocated for Module:

- 20 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Group Activity

Summary:

- Challenging interactions

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip Chart

Challenging Interactions

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 30-3, refer participants to page 30-3, and review the Challenging Interactions information with the class.

At the retail counter you will be handling many different types of customers. Many will be friendly and accommodating, however, occasionally you may encounter a customer who may present a challenging situation. This may be someone who has a difficult time with communication, language barriers, or having a bad day. Beginning an interaction with a customer who is challenging or difficult can be stressful. Our goal is for the customer to walk away from the window feeling as if his or her needs were met. It is important to remember to listen attentively to the customer. This will ensure the customer understands you are trying to help him/her. When you begin the conversation with the customer, be sure you smile and use open body language before you begin speaking in order for the customer to understand you are there to assist them in their mailing needs.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 30-4.

Handling difficult customers may be your biggest challenge in living up to the promise you make of providing great service. So, what is the most effective way to handle this challenge? Let's look at a simple, four-step process that may be helpful for dealing with customer complaints and even the occasional difficult customer.

- Remain calm
  - If you are relaxed, it will help your customer to better keep their composure.
  - Don't argue with the customer and don't place blame on them.
- Show respect
  - It can be difficult to respect a person who may be yelling or swearing.
  - Don't get angry, stay in control, and never argue. This seems to be the toughest rule for most people to accept and follow. Even if you win, you lose.
  - Once you start reacting to the customer in an emotional way, you will lose your power to control the interaction and the situation will be likely to escalate into a no-win situation.

- Show empathy
    - Put yourself in the customer's shoes and try to see the situation from his/her perspective.
    - Listen attentively in order to understand the source of that frustration. When you do that, you send a powerful unspoken message that you care about the customer and the situation.
- Listen Between the Lines
    - Is there an underlying message to your customer's complaint?
    - Does the customer feel cheated or misled by the promises which were given when the product or service was purchased?
    - Does the customer feel ignored or unappreciated?

One thing to keep in mind when beginning a transaction with difficult customers is we can either make the interaction pleasant or more strained depending on the words we choose.

Facilitator: Review the Choosing the Right Words information with the class.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 30-5.

Choosing the Right Words

How we look when we say something is key to how we are understood. The actual ***words*** we use can also be very important. We all have words and phrases that are upsetting or elicit a response when we hear them. These words may invoke or "trigger" a negative reaction. If someone else is capable of getting that kind of response from us with words, it's a sure thing that we might also be affecting someone else with the words we have chosen to say.

There are other words that may be soothing or calming, and tend to invoke a more positive reaction. These words may be used to diffuse challenging situations and assist with customer care and recovery efforts.

Perhaps we have become so accustomed to a particular word (or phase) that we might not think twice about how someone else might interpret our word choice.

When dealing with difficult customers, there are words that calm and words that tend to exacerbate unpleasant customer conflicts.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 30-6. Refer participants to page 30-5.

Facilitator: ACTIVITY- Divide the class into three groups.

Instruct participants to draw a line down the center of the Rip Chart; creating two columns. Have them write the phrase "Trigger Words" at the top of the left column and write "Calming Words" at the top of the right column.

Explain to the participants that:

Trigger words are those which generate negative feelings and are usually less effective in a conversation.

Calming words are those which make us feel relaxed and composed and are usually more effective in an interaction with another person.

Tell the participants to think about everyday encounters with co-workers, friends and family, as well as any customer interactions that may have included words or phrases which elicited a response, good or bad.

Have each group present their findings to the entire class.

Suggested answers:

Trigger Words (less effective word choices)

- **It's not our policy**
- **Calm down…**
- **Sorry I can't help you**
- **I don't know**
- **But…**
- **You should have…**
- **The only thing I can do…**
- **I don't care**
- **Whatever!**
- **Really?**

Calming Words (more effective word choices)

- **Here's what we can do…**
- **Thank you**
- **I am sorry that happened to you**

- **I will find out…**
- **I understand why you…**
- **The best option, I think, is…**
- **Can you help me understand what I can do to assist you?"**
- **Would you like to try…**

Calming a Challenging Customer Activity

Draw a line down the center of the Rip Chart; creating two columns. Write the phrase "Trigger Words" at the top of the left column and write "Calming Words" at the top of the right column.

- Trigger words are those which generate negative feelings and are usually less effective in a conversation.
- Calming words are those which make us feel relaxed and composed and are usually more effective in an interaction with another person.

Think about everyday encounters with co-workers, friends and family, as well as any customer interactions that may have included hot button words or phrases.

When you have finished developing your lists, present your findings to the entire class.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 30-7.

Right Words for the Right Outcome

Don't you wish people who chose these words or phrases would stop using them? What word choice might be used in place of, "calm down?" Instead of saying, "calm down," we might say, "I'd like to help you", or "I'm listening," or "That does sound frustrating." A little empathy goes a long way.

When it comes to, 'but,' an alternative might be, "you did a great job *and* let's take a look at the figures to support your findings." Two sentences might be better than one. "You did a great job on that report. Let's take a look at the figures to support your findings."

Here are a few more "trigger" words and phases with possible alternatives to consider.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 30-8.

- ***You need to***: Customers do not want to hear, ***you need to.*** To the customer, ***you need to*** sounds like an order. Phrases such as, "You need to move to that empty window to fill out the form, and then I'll help you when you're finished" makes the customer feel as if he/she isn't important to you. Try this type of alternative, "If you'll move to that empty window to fill out this form, I'll help you as soon as you're finished". ***No vs. I Can***: Customers are often discouraged if a sales person says, "No, I can't do that". Instead, a better word choice might be, "After you complete the . . . . . then you can…**"** The words you say can affect the transaction and the desire of the customer to continue to visit our Post Offices.

  Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 30-9.

- ***You're wrong,*** or ***that's not true***: Another commonly used phrase in customer service is, "You're wrong. We can't do that." or "That's not true." Both of these statements can be seen as negative to customers. When a customer is buying the wrong product or using the wrong service, you should begin the transaction saying, "I am not sure we can meet your needs the way you have requested. I have a different option for you…" Speaking with customers using positive statements increases the success of the customer experience.

  Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 30-10.

Summary

Considering our word choices before speaking to our customers allows us to improve any interaction. Customers are searching for the best options and they come to the Postal Service to help them find a solution for their mailing and shipping needs. They expect quality interactions when buying postal products and services. Even though some customers will be challenging, it is always important to remember that communicating effectively will make the interaction go more smoothly.

Module 31: Using Retail Communication Channels/Expanded Access

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Collect information using appropriate communication channels available to identify features and benefits of new products
- Improve the customers' retail experience by obtaining product knowledge as soon as new products are introduced into the system
- Reduce customer wait time in line by increasing product knowledge to provide appropriate mailing and shipping options to the customer
- Describe various services available to the customer including Automated Postal Centers, Contract Postal Units/Retail Partners, Stamps by Mail and usps.com
- Increase awareness of expanded channels to provide mailing and shipping options to our customers

Time Allocated for Module:

- 20 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion
- Group Activity

Summary:

- Being Informed Means Being Successful
- Retail Communications Channels
- Exploring Alternatives
- Expanded Access Channels

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- PowerPoint presentation

- Projector
- Rip Chart

Facilitator: Review the Being Informed Means Being Successful information with the class.

Being Informed Means Being Successful

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-3. Refer participants to page 31-3.

Knowledge is power! This phrase is frequently used but rarely understood. Knowing the products and services available to meet the needs of our customers will help to ensure our customers will continue to do business with the Postal Service. Gaining knowledge also ensures you are comfortable completing transactions with all customers, even the most challenging. When you are able to understand and identify the customers mailing needs, you have made the interaction successful. You will feel empowered in your job, leading to greater job satisfaction. In order to gain knowledge, you should explore the various channels where retail information is communicated. This will ensure you have the most up-to-date information available regarding product knowledge and availability.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-4.

ACTIVITY- Begin by instructing participants to close their Participant Guide prior to beginning this activity.

Ask the class the following question:

- **What retail communication channels might provide you with additional information regarding a new product?**

Lead a group discussion and record the answers on a Rip Chart.

Suggested answers:

- **Postal Bulletin**
- **Retail Digest**
- **News Link**
- **Postal Merchandise Guide**
- **Learning Management System**
- **POS Message Center Message**
- **Service Talks**
- **eMail**

Facilitator: Review the Retail Communications Channels information with the class.

When possible take participant to links identified for Retail Communications Channels

Retail Communication Channels

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-5.

There are many retail communication channels available to you. Accessing them on a regular basis will increase your knowledge and assist you in meeting the needs of our customers.

- Postal Bulletin
  - Provides updates to policies, procedures, forms, and operational information about the Postal Service
  - "What's In Store" column in the Postal Bulletin

    http://www.usps.com/cpim/ftp/bulletin/pb.htm
- Retail Marketing website
  - Provides information about a variety of topics, including Access Channels, Communication, Customer Service, Policies, and Products and Services

    http://blue.usps.gov/customerservicesoperationsandretail/home.shtml
- Retail Digest
  - A bi-weekly publication designed to streamline communications originating from HQ USPS Retail. This batch communication greatly reduces the number of individual messages sent to the field retail organization by consolidating all program messages into a single publication.

    http://blue.usps.gov/customerservicesoperationsandretail/communications/publications/retail_digest.shtml?

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-6.

- Postal Merchandise Guide
  - A quarterly reference guide for all of the revenue-generating retail products in the lobby plus merchandising tips to complement standardized offices.
  - Use this tool to maximize your office's retail revenue and expand your customer base.

- Retail Operation Handbook PO-209
  - A tool for providing Postal Service employees information about retail operations

    http://blue.usps.gov/cpim/ftp/hand/po209.pdf
- POS New Functionality Guide

  http://rse2/posone/about/training/courses.asp?VENDOR=NCR
- POS ONE Message Center
  - Communicates important information from USPS Retail to POS ONE users
- News Link
  - The online news source for postal employees
  - The daily link shows up in your Outlook mailbox and archives can be accessed online

    https://liteblue.usps.gov/news/link/archive.htm
- Local Messaging
  - Check with your Area or District

Facilitator: Review the Exploring Alternatives information with the class.

Exploring Alternatives

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-7 and refer participants to page 31-4.

The current state of the economy and the increases in innovation are rapidly changing how the Postal Service does business. In order to continue to serve customers, we must change the way we engage our customers with our products and services. The development of Internet and online services has led to an increase in customer visits to usps.com and the various services available through Click-n-Ship. These services allow customers convenient access to products and services needed for mailings.

Increasing revenue and improving the Retail Customer Experience (RCE) are essential to the success of the Postal Service. It is imperative to provide our customers with choices for purchasing postal products and services; especially when they need access beyond the normal hours of our brick and mortar locations.

When a customer engages with you during a transaction, understanding the importance of providing expanded access options to the customer is essential. Our customers have mailing and shipping choices. Providing them with information on expanded access channels will help to ensure they make the choice to use the Postal Service and not our competition for their mailing and shipping needs.

Facilitator: Review the Expanded Access Channels information with the class. Let's look at the following information to become more familiar with Expanded access Channels. Refer participants to page 31-5.

Expanded Access Channels

With 32,000 postal retail offices and more than 70,000 third-party retailers — Approved Postal Providers — selling postage stamps and providing expanded access to other postal products and services, customers today have about 100,000 locations across the nation where they can do business with the Postal Service. Responding to changing customer needs and a business plan that calls for expanding access to Postal Service products, stores including Costco™ and Office Depot™ are offering shipping and mailing services.

Customers can find dozens of locations to purchase postal services within their neighborhoods by visiting an interactive map at *www.uspseverywhere.com* and typing in a ZIP Code. Using a simple icon guide designating stamps, shipping and packaging, PO Boxes and other services, customers can easily navigate to retail outlets, grocery stores, Self-Service Kiosks, and Post Offices, among other options.

The Postal Service of the future will be smaller, leaner and more competitive, and it will continue to drive commerce, serve communities and deliver value.

Self-Service Kiosk

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-8.

Self-Service kiosks are designed to process 80 percent of the transactions normally handled by a retail employee at the window. Self-Service Kiosks handle non-cash transactions, accepting major credit and debit cards. These centers are located in post office lobbies, the majority in areas open 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. Future plans include locating these kiosks in non-postal locations such as airports, grocery stores, malls, etc. Self-Service Kiosks move simple transactions away from the retail operation. They allow retail professionals to use their skills to assist customers with more complicated mailing needs.

Approved Shippers

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-9.

A USPS Approved Shipper is a private retailer with a packaging and shipping operation – they may provide a variety of shipping services including postal services and competitor services (ie, FedEx, UPS). Through a license agreement, the USPS Approved Shipper is authorized to display postal signage promoting the availability of US Postal Service products and services. These retailers do not receive compensation from the USPS; rather they make profit through non-postal surcharges.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-10.

Automated Teller Machines

Customers may use bank automated teller machines (ATMs) to purchase stamps. The bank may receive stamps through a Stamps to Go contract. Stamps are sold at face value but the banks are allowed to charge a transaction fee.

Stamps by Mail

Stamps by Mail service allows USPS customers in city delivery areas to purchase postal products by ordering them through the mail. The USPS order forms are incorporated in self addressed, postage-paid envelopes. Customers obtain order envelopes (PS Form 3227, *Stamps by Mail*) from letter carriers, in Post Office lobbies, or by telephoning the local delivery unit to request their delivery. After completing an order form and enclosing a check or money order, the customer drops the sealed envelope in a collection box or his or her mailbox. Mail orders are returned to the customer within 3 to 5 business days.

Stamps to Go

Under the Stamps to Go program, the USPS distributes First-Class Mail, Priority Mail Express , and Priority Mail postage stamps to retailers for resale to the general public. Stamps are not to be sold above face value. In consigned stocks, if the vendor chooses to sell at below face value, the retailer still must pay the USPS the full value. The objective of the SOC program is to provide a convenient method of purchasing stamps for household customers who prefer to combine their stamp purchases with other shopping.

Stamps by Phone

By calling 1-800-STAMP-24 (800-782-6724), customers may order stamps and make purchases with their credit cards. This toll-free number is available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. There is a service charge, and stamps are delivered by mail within 3 to 5 business days.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-11. Refer participants to page 31-7.

Contract Postal Units

Contract postal units (CPUs) and Community Post Offices (CPOs) are operated under contract by persons who are not USPS employees. The facilities are provided by the contractor. Contracts to operate these units provide that the contractor will transact specified USPS business. Customers at a full-service CPU generally receive the same products, services, and information that are available at all Post Offices, stations, and branches. Customers are charged the same rates for USPS services and products as those charged in Post Offices. Limited-service CPUs do not carry the full line of postal products and services. Contracts for limited service CPUs specify which products and services will be offered, and the days and hours of operation.

Mobile Retail Units

For special events, holidays, etc., the USPS provides service by taking the Post Office to our customers. Most districts have equipment for a mobile retail unit. Contact your district retail office for availability.

Village Post Offices

Village Post Offices (VPOs) are located within existing communities in a variety of locations, such as businesses, town hall or government centers, and are operated by those entities. VPOs offer a range of products and services that could include collection boxes, PO Boxes, Forever stamps, and Prepaid Priority Mail Flat-Rate boxes and envelopes.

www.usps.com

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-12.

The USPS Internet Web site (http://www.usps.com) provides a full set of services for USPS customers. It is quick, easy and convenient. Interactive pages include lookups for ZIP Codes, Post Offices, specialized USPS facilities, stamp purchasing, Post Office Box Rental, track and confirm, domestic and international rate calculators, and online change-of-address forms. Click-N-Ship and Carrier Pickup, two of our most popular services are also available.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-13.

ACTIVITY- Read the following scenario to the class.

A customer approaches the counter at 11:30 a.m. on Saturday to send a Priority Mail package that needs to go that day. After the sales and services associate greets him, the customer realizes that he forgot one of the items which need to go in the package. The sales and services associate informs the customer that the lobby closes at noon and asks if he'll have time to return before the retail counter closes.

The customer responds that he won't have time to go home and return before closing. Realizing the customer's dilemma, the sales and services associate informs him of all the expanded access solutions that would meet his needs.

After reading the scenario, ask the class the following question:

- **What Expanded Access Channels could they have recommended to the customer?**

Lead a group discussion and record the answers on a rip chart.

Suggested answers:

- **Self-Service Kiosk – Located in the 24-hour lobby; provide other known locations; provide pick-up times and dates; credit/debit card payment only**
- **usps.com (Click-N-Ship, Carrier Pickup, etc.)**
- **1-800-ASK-USPS**

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 31-14.

Summary

Today's customers want choices. Providing customers with quick, easy, and convenient service creates loyal customers who will keep coming back. Loyal customers mean additional revenue generation for the Postal Service! Keeping our customers informed of all the convenient ways they can do business with the Postal Service will sustain a viable Postal Service for the future.

One of the ways you can be more successful at work is by obtaining all the information you can about postal products and services. There are many retail communication channels available to you that will provide up-to-date information about products and services.

The retail employee communication program is designed to communicate both strategic and tactical information to the field retail organization. The entire suite of Retail communication channels is available for you to stay abreast of all the latest updates in the world of postal retail.

Remember, being informed contributes to success!

Module 32: Retail Equipment

Objectives:

Upon the completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Describe the benefits of the equipment used to conduct retail transactions
- Follow safety procedures associated with the equipment used for retail transactions
- Describe the types of information shown on Postage Validation Imprinter (PVI) labels and when each is used

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Discussion
- Presentation

Summary:

- Retail Equipment
- Postage Validation Imprinter (PVI) Label definition

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip Chart

Retail Equipment

The Retail Equipment may be different at each office. You will receive hands-on training on the equipment specific to your office after successfully completing the classroom portion of your sales and services associate training.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-3. Refer participants to page 32-3.

Benefits of the Retail Equipment

The retail equipment allows the sales and services associates to handle customer business with greater efficiency. The design of the retail equipment provides the sales and services associate and customer with many benefits.

- Perform multiple customer transactions and keep a running total of the amount due.
- Automatically calculate the amount of change due the customer.
- Perform standardized transactions.
- Reduce mathematical errors.
- Record the complete day's business.
- Produce a system-generated PS Form 1412A, *Daily Financial Form* eliminating the need for a manual PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Reporting* and the time it would take to prepare it.
- Produce system-generated receipts versus manual receipts.
- Customer can see transactions on customer monitor.
- Customer receives automated receipts.
- Customer receives faster, accurate, and more efficient service.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-4.

Safety Procedures

Facilitator: Discuss safety precaution with participants.

As with any job and any equipment you may use on that job, safety is the responsibility of every individual in the USPS. Your supervisor is responsible for instructing personnel on safety practices applicable to the operation of the equipment.

In the same manner, it is the responsibility of each individual operating the equipment to understand and observe the safety standards and procedures established by the USPS.

The operation of electronic and electrical equipment has several elements of danger. Carelessness can result in injury. You must observe the following precautions, and do not operate equipment without proper authority.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slides 32-5 and 32-6.

Safety Precautions

- Do not operate unsafe or defective equipment.
- Avoid unsafe acts and conditions.
- Practice good housekeeping.
- Do not engage in horseplay.
- Immediately report all hazardous conditions and operations to your supervisor.
- Keep mentally and physically alert.
- Know the location of the main power shutdown devices.
- Know how to get medical aid.
- Keep clothing, hands, and feet dry.
- Avoid the use of toxic or flammable solvents for cleaning purposes. If there are certain jobs specifically requiring the use of these solvents, contact a safety specialist or your supervisor.
- In the event of an electrical fire, use a type C, BC, or ABC extinguisher only. Do not use water or any other liquid stream extinguisher, as either presents a shock hazard to the user and will cause considerable damage to electrical equipment.
- Never place food or liquids on or around any part of the equipment.
- The retail equipment is grounded through the grounding conductor of the power cord. To avoid the danger of electrical shock, make sure the power plug is inserted into a properly wired outlet.
- Check the power cord before plugging it in. Always use a power cord that is in good condition. A power cord that is frayed or has broken insulation is a shock hazard.
- Do not operate the retail equipment without properly installed covers (i.e., without scale platform).

- Always turn the power off when doing any replacement of components.
- Following safety procedures can save you from injury and will prevent lost time for you and the Postal Service.

Postage Validation Imprinter (PVI) Label Definition

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-7. Refer participants to page 32-5.

PVI is the acronym for Postage Validation Imprinter. The office you are assigned to may use the PVI to print postage. We call the postage PVI labels.

Facilitator: Use training PVI labels if available. Review each label type with participants and discuss the information located on each label and its meaning.

TEST LABEL

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-8.

Four formats. Obtained by selecting "LABEL" with mode button and pressing paper feed button. Run at start of tour, after clearing a jam and after loading blank labels. A total of five lables are dispensed, one is blank. These labels are NOT to be given away.



Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-9.

PVI LABEL

No barcode. Provided automatically for non-POSTNET flats, Priority Mail Express and International mail.

These labels must not be used instead of the proper PVI labels – always use correct workflow to avoid misuse.

Note: A separate barcode label is printed for International Mail.



Domestic Express Mail



International Express Mail

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-10.

PVI BARCODE LABEL

5-digit ZIP barcode. To be affixed on domestic parcels, Small parcels and Rolls (SPRs), and Irregular Parcels and Pieces (IPP). Also acceptable on letters.

First-Class Mail Parcel



Parcel Post Parcel



Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-11.

PVI LABEL ALPHA-F

To be affixed on all domestic First-Class Mail flats.



Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-12.

DESTINATION ZIP LABEL ALPHA-Z

5-digit ZIP barcode label with no postage value. Must be used for domestic parcels and SPR (Small Parcels and Rolls/IPP) that are presented for mailing with postage already affixed.

First-Class Mail parcel with postage affixed



Parcel Post parcel with postage affixed





First-Class Mail parcel with Extra Service (Delivery Confirmation)

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-13.

DESTINATION LABEL
ALPHA-F / ALPHA-Z (Zero Label)

May be used for flats with postage already affixed which are NOT sent Priority Mail Express , Registered Mail, or Certified Mail (Affix no label on these flats).

Note: Used for a Flat with no postage required.



Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 32-14.

Summary

The use of retail equipment allows sales and services associates to handle customer business with greater efficiency. Using retail equipment provides sales and services associates with many benefits such as being able to perform multiple customer transactions keeping a running total of the amount due, automatically calculating the amount of change due the customer and performing standardized transactions.

Employees must be aware of safety precautions and follow established safety procedures when using retail equipment.

PVI is the acronym for Postage Validation Imprinter. The office you are assigned to may use the PVI to print postage. We call the postage PVI labels.

Several types of labels are available for use including Test Labels, PVI Labels, PVI Barcode Labels, ALPHA-F, Destination, ALPHA-Z and Destination ALPHA-F / ALPHA-Z.

Module 33: Accountability

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify the required accountability activities that are the responsibility of a sales and services associates
- Identify the necessary forms used for recording and tracking cash, stamps, accountable paper and other assets
- Apply standard procedures for accountability in the Retail unit

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group discussion

Summary:

- Unit Accountabilities

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- Ace Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation

Unit Accountabilities

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-3 and refer participants to page 33-3.Review the Unit Accountability information with participants.

Depending on how your unit is set up, accountable paper will be handled/issued as either Individual Accountability or Segmented Inventory Accountability (SIA):

Individual Accountability – A unit where each sales and services associates have stamp stock assigned to him/her, and is accountable for any losses.

Segmented Inventory Accountability – A unit in where the manager in charge of the unit reserve is financially accountable for stamp stock/products until it is requisitioned by sales and services associates. This eliminates individual accountability for SSAs working from the retail floor stock.

Sales and services associates, however, continue to be responsible for the protection and accurate recording of each transaction and remittance of funds from daily business.

Individual Accountability

Postmasters, managers, or supervisors are responsible for management of all stamp stock credits and cash credits assigned and must ensure the timely performance of all credit counts. Additionally, they are responsible for establishing and maintaining a file for each credit (stamp or cash) assigned to an employee.

All employees with consigned credits are accountable for the value of their assigned stamp stock, cash, and money orders.

A stamp credit is the value of the stamp stock and money orders consigned to a sales and services associates from the unit reserve stock at a postal retail unit (PRU).

In order to maintain individual accountability, SSAs must not trade or purchase stamp stock from one another. In an emergency, a supervisor may authorize sales and services associates to ship or receive stock from another SSA as long as a PS Form 17, *Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return* is filled out and submitted.

Stamp returns are completed in duplicate. Enter customer name, SSA, and the amount of stamp stock issued on PS Form 17.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-5.

Types of Consignment Accountabilities

- Stamp Credit – stamps and cash. The cash credit must not exceed $100.
- Cash Credit – Cash only, must not exceed $100.

Unit Stamp Stock Reserve – stamps only. The Unit Stamp Stock Reserve Custodian (URC) is accountable for the unit stamp stock reserve. The URC consigns and replenishes stamp to SSAs and the retail floor stock.

Unit Reserve Stock Assignment

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-6.

The unit reserve stock custodian is accountable for the value of all items in the unit reserve stock custodian is responsible for managing the stamp stock inventory, and must report unit reserve stock activities. Sales from the unit reserve stock are not allowed. The unit reserve may be assigned to the postmaster, unit manager, or supervisor. At a finance station without a domiciled supervisor, a lead sales and services associate (LSSA) may be assigned the unit reserve. The LSSA may also be assigned a separate stamp and/or cash credit from which direct sales to the public are conducted.

The unit reserve stock custodian maintains and secures all accountable papers for the unit in compliance with the levels authorized for the various stamp credits or segments. The unit reserve stock custodian issues stamp stock directly to sales and services associates who are assigned stamp credits.

Segmented Inventory Accountability (SIA)

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-7.

Each unit must maintain a unit reserve stock and may have a number of different segments.

Sales and services associates who work at a retail window do not have a stamp stock inventory assigned and instead work from a shared retail floor stock.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-8.

An SSA that works from the retail floor stock is authorized a cash retained credit of up to $100, for which they are individually accountable. They must report this cash retained in AIC 753 on their daily PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report*. Other segments may require stamp stock inventory assigned as individual accountability for which they are directly accountable.

Maintaining Segment Accountability

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-9. Refer participants to page 33-5.

The total of all stamp stock is posted in AIC 852, *Total Stamp Sales* and AIC 853, *Stamp Accountability Closing Balance*, which are on the POS system-generated PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report*.

The Point of Service (POS) Clerk Balance List identifies the balance of each segment's stock. This report will always include a unit reserve, a retail floor stock, and may include other segments such as mobile unit, philatelic, or stamps by mail.

The total value of stock computed on the "Clerk Balance List" must always equal the unit's total reported in AIC 853 on the unit's PS Form 1412. On the POS system-generated PS Form 1412, the total of all cash retained or reserves is posted in AIC 753. This is defined on the Clerk Balance List by listing the unit cash reserves plus the various assigned SSA's cash retained credits.

Retail Floor Stock

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-10.

Under the retail floor stock SIA concept, cash is separated from stamp stock in retail credits and a shared retail floor stock replaces individual stamp credits for sales and services associates.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-11.

Summary

Sales and services associates will continue to be responsible for the protection and accurate recording of each transaction and remittance of funds during their daily business.

Module 34: Establishing a Stamp Credit

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify stamp stock credits and explain the financial responsibility associated with them
- Explain the procedures for establishing a stamp stock credit
- Identify and describe the procedures for examination of stamp stock credits
- Explain the procedures for handling count results
- Explain the procedure to replenish a credit
- Explain the security procedures of credits
- Be aware of the proper procedures for handling cash

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 hour

Instructional Methods:

- Discussion
- Presentation

Summary:

- Establishing a Stamp Stock Credit
- Protecting the Stamp Credit

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip Chart
- PS Form 17, *Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return*
- PS Form 3294, *Cash and Stamp Stock Count and Summary*

- PS Form 3294-C *Cash Credit Count and Summary (POS ONE and Postal Stores Only*)
- PS Form 3369, *Consigned Credit Receipt*
- PS Form 3220, *Claim for Stamped Envelope Discount*
- PS Form 3977, *Duplicate Key, Combination, and Password Envelope*

Establishing a Stamp Stock Credit

Introduction

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 34-3. Refer participants to page 34-3.

The amount of a stamp credit you will be issued is determined by the demand of the customers in your office and the amount of time you will spend at the retail counter. There are 2 types of credits, stamp stock or cash credits. The type of credit you will receive is dependent on the unit to which you will be assigned.

Facilitator: Explain the difference between the two types of credits, and how in an office with Segmented Inventory Accountability (SIA) the SSA will be assigned cash credit rather than a stamp stock credit. Refer to Handbook F101 – *Field Accounting Procedures*.

Identify Stamp Stock Credits

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-4.

A stamp stock credit is the set amount of stamp stock consigned to you. Stamp stock credits can consist of accountable paper stock, cash, and money orders that may be sold to customers.

Facilitator: Provide each participant with a PS Form 3220, *Claim for Stamped Envelope Discount*, review the form, and walk through procedures for completing PS Form 3220 with participants.

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Claim for Stamped Envelope Discount

Employee Name	Clerk ID No.	Unit Name	Unit ID No.	Begin Date	End Date

Date Sold	Purchaser	No. of Boxes of 500			
		# 6 ¾ Regular	# 10 Regular	# 6 ¾ Window	# 10 Window
	Total Boxes Sold				
	Discount Per Box*				
	Totals *(Multiply no. of boxes sold by discount per box)*	*a.* $	*b.* $	*c.* $	*d.* $

*To calculate discount, multiply envelope cost X 500, and subtract discounted price found in DMM R000.1.0.

Verified By *(Supervisor)*	Date Entered to AIC 846 or 534	Total Discount Claimed *(Total a thru d)*

PS Form **3220,** October 1996 *(Previous editions unusable)*

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-5.

Stamp stock credits for Sales and Service Associates consist of the following accountable paper items:

- Postage stamps (including definitive, special, commemoratives)
- Plain stamped envelopes and stamped cards
- International Reply Coupons (IRC) a sender of a letter may prepay a reply by purchasing IRCs. When a customer brings in a coupon from another country it is exchanged for the stamp equivalent of current rate per coupon regardless of the country where purchased.

Facilitator: Participants should write the amount of postage on the coupon in the amount that was exchanged.

- Non-postal stamps:
  - Migratory bird hunting stamps
- Semi-Postal Stamps (ASM 13 – 646)
  - Breast Cancer Stamp
- Philatelic product examples:
  - Mint sets
  - Postal Service Guide to US Stamps
- Money Orders
  - Domestic Money Orders
  - International Money Orders
  - Bait Money Orders

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-6.

Types of Unit Accountabilities

Depending on how your unit is set up accountable paper will be handled/issued as either Individual Accountability or Segmented Inventory Accountability (SIA):

Individual Accountability – A unit where each sales and services associate has a stamp stock assigned to him/her, and is accountable for any losses.

Segmented Inventory Accountability – A unit in which the manager in charge of the unit reserve is financially accountable for stamp stock/products until it is requisitioned by the sales and services associate. This eliminates individual accountability for associates working from the retail floor stock. The sales and services associate continue to be responsible for the protection and accurate recording of each transaction and remittance of funds from daily business.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-7 and refer participants to page 34-6.

Establishing a stamp stock credit

Facilitator: Review PS Form 3369, *Consigned Credit Receipt* with participants. Explain the purpose of this form, and the proper completion.

The amount of a stamp stock credit you will be issued is determined by the demand of the customers in your office, and the amount of time you will spend at the retail counter. The credit is established for the total value of your stamp stock accountability, including the maximum amount of change funds, which you may retain at the end of the tour**.**

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-8.

Replenish a stamp stock credit

Facilitator: Review PS Form 17, *Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return* and discuss proper completion of this form.

The stamp stock is replenished on an as needed basis or on a schedule set by your office that is usually weekly. Stamp stock is ordered using PS Form 17.

When stamp stock is given to the sales and services associate, it must be verified by counting and listing each item on the back of the PS Form 17. Once this is done, the sales and services associate will sign PS Form 17 accepting stock.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-9.

Examination of stamp stock credits

Facilitator: Review PS Form 3294, *Cash and Stamp Stock Count and Summary,* and discuss proper completion of this form.

Individual Accountability counts must be performed at least once every 4 months. Independent counts must be done by the sales and service associate and immediate supervisor. **The cash portion of the sales and services associate's accountability should be $100.00 or 10% of the credit, whichever is less.**

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Cash and Stamp Stock Count and Summary

Type of Accountability ☐ Unit Reserve Stamp Stock ☐ Unit Cash Reserve ☐ Stamp Stock Credit

Name of Employee	Clerk ID No.	Unit Name	Unit ID No.	Date of Examination

Unit Reserve Stamp Stock Count Summary

Stamp Stock per PS Form 3958		☐ AIC 057, Employee Stock Credit Overage ☐ AIC 767, Employee Stock Credit Shortage ☐ PS Form 571, *Discrepancy of $100 or More in Financial Responsibility* ☐ PS Form 3368, *Stamp Credit Examination Record*
Stamp Stock on Hand per Count		
Difference ☐ Over ☐ Short		

Unit Cash Reserve Count Summary

Unit Cash per AIC 753		☐ AIC 068, Employee Cash Credit Overage ☐ AIC 764, Employee Cash Credit Shortage ☐ PS Form 571, *Discrepancy of $100 or More in Financial Responsibility* ☐ PS Form 3368, *Stamp Credit Examination Record*
Cash on Hand per Count (from worksheet)		
Difference ☐ Over ☐ Short		

Cash/Stamp Stock Credit Count Summary

Summary of Accountability

		Action Taken
1. Total Cash as counted (from worksheet)	$	
2. Total Stamp Stock as counted (page 2)	$	☐ Within Tolerance ☐ AIC 057, Employee Stock Credit Overage ☐ AIC 767, Employee Stock Credit Shortage ☐ PS Form 571, *Discrepancy of $100 or More in Financial Responsibility* ☐ PS Form 3368, *Stamp Credit Examination Record*
3. Grand Total Cash and Stamp Stock as Counted (Line 1 + Line 2)	$	
4. Stamp Credit as reported in AIC 853 (from last PS Form 1412)	$	
5. Difference (Line 4 - Line 3)	$	

Verification of Money Orders

Domestic	Are they issued in sequence?	☐ Yes	☐ No
Bait	Are they in good condition?	☐ Yes	☐ No
International	Are they issued in sequence?	☐ Yes	☐ No
Last Issued Domestic MO	MO Serial number:		
Last Issued International	MO Serial number:		

Money Orders on Hand: (List block numbers of all money orders)

Notes, etc.:

Worksheet for Unit Cash Reserve Count or Cash/Stamp Stock Credit Count

Denomination	Quantity	Amount
$ 100.00		$
$ 50.00		$
$ 20.00		$
$ 10.00		$
$ 5.00		$
$ 2.00		$
$ 1.00		$
$ 0.50		$
$ 0.25		$
$ 0.10		$
$ 0.05		$
$ 0.01		$
Total Cash		$

I have examined this stamp credit:

(Print Name of Supervisor)

(Signature of Supervisor) *(Postmark)*

I agree to the count:

(Print Name of Employee)

(Signature of Employee) *(Postmark)*

REMINDER: Is the Semi-Annual Examination of PS Form 3977 or the Annual Examination of Keys and Locks due? Use PS Form 3902, *Form 3977 Log and Lock Examination,* to maintain a record of the examinations.

PS Form **3294**, November 2010 *(Page 1 of 2)*

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Cash and Stamp Stock Count and Summary

Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value
Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value
Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value
Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value
Item #	Priority	Item #	Express	Item #	Booklet	Item #	Booklet	Item #	Booklet	Item #	Booklet
Item #	IRC	Item #	Bird	Item #	Booklet	Item #	Booklet	Item #	Booklet	Item #	Booklet
Item #	Postcard	Item #	FC Envelope	Item #	FC Envelope Box	Item #	Coil	Item #	Coil	Item #	Coil
Item #	Coil	Item #	Coil	Item #	Sheet	Item #	Sheet	Item #	Sheet	Item #	Sheet

FC Rate				FC Rate			
Item #	Count			Item #	Count		
			$				

Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value
Item #	Value	Item #	Value	Item #	Value

Redeemed Stock

Item Description	Item #	Price	Quantity	Amount
		$		$ -
		$		$ -
		$		$ -
		$		$ -
		$		$ -
		$		$ -
		$		$ -
		$		$ -
Total Redeemed				$
Sub-Total Stamp Stock				$
Total Stamp Stock				$

PS Form **3294**, November 2010 *(Page 2 of 2)*

Establishing a Cash Credit

Facilitator: Review PS Form 3369, *Consigned Credit Receipt* to each participant. Explain the purpose of this form, and the proper completion.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Consigned Credit Receipt

Name	Location of Credit		
(Check One) ☐ Stamp Credit ☐ Cash Credit	Credit Amount		
	Maximum Authorized Cash		
Issued by *(Signature)*		Date	

I will faithfully account to the U.S. Postal Service for the consigned credit amount shown above or modified by transactions recorded on my Daily Financial Reports. I have read the following statements and have been advised of the priorities of protection to be given to funds and accountable paper in Chapter 3 of Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures*. Employees and contractors will be held responsible for losses of stamps and funds from stamp or cash credits resulting from failure to give the best available protection during and after business hours. Withdrawals of official funds for personal use, whether temporary or permanent, may subject employees or contractors to removal from office, cancellation of contract, and criminal prosecution

Signature	Date

PS Form **3369**, August 2010

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Consigned Credit Receipt

Name	Location of Credit		
(Check One) ☐ Stamp Credit ☐ Cash Credit	Credit Amount		
	Maximum Authorized Cash		
Issued by *(Signature)*		Date	

I will faithfully account to the U.S. Postal Service for the consigned credit amount shown above or modified by transactions recorded on my Daily Financial Reports. I have read the following statements and have been advised of the priorities of protection to be given to funds and accountable paper in Chapter 3 of Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures*. Employees and contractors will be held responsible for losses of stamps and funds from stamp or cash credits resulting from failure to give the best available protection during and after business hours. Withdrawals of official funds for personal use, whether temporary or permanent, may subject employees or contractors to removal from office, cancellation of contract, and criminal prosecution

Signature	Date

PS Form **3369**, August 2010

A $100.00 cash credit is issued to sales and services associates in Segmented Inventory Accountability (SIA) offices. The credit is established for the total value of your cash credit, including the maximum amount of change funds, which you may retain at the end of the tour.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-10. Refer participants to page 34-10.

Replenishing stock in an Segmented Inventory Accountability (SIA) office

Facilitator: Review PS Form 17, *Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return* and point out unique procedures that apply to a Segmented Inventory Accountability (SIA) office.

The stamp stock is replenished on an as-needed basis. Stamp stock is ordered using PS Form 17.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return

Location ID *(10-digit unit finance #)* of shipping unit	Name of Postal Retail Unit			Postmark
_ _ _ _ _ _ - _ _ _ _				
Telephone No.	City	State	5-Digit ZIP Code™	
Signature of Submitter	Required for all Stock Shipped or Returned			
	Location ID *(10-digit unit finance #)* of receiving unit _ _ _ _ _ _ - _ _ _ _			Date
Signature of Shipper	Registry Number Used		Shipment # *(10-digit)*	
Signature of Witness	**Stamp Requistion** - Prepare in duplicate. Submit ORIGINAL and keep a COPY at the unit. Print clearly all information. **Stamp Return to SDO/SSC -** Prepare four copies, ORIGINAL in an envelope taped to the outside of package, two COPIES inside, and keep a COPY at the unit. **Ship to Other Locations -** Prepare in duplicate, submit ORIGINAL inside of package to receiving unit, and keep a COPY at the unit. Use the location ID *(10-digit unit finance #)* of receiving unit.			

Type: *(Check One)* ☐ Scheduled Order ☐ Emergency Order ☐ Return Stock ☐ Return for Destruction ☐ Ship to Other Location

Do Not Substitute	Item No.	Quantity	Redemption Rate (Destruction)	Dollar Value	Denomination	Description
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
☐						
				Total Value	Signature of Person Receiving Stock	
				$	Signature of Witness	

Section to Be Completed by Stamp Destruction Committee

Method of Disposition	Value *(In words)* **(SDO/SSC USE ONLY CORRECTED VALUE)**

Certificate of Destruction Committee

We certify that the stock value (in words) was verified.

Member of Committee and Title

Member of Committee and Title

Member of Committee and Title

Postmark

Date

Each member witnessed the disposal of the stock by the method specified above.

Member of Committee and Title

Member of Committee and Title

Member of Committee and Title

Postmark

Date

PS Form **17,** May 2007 (PSN 7530-03-000-9112)

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-11.

Examination of cash credits

Facilitator: Review PS Form 3294-C, *Cash Credit Count and Summary (POS ONE),* and discuss proper completion of this form.

Segmented Inventory Accountability counts must be performed at least once every Postal Quarter (3 months). Independent counts must be done by the Sales and Service Associate and their immediate supervisor.

Count results

Facilitator: Provide participants with the definition of tolerance (the amount plus or minus a clerk is allowed to be off in their credit without requiring any action to be taken).

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-12.

The tolerance of a cash/stamp credit is based upon the amount entered on the sales and services associate's PS Form 3369, *Consigned Credit Report* or closing balance of the PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report*. In SIA offices sales and services associates who are assigned a cash credit have a tolerance of $10.00.

When an out of tolerance overage occurs, the full amount of overage must be placed into Account Identifier Code (AIC) 057 for Stamp Stock Credits or AIC 068 for Cash Credits.

When an out of tolerance shortage occurs, the full amount of shortage must be placed into AIC 767 for Stamp Stock Credits or AIC 764 for Cash Credits. If the amount of the shortage is out of tolerance, a letter of demand must be issued to the employee for the full amount of the shortage.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*

RECEIPTS

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053	
Express Mail Advance Deposits		055	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage - (SPORT Offices - Amount must = AIC 650)		057	
Customer Permit Account Advance Deposits		070	
Special Provisions Locally Managed Accounts Advance Deposits		074	
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007	
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011	
Forever Stamp Sales - Vending		012	
Forever Stamp Sales - SPORT Offices		097	
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084	
Postage Stock Sales		090	
Bird Stamp Sales		091	
Philatelic Product Sales		092	
Packaging Product Sales		093	
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094	
Vending Equipment Postage Sales		096	
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100	
	Fee	101	
International Money Order Sales	Value	102	
	Fee	103	
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110	
Postage Due Invoices		114	
12 - Month PO Box Rent and Caller Service Fees		115	
6 - Month PO Box Rent and Caller Service Fees		158	
Lobby Services Revenue		123	
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		126	
Vending Machine Overage - (Amount must = AIC 699)		175	
Freedom of Information Fees		198	
Official Licensed Retail Products		231	
Financial Differences Overage		247	
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280	
Stamp Stock Shortage Offset - (Amount must = AIC 849)		299	
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367	
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report		**353**	
Cash Required		400	

STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840	
Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841	
Stock Adjustment Overage (Amount must = AIC 650 or 699)	(+)	843	
Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844	
Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846	
Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848	
Stock Adjustment Shortage (Amount must = AIC 299)	(-)	849	
Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850	
Total Sales *(007-014, 084-089, 090-092, 094-097)*		852	
Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853	

DISBURSEMENTS

Description	AIC	$ Amount
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits Withdrawal	453	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawal	457	
Customer Permit Account Withdrawal	470	
Special Provisions Locally Managed Customer Accounts Withdrawal	474	
Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips	526	
Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees	528	
Refund of Fees - Retail Services	535	
Refund - Postage and Fees	553	
Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order	586	
Vending Machine Shortages - (Amount must = AIC 299)	612	
Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	624	
Financial Differences Shortage	647	
Stock Examination Overage - (SPORT Offices - Amount must = AIC 843)	650	
Refund - Express Mail	676	
Stamp Stock Overage Offset - (Amount must = AIC 843)	699	
Employee Stamp Credit Shortage	767	
Cash Remitted Advance	751	
Cash Remitted Final	752	
Credit Cards Remitted	762	
Debit Cards Remitted	772	
Cash Retained Today	**753**	
Cash Accounted For	800	

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412**, March 2007 PSN 7530-07-000-5259

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-13.

Security procedures for credits

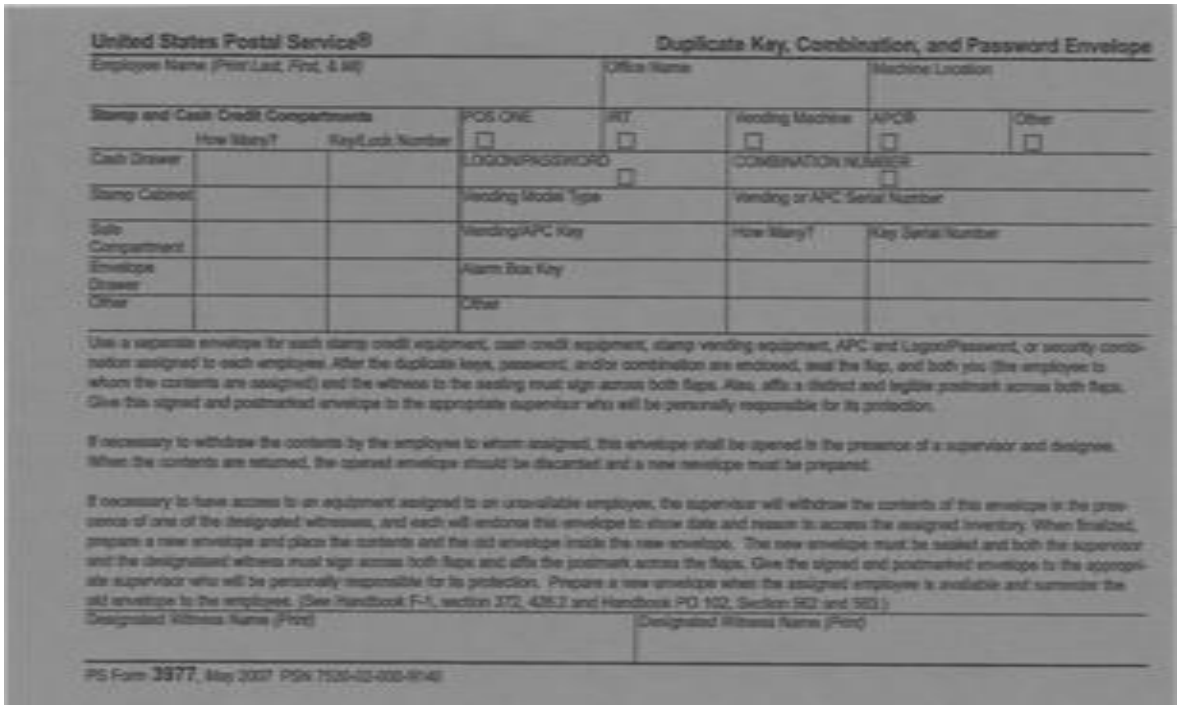
Equipment assigned to be used to protect stock or funds (i.e., locked containers or vaults) must be examined by the supervisor and the employee to determine that it provides proper safekeeping.

The SSA must inform the supervisor is they notice that the container is not secure. If a container is not secure, the supervisor must report it and secure the stock until the proper equipment is received. Any sign of wear, tear, or damage should be reported to your immediate supervisor.

It is your responsibility to make sure accountable paper is locked in a container and stored in a security container, safe or vault, following the end of your tour of duty.

- Credits must be placed in a locked container and stored in a security container, safe, or vault, following the end of your tour of duty.
- No one should have access to the credit of another employee.
- You must be present whenever your credit is examined. If you are not available, there must be a witness of your choice present. You must submit to the manager/postmaster two names of employees you select to represent you in your absence. The names are entered on PS Form 3977, *Duplicate Key, Combination, and Password Envelope*.

  Facilitator: Show the PS Form 3977, *Duplicate Key, Combination, and Password Envelope*.



United States Postal Service® — **Duplicate Key, Combination, and Password Envelope**

Employee Name (Print Last, First, & MI)			Office Name		Machine Location	
Stamp and Cash Credit Compartments		POS ONE ☐	AIT ☐	Vending Machine ☐	APC® ☐	Other ☐
	How Many?	Key/Lock Number				
Cash Drawer			LOGON/PASSWORD ☐		COMBINATION NUMBER ☐	
Stamp Cabinet			Vending Model Type		Vending or APC Serial Number	
Safe Compartment			Vending/APC Key		How Many?	Key Serial Number
Envelope Drawer			Alarm Box Key			
Other			Other			

Use a separate envelope for each stamp credit equipment, cash credit equipment, stamp vending equipment, APC and Logon/Password, or security combination assigned to each employee. After the duplicate keys, password, and/or combination are enclosed, seal the flap, and both you (the employee to whom the contents are assigned) and the witness to the sealing must sign across both flaps. Also, affix a distinct and legible postmark across both flaps. Give this signed and postmarked envelope to the appropriate supervisor who will be personally responsible for its protection.

If necessary to withdraw the contents by the employee to whom assigned, this envelope shall be opened in the presence of a supervisor and designee. When the contents are returned, the opened envelope should be discarded and a new envelope must be prepared.

If necessary to have access to an equipment assigned to an unavailable employee, the supervisor will withdraw the contents of this envelope in the presence of one of the designated witnesses, and each will endorse this envelope to show date and reason to access the assigned inventory. When finalized, prepare a new envelope and place the contents and the old envelope inside the new envelope. The new envelope must be sealed and both the supervisor and the designated witness must sign across both flaps and affix the postmark across the flaps. Give the signed and postmarked envelope to the appropriate supervisor who will be personally responsible for its protection. Prepare a new envelope when the assigned employee is available and surrender the old envelope to the employee. (See Handbook F-1, section 372, 426.2 and Handbook PO 102, Section 962 and 963.)

Designated Witness Name (Print)	Designated Witness Name (Print)

PS Form **3977**, May 2007 PSN 7530-02-000-9140

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-14 and refer participants to page 34-14.

Levels of Security

Ensure that the descending levels of security in your installation are followed.

Level	Equipment
1	Burglar-resistant chests in fireproof safes or security containers located in walk-in vaults.
2	USPS standard vaults or security containers.
3	Security chests or burglar-resistant chest portion of fireproof safes.
4	Fireproof safes or vaults not built to USPS standards.
5	Lockable metal cabinets and file drawers.

Handbook F-1

Facilitator: Refer participants to Handbook F-1, 2-5.2.2.

Protecting the Stamp Credit

Priorities of Protection

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-15. Refer participants to page 33-14.

Certain items must be given priority of protection over others, and postmasters are responsible for making sure that the protective equipment is on hand for providing maximum security. The following are priorities of protection:

Priority	Item
1	Postal funds
2	Postage stamps, aerogrammes, international reply coupons, migratory-bird hunting and conservation stamps (bird stamps), philatelic and blank money order forms.
3	Stamped envelopes and postal cards, money order imprinters, non-saleable stamp stock, and non-postal items.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 33-16.

Summary

The Postal Service is a business and as any other business, must protect its assets, such as cash on hand and stamp inventory.

Security and accountability of stamp stock and cash credits are an important part of the sales and services associates' role.

Keeping track of and securing those assets protects you and the Postal Service from loss and theft.

Module 35: Daily Financial Report

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Explain how to complete a preliminary and final PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report.*
- Describe procedures to remit advance and final deposits
- Identify and describe accountability and security measures for close-out procedures

Time Allocated for Module:

- 20 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Presentation
- Exercises

Summary:

- PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report*

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip Chart
- PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report*

PS Form 1412, Daily Financial Report

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slides 35-3, refer participants to page 35-3, and review applicable sections of PS Form 1412, Daily Financial Report.

Sales and services associates handle many financial transactions. It is vital to handle all financial transactions accurately, and report them properly.

PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report* is designed to provide a running record of receipt controls, stamp accountability, and cash retained. This form is completed everyday you conduct business at the retail counter.

During this session, we will discuss how to close out financial transactions using PS Form 1412. A supervisor or their designee will keep the copy.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 35-4.

Preparing for Close Out

The very first step in preparing to close-out is to gather and group all materials related to the day's financial transactions. You should divide money into groups of cash, checks, and money orders; then group supporting documents according to the type of transactions.

Note: The POS system provides messaging during the close unit workflow to assist the closeout employee with the proper procedures for closing the unit, verifying the PS Form 1412, preparing and submitting the bank deposit, and completing all of the supporting documentation that accompanies it. (Refer to the most recent version of the POS ONE Procedures Guide available on the POS ONE website.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 35-5.

Touring PS Form 1412

The PS Form 1412 is divided into the following sections:

- Stamp Accountability (this tracks accountability from opening to closing)
- Receipts (Items that represent money going into the till)
- Disbursements (Items that represent money coming out of the till)
- Unit ID section
- Initial section

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 35-6.

Account Identifier Codes (AICs)

Receipts	001 through 400
Disbursements	401 through 800
Stamp Accountability	840 through 853

Facilitator: Amounts reported in specific AICs flow to a corresponding General Ledger Accounts (GLA) in our accounting systems.

On the PS Form 1412 show where the Account Identifier Codes (AICs) are located. Explain the information on PS Form 1412 using the examples on the next 2 pages and review the form with participants. Describe briefly the items located in each part of the form.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Daily Financial Report

Unit or Individual Name

Unit Finance Number *(10-digit Unit Finance #)*

RECEIPTS

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Forever Stamp Sales - Retail Window		007	
Forever Stamp Sales - By Internet - Mail - Telephone		011	
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits		053	
Customs Collection		054	
Express Mail Advance Deposits		055	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage		057	
Customers Permit Account Advance Deposits		070	
Special Provisions Locally Managed Accounts Advance Deposits		074	
Species Conservation Semi-Postal Stamp		081	
Breast Cancer Research Stamp Sales		084	
Postage Stock Sales		090	
Bird Stamp Sales		091	
Philatelic Product Sales		092	
Packaging Product Sales		093	
Stamps by Mail - Internet - Telephone		094	
Domestic Money Order Sales	Value	100	
	Fee	101	
International Money Order Sales	Value	102	
	Fee	103	
Post Office Postage Meter Sales		110	
Additional Postage Revenue		112	
Postage Due Invoices		114	
12-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		115	
6-Month PO Box and Caller Service Fees		158	
3-Month PO Box Fees		203	
Lobby Services Revenue		123	
USPS Customs Fees and Storage Charges		148	
Freedom of Information Fees		198	
Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue		202	
Financial Differences Overage		247	
Disbursement Sent to ASC		280	
Stamp Credit Shortage Cleared		367	
Cash Retained on Hand From Previous Report		**353**	
Cash Required		400	

STAMP ACCOUNTABILITY

Description		AIC	$ Amount
Opening Balance - Stamp Accountability		840	
Stamp Stock Received	(+)	841	
Stock Increase - Revaluation	(+)	844	
Stamped Envelope Discount	(-)	846	
Stamp Stock Returned	(-)	848	
Stock Decrease - Revaluation	(-)	850	
Total Sales (007-013, 081-092, 094)		852	
Closing Balance Stamp Accountability		853	

DISBURSEMENTS

Description	AIC	$ Amount
Business Reply Mail/Postage Due Advance Deposits Withdrawal	453	
Employee Stamp Credit Overage Withdrawal	457	
Customer Permit Account Withdrawal	470	
Special Provisions Locally Managed Customer Accounts Withdrawal	474	
Refund - Spoiled/Unused Customer Meter Strips	526	
Refund - Permit, Postage, and Fees	528	
Refund of Fees - Retail Services	535	
Refund - Postage and Fees	553	
Fee Offset - No Fee Money Order	586	
Refund - Miscellaneous Nonpostal Revenue	624	
Financial Differences Shortage	647	
Refund - Express Mail	676	
Employee Stamp Credit Shortage	767	
Employee Receivables (PS Form 1902)	636	
Cash Remitted Advance	751	
Cash Remitted Final	752	
Credit Cards Remitted	762	
Debit Cards Remitted	772	
Cash Retained Today	**753**	
Cash Accounted For	800	

I certify that this is a true statement and the accountability consigned to me is as shown on this form:

Signature | Date

PS Form **1412,** December 2011 PSN 7530-07-000-5259

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 35-7 and 35-8. Refer participants to page 35-5.

Read the section below to review the parts of the 1412.

As a review, let's go over what you have learned about the parts of the PS Form 1412:

- **The unit name, finance number and unit ID go on the top of the form.**
- **There are three major sections on the PS Form 1412: receipts, stamp accountability, and disbursements.**
- **The Receipts section (left side of the form) is used to record summary amounts, by Account Identifier Code (AIC), of different postal products and services for that business day and revenue received.**
- **The right side of the PS Form 1412 has 2 sections:**
  - **Stamp Accountability –The amount of stamps and money a Sales and Services Associate has at the beginning and end of the day.**
  - **Disbursements—Items for which money was paid out.**
- **The signature of the preparer and date of business goes on the bottom of the form. The PS Form 1412 should be completed in pencil, signatures and dates should be completed in ink.**

Facilitator: Have the participants complete their first manual 1412 with the following information. Explain the procedures for computing postage sales by copying the totals from the support documents to the corresponding AICs on the PS Form 1412 for business on a typical transaction day.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 35-9.

Opening Balance	(AIC 840)	$1,000.00
Cash Remitted Final	(AIC 752)	$74.00

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 35-10.

Enter the totals from support documents in the corresponding Disbursement AICs. Add down the Disbursement Column (AIC 453 through 753) and enter the total in AIC 800.

Carry the AIC 800 total over and enter the same amount in AIC 400.

Enter the totals from support documents in the corresponding Receipt AICs. Add the receipt column (AIC053-353). Write that subtotal on the back of the form. Subtract it from the AIC400 entry.

The result is the entry in AIC 090 (Postage Stamp Sales).When that is entered, the receipt section and the disbursement section totals are equal. These must always be equal: AIC400 and AIC800 must always be the same.

On retail equipment, the entry of all postage sales must be done at the time of sale and a receipt given to the customer. Only with a manual PS Form 1412 will you calculate AIC 090 Postage Stamp Sales at the end of the day.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 35-11.

Summary

PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report* provides a running record of receipt controls, stamp accountability, and cash retained. This form is completed everyday you conduct business at the retail counter. PS Form 1412 must be prepared in duplicate.

First step in preparing closeout is to gather and group all materials related to the day's financial transactions.

PS Form 1412 is divided into: Unit ID section, Receipts, Stamp Accountability, and Disbursements.

Record amounts collected for sales of postal products and services provided for that business day, each in their corresponding Account Identifier Code (AIC) in the Receipts section.

Signature of the preparer and date of business goes on bottom of form. Use an ink pen for completion of the PS Form 1412 with signatures and dates.

Module 36: Acceptable Payment Methods

Objectives:

Upon the completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Define the various credit/debit cards that are accepted
- Discuss acceptable purchases with credit/debit cards
- Describe the components of credit/debit card sales
- Explain the features of the Cash Back option
- Explain other acceptable payment methods
- Explain the procedure for handling suspected counterfeit currency
- Explain check cashing policies

Time Allocated for Module:

- 1 hour

Instructional Methods:

- Discussion
- Lecture

Summary:

- Acceptable Payment Methods

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- Handbook F-1 Post Office Accounting Procedures
- PUB-348, Window Service Crime Prevention Booklet
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- ACE Computer

Acceptable Payment Methods

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-3. Refer participants to page 36-3.

The Postal Service accepts a wide range of payment forms at local post offices and retail counters including cash, debit/credit cards, personal/business checks, travelers' checks, money orders, cashiers checks, and certified checks.

Acceptable Purchases with a Credit Card

Under our credit/debit card program, all postal products and services can be purchased by credit card, with the following exceptions:

- Trust fund deposits (including, but not limited to USPS Corporate Accounts, permit imprints, business reply/postage due, periodicals)
- Pre-cancelled stamps
- Money Orders
- COD funds, Money by wire (principle and fees)
- Employee debts
- Passport fees remitted to the Department of State

Credit Cards Accepted by the USPS

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-4.

Currently, the cards accepted by the USPS are VISA, MasterCard, American Express, Discover, Japan Credit Bureau (JCB), Diners Club/Carte Blanche.

Facilitator: You cannot use a credit card for Every Door Delivery Mail

Debit Cards Accepted by the USPS

All debit card networks are currently accepted.

Facilitator: You cannot receive reimbursement from a debit card at the time of transaction. A PS Form 3533 must be accomplished to provide reimbursement to the customer.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-5.

Verification of a credit card sale

When a customer hands you a credit card, you must verify that there is a signature in the signature block, on the back of the card. If there is no signature, do not accept the card. Request another card or suggest another payment option. In accordance with the national credit card policy, customer signatures are required on credit cards in order for SSAs to accept as a form of payment.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-6 and refer participants to page 36-4.

Acceptable Purchases with a Debit Card

Under the credit/debit card program, all postal products and services can be purchased by a customer using their debit card except Passport fees remitted to the Department of State.

Note: Debit card purchase can not be immediately reversed.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-7.

The Cash Back Option

The Cash Back Option offers retail customers the opportunity to receive up to $50 cash back, in increments of $10 when they choose a debit card as their choice of payment. Cash back will only be offered if the SSA has cash available. There is no minimum purchase amount and there is no limit to the number of times a customer can request cash back during one 24-hour period. However, each cash back request must be limited by a separate purchase and paid for with an online debit card. An online debit card requires a customer to enter a PIN. Customers must enter their PIN in order to receive cash back. Cash retained limits must not be increased to accommodate customers requesting cash back.

SSAs should follow all the steps listed for a successful debit card sale.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-8 and have participants access F-101, Field Accounting Procedures, Section 9, Cash Management.

Examples of Acceptable Payment Methods are:

- Cash
- Debit/credit
- Personal/Business Checks
- Travelers Checks (at least 50% of the face value) for purchases
- Postal/Non-Postal Money Order
- Cashier's Checks
- Certified Checks
- Treasury Checks

Check Acceptance

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-9 and review national and local check acceptance policy, including acceptable forms of identification.

Note: Local policies may have stricter guidelines.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-10.

Procedures for Handling Cash

When making change, you must follow Postal regulations that require each unit of money (dollars, quarters, pennies, etc.) to be counted out to the customer. When returning change, you may (1) count back change from the smallest coin up to the tendered amount, or (2) count out the change indicated on the retail equipment display, from the largest bill to the smallest coin. Either way is correct. The important thing is that every coin and bill be counted out to the customer. Additionally, emphasize advance deposits and closeouts should not be left unattended. Advance deposits must be remitted before excessive cash builds up in a SSA's drawer. Additionally, each and every customer MUST be given a receipt at the end of the transaction.

Facilitator: Emphasize policy for securing funds while in SSA's custody. Clerks are prohibited from counting the advance clerk cash deposit at the window (in the screen line).

Counterfeit Currency

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-11 and review Publication 348, Windows Services Crime Prevention Booklet.

Counterfeiting larger denomination of US currency bills is an increasing problem. The best method is to compare suspect bills with a genuine bill. If you are suspicious of a bill, notify your supervisor.

Facilitator: perform the following exercises:

Customer pays for a book of stamps with a $50.00 bill. Have participants count back the change to the customer.

Customer pays for postage and mailing transaction that totals $32.29. Customer tenders $40.50. The postal equipment display indicates $8.21 change is due the customer. Have participants count out the change.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 36-12.

Summary

The Postal Service accepts a wide range of payment forms at local post offices and retail counters including cash, debit/credit cards, personal/business checks, travelers' checks, money orders, cashier's checks, and certified checks.

Currently, the credit cards accepted by the USPS are VISA, MasterCard, American Express, Discover, Japan Credit Bureau (JCB), Diners Club/Carte Blanche. All debit cards are currently accepted as forms of payment.

All Postal products and services can be purchased by credit card, except Trust Fund deposits, pre-cancelled stamps, money orders, COD funds, money-by-wire, Every Door Direct Mail-Retail, employee debts and Passport fees remitted to the Department of State.

National credit card policy requires that all cards must be signed by customers. Cards are not valid unless signed. When a customer hands you the card, you must verify that there is a signature in the signature block, on the backside of the card.

The Cash Back Option offers retail customers an opportunity to receive up to $50 cash back during debit card purchases.

When making change, the important thing is that every coin and bill be counted back to the customer. Each customer must be given a receipt at the end of the transaction.

Counterfeiting larger denomination of US currency bills is an increasing problem. The best method to prevent receipt of counterfeit currency is to compare suspect bills with a genuine bill. If you are suspicious of a bill, notify your supervisor.

Module 37: Credit Card Compliance

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Explain the format of payment cards
- Identify the payment information that must be protected
- Describe the significance of the payment information
- Discuss the risks of exposure of payment card information
- Apply the procedures for accepting payment cards

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Group Discussion

Summary:

- Credit Card Compliance/ Security Awareness

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation

Credit Card Compliance/Security Awareness

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-3. Refer participants to page 37-3.

The use of payment cards to purchase Postal products and services is convenient for the customer and allows them to make purchases electronically.

This service provides the Postal Service a competitive advantage and meets customer service expectations by processing electronic payment card transactions securely and efficiently.

This ability also supports the Postal Service's "Green Initiative" by initiating a paperless transaction.

Payment Card Industry (PCI) Data Security Standards (DSS) strive to create a level of protection for card issuers by ensuring that merchants meet minimum levels of security when they store, process and transmit cardholder data.

PCI DSS requirements mandate annual security awareness training for organizations accepting payment cards for purchase of goods and services. Documentation of annual training completion, including dates and signatures, or electronic confirmation in a Learning Management System is also required.

This training is required for any employee that processes or handles credit card information, especially:

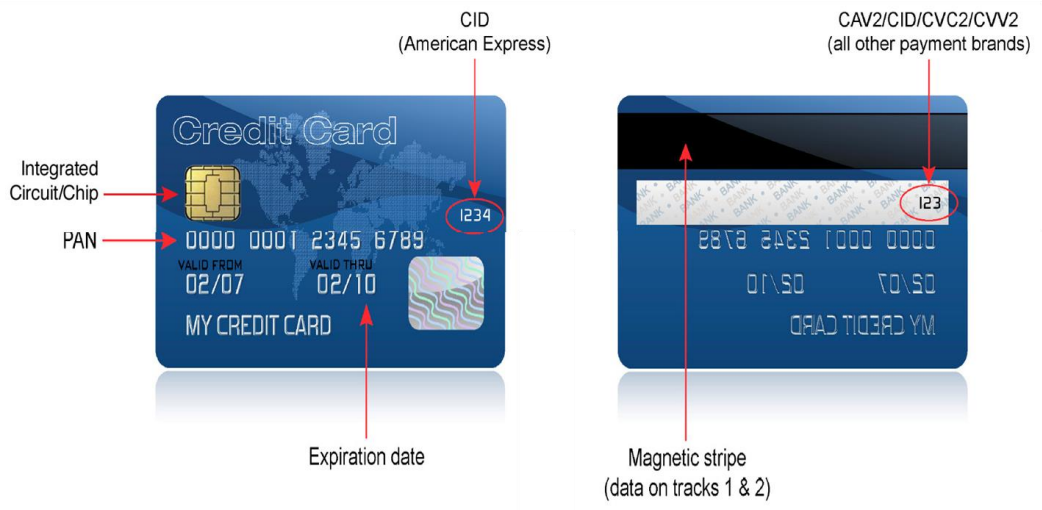
- Sales and services associates and supervisors
- Special event sales and services associates and supervisors
- Call Center associates and supervisors (as appropriate)

Facilitator: Lead a discussion on the need for security awareness when processing payment cards.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-4 and refer participants to page 37-4.

Payment Card Format

The magnetic strip on the back of the payment card contains detailed cardholder data.



Full track data from the magnetic strip includes:

- Cardholder Name
- Primary Account Number (PAN)
- Service Code
- Expiration Date

All of this data is considered cardholder data. This data may be stored, but PAN data is required to be encrypted.

None of the data that is considered Sensitive Authentication Data can be stored, per PCI DSS requirement 3.2. This data includes:

- Full Magnetic Stripe Data
- CVV2/CVC2/CAV2/CID (Card Verification Validation or Card ID)
- PIN/PIN Block (Personal Identification Number)

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-5.

Payment Card Information to Protect

It is very important that we protect the privacy of our customers. This involves taking steps to keep the payment card information secure for those customers presenting the cards for payment of products and services.

Ensure that the following information is protected:

- Cardholder Name
- Primary Account Number (PAN) [Full card number]
- Expiration Date
- CVV2 Data – used for Card Not Present Transactions and located on back of card
- Magnetic Strip – contains all information on payment card

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-6.

Significance of Payment Card Information

Data contained on payment cards is required to process and complete payment transactions. The public expects that merchants and financial institutions will protect payment card data to thwart data theft and prevent unauthorized use.

Information that is targeted for theft includes:

- The Primary Account Number (PAN) contains all of the digits of the primary account number and is required to process a transaction.
- The Expiration Date is necessary for the transaction to process and be completed.
- CVV2 contains additional authentication that is required for Card Not Present transactions.

Illegal Methods to Collect Payment Card Data

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-7.

Criminals posing as repair personnel may install a skimmer device inside existing terminals or replace the entire card reader unit to capture an image of the card. This can happen at any retail sales outlet, including gas stations. Skimming devices hidden within the terminal are invisible, and neither the merchant staff nor the cardholder will know that a card was skimmed.



Another method to obtain payment card data is to take a photo of a payment card, using a cell phone, while standing behind the customer being served. Criminals can observe and memorize the Primary Account Number (PAN) and expiration date on the face of the card, if they are allowed to be close to the customer.

Call centers are on high alert for thieves copying payment card information on a separate sheet of paper.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-8 and refer participants to page 37-7.

Risks of Exposure

Once the payment card information is obtained, it may result in:

- The impersonation of authentic cardholder
- Fraudulent use of the stolen card
- Creation of duplicate card, based on obtained payment card information
- Chargeback costs to Postal Service

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-9. Refer participants to page 37-8.

Procedures for Processing Payment Card Transactions

The Postal Service accepts the following credit cards for the purchase of most Postal Service products and services:

- Diners Club
- American Express
- Visa
- MasterCard
- Discover/Novus
- Japan Credit Bureau (JCB)

All credit cards must be signed. When handling the credit card, ensure that the credit card information on the card is protected from view by other customers. Follow all other established card acceptance and authorization procedures when completing the transaction.

Report any suspicious behavior to your supervisor. You may have to request individuals in line to stand behind the line to ensure the privacy of the customer being served.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-10.

Credit cards are not accepted for:

- Purchase of Money Orders
- Trust Fund Deposits
- Permit Imprint Deposits
- Purchase of Pre-Canceled Stamps
- Periodicals Postage
- Postage Meter Setting
- Money-By-Wire
- Employee Debt Reconciliation
- Cash on Deliver (COD) Funds
- Bulk Mailings

Procedures for Processing Debit Card Transactions

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-11.

Most debit cards and electronic benefit transfer (EBT) cards are accepted for all Postal Service products and services. Follow the Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) for processing Debit cards.

Signatures are not required on debit cards used with a personal identification number (PIN). Ensure that the customer has privacy when entering their PIN. Contact your manager or station supervisor for annual updates.

Procedures for Processing Open Loop Gift Cards

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-12.

Open Loop Gift Cards are pre-paid gift cards that have the American Express, Discover, MasterCard, or Visa logo on the front of the card.

Open Loop Gift Cards can be processed by any merchant who accepts these credit cards.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 37-13.

Summary

Our customers trust us to protect their payment card information when they use them to purchase Postal products and services. It is your responsibility to preserve this public trust.

Ensure that you follow all standard operating procedures when accepting payment cards and report any suspicious activity to your supervisor or Postmaster.

Module 38: Money Orders

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Identify and describe the features and benefits of Money Orders
- Describe the types of Money Orders
- Define the components of the Bank Secrecy Act
- Explain the procedures for inquiry of a lost or stolen Money Order
- Explain the procedures for cashing a Money Order
- Explain the Bait Money Order Program
- Explain Sure Money® (Dinero Seguro®)

Time Allocated for Module:

- 2 hours

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Demonstration
- Question/Answer
- Role Play

Summary:

- Money Orders
- Bank Secrecy Act
- Sure Money®

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- PowerPoint presentation
- Projector
- Rip chart
-

- PS Forms 8105-A, 8105-B, 6401
- Domestic Mail Manual (DMM)
- International Mail Manual (IMM)
- Postal Bulletin
- Notice 299, *US Postal Money Order reference card*

Money Orders

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-3. Refer participants to page 38-3.

Postal Money Orders are a safe, convenient, and economical alternative to sending cash through the mail. They can be purchased from any Post Office in the United States as well as from any rural route carrier.

Features and Benefits of Money Orders

- Can be purchased with cash, debit card, or traveler's check
- Can be cashed at any Post Office provided that sufficient funds are on hand and most financial institutions
- Can be replaced if lost, stolen, or damaged (for a fee).
- No expiration dates on Money Orders

Types of Money Orders

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-4 and discuss each type of Money Order using a sample, if available.

The Postal Service issues 2 types of Money Orders:

Domestic Service (Green) – available to all 50 states, U.S. territories and possessions, APO/FPO addresses (from domestic customers), and to U.S. embassies in foreign countries. Currently the maximum amount for a domestic Money Order is $1,000.00 with a two-tier fee for each Money Order.

Direct Service (Pink)(United States International Money Order) - International service Money Order for countries that accept the pink MP-1. The maximum amount for an International Money Order is determined by each country (refer to the IMM – never more than $700.00 US). This service is available to transfer funds to individuals or firms in countries that have entered into agreements with the USPS for the exchange of postal Money Orders. This list of countries can be found at: https://www.usps.com/shop/money-orders.htm, *Domestic & International Money Orders.*

Inquiry of a Lost or Stolen Money Order

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-5 and display an example of PS Form 6401, Money Order Inquiry.

The PS Form 6401, *Money Order Inquiry,* is the form to use for an inquiry regarding a Domestic Money Order (United States Postal Money Order), as well as filing inquiries or replacement requests of an International Money Order (Direct Service). This form is also used for the Direct Service (United States International Money Order) in countries where this service is permitted. If customers need a replacement Money Order, or proof that a Money Order was cashed, including a photocopy, they should use this form. There is a fee to use this form (see current rate chart). The customer should complete the form and return it to the sales and services associate for processing.

Bait Money Order Program

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-6.

Bait Money Orders are used to aid the Postal Inspection Service in Postal burglary and robbery investigations. Once a Bait Money Order is cashed and recovered, numerous investigative leads can be pursued which may identify and lead to prompt apprehension of the suspect.

Each sales and services associate will receive three Bait Money Orders and these Bait Money Orders are accountable. Place and store the Bait Money Orders under the largest currency denomination compartment in your till drawer.

Procedures for Cashing Money Orders

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-7 and refer participants to page 38-4.

Use the Postal Bulletin and the IMM while discussing the cashing of Money Orders. Pass out copies of Notice 299 (available from Topeka MDC) for review and discussion.

Customers can cash Domestic and authorized International Money Orders at post offices. Domestic Money Orders do not have an expiration date. To cash a Money Order, do the following:

- Look for the security features: When held to the light, a watermark of Benjamin Franklin is repeated from top to bottom on the left side. When held to the light, a dark line (security thread) runs from top to bottom with the word "USPS" repeated. There should be no discoloration around the dollar amounts (which might indicate the amounts were changed). Warning instructions are listed on the reverse side of the Money Order.
- Denominations for domestic Money Orders must not exceed $1,000, and International Money Orders must not exceed $700.
- Check the Missing, Lost, or Stolen U.S. Money Order List from the current Postal Bulletin or on www.usps.com.
- If no security features are evident or if the Money Order is on the Missing, Lost, or Stolen List, ask the customer to wait and speak to your supervisor. Your supervisor will contact the local Inspection Service office.
- Current government-issued or state-issued picture identification is required to cash a postal money order.
- Ensure that the money order is properly endorsed as required.

Facilitator: Distribute PS Forms 8105-A and 8105-B. Discuss both of these forms with participants.

Bank Secrecy Act

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-8 and Refer participants to page 38-5 and show slide 38-9.

Let's discuss a very important responsibility that we have because we sell financial products like money orders, wire transfers, and stored value cards (like gift cards). Because we sell these financial instruments, we must stay in compliance with laws and regulations that help prevent the crimes of money laundering and terrorist financing.

The most relevant of these regulations is called the Bank Secrecy Act or B-S-A. We use the term BSA whenever we are talking about these compliance tasks.

You should have already seen the four LMS Modules covering BSA. We're going to review the key points in all of those modules now because your role in helping the Postal Service stay in compliance is very important.

You may already be familiar with money laundering from TV, movies and the news, but I want to repeat the example of money laundering so that you remember exactly how criminals attempt to use our products.

Let's say a drug dealer sells some illegal drugs for a large amount of cash. It's hard to transport large amounts of cash out of the country, deposit them into a bank, or use it for purchases without arousing suspicion. So the dealer wants to get "clean" money by laundering it through other financial transactions.

Buying and selling postal money orders is one way of doing that. By buying financial instruments like money orders, the criminal takes the "dirty" cash, gives it to the Postal Service and gets legitimate money orders in return. These money orders are easier to transport, issued by a legitimate business, and have no link to the original crime. This is what we are trying to prevent.

While drugs, prostitution and other street crimes are typical reasons people try to launder money it is also involved in financing terrorism like the 9/11 attacks. It is often a way some people try to hide money in order to prevent paying taxes.

As Retail Associates you have two basic BSA responsibilities.

- The first is to report all purchases of postal financial instruments that total three thousand dollars or more per customer per day or the cashing of money orders and/or U.S. Treasury Checks for more than ten thousand dollars per customer per day. You do this using Postal Form 8105-A, also called a Funds Transaction Report or FTR.
- The second is to report suspicious transactions. A suspicious transaction is one where you think there is an attempt to launder money. It usually involves techniques criminals use to avoid reporting the transaction on an 8105-A. You do this using a Postal Form 8105-B, also called a Suspicious Transaction Report or STR. Both these forms are available online if you are using a POS machine or on paper if you are not.

Facilitator: Conduct a question and answer session using the questions below: (make certain you let the students know they are not expected to know all the answers).

1. **Question:** What does BSA stand for?

   Answer: Bank Secrecy Act

2. **Question:** What are the two activities we must report?

Answer: Purchases of postal financial instruments totaling $3,000 or more per day or the cashing of money orders or U.S. Treasury Checks for more than $10,000 and the reporting of suspicious transactions.

3. **Question from the LMS training:** What is the Federal Agency that oversees our BSA compliance?

   Answer: FinCEN – The Financial Crime Enforcement Network

Not filling out these forms for every applicable transaction is not an option. Remember this, as Retail Associates, there may be times when you have many customers waiting in line. While we focus on providing the best customer service possible, we still must complete these tasks, especially the 8105-A-form and here's why.

The Postal Service is required by law to submit these reports. And the spotlight is really on us because we are the only organization specified by name in the Bank Secrecy Act. If we don't, we can receive hefty fines of 25 thousand dollars per incident per day.

Also, individuals, at any level of the organization, who purposely do not fulfill or prevent the fulfillment of these responsibilities, could be held criminally liable.

We work very hard to stay in compliance because if we are fined we lose more than money. We lose the trust of the public; we lose our reputation and we lose the historic legacy of the Postal Service. That will damage our organization far more than any fine, no matter how large. So you see how important it is to us. Also, we do it because it is the right thing to do.

Facilitator: Conduct a question and answer session using the questions below:

1. **Question:** Besides large fines, what other consequences would not complying with BSA have for the Postal Service?

   Answer: Hurt our reputation and legacy and cause the public to lose trust in us.

Facilitator: Provide the following interesting fact.

The slang term for money launderers is Smurfs (However, don't automatically assume that all small little blue people in line are money launderers). The term "Smurf" does come from the famous cartoon characters. The term was first used by an IRS Special Agent in Miami who described a group of money-launderers going from bank to bank as a group of little Smurfs. The term caught on and has become common in the anti-money laundering and law enforcement communities. (Note to Instructor: This is the real story. The BSA team met the retired Special Agent and has independent verification that this version is the real deal.)

PS Form 8105-A, *Funds Transaction Report*

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-11 and refer participants to page 38-6.

Let's review the key information about the 8105-A form.

Collect customer information for transactions of three thousand dollars or more for:

- Money orders
- A combination of money orders and other financial services
- A number of transactions by the same customer on the same day at the same or different post offices if you are aware of the activity.

Have the customer fill out a paper 8105-A form and provide it to you. Even if you are filling it out online, this will make it easier for you because all of the information will be on the form.

If you are working in a POS office, you will transfer this to the online form. After you enter the necessary data in the POS system, give the paper form back to the customer.

The customer can use the same form for future transactions, but remember you will have to verify the customer's government issued identification every time an 8105-A form is required.

If you are working in a non-POS office, you will take the paper form from the customer and submit it to the address printed on the front of the form.

Paper forms must be submitted the same day the transaction occurs. Make sure that all mandatory fields are complete.

The information you need is:

- Last Name and First Name
- Address including City, State and ZIP (If you are using POS, the ZIP code will automatically populate the city and state)
- Country
- Date of Birth
- Social Security Number/ Employee Identification Number /Tax Identification Number or Alien Registration number or Passport number from any country. If the customer is using a passport, you also must include the country that issued the passport on the 8105-A form.

• Occupation

Optional information to collect is the customer's Telephone Number. Be sure to include the area code.

A quick word about Occupation: Collecting this information for all 8105-A-forms is a relatively new requirement that was implemented in 2013. Before it was only collected for transactions of more than ten thousand dollars.

The paper forms are being updated and currently state that occupation is required for transactions over ten thousand dollars, but it is very important that you collect this information on all 8105-A forms. Collecting the information from the customer is step one.

Step two is looking at an acceptable government-issued photo ID to verify the customer's identity. Acceptable forms of identification are any official federal, state or local government issued IDs.

Mexican Matricula Consular cards and Visa Border Crossing IDs also are valid forms of identification. Make sure the ID is current and that the picture matches the customer.

Remember, EVERY purchase of postal financial instruments for the same customer on the same day, of three thousand dollars or more requires an 8105-A form. The law also requires us to obtain the same information for customers cashing over $10,000 in financial instruments including Treasury Checks by the same customer in the same day.

Facilitator: Facilitate a question and answer session using the questions below.

1, Question: Is there a situation when a Retail Associate should not file an 8105-A form for the purchase of postal financial instruments totaling $3,000 or more?

Answer: No, there isn't one. Retail Associates must always collect the data required for an 8105-A form whenever a customer purchases money orders, gift cards, or wire transfers totaling $3,000 or more per day. The same information must be collected when a customer cashes money orders or U.S. Treasury Checks totaling more than $10,000 in a single day.

2. Question: Is a Chinese Passport an acceptable form of identification?

Answer: Yes.

3. Question: If an ID has expired one day before the transaction, is it still an acceptable form of identification?

Answer: No

4. **Question from LMS training:** Can an 8105-A form be filled out in Spanish at Post Offices in the southwest or in major cities?

Answer: No, all 8105-A forms must be filled out in English.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-14 and 38-15 and conduct the following activity:

Distribute PS Form 8105-A to each student. <STOP> When you are certain each student has a form, tell the class they will now become customers.

Have participants complete section I on the PS Form 8105-A using their personal information. For their social security number, use 999-99-9999. (This is for training purposes only). Social security numbers are always comprised of only 9 numbers – no more, no less.

<STOP> Ensure that all participants have completed Section 1.

Have each participant exchange forms with another participant and complete Section III as a USPS employee using the following scenario.

Scenario: The customer purchased postal money orders totaling $3,500. The serial numbers are 0658987256 through 0658987259.

<STOP>Allow the student's time to complete. After they indicate they have finished explain each line on the form, step by step.

Ask the class how many students checked their neighbor's identification. Remind them that this is a requirement that is not optional.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-16.

PS Form 8105-B, *Suspicious Transaction Report*

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-17 and refer participants to page 38-9.

Let's talk about suspicious transactions and the 8105-B form. Reporting a suspicious transaction requires more of a judgment call by the Retail Associate. This is why knowing about typical suspicious transactions is so important.

Let's review typical suspicious transactions.

- Two or more customers working together
- Customers coming in regularly and buying money orders just under the $3,000 reporting limit
- Customers asking for smaller amount when they learned they'd have to fill out an 8105-A-form
- Customers who tried to change their appearance or go to different Retail Associates to hide transactions amounting to $3,000 or more.
- Regular customer(s) who suddenly have a large amount of cash to spend on money orders.

Facilitator: Facilitate a question and answer session using the questions below.

1. **Question:** If you see five people come into the Post Office together and one person in the groups hands cash to each of the others and they all buy money orders under the reporting limit, should you allow them to complete the transaction.

   Answer: Yes, but you should work with your fellow Retail Associates to fill out a Suspicious Transaction Report and not let any of those customers think you find their transactions suspicious.

There may be other transactions that seem out of the ordinary and you determine are suspicious. However, remember that you have to be able to describe what made the transaction suspicious on the 8105-B-form. So focus on the transaction, not the customer. A rude or oddly dressed customer doesn't make their transactions necessarily suspicious.

Facilitator: Provide to the participant the following comments and continue to the question and answer session using the questions below.

NEVER – let me repeat – NEVER let a customer know that you are reporting or considering reporting his or her transaction as suspicious. It is against the law. Also, NEVER leave the safety of the window to collect information on the customer. Your personal safety is more important.

2. **Question:** If a customer wearing motor cycle leathers buys $1,200 in money orders and you never see that customer again, is that a suspicious transaction?

   Answer: No. It wasn't a suspicious transaction and it shouldn't be suspicious just because of the way the customer was dressed.

3. **Question from the LMS training:** Is it OK to finish filling out an 8105-B form at the end of your shift?

   `Answer: Yes, because sometimes you need to add a written explanation from notes you took at the time of the transaction. If you are filling out extra comments at the end of your shift, you will need to submit them on a paper 8105-B form. These forms must be submitted to the address on the front of the form the same day the transaction was performed.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-18.

4.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-19.

Divide participants into pairs. <STOP> Using one PS Form 8105-B for each pair, complete the form using the following scenario. Remember, only one form is required. It should contain the consolidated information from both sales and services associates.

***Scenario*: All of you are sales and services associates. It is 10:00 A.M. You observe two male customers, approximately 20 years old, talking as they enter the lobby. These same two customers have been coming in every day and purchasing money orders for the past several weeks.**

One customer asks for $5,000 in money orders, but changes his mind when you advise him to complete PS Form 8105-A; he purchases $2800 in money orders from you, serial numbers 0658987256 thru 260.

The other customer purchases $2800 from another sales and services associate, serial numbers 0658885335 thru 339.

You also notice that they leave the premises in a Lexus, with license plate 'smurfin'. They mailed a Priority Mail Express package (ER 795958902US) to Super Smurf, 1254 Money laundering Street, New York, NY 10013.

When the pairs have indicated completion, thoroughly discuss as a group each line of the completed PS Form 8105-B. When discussing the written comments, remind students that:

- **if customer is unknown it is possible that the return address may be fictitious – this is why this is placed at the bottom of the comment section**
- **information that is known to be true should be placed in the fields provided above the comments**

Responsibilities

If you have a question about BSA responsibilities ask your manager or send an email to: bsa@usps.gov

Also, more information and BSA news is available on the BSA website on Blue:

blue.usps.gov/corptreasury/bsa/bsa_home.htm

Remember, anytime a form is not submitted, the postal service is not in compliance with the Bank Secrecy Act.

Watch the Postal Bulletin for important BSA updates! Remember, our BSA responsibilities not only keep the Postal Service in compliance with the law, it also protects our legacy and our customer's trust. On top of that it's the right thing to do.

Facilitator: Conduct a question and answer session using the questions below:

International Wire Transfer (Sure Money)

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-21. Refer participants to page 38-13.

Sure Money® (Dinero Seguro®) is a money-by-wire transfer service and an extension of the Postal Service traditional money order service. Sure Money® currently moves money from the United States to other select countries. It does so more safely than other means, and in a matter of minutes rather than days. Sure Money® is Dinero Seguro® in Spanish. All Bank Secrecy Act rules and policies will apply.

You should treat Sure Money® like any other financial transaction as far as anti-money laundering is concerned. When reporting transactions of $2,000 or more, the system prompts you for certain identifying information when you enter these transactions. You must make sure your customer provides the necessary identifying information or the system will not allow the transaction to proceed.

Facilitator: Dinero Seguro/Sure Money has a $2000 daily remittance maximum. These transactions are linked across the POS system for ease of tracking.

Remember, the BSA compliance rules are the same for Sure Money as for Postal Money Orders. Following are some BSA compliance questions to refresh your memory.

Conduct a question and answer session using the questions below:

1. **Question**: What can be used in the place of a social security number?

   Answer: Employee Identification Number/Tax Identification Number or Alien Registration number or Passport number from any country. If the customer is using a passport, you also must include the country that issued the passport on the 8105-A form.

2.

2. **Question**: For transactions of $750 or more, what verification is required?

   Answer: Photo ID

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-22.

The law requires you to verify the identity of customers by examining the photograph on the identification presented and ensuring that the person making the transaction resembles the person on the photograph. Upon entering the identification number into the transaction record, you will be required to answer "YES" to the question "Did you verify the customer's identity by examining the picture in the Photo ID?"

1. **Question**: Identifying information must be entered into the Sure Money® transaction record. What does the identifying information include?

   Answer:

   - Sender's name
   - Recipient's name and address
   - The sender's social security number
   - Date of birth
   - Photo identification

5.**Question:** What types of identification can be accepted when purchasing Sure Money® transactions?

Answer: Only Federal or State government-issued photo identifications are accepted. Examples are:

Acceptable forms of identification are any official federal, state or local government issued IDs. Mexican Matricula Consular cards and Visa Border Crossing IDs also are valid forms of identification. Make sure the ID is current and that the picture matches the customer.

•

6.**Question**: Is a PS Form 8105-A required if a customer purchases a Sure Money® transaction for $600 and $2,500 in money orders or stored value cards?

Answer: Yes

7.**Question:** Is a PS Form 8105-A required if a customer purchases a Sure Money® transaction for $1,800 for themselves?

Answer: No. When you enter the required information into the transaction record, it satisfies the PS Form 8105-A requirement.

Recap

No matter how tough it may seem, you must stay in compliance with the Bank Secrecy Act.

A man went to the local post office and approached his favorite sales and services associate. The man explained that he wanted to use cash to purchase $5,000 worth of money orders. He wanted to send the money orders to his daughter who was away at college for the purchase of a car. The sales and services associate would not process the transaction because the man refused to complete a PS Form 8105-A. The man became very angry and left. The associate complied with the Bank Secrecy Act as required by law even though he knew this was a legitimate transaction.

The man was his father.

Another unknown customer came to the same associate wanting to purchase $5,000 worth of money orders. The man acted suspiciously and refused to complete the PS Form 8105-A. He decided to purchase $2,900 in money orders instead. The sales and services associate acted appropriately by submitting a PS Form 8105-B after the customer left.

A PS Form 8105-A must be completed any time money order transactions total $3,000 or cashed money orders total more than $10,000 in a day, There are no exceptions.

A PS Form 8105-B must be completed any time you suspect criminal activity. It deters criminals from using our postal facilities for the purpose of money laundering and it is the law.

PS Forms 8105-A and B may not be altered, nor are you allowed to send them anywhere but the address listed on the most current version of the forms.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 38-23 and refer participants to page 38-15.

Role Play Exercises

Facilitator: Observe that the following criteria are met with each of the following scenarios. Ensure that you explain to the participant this is expected:

Are principles of GIST being used during the transaction?

Is the money order endorsed properly if it is being cashed?

Has the Postal Bulletin been checked for the lost or stolen money order list if being cashed?

Are proper procedures followed for cashing money orders?

- **Is PS Form 8105-A being used?**
- **Is PS Form 8105-B being used?**

Scenario #1

A customer asks the sales and services associate how to send money to Mexico.

Scenario #2

A customer requests Money Orders that total $3,500.00.

Scenario #3

A customer comes in and asks for a Money Order for $1,000.00.

Scenario #4

A customer wishes to purchase an International Money Order to send to Cuba.

Scenario #5

A customer comes to the retail unit with a $500.00 postal Money Order to cash.

Scenario #6

A customer asks to purchase Money Orders that total $4,000.00.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slides 38-24 and 38-25.

Summary

Postal Money Orders are a safe, convenient, and economical alternative to sending cash through the mail. They can be purchased from any post office in the United States as well as from any rural route carrier.

Money Orders can be purchased with cash, debit card, or traveler's check. Money Orders can be cashed at any Post Office and most financial institutions. Money Orders can be replaced if lost, stolen, or damaged (for a fee).

The Postal Service issues two types of Money Orders, Domestic service and Direct Service.

The PS Form 6401, *Money Order Inquiry*, is the form to use for an inquiry regarding a Domestic Money Order (United States Postal Money Order), as well as filing inquiries or replacement requests of an International Money Order (Direct Service).

Bait Money Orders are used to aid the Postal Inspection Service in Postal burglary and robbery investigations.

Each sales and services associate will receive three Bait Money Orders and these Bait Money Orders are accountable. Place and store the Bait Money Orders under the largest currency denomination compartment in your till drawer.

The USPS sells over $29 billion worth of money orders, stored value cards and fund transfers. This, unfortunately, gives criminals an opportunity to use our services for illegal purposes.

Only through strict compliance with the law can we have a real impact on reducing this crime in our post offices and making our workplace even safer for our employees and customers.

Sure Money® (Dinero Seguro®) is a money-by-wire transfer service and an extension of the Postal Service traditional money order service. Sure Money® transfers money from the United States to other select countries safely, and in a matter of minutes.. Sure Money® is Dinero Seguro® in Spanish. All Bank Secrecy Act rules and policies will apply.

Module 39: Security and Sanctity of the Mail

Objectives:

Upon completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Describe the sales and services associate's role as part of the public trust vested in each postal employee
- Describe unacceptable conduct involving security and sanctity of the mail
- Describe the consequences of failing to uphold the security and sanctity of the mails
- Explain sales and services associate's responsibility with Customs Border Protection Manifest
- Identify the references for employee responsibilities with regard to security and sanctity of the mail

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Presentation
- Discussion
- Question/Answer

Summary:

- Security and Sanctity of the Mail
- Customs Border Protection Manifest (CBPMAN)

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- PowerPoint presentation
- Projector
- Rip chart
- Markers

- Pen and pencils
- "*A Matter of Integrity*", obtained from the Materials Distribution Center, PSIN: DVD-64-23C, Description: 41520-00: Video, *A Matter of Integrity*. PSN: 6910-04-000-8580

Security and Sanctity of the Mail

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-3. Refer participants to page 39-3.

The Postal Service must preserve and protect the security and sanctity of the mail in its custody from unauthorized opening, inspection, reading of contents or covers, tampering, delay or other unauthorized act.

Postal Service employees are mandated by federal law to preserve and protect all mail placed in our custody.

Any postal employee committing or allowing any of these unauthorized acts is subject to administrative discipline or criminal prosecution leading to fine, imprisonment, or both.

Postal Service employees operate under a mandate to preserve and protect the mail placed in their custody. Ensuring security and sanctity of the mail is a public trust vested in each Postal Service employee.

The Postal Service is committed to keeping the mail safe and moving.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-4.

The contents and/or information contained in any mailpiece in the mailstream must be protected. If a SSA has questions pertaining to mail security/sanctity issues, they should refer their questions/concerns to their supervisor, or postmaster. Each employee has a responsibility to report any information they may have of any theft, pilferage, unlawful delay of mail, or evidence of intent on the part of individuals to commit such crimes to their supervisor or to a Postal Inspector .

Maintaining the Security and Sanctity of the Mail

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-5.

Maintaining the security and sanctity of the mail is one of the core responsibilities entrusted to the Postal Service and all of its employees.

It is important for both the Postal Service and our customers because it:

- Helps to instill customer confidence in Postal Service employees and the Postal Service
- Assists in projecting a positive public image for the Postal Service
- Assists the Postal Service in maintaining a competitive advantage
- Protects the privacy of our customers

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-6.

Successful efforts to protect and maintaining the sanctity of the mail result in:

- Fewer customer complaints
- Fewer insurance claims
- Fewer disciplinary actions
- Fewer criminal prosecutions
- Fewer customers going over to the competition
- Growth in the Postal Service's customer base
- Increased revenue generation
- Greater customer satisfaction

Unacceptable Practices

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-7 and refer participants to page 39-4.

All Postal Service employees must be alert for signs of problems or possible criminal activities directed at violating the security and sanctity of the mail.

The following are examples of issues related to security and sanctity of the mail:

Theft - Taking something that does not belong to you (i.e., taking excess merchandise samples or undeliverable publications for personal use). Theft also includes removing merchandise, money, or coupons from undeliverable bulk business mail. Employees are not permitted to take excess merchandise samples, or undeliverable publications for personal or postal use. Theft of mail can lead to disciplinary actions or criminal prosecutions.

Destruction or damage of mail -Deliberately damaging or losing of mail (i.e., discarding or defacing deliverable mail, allowing the mail to remain unprotected from theft and/or inclement weather). Destruction or damage of mail by Postal Service employees is also unacceptable. Postal Service employees are not permitted to deliberately damage or lose mail. Policies, procedures, and guidelines have been established to address the deliberate damaging or loss of mail. When employees allow this to occur they violate the trust the public has placed in them. When violations of this trust occur, sanctions involving the disciplinary process up to and including removal from the Postal Service are imposed.

Delay of mail - Improperly detaining or deliberately failing to deliver mail in accordance with the service standards prescribed for each class of mail amounts to delay in delivery of mail.

Opening - With few exceptions, no one, except those employed by the Postal Service for that purpose, may break or permit the breaking of the seals of any class mail matter without a federal search warrant, even though it may contain criminal or otherwise non-mailable matter, or would furnish evidence of the commission of a crime. Any postal employee committing or allowing any of these unauthorized acts is subject to administrative discipline and/or criminal prosecution.

Any postal employee committing or allowing any of these unauthorized acts is subject to administrative discipline or criminal prosecution leading to fine, imprisonment, or both.

References for employee responsibilities appear in various handbooks and manuals: Administrative Support Manual (ASM), Section 274 and Postal Operations Manual (POM), subchapter 691 specifically detail mail security.

Penalties

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-8. Refer participants to page 39-5.

Various federal laws provide for criminal penalties for the theft, delay in delivery, desertion, destruction, or obstruction of U.S. Mail. Some of the laws enforced can be found in Title 18 of the U.S. Code.

Section	Offense	Penalty
1700	Desertion of mail	Violators are fined or imprisoned not more than one year, or both
1701	Obstruction of mail	Violators are fined or imprisoned not more than six months or both
1702	Obstruction of correspondence	Violators are fined or imprisoned not more than five years, or both
1703	Delay or destruction of mail	Violators are fined or imprisoned not more than one year, or both
1709	Theft or receipt of stolen mail generally	Violators are fined or imprisoned not more than five years, or both

Public Trust

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-9.

In 2011 for the seventh consecutive year the Postal Service was rated as the number one agency Americans trust to protect their privacy, according to a national study conducted by the Ponemon Institute. And it is the job of the U.S. Postal Inspection Service to maintain America's confidence in the mail by protecting the Postal Service, securing the nation's mail system, and ensuring public trust in the mail.

Facilitator Note: Show slide 10 and play the "A Matter of Integrity" video for the participants.

U.S. Postal Inspection Service

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-11.

Congress empowered the U.S. Postal Inspection Service to investigate postal offenses and postal-related civil matters. Through its security and law enforcement functions, the USPIS provides assurance to postal customers of the sanctity of the seal in transmitting correspondence and messages.

As the primary law enforcement arm of the Postal Service, the USPIS is a highly specialized, professional organization performing investigative and security functions essential to a sound and stable postal system. Postal Inspectors are federal law enforcement officers who enforce federal statutes related to mail security, which includes the desertion, obstruction, delay or destruction of mail. Many of the laws enforced by Postal Inspectors are found in Title 18 of the U.S. Code.

Call Postal Inspectors at 1-877-876-2455 to report all postal crime; including criminal acts against postal employees, customers, and contractors who deliver mail.

Customs Border Protection Manifest (CBPMAN)

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-12. Refer participants to page 39-7.

The Postal Accountability and Enhancement Act (PAEA) passed in December 2006 requires that the United States Postal Service (USPS) comply with Customs procedures applied to similar shipments of private companies that are substantially owned and controlled by U.S. citizens. This implies that the USPS develop a method to electronically capture and save the Customs Declaration information required for all mailpieces with a destination address outside the United States. USPS is required to send this information electronically to the Customs and Border Protection (CBP) agency prior to the mailpiece leaving the United States.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-13.

The POS One Electronic Customs Data Capture solution was developed to capture this information as close to real time as possible in order to provide it to Customs and Border Protection in a timely manner. This solution supports those customers who have either completed a paper PS Form 2976-A and/or entered their information through the USPS website and presents the mailpiece to the retail window for mailing. The sales and services associate will process the form in accordance to provided standard operating procedures.

The Postal Service will be transmitting information previously handwritten on PS Form 2976-A, *Customs Declaration and Dispatch Note — CP 72*, to CBP by electronic data transfer. Sales and services associates will continue to file the manual copy of the PS Form 2976-A and maintain the copy for 30 days.

This means that if the customer fills out a PS Form 2976-A by hand, the information will need to be entered electronically when they bring their package to the post office.

The easiest way to expedite this process and fulfill the electronic data transfer requirement is for them to have completed the PS Form 2976-A online, print it and bring it with them to the post office.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-14.

They should be encouraged to use Click-N-Ship where they can enter their mailing information and purchase their postage. They should also be reminded of the discount.

The Customs and Border Protection (CBP) brochure Publication 613, "Shipping International Packages" is available for sales and services associates to give to customers who ship international packages. The brochures are designed to encourage customers to complete their PS Form 2976-A online.

Sales and services associates should:

- Perform acceptance scans on all Customs Forms received at retail.
- Distribute one Publication 612 "Sending an International Package" brochure to all customers who mail International packages that require a 2976-A.

Continue to encourage customers to complete their PS Form 2976-A online to meet Customs and Border Protection (CBP) requirements for electronic filing of Customs forms. Ensure that any customs forms which are bypassed at POS offices are reconciled either in POS or through the ACE computer on the same day.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 39-15.

Summary

Maintaining the sanctity and security of the mail is a core responsibility of the Postal Service and its employees. All Postal Service employees must, by law, protect mail in their custody from criminal misuse, which includes the opening or inspecting of mail, reading the contents of mail or mail covers, and tampering with mail, delaying delivery of mail, or similar unauthorized acts.

Any postal employee committing or allowing any of these unauthorized acts is subject to administrative discipline or criminal prosecution leading to fine, imprisonment, or both.

The mission of the USPIS is to protect the Postal Service, secure the nation's mail system, and ensure public trust in the mail. The mission of the Office of Inspector General is to investigate fraud, waste and abuse in the postal system.

Module 40: Policy and Security eLearning Review

Objective:

Instructor-led review of eLearning modules designed to clarify and or re-enforce content and concepts presented during the following eLearning training modules: Understanding the USPS, Growing the Business, Directives, HAZMAT, Anonymous Mail and Claims and Inquiries.

Time Allocated for Module:

- 30 Minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Discussion

Summary:

- Understanding the USPS
- Growing the Business
- Directives
- HAZMAT
- Anonymous Mail
- Domestic and International Claims

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- PowerPoint Presentation

Facilitator: This module is designed as a participant review activity to reinforce the product information presented in eLearning lessons.

There are three options to present this material:

1. **Utilize the PowerPoint presentation to support facilitation of the material.**
2. **Divide class into two groups. Each group formulates ten questions relating to topics within this module.**

   Formulated questions are posed alternately to the opposing group. The group collectively responds to the opponent's questions.

   Allow groups 10 minutes to formulate questions and 20 minutes for question and answer session. Groups are rewarded one point for each correct answer and the group with the highest score at the end of the activity is declared the winner.
3. **Divide the class into equal teams and utilize round three of the Quiz Bowl presentation to support facilitation of the material. Team with the most points at the end of all three rounds is declared the winner.**

Understanding the USPS

We process and deliver more than 212 billion pieces of mail; letters, cards, ads, bills, payments and packages; every year to more than 300 million people at 150 million homes, businesses and Post Office Boxes in every state, city and town, and in Puerto Rico, Guam, the American Virgin Islands and American Samoa.

The USPS handles 46 percent of the world's card and letter mail volume; delivering more mail to more addresses in a larger geographical area than any other post in the world.

The Postal Service does not receive tax dollars for operations and is the second largest employer in the United States today.

Ensuring Security and Sanctity of the Mail

Postal Service preserves and protects the security of mail in its custody from unauthorized opening, inspection, or reading of contents. This is a public trust vested in each Postal Service employee.

Failure to uphold the public trust vested in each Postal Service employee may cause removal from the Postal Service as well as criminal prosecution, resulting in fines and/or imprisonment.

Corporate Strategy

The USPS must operate as a much leaner, more efficient organization. To that end, the corporate strategy is to improve operational efficiency.

The plan is to reduce the cost of meeting universal service obligations by focusing on major cost drivers, especially delivery operations.

Standardization and innovation will be central to the Postal Service's cost reduction strategies.

The Postal Service, through transformation, will aggressively review and update its processes, establish new standards, train its employees on best practices, and manage challenging process management objectives.

24-Hour Clock

The 24-Hour Clock is an end-to-end process to ensure mail is collected, distributed and delivered. Each process indicator of the 24-Hour Clock has been identified as an essential ingredient to service performance.

Successful implementation of these processes will standardize operations and provide improved service to our customers. Effectively managing these processes will result in reduced costs and efficient operations.

The eight key indicators of the 24-Hour Clock are:

1. All carriers back by 1800 (6PM)
2. Cancel 80% of collection mail by 2000 (8PM)
3. Process outgoing primary-sort mail by 2300 (11PM)
4. Process outgoing secondary-sort mail by 2400 (midnight)
5. Clear MMP mail by 2400. Have zero MMP on hand at 2400 (midnight)
6. Assign commercial air/FedEx outgoing mail by 0230 (2:30AM)
7. Process all DPS 2nd-pass mail by 0700 (7AM)
8. Dispatch mail on time from plants to delivery units between the hours of 0400-0900 (4AM to 9AM)

The 24-Hour clock is a reminder to better manage time, move the mail, and provide customers with the service they expect. The 24-hour clock provides the field with key indicators that demonstrate operational affect on mailflow, ultimately influencing service.

Growing the Business

Businesses must be innovative and creative; continuously seeking new solutions, opportunities, and ways to grow the business. Customer loyalty is a key component to success and all employees, regardless of position, can contribute to that success.

The most successful and respected organizations today are bolstering customer loyalty by ensuring that the customer experience exceeds all expectations.

Today's Customers

Today's customers have more information available at their fingertips than ever before. They are educated, price conscious, and with so many new choices; more demanding.

Customers want value, exceptional service, assurance, and reliability.

Failing to provide total satisfaction with every business encounter will not deter customers from continuing to use shipping and mailing services; however they will take that business elsewhere. It is important to remember that a missed opportunity equals missed revenue. Quality end-to-end service is the key to success.

Building Customer Relationships

Positive Attitude

All employees must take every opportunity to turn each interaction into a positive one; by treating customers they way they expect to be treated.

Listening

If the customer knows that they have been heard, and their needs have been met, they feel valued.

Communication

Employees should be prepared to talk about products and services at a moments notice; and with potentially little time to convey the message.

Adapting to Change

All employees should speak about changes in a supporting way and act on changes in a building way.

Product Knowledge

Employees must be knowledgeable of all postal products and services to be able to provide solutions and reinforce that the customer has made the right choice.

Soliciting Customer Feedback

Feedback is an important part of building customer relationships. It is important to listen to customers for their concerns or recommendations.

Be the Best

Customers are our strength and our future and it is the responsibility of every employee to build and maintain positive customer relationships.

Today's Postal Service

Today's Postal Service offers reliability, convenience, and smart pricing; equating to a better value for customers. The Postal Service can deliver reliably at a better price than competitors can; creating customers for life and a strong future for everyone, organizationally and individually.

The Postal Service has offices in every city and town; providing a presence in every community with unmatched accessibility.

Online Products and Services

The USPS.com website enables business owners to ship packages without leaving their desk, order shipping supplies between meetings, or find out where a customer's package is in its destination.

Some products and services offered online are Shipping Assistant, Click-N-Ship, Carrier Pickup, Pickup on Demand, Cardstore, Direct Mail, and Premium Forwarding Service.

Other Products and Services

Postal Service offers other products and services to customers such as Self- Service Ship and Mail Centers, Stamps by Mail, Phone, and Fax, Forever Stamp, and Semi-Postal Stamps.

Employee Roles

The Postal Service maintains a workforce of 594,000 employees who regardless of their position play an important role in meeting customer needs and growing the business.

The Postal Service's strength is in its numbers and collectively, all employees can become a powerful force by educating customers about USPS.com and other postal products.

Postmasters

Postmasters are business leaders and community anchors. Business Connect allows them to make the local contacts the Postal Service needs to increase its share of the shipping market.

Sales and Services Associates

SSAs can match customers' shipping needs with premium services such as Priority Mail Express and Priority Mail; giving them personalized attention, which guarantees that they will get the right service at the lowest price.

Sales and services associates have a great impact on service by fully understanding all products and services and using that knowledge to increase business.

Carriers

Carriers grow the business by letting customers know about the pricing changes coming their way. Their relationship with the customer is one of the Postal Service's greatest assets that can be built upon to strengthen the organization and increase profitability.

Mail Processing Employees

Mail processing employees ensure that sort plans are correct and the greatest depth of sort is being met. All mail processing employees should work towards meeting the indicators of the 24-Hour Clock.

Mail processing employees have the same opportunities their retail and delivery co-workers do to generate new business via the "Submit a Lead" program.

Supervisors

In a processing and distribution environment, supervisors make sure that mail is processed and dispatched as required and ensure that employees come to work every day to meet workforce availability requirements.

Supervisors must ensure that throughput and productivity goals are attained or surpassed to achieve the goals of the 24-Hour Clock.

Maintenance

Maintenance employees ensure that mail processing equipment is properly maintained and that it will run at optimum capacity; resulting in maximum throughput and meeting or exceeding productivity goals.

Transportation

Transportation employees must ensure that collection mail arrives at the plant docks as early as possible and mail dispatched for delivery arrives at the carrier stations on time.

Strategic Partnerships

One of the Postal Services' strengths continues to be maintaining the most retail collection outlets (first mile) and the most door-to-door delivery service points (last mile).

This creates an incredible opportunity for revenue growth from shipping companies such as FedEx and UPS who can also save money by allowing the Postal Service to deliver the "first mile/last mile. Whenever the public and private sectors work together, the real beneficiary is the American public.

Postal Service and FedEx Partnership

Postal Service and FedEx give the American consumer greater choice, flexibility, and convenience while maintaining a high standard of fast, reliable, and efficient service.

Postal Service and UPS Partnership

Postal Service also has a partnership with UPS to provide airline transportation primarily for a portion of First-Class Mail and to a lesser extent a portion of Priority Mail volumes.

This newly established relationship with UPS will help to improve service levels on First-Class Mail.

Directives

Postal policies and procedures are an essential part of every business process. They tell our customers how to do business with us, and they give you the information you need to do your job.

Postal Service directives are available online via the Postal Service PolicyNet website.

Manuals that you will use most often are the Domestic Mail Manual (DMM), International Mail Manual (IMM), Administrative Support Manual (ASM), Postal Operations Manual (POM), and the Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM).

Domestic Mail Manual (DMM)

The DMM sets forth the policies, regulations and procedures governing domestic mail services.

Information contained in this manual includes; prices for postage and restrictions on its use, standards of the different classes of mail, and Special Services and conditions governing their use.

International Mail Manual (IMM)

The IMM sets forth the policies, regulations, and procedures governing International Mail services and is the equivalent of the DMM for International Mail.

Information contained in the IMM includes the policies and procedures pertaining to treatment of outbound mail and mailing conditions specific for each individual country

Administrative Support Manual (ASM)

The ASM contains policies and procedures for administrative and support functions within the Postal Service.

Some of the topics covered in the ASM include; the Postal Service organization, audits and investigations, communications, facilities and equipment, and the Privacy Act.

Postal Operations Manual (POM)

The POM sets forth the policies and procedures that govern operational functions of field organizations within the Postal Service.

The operational functions covered are retail, philatelic, collection, mail processing, transportation, and delivery and vehicle operations.

Employee and Labor Relations Manual (ELM)

The ELM sets forth the personnel policies and regulations governing employment within the Postal Service.

Subjects addressed in the ELM include; employment and placement, pay administration, employee benefits, training and development, safety, health and environment, and labor relations.

Handbooks

Handbooks supplement information contained within Postal Service manuals and provide more detailed information about the topic.

Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures*, offers standardized procedures for key field accounting activities.

By following the standard procedures contained in this handbook, Postal Service employees can perform financial transactions efficiently while creating consistent and accurate financial data. Many of the financial activities performed by an SSA are described in detail in the F-101.

Publications

Publications support subjects that cannot be fully addressed in manuals or handbooks and appear in a variety of formats such as books, brochures, and reports.

Publications generally do not focus on policy as extensively as manuals or on task descriptions as extensively as handbooks. Some publications that you might use as a sales and services associate include; Publication 2, *Packaging for Mailing*, Publication 28, *Postal Addressing Standards* and Publication 52, *Hazardous, Restricted, and Perishable Mail*.

Postal Bulletin

Retail updates are included in the bi-weekly Postal Bulletin. It is the official source of updates to postal policies and procedures and details updates and amendments to current directives.

The Postal Bulletin contains: new stamp issuance information, a list of missing, lost, or stolen postal money orders, and a list of invalid USPS Corporate Account numbers.

Forms

Forms can be accessed by clicking Forms located under Essential Links on the Bluepage. The Forms webpage contains electronic versions of official postal forms. Forms can be selected using the from title or form number.

HAZMAT

Hazardous materials are substances or materials containing a chemical or infectious biological substance in a quantity and/or form that may pose an unreasonable risk to health, safety, or property when transported in commerce, and which pose a risk to the safety and health of USPS employees if not handled properly.

Sales and services associates need to know what constitutes HAZMAT, how to identify HAZMAT, and how to safely handle HAZMAT.

Types of HAZMAT include:

- Flammable materials (can be in the form of a liquid, solid or gas)
- Corrosive materials (materials which will cause burns, irritate eyes, nose, and lungs)
- Reactive materials (when a material undergoes a chemical reaction, it is said to be reactive. Examples include; heat generation, fire, explosion, toxic gas/vapor production)
- Toxic materials (materials that have an adverse effect on the body, including allergic reactions, cancer, etc.)
- Biological materials (materials including body fluids such as blood, urine, poisonous insects, plants, and harmful microorganisms)
- Radioactive materials

Declared / Undeclared HAZMAT

Declared HAZMAT is mail that is properly packaged, marked and declared by the mailer, and which is properly accepted by the Postal Service in accordance with the DMM, and Publication 52.

Undeclared HAZMAT is any parcel suspected of containing acceptable or prohibited HAZMAT as described in the DMM and Publication 52, which is not properly packaged, labeled or identified.

If you suspect that a parcel may contain hazardous chemicals or infectious substances, you should pay attention to other indicators such as the following package characteristics:

- Sound of broken glass or plastic
- Stains or leakage, or unusual odor
- Delivery or return address information (i.e. Chemical company. Laboratory, etc.)
- Preprinted markings on parcel (i.e. bleach aerosol hair spray, etc.)

- Manufacturer's name (i.e. Joe's Chemicals, Butane Lighters R US, etc.)
- Shifting weight or liquid sound

HAZMAT must be separated from other mail and placed in a reliable steel container away from traffic flows. Do not place HAZMAT in a canvas hamper or in cardboard containers.

If you are uncertain as to the mailability, labeling or packaging requirements for any substance, contact your district Business Mail Entry Unit or the Pricing and Classification Service Center.

Prevent All Cigarette Trafficking (PACT) Act of 2009

Cigarettes and Smokeless Tobacco as Nonmailable Matter

What: The United States Postal Service cannot accept or transmit any package that it knows, or has reasonable cause to believe, contains nonmailable smokeless tobacco or cigarettes.

Cigarettes and smokeless tobacco shipments are banned from the mail if they do not fit in one of the following exceptions:

- *Alaska/Hawaii*: Shipments entirely within Alaska or Hawaii
- *Business/Regulatory Purposes*: Shipments transmitted between verified and authorized tobacco industry businesses for business purposes or between such businesses and federal or state agencies for regulatory purposes
- *Certain Individuals*: Infrequent, lightweight shipments mailed by age-verified adult individuals
- *Consumer Testing/Public Health*: Shipments of cigarettes sent by verified and authorized manufacturers to verified adult smokers age 21 and over for consumer testing purposes and shipments sent by federal agencies to consumers for public health purposes

When: A final rule to implement these changes was published in the *Federal Register* on May 27, 2010. The final rule was effective on June 29, 2010.

Why: These new rules result from the enactment of the Prevent All Cigarette Trafficking (PACT) Act, which was signed by the President on March 31, 2010.

Changes: Effective January 22, 2012, the Postal Service is revising the Mailing Standards of the United States Postal Service, *Domestic Mail Manual* (DMM) 601.11 to include the new extra services Adult Signature Required and Adult Signature Restricted Delivery in conjunction with Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail as a mailing option for customers mailing cigarettes and smokeless tobacco domestically under the "Business and Regulatory" exception and Adult Signature Restricted Delivery in conjunction with Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail for the "Consumer Testing" exception.

Note: Adult Signature is already a valid service option for customers mailing cigarettes and smokeless tobacco under the "Certain Individual" exception.

Details - Key elements of the final rule: Cigarettes and smokeless tobacco are nonmailable unless an exception applies.

All accepted shipments of cigarettes and smokeless tobacco must be presented in face-to-face transactions with USPS employees (this includes shipments with postage paid online or through commercial shippers).

Carrier Pickup™ and Pickup On Demand® Service are not permitted for excepted shipments.

Customers creating postage labels using Click-N-Ship® or Shipping Assistant® must bring their packages to a post office (excluding any contract retail unit) for mailing.

All excepted shipments of cigarettes must bear a unique marking on the address side of the package. Each exception category has its own marking.

With the exception of shipments entirely within Alaska and Hawaii, and to APO/FPO/DPO addresses, all exception shipments of cigarettes and smokeless tobacco must be sent via the following options:

1. Priority Mail Express ® Hold For Pickup
2. Priority Mail Express with Adult Signature Required or Adult Signature Restricted Delivery Extra Service (Adult Signature Restricted Delivery only for the "Consumer Testing" exception) is available for online and commercial customers only; however, shipment must be presented to a USPS employee at a post office
3. Priority Mail® with Adult Signature Required or Adult Signature Restricted Delivery extra service (Adult Signature Restricted Delivery only for the "Consumer Testing" exception) is available for online and commercial customers only; however, shipment must be presented to a USPS employee at a post office

For shipments from the United States to APO/FPO/DPO addresses, check the *Postal Bulletin* or the link at http://postcalc.usps.gov/Restrictions.aspx for tobacco restrictions, which apply to certain ZIP Codes, and confirm with a USPS employee that Priority Mail Express or Priority Mail with USPS Tracking is available to the desired destination.

When permitted, shipments of cigarettes and smokeless tobacco to APO/FPO/DPO addresses must use Priority Mail Express Military Service (PMEMS) "Priority Mail Express" or Priority Mail with USPS Tracking. Priority Mail Express Hold for Pickup, Adult Signature Required and Adult Signature Restricted Delivery are not available for shipments to APO/FPO/DPO addresses.

Other than shipments entirely within Alaska or Hawaii, absolutely no sales transactions of cigarettes or smokeless tobacco may be sent by mail. Business/government customers sending shipments under the "business/regulatory" and "consumer testing/public health" exceptions must apply for and receive an eligibility letter from the Pricing and Classification Service Center (PCSC) prior to mailing. This letter must be presented each time an excepted mailing is presented to a Postal Service employee at acceptance.

Shipments sent by business/government customers under the "business/regulatory" and "consumer testing/public health" exceptions must bear a return receipt (PS Form 3811) returnable to the PCSC PACT Mailing Office.

Delivery of cigarettes or smokeless tobacco mailed under the "consumer testing/public health" exception is restricted to the addressee, who must be at least 21 years of age.

Individuals sending shipments under the "certain individuals" exception must furnish proof of age at the time of mailing and must orally confirm that the addressee is of age to purchase tobacco at the place of destination. The operative legal age to purchase tobacco is age 18 in all states and U.S. territories and possessions, with the exception that the minimum age is 19 in the states of Alaska, Alabama, New Jersey, and Utah, and in Nassau, Onondaga, and Suffolk counties in New York.

Shipments sent under the "certain individuals" exception must be infrequent (no more than 10 shipments in any 30-day period) and weigh 10 ounces or less; however, no special weight limits apply to shipments entirely within Alaska and Hawaii.

Cigarettes and smokeless tobacco are prohibited in both inbound and outbound international mail.

Note: These rules do not apply to cigars, which continue to be mailable matter.

What you need to know:

Familiarize yourself with the contents of the Field Information Kit on the PACT Act 2009 located on the Customer Services Operations and Retail website, including service talks and other helpful information.

http://blue.usps.gov/customerservicesoperationsandretail/policyandprocedures/servicetalks/domesticservicetalks/pdf/pact_act_field_information_kit.pdf

Anonymous Mail

Aviation Mail Security program represents the commitment of the U.S. Postal Service to providing a safe environment for our customers, employees, and the traveling public.

The danger to life and property in the handling and transportation of Anonymous Mail is real.

Any mailpiece that bears only stamps as postage weighs more than 13 ounces and was not accepted by an employee at a retail service counter.

Anonymous mail is considered anonymous because it cannot be traced back to the sender.

The mission of the National Preparedness, Aviation Mail Security Program is to prevent anonymous mail from entering the system and promote the safety of all employees, customers, and transportation networks.

Identifiable Mail is categorized as identifiable because it can be traced back to the sender or the mailpiece point of entry into the mailstream.

Identifiable Mail includes postage that incorporates traceable information about the sender or stamped mail that was presented in person by a mailer at a retail window.

Identifiable Mail:

- Can bear electronic postage such as Postage Validation Imprints (PVI), meter strips, PC Postage, Click-N-Ship® and eStamps.
- Can also bear Self-Service Kiosk postage, permit imprint, or Aviation Security (AVSEC) Clearance Stamps.

Attachment of any of these items to the mailpiece makes the mailpiece identifiable because, if needed, the mailpiece can be traced back to the mailer or the mailpieces' point of entry into the mailstream.

Standard Operating Procedures

Aviation Security Anonymous Mail Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) explains the policies and procedures relating to the acceptance, handling, processing and transportation of anonymous mail.

Acceptance

All anonymous mail brought into your facility by carriers, collectors, or contract delivery service suppliers must be forwarded as quickly as possible to your facility's Anonymous Mail Unit (AMU).

You may not apply a $0.00 PVI, postal meter strip or AVSEC Clearance Stamp to anonymous mailpieces brought into your facility by carriers, collectors or contract delivery service suppliers, or to mailpieces found in unattended locations such as counters, docks; lobbies, or collection receptacles.

Mailpieces found in unattended locations must be screened for anonymous mail; anonymous mail must be isolated, placarded, and expedited to the facility's Anonymous Mail Unit for processing. If you are in doubt about how to handle a mailpiece, ask your supervisor for assistance.

When you are presented with this type of mail at the retail counter

- Weigh the mailpiece to determine if it weighs more than 13 ounce
- If so, then apply a $0.00 PVI or meter strip adjacent to the postage stamps, and cancel the postage stamps with a USPS postmark device or round dater that uses black ink.
- If the retail unit does not have the ability to apply a $0.00 PVI or postal meter strip, apply an ACSEC Clearance Stamp adjacent to the postage stamps to make the mailpiece identifiable.

Labels and Decals

In addition to the Standard Operating Procedures, the Decal DDD1-The 13 Ounce Rule, Label DDD2-Important Customer Information, and Label 127-Surface Transportation Only (No Fly Sticker) are used as part of the Anonymous Mail Program.

Decal DDD1, The 13 Ounce Rule

Decal DDD1 is attached to all mail receptacles, lobby drops, and Self-Service Kiosk collection receptacles. It explains to mailers that mailpieces weighing more than 13 ounces bearing stamps only as postage must be taken by the customer to a retail service counter a post office in order to be mailed.

Label DDD2 Important Customer Information label

Label DDD2 is attached to anonymous mailpieces being returned to customers and explains to customers that due to security requirements mailpieces weighing more than 13 ounces, bearing stamps only as postage must be taken by the customer to a retail service associate at a post office in order to be mailed.

Label 127 Surface Transportation Only

Label 127 is attached to anonymous mail being returned to customers and ensures that the mailpiece is returned to mailer by surface transportation only.

It is used in conjunction with a Label DDD2 for anonymous mailpieces being returned to the mailers. Once a mailpiece has been confirmed to be anonymous, a Label DDD2 and a Label 127 sticker are attached to the anonymous mailpiece.

Anonymous Mailpiece Reclassified as an Identifiable Mailpiece

Mailpieces weighing more than 13 ounces and bearing only stamps as postage can be reclassified as identifiable mail only if the customer delivers it in person to a retail window.

Affix a meter strip or $0.00 PVI label to the item to indicate that an employee at a retail counter has properly accepted the mailpiece.

If the acceptance office does not have the capability to affix a meter strip or $0.00 PVI to the mailpiece, you must apply an AVSEC Clearance Stamp to the mailpiece to indicate that it was accepted from a customer in a face-to-face transaction at a retail counter.

Mailpiece Bearing a Label DDD2

Occasionally, a customer may present an item for mailing that bears a Label DDD2, Customer Notification Sticker. Employees at a retail service counter presented with a mailpiece accepted directly from a customer bearing Label DDD2 should:

- Remove Label DDD2
- Remove Label 127
- Apply a $0.00 PVI, meter strip, or AVSEC Clearance Stamp as applicable adjacent to the postage stamps

- If the retail unit does not have the ability to apply a $0.00 PVI or postal meter strip to these mailpieces, an AVSEC Clearance Stamp should be applied adjacent to the postage stamps to make the mailpiece identifiable
- Cancel the postage stamps with a postmark device or round-dater stamp that uses black ink and is intended for that purpose

If customers have questions about these policies/procedures, refer them to the facilities postmaster or facility manager for assistance.

Domestic and International Claims

The vast majority of items shipped through the Postal Service arrive undamaged and within the appropriate delivery standard. But there are times when mail gets damaged during processing.

Domestic Claims

Customers must allow sufficient time for delivery of the mailpiece before they can initiate a Domestic Claim. Postal Service customers may file a Domestic Claim for packages that are lost, damaged or missing contents either online at USPS.com, by mail, or at a Postal Retail Unit (PRU).

Customers should file all claims for damaged or missing contents immediately, but they must file no later than 60 days from the date of mailing.

Customers can check the status of their claim online after 10 days via www.usps.com.

Customers must retain the damaged item and packaging in case presentation of the item to a PRU is required. Accounting Services will notify the customer by mail if they are required to present the damaged item and packaging to a Postal Retail Unit for verification.

PS Form 1000

Customers filing a Domestic Claim by mail must complete PS Form 1000, *Domestic or International Claim* and mail the completed PS Form 1000 to Accounting Services.

To document the value, the customer may provide a dated sales receipt, a dated invoice, a statement of value or appraisal from a reputable dealer, an estimate of repair costs, or a copy of a canceled check or money order. A statement of value from the customer is acceptable, but indemnity is limited to $100.

Customers may also submit a paid repair bill if the claim is for partial damage, but the repair costs may not exceed the original purchase price.

Customers presenting damaged items to support their claim must provide proof of damage that includes the actual item, the package, the wrapper, and all packaging materials.

Accepting a Claim

If you are accepting the claim, you must verify the damage and complete PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*.

To process the claim, you must verify that PS Form 1000 is complete and ensure that the required supporting documentation is attached and provide the customer with copies of PS Forms 1000, 3831, *Receipt for Articles(s) Damaged in Mails* and supporting documentation.

You should obtain a copy of the Accounting Services letter from the customer, take possession of the damaged item and packaging, and complete.

PS Form 3831, *Receipt for Articles(s) Damaged in Mails*

PS Form 3831, *Receipt for Articles(s) Damaged in Mails* is an acknowledgement that you have accepted the items in connection with a claim for indemnity.

Provide a copy of PS Form 3831 to the customer. The damaged article and packaging are retained by the Postal Service until the claim process is complete.

PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*

You must also complete PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents*. This form is for internal use only. This form should not be completed in the presence of the customer.

PS Forms 1000 and 2856, along with supporting documentation, are mailed daily to Accounting Services. Claims cannot be adjudicated at PRUs, they must be handled by the Accounting Service Center.

International Claims

Customers may file International Claims for Global Express Guaranteed (GXG), Priority Mail Express International, Registered items, and insured and ordinary parcels.

Claims for registered items and insured and ordinary parcels may not be filed until after an inquiry has been completed. Claims for items that have been damaged or have missing contents should be filed immediately.

Before a customer can initiate an inquiry on a missing item, they must allow sufficient time for the delivery of the mailpiece in that country. An inquiry for a Priority Mail Express International article can be filed no sooner than 3 days from the date of mailing and must be filed no later than 90 days from the date of mailing.

Postal Service International Inquiry Center (IIC)

To report the loss, damage, or missing contents of an article sent to a foreign country, customers must call the Postal Service International Inquiry Center (IIC) at 800-222-1811.

Customers will need to provide IIC with relevant information about the article. If the IIC determines that a claim for the item should be initiated, they will provide the customer with a claim packet. There are several different rules for International claims, and the process may be different depending on the destination country.

Claim Forms

Claims must be supported by PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents* for inbound registered items and insured and ordinary parcels received in damaged condition or with missing contents.

Accepting and International Claim

When accepting an International Claim, you must

- Verify that all of the applicable fields on PS Form 1000, *Domestic or International Claim*, are complete
- Verify the required supporting documentation, provide the customer with copies of PS Form 1000 and the supporting documents submitted with the claim
- Attach a completed PS Form 2856, *Damage Report of Insured Parcel and Contents* to the claim packet and mail it to International Claims, Accounting Services

Customers filing an International Claim for damaged or missing contents must present the damaged article, mailing container, wrapping, packaging, and any other content received to the post office for inspection.

To obtain the status or information regarding a filed claim, both customers and Postal Service employees may contact the Accounting Help Desk (AHD) at 866-974-2733.

Appeal a Claim Decision

When domestic insurance claims are denied, customers may appeal the decision by filing a written appeal and submitting it to Accounting Services. Customers have 60 days from the date of the original decision to file the appeal.

If a customer receives a check for less than the claimed amount, the customer may file a check protest appeal by submitting a written letter within 60 days of the date of the check. The appeal letter should be mailed to St. Louis Accounting Service Center.

Module 41: Union Model

Objectives:

Upon the completion of this module, you will be able to:

- Recognize improper security practices
- Ensure proper training with the OJI is conducted
- Explain Article 28 (Protection of each employee's rights)

Time Allocated for Module:

1 hour and 30 minutes

Instructional Methods:

- Lecture
- Discussion

Summary:

- Union Model

Participant Material Used:

- Participant Guide

Media Required:

- ACE Computer
- Projector
- PowerPoint presentation
- Rip Chart

Union Model

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-3. Refer participants to page 41-3 and lead a discussion on Article 28-Employer Claims covering shortages.

Employees must exercise reasonable care in protecting their stamp stock and cash while performing their duties.

- Audit or Count Drawers - A count of each employee's fixed credit must be conducted no less frequently than every four (4) months. A count of employee's cash credit is to be conducted at least once a month.
- Counts must take place away from the window. Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures,* states that the count should be conducted in a "quiet area." Counts should not be conducted at the window.
- Do not perform any transactions while a count is being conducted.
- Count your own drawer. Do not watch your supervisor count your drawer. Both the employee and the supervisor conduct counts. Handbook F-101 states that the employee must be given the opportunity to be present at the count.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-4.

- If you are out of tolerance (short or over), do not sign the count sheet. Request a re-count of your stock. Handbook F-101 states that a recount is only taken at the request of the employee, not of management. By signing the count sheet, the count is over.
- If there is a shortage, management must issue a letter of demand. Handbook F-101 states that all employees must receive written notice of money demand. Your supervisor must give you written notice and provide you with your rights to file a grievance. Do not pay just because a manager says you have to. You should request to talk with a steward. Any overage or shortage should immediately be placed in trust or suspense.
- If a grievance is initiated, regardless of the amount of the debt, collection of the debt will be delayed until the grievance is settled.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-5.

The employee has the right to decline to sign and/or take the exam if he/she feels that the training was not adequate. Upon completion of the classroom portion of the training, each employee will be assigned to an On the Job Instructor (OJI). The OJI will work with employee to cover items

that are necessary to perform the job properly. This includes retail equipment training.

The exam is now given after the classroom portion of the training, and prior to the on the job training.

Security Violations

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-6.

Adequate Security- Management is responsible to provide you with adequate security.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-7. Refer participants to page 41-4.

Locked drawers that can be opened without a key are an example of a violation which should be written up on the American Postal Workers Union (APWU) form "Report of Security Problem or Poor Financial Practice."

- Make a copy and submit the form to your supervisor for response. It does not need to be the APWU form, but it must be in writing.
- Locks must be changed on your drawer prior to it being issued to you. Handbook F-101 requires locks to be changed whenever an employee relinquishes control for any reason, usually when they bid out.
- Duplicate Key Envelope (PS Form 3977) - Envelopes must be checked every six (6) months to assure no one has tampered with it.
- Annual Lock and Key Examination - Handbook F-101 requires that a unit's supervisor must take an annual lock and key exam of all locks and keys in the unit, except for duplicate keys.
- Does or did anyone have access to your drawer? Handbook F-101 states no employee, supervisor, or Postmaster may have access to the stamp credit or cash credit of another employee.
- Stamp Orders - Handbook F-101 states that stamp orders are filled on a weekly basis.
- Count all Stamp Stock that is received. Stamp stock should not be given to clerks unless there is time available for the clerk to count the stamp stock. This should not be conducted between customers.

- No one else may work out of your drawer. Save all PS Form 1412, *Daily Financial Report*, PS Form1908, *Financial Adjustment Memorandum*, PS Form 17, *Stamp Requisition/Stamp Return* and PS Form 3294, *Cash and Stamp Stock Count and Summary*. Anything that will assist in tracing accountability.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-8.

Take the time to do things properly. If you are being pressured by a supervisor or postmaster into making errors or if you have any questions about financial accountability, see a union steward. Do not take risks that could lead to discipline.

- Were all of your postage stock and accountable items counted?
- Were you given an opportunity for rechecks of computations and a recount?
- Did you sign PS Form 3294 that you agreed to the count?
- Was the result of the count entered on PS Form 3368?
- Was your Step-1 grievance filed within 14 days of the date of the Letter of Demand?
- Are you provided with a locking drawer?
- Do you always lock your drawer if away for any reason?
- Have you exchanged stock without a PS Form 17?

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-9.

- Was a Letter of Demand issued?
- Was your stamp stock counted within four months?
- Was your cash credit counted within a month?
- Have you designated someone to count in your absence?
- Were you or your designee present at the count?
- Have you permitted anyone to work from your drawer?
- Do you get a receipt for all money turned in?
- Do you count all requisitions upon receipt?
- Have you reported faulty equipment as soon as it was discovered?

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-10.

- Do you show all transactions on PS Form 1412?
- At the end of a day, do you run adding machine tape(s) of money orders and fees in numerical sequence?
- Do you enter money order numbers at beginning and end of tapes(s)?
- Do you verify that all vouchers are accounted for?
- If you have missing voucher(s), is drawer counted immediately and overages entered into trust?
- Do you enter money orders and fees on PS Form 1412?
- Accepting checks. Was check accepted for money order or food stamps?

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-11.

- Was check made to Postmaster in the exact amount of transaction?
- Is a bad check list posted?
- Were proper procedures for check acceptance followed including all required forms of identification presented?
- Was the form of identification one of the following; driver's license, military I.D. card, passport, or state issued I.D. Other credentials showing the signature and having serial number or other information which can be traced?
- Did you compare the signature on the check with the identification?
- Did the signature match?
- Upon leaving unit such as transfer, separation, etc., were the locks changed?

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-12.

- Are master keys kept in PS Form 3977, and proper procedures followed?
- Is safe combination changed when a person knowing the combination is separated, transferred, etc.?
- Is overage in your trust fund?
- Do you have legal financial transactions with other employees? If so, please document.

- If overages/shortages are being applied to offset each other have you attached supporting documentation that provides the relationship between the two? Has permission been obtained by all involved parties?

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-13.

Best Practices

This list of best practices is designed to assist you in meeting your financial responsibilities as a sales and services associate.

- Scan and enter every sale item
- Input every transaction into POS ONE at the time of the transaction
- Do not make any personal transactions from your cash drawer to include making any exchange for change, cashing personal checks or money orders
- Avoid "GL Adjustments", "Error Corrects". "No Sales", etc. if possible. These types of transactions may give the appearance that funds are being manipulated
- If an error is made when issuing a PVI, complete and submit PS Form 3533 on the same day. Do not use the PVI on another transaction
- Always provide the customer with a receipt
- Never hold checks for any reason
- Always use money orders in sequential order
- Serve customers one-at-a-time
- Avoid interruptions during a transaction
- When you are away from the window, ensure that your cash drawer is locked
- Log off your POS ONE terminal when taking break or at lunch
- Ensure that you always count change back to the customer
- Verify that the money order is correct and the funds have been paid before providing the money order the customer

Facilitator: Demonstrate how to access Handbook F101.

Handbook F-101, *Field Accounting Procedures*, is your source for information on retail counter procedures. Please take the time to familiarize yourself with this valuable resource.

Article 28

Employer Claims

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-14. Refer participants to page 41-7.

The parties agree that continued public confidence in the Postal Service requires the proper care and handling of the USPS property, postal funds and the mails. In advance of any money demand upon an employee for any reason, the employee must be informed in writing and the demand must include the reasons therefore.

Section 1 Shortage in Fixed Credits

Employees who are assigned fixed credits or vending credits shall be strictly accountable for the amount of the credit. If any shortage occurs, the employee shall be financially liable unless the employee exercises reasonable care in the performance of his duties. In this regard, the Employer agrees to:

A. Continue to provide adequate security for all employees responsible for postal funds;

B. Prohibit an employee from using the fixed credit or other financial accountability of any other employee without permission;

C. Grant the opportunity to an employee to be present whenever that employee's fixed credit is being counted and if the employee is not available to have a witness of the employee's choice present;

D. Absolve an employee of any liability for loss from cashing checks if the employee follows established procedures; and

E. Count each employee's fixed credit no less frequently than every four months.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-15.

Article 28, Section 1, has been interpreted by arbitrators to allow management to hold any employee accountable for a shortage or loss, unless the union shows the employee has exercised reasonable care or established one of the enumerated defenses discussed in the following sections.

However, even in cases involving one of the enumerated defenses, that something else, such as a particular conservative arbitrators' decisions almost always turn on whether the grievant is negligent, the union must generally show failure by management, caused the loss, and that the grievant's negligence was not a contributing factor.

The responsibility of the union filling in possible gaps in evidence frequently leads to the denial of grievances, because in many cases, the specific transaction causing the loss in not known.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-16.

Sometimes, however, an arbitrator will modify a grievance where proof of causation is lacking, if there seems to be some injustice in holding the grievant liable. For example, where physical security or work procedures are very poor, or the grievant's work record is very good or long. When an arbitrator is moved by those factors, they will generally either:

- Split the loss on grounds of fairness; adopt a comparative negligence approach; or
- Shift the burden of proof to management to show for example, that a proven lack of security did not cause the loss, or that the grievant's negligence was actually a contributing factor.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-17.

The table specifies the tolerances for stamp/cash credits:

Amount of Stamp Stock	**Tolerance**
Up to $30,000.0	$50.00
$30,000.01 to $ 60,000.00	$100.00
Above $60,000.00	$150.00
Amount of Cash Credit	**Tolerance**
Up top $100.99	$10.00

The two leading causes of clerk shortages are in the selling of money orders and the failure to properly count money during a window transaction.

Facilitator: Show PowerPoint slide 41-18.

Collection Procedures

A. If a grievance is initiated and advanced through the grievance-arbitration procedure or a petition has been filed pursuant to the Debt Collection Act, regardless of the amount and type of debt, collection of the debt will be delayed until disposition of the grievance and/or petition has ()have) been had, either through settlement or exhaustion of contractual and/or administrative remedies,

B. No more than 15 percent of an employee's disposable pay or 20 percent of the employee's gross pay, whichever is lower, maybe deducted each pay period to satisfy a postal debt, unless the parties agree, in writing, to different amount.

Facilitator: Article 28 rights apply to PSEs.

Show PowerPoint slide 41-19.

Summary

Use the Report of Security Problem or Poor Financial Practice form provided by the APWU or other form to report security problems or financial practices that indicate security violations.

Appendix

Initial Process to Determine Price

Step 1: Determine Mailability

Items ¼ inch thick or less must be:

- Rectangular
- At least:
  - 3.5 inches in height
  - 5 inches in length
  - .007 inches in thickness

The length is the dimension parallel to the address as read.

Items that do not meet these standards are NOT mailable

Items over ¼ inch thick must:

Have enough surface area to place the postage and address on the same side of the item

Step 2: Determine Processing Category

The processing category is based strictly on the physical dimensions and characteristics of the mailpiece, regardless of address orientation. The five mail processing categories are: letters, flats, machinable parcels, irregular parcels, and outside parcels.

Letters	Minimum	Maximum
Dimensions: Height	3 ½ inches	6 ⅛ inches
Length	5 inches	11 ½ inches
Thickness	.007 inch	¼ inch
Weight	----	3.5 ounces

Characteristics:
- Rectangular

Flats	Minimum	Maximum
Dimensions: Height	6 ⅛ inches	12 inches
Length	11 ½ inches	15 inches
Thickness	¼ inch	¾ inch
Weight	----	----

Characteristics:
- Rectangular
- Flexible
- Uniformly Thick

Flats must exceed ONE of the maximum dimensions of a letter.

Machinable Parcels	Minimum	Maximum
Dimensions: Height	3 inches	17 inches
Length	6 inches	27 inches
Thickness	¼ inch	17 inches
Weight	6 ounces	25 pounds

Parcel Select and Parcel Return Service parcels may weigh up to 35 pounds except for books or printed matter. The maximum weight for these items is 25 pounds

Step 2: Determine Processing Category

Irregular Parcels	Minimum	Maximum
Dimensions: Height	3 inches	-----
Dimensions: Length	6 inches	-----
Dimensions: Thickness	¼ inch	-----
Weight	6 ounces	70 pounds

Irregular parcels also include :
- Rolls and tubes up to 26"
- Unwrapped, paper-wrapped, or sleeve-wrapped articles which are not letter-size or flat-size,
- Articles enclosed in envelopes that are not letter-size, flat-size or machinable parcels

*Irregular parcels **do not meet ONE or more** of the minimum dimensions of a machinable parcel.*

Outside Parcels	Minimum	Maximum
Dimensions: Height	17 inches	-----
Dimensions: Length	27 inches	-----
Dimensions: Thickness	17 inches	-----
Weight	25 pounds	70 pounds

Outside parcels also include :
- Rolls and tubes longer than 26"
- Metal band strapped boxes
- Metal and wood boxes
- Tires
- Trailer hitches
- Exhaust pipes
- Shrubs, and trees

*Outside parcels **exceed ONE or more** of the maximum dimensions of a machinable parcel.*

Step 3: Nonmachinable Characteristics

Machinable:
- Flats
- Machinable Parcel

Letters may be nonmachinable based on their characteristics

Nonmachinable:
- Irregular Parcel
- Outside Parcel

The nonmachinable surcharge applies to First-Class Mail letter-size pieces that weigh 3.5 ounces or less and have one or more of these characteristics:

- Aspect ratio is less than 1.3 or more than 2.5
- Booklet or folded self-mailer that is not tabbed per DMM
- Rigid
- Over 4-1/4 inches high or 6 inches long, the thickness is less than 0.009 inch.
- Letter enclosed in plastic or envelop that is not paper
- Clasp, string or similar closure
- Uneven thickness
- Delivery address parallel to shorter dimension

Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM) New Functionality Guide

06/14/12 (v1.00)

IMPORTANT: This guide is intended to be read by all POS ONE users no more than two weeks prior to the functionality being activated in their units.

Regarding the use of this guide: POS ONE training materials are produced by USPS Retail Operations and may be sent to the field electronically for the purpose of convenience, cost effectiveness and timely delivery. The materials are not to be electronically edited and reprinted without permission of Retail Operations.

Note: The sign in sheet at the back of this guide should be recorded and maintained locally.

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I. Front Office Changes

1. Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM)

Under **[Customer Services]**, the **<Pre-paid Mail Acceptance>>>** button has been changed to **<Pre-paid Mail / Shipment Acceptance>>>** and will include the new EDDM workflow.

When the **<Pre-paid Mail / Shipment Acceptance>>>** is selected, you will be taken to the current Pre-paid Mail Acceptance screen, with the new option **<Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM)>** added to the third button. See screen below.



This workflow will allow you to:

- Accept an EDDM mailing with an online receipt. (Note: online receipt is referring to PS Form 3587)
- Accept an EDDM mailing without an online receipt. (Note: online receipt is referring to PS Form 3587)

The workflows for each of these are described below.

Note: A customer has the option to pay for an EDDM mailing with a meter strip(s) as full or partial payment. The acceptance of the meter strip(s) is handled through the EDDM workflow. Any balance due will be handled through the current End of Visit payment screen.

All tenders are accepted for an EDDM mailing paid at the retail counter and the amount is posted to AIC 207.

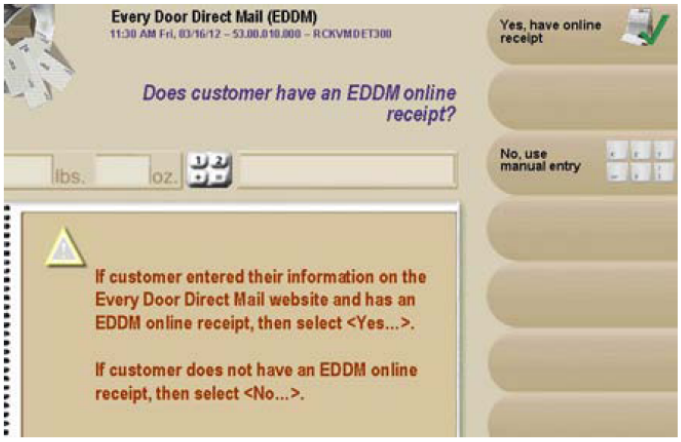
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A. EDDM Mailing with Online Receipt (PS Form 3587)

To accept an EDDM mailing with an online receipt (PS Form 3587) follow the steps below.

1. Press **[Customer Services]**.
2. Select **<Pre-paid Mail / Shipment Acceptance>>>**.
3. Select **<Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM)>**.

The screen below is displayed prompting you to indicate whether or not the customer has an EDDM online receipt.
Note: online receipt is referring to PS Form 3587.
See screen below.



4. Select **<Yes, have online receipt>**.
   Note: online receipt is referring to PS Form 3587
5. Scan the online receipt (PS Form 3587) barcode or enter the barcode number.

Note: Information concerning the mailing is now entered in the notebook area, including whether the postage amount was paid online or needs to be paid at the retail window. The screen below shows that the postage was paid for online.

Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM) New Functionality Guide v1.00



- If the customer has paid for the postage online, proceed to step 6.
- If the customer has not paid for the postage online but has a meter strip to pay for all or part of the postage, proceed to step 7.
- If the customer is paying for the postage at the retail counter, proceed to step 8.

6. If postage has been paid online, select **<Yes>** or **<No>** to the question "Any more Every Door Direct Mail for this customer?".
   A. Select **<Yes>** to repeat workflow and enter another EDDM mailing.
   B. Select **<No>** to return to the Domestic Mail screen and complete the customer visit.

If the postage has not been paid online, the screen below is displayed.



7. If the customer has a meter strip to pay for all or part of the mailing, select **<Meter Strip (Partial or Full Amount)>**.
   A. Enter the meter strip amount.
   Note: If the customer presents more than one meter strip, add the amount of each strip and enter the total.
   B. Select **<Continue>**.
   C. Select **<Yes>** or **<No>** to the question "Any more Every Door Direct Mail for this customer?".

D. Select **<Yes>** to repeat workflow and enter another EDDM mailing.

E. Select **<No>** to return to the Domestic Mail screen and complete the customer visit.

Note: The meter strip amount will reduce the total amount due. Any balance will be required to be paid at the end of the visit.

8. If the postage has not been paid online and the customer is not using a meter strip as payment, select **<Continue>**.
   Note: <Continue> will require the transaction to be paid in full at the end of the visit.

   A. Select **<Yes>** or **<No>** to the question "Any more Every Door Direct Mail for this customer?".

   B. Select **<Yes>** to repeat workflow and enter another EDDM mailing.

   C. Select **<No>** to return to the Domestic Mail screen and complete the customer visit.

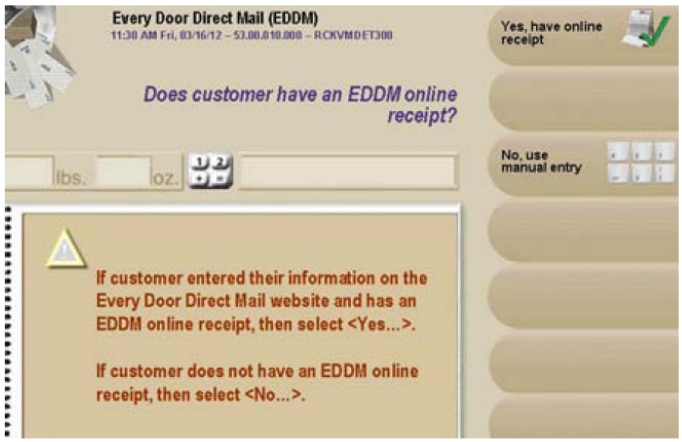
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B. EDDM Mailing without Online Receipt (PS Form 3587)

To accept an EDDM mailing without an online receipt (PS Form 3587) follow the steps below.

1. Press **[Customer Services]**.
2. Select **<Pre-paid Mail / Shipment Acceptance>>>**.
3. Select **<Every Door Direct Mail (EDDM)>**.

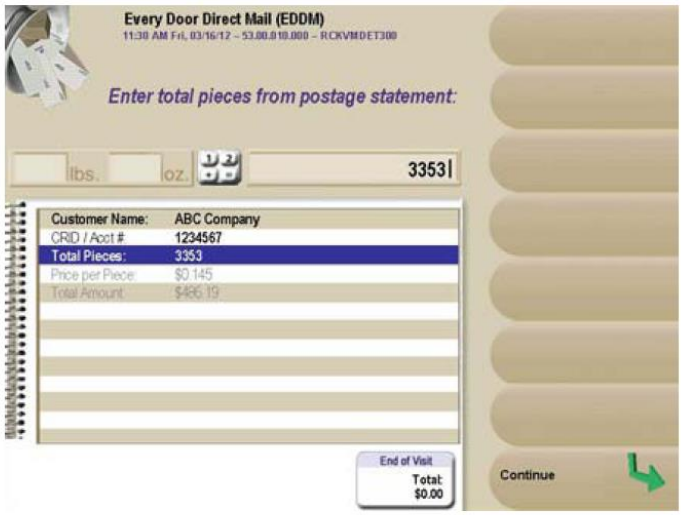
The screen below is displayed prompting you to indicate whether or not the customer has an EDDM online receipt.
Note: online receipt is referring to PS Form 3587.
See screen below.



4. Select **<No, use manual entry>**.
5. Enter the customer name from the postage statement.
6. Select **<Continue>**.
7. If available, enter the customer registration ID or account number from the postage statement.
8. Select **<Continue>**.
9. Enter the total pieces from the postage statement.
   Note: The maximum amount is currently set at 5000 pieces per transaction.

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10. The "Price per Piece" and "Total Amount" information is automatically populated after the total pieces are entered. This information cannot be edited. See screen below.



11. Select **<Continue>**.
12. If the customer has a meter strip to pay for partial or full amount of the mailing, select <Meter Strip (Partial or Full Amount>.
    A. Enter the meter strip amount.
       Note: If the customer presents more than one meter strip, add the amount of each strip and enter the total.
    B. Select **<Continue>**.

    Note: The meter strip amount will reduce the total amount due. Any balance will be required to be paid at the end of the visit.
13. If the customer is not using a meter strip as payment, select **<Continue>**.

    Note: <Continue> will require the transaction to be paid in full at the end of the visit.
14. Select **<Yes>** or **<No>** to the question "Any more Every Door Direct Mail for the customer".
    A. Select **<Yes>** to repeat workflow and enter another EDDM mailing.
    B. Select **<No>** to return to the Domestic Mail screen and complete the customer visit.

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II. Back Office Changes

2. Every Direct Door Mail - Unit Report

A new unit level report titled *Every Direct Door Mail - Unit*, will include all EDDM transactions (pre-paid and paid at the retail counter). The report will include the barcode scanned/entered, total number of pieces per EDDM transaction, and an indicator for pre-paid or paid at the retail counter.

If the mailing was paid at the retail counter, the report will indicate the amount paid.

The report will be sorted by clerk, and include a grand total of the number of EDDM transactions and the amount of pieces.

PACT ACT – Job Aid

Mailable Cigarettes and Smokeless Tobacco: Acceptance Rules

Exception	Type of Mailer	Return Receipt to PCSC Required?	Express Mail Hold For Pickup Available?	Express Mail and Priority Mail with Adult Signature[6/] Available?	Priority Mail with Delivery Confirmation Available?	Establish Eligibility to Mail?	Photo ID Required?	Special Marking Required?	Quantity Limit?	Frequency Limit?
Noncontiguous States (AK, HI)	Business/ Government/ individual	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes [1/]	No	No
Business/ Regulatory	Business /Government	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes, PCSC Letter required	No	Yes [2/]	No	No
Certain Individuals	Individual only, except for mail sent to APO/FPO/ DPO addresses	No	Yes	Yes	Yes, only shipments to APO/FPO/ DPO ZIP Codes	Yes, must affirm an individual addressee is higher of age 18 or minimum age to purchase tobacco[5/]	Yes, sender at least higher of age 18 or minimum age to purchase tobacco[5/]	Yes [3/]	10 oz. or less	≤10 mailings/30 days
Consumer Testing/Public health (cigarettes only)	Business/ Government	Yes	Yes	Yes (mailer must use Adult Signature Restricted Delivery)	No	Yes, PCSC letter required	No	Yes [4/]	12 packs of cigarettes	≤1 mailing/ 30 days per addressee

[1/] INTRASTATE SHIPMENT OF CIGARETTES OR SMOKELESS TOBACCO
[2/] PERMITTED TOBACCO MAILING – DELIVER ONLY TO ADDRESSED BUSINESS/AGENCY---- RECIPIENT MUST FURNISH PROOF OF AGE AND EMPLOYMENT
[3/] PERMITTED TOBACCO MAILING – DELIVER ONLY TO AGE-VERIFIED ADULT OF LEGAL AGE
[4/] PERMITTED TOBACCO MAILING – DELIVER ONLY TO ADDRESSEE UPON AGE VERIFICATION - AGE 21 OR ABOVE
[5/] Minimum legal age to purchase tobacco is age 18 in all states and U.S. territories and possessions, with the exception that the minimum age is 19 in the states of Alaska, Alabama, New Jersey, and Utah, and in Nassau, Onondaga, and Suffolk counties in New York.
[6/] Additional options include:

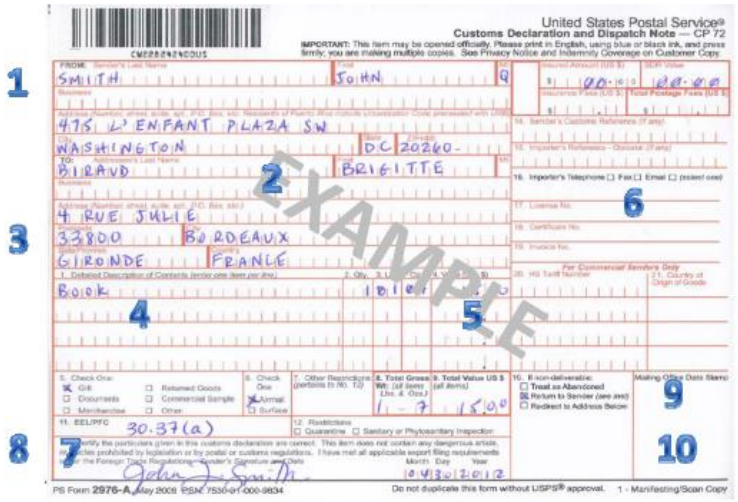
- Express Mail with Adult Signature Required or Adult Signature Restricted Delivery extra service (available to online and commercial customers only).
- Priority Mail with Adult Signature Required or Adult Signature Restricted Delivery extra service (available to online and commercial customers only).

Common Customs Declaration Errors – PS Form 2976-A

A guide for Retail Associates

Please review the shipment prior to acceptance scan.

1. The label was handwritten illegibly.	Please ask the customer to rewrite the label or enter the information into an electronic customs declaration form.
2. Sender and recipient names or addresses are not complete.	Confirm that the customer has listed the recipient's full name and address; first or last initials will not be accepted.
3. Shipping and customs declaration information are different.	The shipment will be returned to sender if not corrected.
4. Content description is generic .	The customer must be specific about the contents of the shipment. "Gifts," "Toys," or "Clothes" are not sufficient.
5. No value is provided for the item(s) in the shipment.	A dollar amount must be specified for each of the items.
6. Appropriate license information is not included.	The customer must include license information or confirm that their shipment is exempt from any license requirements.
7. Customs declaration form is not signed.	Even if the customs declaration form is created electronically, an original signature is required.
8. Customs form is not placed close to the shipping label.	To assist in the timely delivery of the shipment through the mailstream, the customer should place the labels together.
9. There is no round-date stamp.	After customs information has been entered into CBPMAN, any hand-written customs declaration forms must be round-date stamped before given an acceptance scan and sent for dispatch.
10. The round-date stamp covers the shipping information.	When placing the round-date stamp on the package, please be sure not to place it over shipping information.





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